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Grace, Actual and Habitual: A Dogmatic Treatise

Joseph Pohle

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Grace

Actual and Habitual

A Dogmatic Treatise

By

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INTRODUCTION

Humanity was reconciled to God by the Redemption. This does not, however, mean that every individual human being was forthwith justified, for individual justification is wrought by the application to the soul of grace derived from the inexhaustible merits of Jesus Christ.

There are two kinds of grace: (1) actual and (2) habitual. Actual grace is a supernatural gift by which rational creatures are enabled to perform salutary acts. Habitual, or, as it is commonly called, sanctifying, grace is a habit, or more or less enduring state, which renders men pleasing to God.

This distinction is of comparatively recent date, but it furnishes an excellent principle of division for a dogmatic treatise on grace.(1)

PART I. ACTUAL GRACE

Actual grace is a transient supernatural help given by God from the treasury of the merits of Jesus Christ for the purpose of enabling man to work out his eternal salvation.

We shall consider: (1) The Nature of Actual Grace; (2) Its Properties, and (3) Its Relation to Free-Will.

GENERAL READINGS:—St. Thomas, _Summa Theologica_, 1a 2ae, qu. 109-114, and the commentators, especially Billuart, _De Gratia_ (ed. Lequette, t. III); the

Salmanticenses, _De Gratia Dei_ (_Cursus Theologiae_, Vol. IX sqq., Paris 1870); Thomas de Lemos, _Panoplia Divinae Gratiae_, Liège 1676; Dominicus Soto, _De Natura et Gratia_, l. III, Venice 1560; *Ripalda,(2) _De Ente Supernaturali_, 3 vols. (I, Bordeaux 1634; II, Lyons 1645; III, Cologne 1648).

*C. v. Schäzler, _Natur und Übernatur: Das Dogma von der Gnade_, Mainz 1865; IDEM, _Neue Untersuchungen über das Dogma von der Gnade_, Mainz 1867; *J. E. Kuhn, _Die christliche Lehre von der göttlichen Gnade_, Tübingen 1868; Jos. Kleutgen, S. J., _Theologie der Vorseit_, Vol. II, 2nd ed., pp. 152 sqq., Münster 1872; R. Cercià, _De Gratia Christi_, 3 vols., Paris 1879; *C. Mazzella, S. J., _De Gratia Christi_, 4th ed., Rome 1895; *J. H. Oswald, _Die Lehre von der Heiligung, d. i. Gnade, Rechtfertigung, Gnadenwahl_, 3rd ed., Paderborn 1885; *D. Palmieri, S. J., _De Gratia Divina Actuali_, Gulpen 1885; *Heinrich-Gutberlet, _Dogmatische Theologie_, Vol. VIII, Mainz 1897; *S. Schiffini, S. J., _De Gratia Divina_, Freiburg 1901; G. Lahousse, S. J., _De Gratia Divina_, Louvain 1902; Chr. Pesch, S. J., _Praelectiones Dogmaticae_, Vol. V, 3rd ed., Freiburg 1908; G. van Noort, _De Gratia Christi_, Amsterdam 1908; E. J. Wirth, _Divine Grace_, New York 1903; S. J. Hunter, S. J., _Outlines of Dogmatic Theology_, Vol. III, pp. 1 sqq.; Wilhelm-Scannell, _A Manual of Catholic Theology_, Vol. II, 2nd ed., pp. 227 sqq., London 1901; A. Devine, _The Sacraments Explained_, 3rd ed. pp. 1-43, London 1905.—L. Labauche, S. S., _God and Man, Lectures on Dogmatic Theology II_, pp. 123 sqq., New York 1916.—J. E. Nieremberg, S. J., _The Marvels of Divine Grace_, tr. by Lady Lovat, London 1917.

On the teaching of the Fathers cfr. Isaac Habert, _Theologiae Græcorum Patrum Vindicatae circa Universam Materiam Gratiae Libri III_, Paris 1646; E. Scholz, _Die Lehre des hl. Basilius von der Gnade_, Freiburg 1881; Hümmer, _Des hl. Gregor von Nazianz Lehre von der Gnade_, Kempten 1890; E. Weigl, _Die Heilslehre des hl. Cyrill von Alexandrien_, Mainz 1905.

Chapter I. The Nature Of Actual Grace

Section 1. Definition Of Actual Grace

1. GENERAL NOTION OF GRACE.—The best way to arrive at a correct definition of actual grace is by the synthetic method. We therefore begin with the general notion of grace.

Like “nature,”(3) grace (_gratia_, χάρις) is a word of wide reach, used in a great variety of senses. Habert(4) enumerates no less than fourteen; which, however, may be reduced to four.

a) Subjectively, grace signifies good will or benevolence shown by a superior to an inferior, as when a criminal is pardoned by the king’s grace.

b) Objectively, it designates a favor inspired by good will or benevolence. In this sense the term may be applied to any free and gratuitous gift (_donum gratis datum_), as when a king bestows graces on his lieges.

c) Grace may also mean personal charm or attractiveness. In this sense the term frequently occurs in Latin and Greek literature (the Three Graces). Charm elicits love and prompts a person to the bestowal of favors.

d) The recipient of gifts or favors usually feels gratitude towards the giver, which he expresses in the form of thanks. Hence the word _gratiae_ (plural) frequently stands for thanksgiving ("_gratias agere_," "_Deo gratias_," "to say grace after meals").(5)

The first and fundamental of these meanings is "a free gift or favor." The benevolence of the giver and the attractiveness of the recipient are merely the reasons for which the gift is imparted, whereas the expression of thanks is an effect following its bestowal.

Dogmatic theology is concerned exclusively with grace in the fundamental sense of the term.

e) Grace is called a gift (_donum_, δωρεά), because it is owing to free benevolence, not required by justice. It is called gratuitous (_gratis datum_), because it is bestowed without any corresponding merit on the part of the creature. A gift may be due to the recipient as a matter of distributive or commutative justice, and in that case it would not be absolutely gratuitous (_gratis_). Grace, on the contrary, is bestowed out of pure benevolence, from no other motive than sheer love. This is manifestly St. Paul's idea when he writes: "And if by grace, it is not now by works: otherwise grace is no more grace."(6) It is likewise the meaning of St. Augustine when he says, in his Homilies on the Gospel of St. John, that grace is "something gratuitously given ... as a present, not in return for something else."(7)

2. NATURAL AND SUPERNATURAL GRACE.—Grace is not necessarily supernatural. Sacred Scripture and the Fathers sometimes apply the word to purely natural gifts. We petition God for our daily bread, for good health, fair weather and other temporal favors, and we thank Him for preserving us from pestilence, famine, and war, although these are blessings which do not transcend the order of nature.(8)

a) Our petitions for purely natural favors are inspired by the conviction that creation itself, and everything connected therewith, is a gratuitous gift of God. This conviction is well founded. God was under no necessity of creating anything: creation was an act of His free-will. Again, many of the favors to which human nature, as such, has a claim, are free gifts when conferred upon the individual. Good health, fortitude, talent, etc., are natural graces, for which we are allowed, nay obliged, to petition God. The Pelagians employed this truth to conceal a pernicious error when they unctuously descanted on the magnitude and necessity of grace as manifested in creation. It was by such trickery that their leader succeeded in persuading the bishops assembled at the Council of Diospolis or Lydda (A. D. 415) that his teaching was quite orthodox. St. Augustine and four other African bishops later reported to Pope Innocent I, that if these prelates had perceived that Pelagius meant to deny that grace by which we are Christians and sons of God, they would not have listened to him so patiently, and that, consequently, no blame attached to these judges because they simply took the term "grace" in its ecclesiastical sense.(9)

b) Generally speaking, however, the term “grace” is reserved for what are commonly called the supernatural gifts of God, the merely preternatural as well as the strictly supernatural.(10) In this sense "grace" is as sharply opposed to purely natural favors as nature is opposed to the supernatural.

The importance of the distinction between supernatural and purely natural grace will appear from an analysis of the concept itself. Considered as gifts of God, the strictly supernatural graces (_e.g._, justification, divine sonship, the beatific vision) ontologically exceed the bounds of nature. Considered as purely gratuitous favors, they are negatively and positively undeserved. The grace involved in creation, for instance, is not conferred on some existing beneficiary, but actually produces its recipient. The creation itself, therefore, being entirely _gratis data_, all that succeeds it, supernatural grace included, must be negatively undeserved, in as far as it was not necessary for the recipient to exist at all. But the supernatural graces are _indebitae_ also positively, _i.e._ positing the creation, because they transcend every creatural claim and power. Both elements are contained in the above-quoted letter of the African bishops to Pope Innocent I: “Though it may be said in a certain legitimate sense, that we were created by the grace of God, ... that is a different grace by which we are called predestined, by which we are justified, and by which we receive eternal beatitude.”(11) Of this last-mentioned grace (_i.e._ grace in the strictly supernatural sense), St. Augustine says: “This, the grace which Catholic bishops are wont to read in the books of God and preach to their people, and the grace which the Apostle commends, is not that by which we are created as men, but that by which as sinful men we are justified.”(12) In other words, natural is opposed to supernatural grace in the same way that nature is opposed to the supernatural. “[To believe] is the work of grace, not of nature. It is, I say, the work of grace, which the second Adam brought us, not of nature, which Adam wholly lost in himself.”(13) Adding the new note obtained by this analysis we arrive at the following definition: Grace is a gratuitous _super-natural_ gift.(14)

3. THE GRACE OF GOD AND THE GRACE OF CHRIST.—Though all supernatural graces are from God, a distinction is made between the “grace of God” and the “grace of Christ.” The difference between them is purely accidental, based on the fact that the “grace of Christ” flows exclusively from the merits of the atonement.

a) The following points may serve as criteria to distinguish the two notions:

A) The _gratia Dei_ springs from divine benevolence and presupposes a recipient who is unworthy merely in a negative sense (=not worthy, _non dignus_), whereas the _gratia Christi_ flows from mercy and benevolence and is conferred on a recipient who is positively unworthy (_indignus_).

B) The _gratia Dei_ elevates the soul to the supernatural order (_gratia elevans_), while the _gratia Christi_ heals the wounds inflicted by sin, especially concupiscence (_gratia elevans simul et sanans_).

C) The _gratia Dei_ is a gratuitous gift conferred by the Blessed Trinity without regard to the theandric merits of Jesus Christ, whereas the _gratia Christi_ is based entirely on those merits.

b) The Scotists hold that the distinction between _gratia Dei_ and _gratia Christi_ is purely logical. They regard the God-man as the predestined centre of the universe and the source of all graces.(15) The Thomists, on the other hand, regard the grace of the angels, and that wherewith our first parents were endowed in Paradise, purely as _gratia Dei_; they hold that the merits of Christ did not become operative until after the Fall, and that, consequently, there is a real distinction between the grace of the angels and that of our first parents on the one hand, and the grace of Christ on the other.

As it cannot reasonably be supposed that the angels are endowed with specifically the same graces by which mankind was redeemed from sin, the Scotists are forced to admit a distinction between the grace of Christ as God-man (_gratia Christi Dei-hominis_) and the grace of Christ as Redeemer (_gratia Christi Redemptoris_), so that even according to them, the dogmatic treatise on Grace is concerned solely with the grace of Christ _qua_ Redeemer.

Hence, grace must be more particularly defined as a gratuitous supernatural gift _derived from the merits of Jesus Christ_.(16)

4. EXTERNAL AND INTERNAL GRACE.—External grace (_gratia externa_) comprises all those strictly supernatural institutions which stimulate pious thoughts and salutary resolutions in the human soul. Such are, for example, Holy Scripture, the Church, the Sacraments, the example of Jesus Christ, etc. Internal grace (_gratia interna_) inheres or operates invisibly in the soul, and places it in relation with God as its supernatural end. Internal graces are, _e.g._, the theological virtues, the power of forgiving sins, etc. The Pelagians admitted external, but obstinately denied internal grace.(17)

St. Paul(18) emphasizes the distinction between external and internal grace by designating the former as “law” (_lex_, νόμος) and the latter as “faith” (_fides_, πίστις). With one exception, (_viz._, the Hypostatic Union, which is the climax of all graces), external is inferior to, because a mere preparation for, internal grace, which aims at sanctification. We are concerned in this treatise solely with internal grace. Hence, proceeding a step further, we may define grace as a gratuitous, supernatural, _internal_ gift of God, derived from the merits of Jesus Christ.(19)

5. “GRATIA GRATIS DATA” and “GRATIA GRATUM FACIENS.”—The supernatural grace of Christ, existing invisibly in the soul either as a transient impulse (_actus_) or as a permanent state (_habitus_), tends either to the salvation of the person in whom it inheres or through him to the sanctification of others. In the former case it is called ingratiating (_gratia gratum faciens_), in the latter, gratuitously given (_gratia gratis data_). The term _gratia gratis data_ is based on the words of our Lord recorded in the Gospel of St. Matthew: “Heal the sick, raise the dead, cleanse the lepers, cast out devils: freely have you received, freely give.”(20)

a) The _gratia gratum faciens_ is intended for all men without exception; the _gratia gratis data_ only for a few specially chosen persons. To the class of gratuitously bestowed graces belong the charismata of the prophets and the ordinary powers of the priesthood.(21)

Each of these two species of internal grace may exist independently of the other because personal holiness is not a necessary prerequisite for the exercise of the charismata or the power of forgiving sins, etc.

b) Considered with regard to its intrinsic worth, the _gratia gratum faciens_ is decidedly superior to the _gratia gratis data_. St. Paul, after enumerating all the charismata, admonishes the Corinthians: “Be zealous for the better gifts, and I show unto you yet a more excellent way,”(22) and then sings the praises of charity:(23) “If I speak with the tongues of men and of angels, and have not charity, I am become as sounding brass, or a tinkling cymbal. And if I should have prophecy and should know all the mysteries, and all knowledge, and if I should have all faith, so that I could remove mountains, I am nothing, etc.”(24) Charity is a _gratia gratum faciens_. Hence, since the _gratia gratis data_ is treated elsewhere (Apologetics, Mystic and Sacramental Theology), we must add another note to our definition: Grace is a gratuitous, supernatural, internal gift, derived from the merits of Jesus Christ, _by which man is rendered pleasing in the sight of God_.(25)

6. ACTUAL AND HABITUAL GRACE.—The _gratia gratum faciens_ is given either for the performance of a supernatural act or for the production of a permanent supernatural state (_habitus_). In the latter case it is called habitual, or, as it sanctifies the creature in the eyes of God, sanctifying grace.

Actual grace comprises two essential elements: (1) divine help as the principle of every salutary supernatural act, and (2) the salutary act itself. Hence its designation by the Fathers as Θεοῦ ἐνέργεια, ἡ τοῦ Λόγου χείρ, θεία κίνησις, or, in Latin, _Dei auxilium, subsidium, adiutorium, motio divina_,—all of which appellations have been adopted by the Schoolmen. Actual grace invariably tends either to produce habitual or sanctifying grace, or to preserve and increase it where it already exists. It follows that, being merely a means to an end, actual grace is inferior to sanctifying grace, which is that end itself.

Actual grace may therefore be defined as an unmerited, supernatural, internal divine help, based on the merits of Jesus Christ, which renders man pleasing in the sight of God, enabling him to perform salutary acts; or, somewhat more succinctly, as a supernatural help bestowed for the performance of salutary acts, in consideration of the merits of Jesus Christ.

Actual grace is (1) a _help_ (_auxilium_), because it consists in a transient influence exercised by God on the soul. (2) A _supernatural_ help, to distinguish it from God’s ordinary providence and all such merely natural graces as man would probably have received in the state of pure nature.(26) (3) It is attributed to the merits of Jesus Christ, in order to indicate that the graces granted to fallen man are all derived from the atonement both as their efficient and their meritorious cause. (4) Actual grace is said to be given for the performance of salutary acts to show that its immediate purpose or end is an act, not a state, and that the acts for which it is given must be in the order of salvation.

7. THE TWOFOLD CAUSALITY OF ACTUAL GRACE.—If grace is a supernatural help, mere nature cannot, of its own strength, perform salutary acts. Consequently,

actual grace exercises a causal influence without which man would be helpless in the matter of salvation.

The causality of actual grace is both moral and physical.

a) As a moral cause grace removes the obstacles which render the work of salvation difficult. Besides this negative it also has a positive effect: it inspires delight in virtue and hatred of sin.

This mode of operation manifestly presupposes a certain weakness of the human will, _i.e._ _concupiscence_, which is an effect of original sin. Actual grace exercises a healing influence on the will(27) and is therefore called _gratia sanans sive medicinalis_. “Unless something is put before the soul to please and attract it,” says St. Augustine, “the will can in no wise be moved; but it is not in man’s power to bring this about.”(28) Concretely, this moral causality of grace manifests itself as a divinely inspired joy in virtue and a hatred of sin, both of which incline the will to the free performance of salutary acts. These sentiments may in some cases be so strong as to deprive the will temporarily of its freedom to resist. The sudden conversion of St. Paul is a case in point. Holy Scripture expressly assures us that God is the absolute master of the human will and, if He so chooses, can bend it under His yoke without using physical force. Cfr. Prov. XXI, 1: “The heart of the king is in the hand of the Lord: whithersoever he will, he shall turn it.” “Who will be so foolish as to say,” queries St. Augustine, “that God cannot change the evil wills of men, whichever, whenever, and wheresoever He chooses, and direct them to what is good?”(29) It is but rarely, of course, that God grants to any man a summary victory over his sinful nature; but this fact does not prevent the Church from praying: “Vouchsafe, O Lord, to compel our wills to thee, even though they be rebellious.”(30)

b) Even more important than the moral causality of grace is its physical causality. Man depends entirely on God for the physical strength necessary to perform salutary works. Grace elevates the faculties of the soul to the supernatural sphere, thereby enabling it to perform supernatural acts.

Physical is as distinct from moral causality in the order of grace as in the order of nature. The holding out of a beautiful toy will not enable a child to walk without support from its elders. Moral causality is insufficient to enable a man to perform salutary acts. Grace (as we shall show later) is absolutely, _i.e._ metaphysically, necessary for all salutary acts, whether easy or difficult, and hence the incapacity of nature cannot be ascribed solely to weakness and to the moral difficulty resulting from sin, but must be attributed mainly to physical impotence. A bird without wings is not merely impeded but utterly unable to fly; similarly, man without grace is not only handicapped but absolutely incapacitated for the work of salvation. Considered under this aspect, actual grace is called _gratia elevans_, because it elevates man to the supernatural state.(31)

This double causality of grace is well brought out in Perrone’s classic definition: “_Gratia actualis est gratuitum illud auxilium,_(_32_)_ quod Deus_(_33_)_ per Christi merita_(_34_)_ homini lapso_(_35_)_ largitur, tum ut eius infirmitati consulat,_(_36_)_ ... tum ut eum erigat ad statum supernaturalem atque idoneum faciat ad actus

supernaturales eliciendos,_(_37_)_ ut iustificationem possit adipisci_(_38_)_ in eaque iam consecuta perseverare, donec perveniat ad vitam aeternam._”(39) In English: “Actual grace is that unmerited interior assistance which God, by virtue of the merits of Christ, confers upon fallen man, in order, on the one hand, to remedy his infirmity resulting from sin and, on the other, to raise him to the supernatural order and thereby to render him capable of performing supernatural acts, so that he may attain justification, persevere in it to the end, and thus enter into everlasting life.” This definition is strictly scientific, for it enumerates all the elements that enter into the essence of actual grace.

Section 2. Division Of Actual Grace

Actual grace may be divided according to: (1) the difference existing between the faculties of the human soul, and (2) in reference to the freedom of the will.

Considered in its relation to the different faculties of the soul, actual grace is either of the intellect, or of the will, or of the sensitive faculties. With regard to the free consent of the will, it is either (1) prevenient, also called coöperating, or (2) efficacious or merely sufficient.

1. THE ILLUMINATING GRACE OF THE INTELLECT.—Actual grace, in so far as it inspires salutary thoughts, is called illuminating (_gratia illuminationis s. illustrationis_).

This illumination of the intellect by grace may be either mediate or immediate. It is mediate if grace suggests salutary thoughts to the intellect by purely natural means, or external graces, such as a stirring sermon, the perusal of a good book, etc.; it is immediate when the Holy Ghost elevates the powers of the soul, and through the instrumentality of the so-called _potentia obedientialis_,(40) produces in it entitatively supernatural acts.

The existence of the grace of immediate illumination follows from its absolute necessity as a means of salvation, defined by the Second Council of Orange, A. D. 529.(41)

a) The grace of mediate illumination may be inferred aprioristically from the existence of a divine revelation equipped with such supernatural institutions as the Bible, the sacraments, rites, ceremonies, etc. In conformity with the psychological laws governing the association of ideas, intelligent meditation on the agencies comprised under the term “external grace”(42) elicits in the mind salutary thoughts, which are not necessarily supernatural in their inception.

It is not unlikely that Sacred Scripture refers to such graces as these when it recommends “the law of God” or “the example of Christ” as fit subjects for meditation. Cfr. Ps. XVIII, 8 sq.: “The law of the Lord is unspotted, converting souls, ... the commandment of the Lord is lightsome, enlightening the eyes.”(43) 1 Pet. II, 21: “Christ also suffered for us, leaving you an example that you should follow his steps.”(44) St. Augustine probably had in mind the grace of mediate illumination when he wrote: “God acts upon us by the incentives of visible objects to will and to

believe, either externally by evangelical exhortations, ... or internally, as no man has control over what enters into his thoughts."(45) The grace of mediate illumination has for its object to prepare the way quietly and unostentatiously for a grace of greater import, namely, the immediate illumination of the mind by the Holy Ghost.

b) The grace of immediate far surpasses that of mediate illumination because the supernatural life of the soul originates in faith, which in turn is based on a strictly supernatural enlightenment of the mind.

α) St. Paul expressly teaches: "And such confidence we have, through Christ, towards God; not that we are sufficient to think anything of ourselves, as of ourselves: but our sufficiency is of God."(46)

The salient portion of this text reads as follows in the original Greek: Οὐχ ὅτι ἱκανοί ἐσμεν λογίσασθαί τι ἀφ᾽ ἑαυτῶν ὡς ἐξ ἑαυτῶν, ἀλλ᾽ ἡ ἱκανότης ἡμῶν ἐκ τοῦ Θεοῦ. Speaking in the plural (_pluralis maiestaticus_), the Apostle confesses himself unable to conceive a single salutary thought (λογίσασθαι), and ascribes the power (ἱκανότης) to do so to God. Considered merely as vital acts, such thoughts proceed from the natural faculties of the mind (ἀφ᾽ ἑαυτῶν), but the power that produces them is divine (ἐκ Θεοῦ), not human (ἐξ ἑαυτῶν). Hence each salutary thought exceeds the power of man, and is an immediate supernatural grace.

A still more cogent argument can be derived from 1 Cor. III, 6 sq.: "I have planted, Apollo watered, but God gave the increase. Therefore, neither he that planteth is anything, nor he that watereth; but God that giveth the increase."(47) In this beautiful allegory the Apostle compares the genesis of supernatural faith in the soul to that of a plant under the care of a gardener, who while he plants and waters, yet looks to God for "the increase." The Apostle and his disciple Apollo are the spiritual gardeners through whose preaching the Corinthians received the grace of mediate illumination. But, as St. Paul says, this preaching would have been useless (_non est aliquid_) had not God given "the increase." In other words, the grace of immediate illumination was necessary to make the Apostolic preaching effective. "For," in the words of St. Augustine, "God Himself contributes to the production of fruit in good trees, when He both externally waters and tends them by the agency of His servants, and internally by Himself also gives the increase."(48)

β) The argument from Tradition is based chiefly on St. Augustine, "the Doctor of Grace," whose authority in this branch of dogmatic theology is unique.(49) His writings abound in many such synonymous terms for the grace of immediate illumination, as _cogitatio pia, vocatio alta et secreta, locutio in cogitatione, aperitio veritatis_, etc., etc.

He says among other things: "Instruction and admonition are external aids, but he who controls the hearts has his cathedra in heaven."(50) Augustine esteems human preaching as nothing and ascribes all its good effects to grace. "It is the internal Master who teaches; Christ teaches and His inspiration."(51) In harmony with his master, St. Fulgentius of Ruspe, the ablest defender of the Augustinian (_i.e._ Catholic) doctrine of grace, says: "In vain will our sacred discourses strike the external ear, unless God by a spiritual gift opens the hearing of the interior man."(52)

2. THE STRENGTHENING GRACE OF THE WILL.—This grace, usually called _gratia inspirationis_,(53) may also be either mediate or immediate, according as pious affections and wholesome resolutions are produced in the soul by a preceding illumination of the intellect or directly by the Holy Ghost. Owing to the psychological interaction of intellect and will, every grace of the mind, whether mediate or immediate, is _eo ipso_ also a mediate grace of the will, which implies a new act of the soul, but not a new grace. What we are concerned with here is the immediate strengthening grace of the will, which is far more important and more necessary.

We are not able to demonstrate this teaching from Sacred Scripture. The texts John VI, 44 and Phil. II, 13, which are usually adduced in this connection, are inconclusive.

Hence we must rely solely on Tradition. The argument from Tradition is based mainly on St. Augustine. In defending divine grace against Pelagius, this holy Doctor asserts the indispensability and superior value of the strengthening grace of the will.

“By that grace it is effected, not only that we discover what ought to be done, but also that we do what we have discovered; not only that we believe what ought to be loved, but also that we love what we have believed.”(54) And again: “Let him discern between knowledge and charity, as they ought to be distinguished, because knowledge puffeth up, but charity edifieth.... And inasmuch as both are gifts of God, although one is less and the other greater, he must not extol our righteousness above the praise which is due to Him who justifies us in such a way as to assign to the lesser of these two gifts the help of divine grace, and to claim the greater one for the control of the human will.”(55) St. Augustine emphasized the existence and necessity of this higher grace of the will in his controversy with the Pelagians. He was firmly convinced that a man may know the way of salvation, and yet refuse to follow it.(56) He insisted that mere knowledge is not virtue, as Socrates had falsely taught.

Ecclesiastical Tradition was always in perfect accord with this teaching, which eventually came to be defined by the plenary Council of Carthage (A. D. 418) as follows: “If any one assert that this same grace of God, granted through our Lord Jesus Christ, helps to avoid sin only for the reason that it opens and reveals to us an understanding of the [divine] commands, so that we may know what we should desire and what we should avoid; but that it is not granted to us by the same (grace) to desire and be able to do that which we know we ought to do, let him be anathema;—since both are gifts of God: to know what we must do and to have the wish to do it.”(57)

Like the illuminating grace of the intellect the strengthening grace of the will effects vital acts and manifests itself chiefly in what are known as the emotions of the will. St. Prosper, after Fulgentius the most prominent disciple of St. Augustine, enumerates these as follows: “Fear (for ‘the fear of the Lord is the beginning of wisdom’); joy (‘I rejoiced at the things that were said to me: We shall go into the house of the Lord’); desire (‘My soul longeth and fainteth for the courts of the Lord’); delight (‘How sweet are thy words to my palate, more than honey to my mouth’);”—and he adds: “Who can see or tell by what affections God visits and guides

the human soul?”(58)

3. ACTUAL GRACES OF THE SENSITIVE SPHERE.—Though it cannot be determined with certainty of faith, it is highly probable that actual grace influences the sensitive faculties of the soul as well as the intellect and the will.

God, who is the first and sole cause of all things, is no doubt able to excite in the human imagination phantasms corresponding to the supernatural thoughts produced in the intellect, and to impede or paralyze the rebellious stirrings of concupiscence which resist the grace of the will,—either by infusing contrary dispositions or by allowing spiritual joy to run over into the _appetitus sensitivus_. The existence of such graces (which need not necessarily be supernatural except _quoad modum et finem_) may be inferred with great probability from the fact that man is a compound of body and soul. Aristotle holds that the human mind cannot think without the aid of the imagination.(59) If this is true, every supernatural thought must be preceded by a corresponding phantasm to excite and sustain it. As for the sensitive appetite, it may either assume the form of concupiscence and hinder the work of salvation, or aid it by favorable emotions excited supernaturally. St. Augustine says that the _delectatio victrix_ has for its object “to impart sweetness to that which gave no pleasure.”(60) St. Paul, who thrice besought the Lord to relieve him of the sting of his flesh, was told: “My grace is sufficient for thee.”(61)

4. _The Illuminating Grace of the Mind and the Strengthening Grace of the Will Considered as Vital Acts of the Soul._—If we examine these graces more closely to determine their physical nature, we find that they are simply vital acts of the intellect and the will, and receive the character of divine “graces” from the fact that they are supernaturally excited in the soul by God.

a) The Biblical, Patristic, and conciliar terms _cogitatio_, _suasio_, _scientia_, _cognitio_, as well as _delectatio_, _voluptas_, _desiderium_, _caritas_, _bona voluntas_, _cupiditas_, all manifestly point to vital acts of the soul. But even where grace is described as _vocatio_, _illuminatio_, _illustratio_, _excitatio_, _pulsatio_, _inspiratio_, or _tractio_, the reference can only be—if not _formaliter_, at least _virtualiter_—to immanent vital acts of the intellect or will. This is the concurrent teaching of SS. Augustine and Thomas Aquinas. The former says: “God calls [us] by [our] innermost thoughts,” and: “See how the Father draws [and] by teaching delights [us].”(62) The latter quotes the Aristotelian axiom: “_Actus moventis in moto est motus._”(63)

If the graces of the intellect and of the will are supernaturally inspired acts of the soul, by what process does the mind of man respond to the impulse of illumination and inspiration?

The language employed by the Fathers and councils leaves no doubt that supernatural knowledge manifests itself mainly in judgments. But simple apprehension and ratiocination must also play a part, (1) because these two operations are of the essence of human thought, and the grace of illumination always works through natural agencies; and (2) because some intellectual apprehensions are merely condensed judgments and syllogisms.

The graces of the will naturally work through the spiritual emotions or passions, of which there are eleven: love and hatred, joy and sadness, desire and abhorrence, hope and despair, fear and daring, and lastly anger. With the exception of despair (for which there is no place in the business of salvation), all these passions have a practical relation to good and evil and are consequently called “graces” both in Scripture and Tradition. Love (_amor_) is the fundamental affection of the will, to which all others are reducible, and hence the principal function of grace, in so far as it affects the will, must consist in producing acts of love.(64) The Council of Carthage (A. D. 418) declares that “both to know what we must do, and to love to do it, is a gift of God.”(65) It would be a mistake, however, to identify this “love” with theological charity, which is “a perfect love of God above all things for His own sake.”(66) Justification begins with supernatural faith, is followed by fear, hope, and contrition, and culminates in charity.(67)

St. Augustine sometimes employs the word _caritas_ in connections where it cannot possibly mean theological love.(68) This peculiar usage is based on the idea that love of goodness in a certain way attracts man towards God and prepares him for the theological virtue of charity. In studying the writings of St. Augustine, therefore, we must carefully distinguish between _caritas_ in the strict, and _caritas_ in a secondary and derived sense.(69) The champions of the falsely so-called Augustinian theory of grace(70) disregard this important distinction and erroneously claim that St. Augustine identifies “grace” with _caritas_ in the sense of theological love; just as if faith, hope, contrition, and the fear of God were not also graces in the true meaning of the term, and could not exist without theological charity.

b) Not a few theologians, especially of the Thomist school, enlarge the list of actual graces by including therein, besides the supernatural vital acts of the soul, certain extrinsic, non-vital qualities (_qualitates fluentes, non vitales_) that precede these acts and form their basis. It is impossible, they argue, to elicit vital or immanent supernatural acts unless the faculties of the soul have previously been raised to the supernatural order by means of the _potentia obœdientialis_. The _gratia elevans_, which produces in the soul of the sinner the same effects that the so-called infused habits produce in the soul of the just, is a supernatural power really distinct from its vital effects. In other words, they say, the vital supernatural acts of the soul are preceded and produced by a non-vital grace, which must be conceived as a “fluent quality.” These “fluent” (the opponents of the theory ironically call them “dead”) qualities are alleged to be real graces.(71) Alvarez and others endeavor to give their theory a dogmatic standing by quoting in its support all those passages of Sacred Scripture, the Fathers and councils in which prevenient grace is described as _pulsatio_, _excitatio_, _vocatio_, _tractio_, _tactus_, and so forth. The act of knocking or calling, they say, is not identical with the act of opening, in fact the former is a grace in a higher sense than the latter, because it is performed by God alone, while the response comes from the soul coöperating with God.(72)

The theory thus briefly described is both theologically and philosophically untenable.

α) Holy Scripture and Tradition nowhere mention any such non-vital entities or qualities,—a circumstance which would be inexplicable if it were true, what Cardinal Gotti asserts,(73) that the term “grace” applies primarily and in the strict sense to these qualities, while the vital acts are merely effects. Whenever Sacred Scripture, the Fathers, and the Church speak literally, without the use of metaphors, they invariably apply the term “grace” to these vital acts themselves and ascribe their supernatural character to an immediate act of God.(74) In perfect conformity with this teaching St. Augustine explains such metaphorical terms as _vocare_ and _tangere_ in the sense of _credere_ and _fides_.(75) God employs no “fluent qualities” or “non-vital entities” in the dispensation of His grace, but effects the supernatural elevation of the soul immediately and by Himself.(76)

β) The theory under consideration is inadmissible also from the philosophical point of view. A quality does not “flow” or tend to revert to nothingness. On the contrary, its very nature demands that it remain constant until destroyed by its opposite or by some positive cause. It is impossible to conceive a quality that would of itself revert to nothingness without the intervention of a destructive cause. Billuart merely beats the air when he says: “_Potest dici qualitas incompleta habens se per modum passionis transeuntis._”(77) What would Aristotle have said if he had been told of a thing that was half ποιόν and half πάσχειν, and consequently neither the one nor the other? Actual grace is transitory; it passes away with the act which it inspires, and consequently may be said to “flow.” But this very fact proves that it is not a dead quality, but a _modus vitalis supernaturalis_. In the dispensation of His grace, God employs no fluent qualities or non-vital entities, but He Himself is the immediate cause of the supernatural elevation of the human soul and its faculties. St. Thomas is perfectly consistent, therefore, when he defines actual grace as a vital act of the soul.(78)

5. PREVENIENT AND COÖPERATING GRACE.—The vital acts of the soul are either spontaneous impulses or free acts of the will. Grace may precede free-will or coöperate with it. If it precedes the free determination of the will it is called prevenient; if it accompanies (or coincides with) that determination and merely coöperates with the will, it is called coöperating grace.

Prevenient grace, regarded as a divine call to penance, is often styled _gratia vocans sive excitans_, and if it is received with a willing heart, _gratia adiuvans_. Both species are distinctly mentioned in Holy Scripture. Cfr. Eph. V, 14: “Wherefore he saith: Rise thou that sleepest, and arise from the dead: and Christ shall enlighten thee.” 2 Tim. I, 9: “Who hath delivered us and called us by his holy calling, not according to our works, but according to his own purpose and grace, which was given us in Christ Jesus before the times of the world.” Rom. VIII, 26: “Likewise the Spirit also helpeth our infirmity.” Rom. VIII, 30: “And whom he predestinated, them he also called. And whom he called, them he also justified. And whom he justified, them he also glorified.” Apoc. III, 20: “Behold I stand at the gate and knock. If any man shall hear my voice, and open to me the door, I will come in to him, and will sup with him, and he with me.”

St. Augustine says: “Forasmuch as our turning away from God is our own act and deed, and this is [our] depraved will; but that we turn to God, this we cannot do except He rouse and help us, and this is [our] good will,—what have we that we have not received?”(79)

An equivalent division is that into _gratia operans_ and _coöperans_, respectively—names which are also founded on Scripture. Cfr. Phil. II, 13: “For it is God who worketh in you, both to will and to accomplish, according to his good will.” Mark XVI, 20: “But they going forth preached everywhere: the Lord working withal, and confirming the word with signs that followed.”

St. Augustine describes the respective functions of these graces as follows: “He [God] begins His influence by working in us that we may have the will, and He completes it by working with us when we have the will.”(80)

A third division of the same grace is that into _praeveniens_ and _subsequens_. It is likewise distinctly Scriptural,(81) and its two members coincide materially with _gratia vocans_ and _adiuvans_, as can be seen by comparing the usage of St. Augustine with that of the Tridentine Council. “God’s mercy,” says the holy Doctor, “prevents [_i.e._ precedes] the unwilling to make him willing; it follows the willing lest he will in vain.”(82) And the Council of Trent declares that “in adults the beginning of justification is to be derived from the prevenient grace of God, through Jesus Christ, that is to say, from His vocation, whereby, without any merits existing on their part, they are called.”(83)

If we conceive a continuous series of supernatural graces, each may be called either prevenient or subsequent, according as it is regarded either as a cause or as an effect. St. Thomas explains this as follows: “As grace is divided into working and coöperating grace, according to its diverse effects, so it may also be divided into prevenient and subsequent grace, according to the meaning attached to the term grace [_i.e._, either habitual or actual]. The effects which grace works in us are five: (1) It heals the soul; (2) moves it to will that which is good; (3) enables man efficaciously to perform the good deeds which he wills; (4) helps him to persevere in his good resolves; and (5) assists him in attaining to the state of glory. In so far as it produces the first of these effects, grace is called prevenient in respect of the second; and in so far as it produces the second, it is called subsequent in respect of the first. And as each effect is posterior to one and prior to another, so grace may be called prevenient or subsequent according as we regard it in its relations to different effects.”(84)

Among so many prevenient graces there must be one which is preceded by none other (_simpliciter praeveniens_), and this is preëminently the _gratia vocans s. excitans_.

There is a fourth and last division, mentioned by the Council of Trent, which is also based on the relation of grace to free-will. “Jesus Christ Himself,” says the holy Synod, “continually infuses His virtue into the justified, and this virtue always precedes, accompanies, and follows their good works.”(85) The opposition here lies between _gratia antecedens_, which is a spontaneous movement of the soul, and

gratia concomitans, which coöperates with free-will after it has given its consent. This terminology may be applied to the good works of sinners and saints alike. For the sinner no less than the just man receives two different kinds of graces—(1) such as precede the free determination of the will and (2) such as accompany his free acts.

Thus it can be readily seen that the fundamental division of actual grace, considered in its relation to free-will, is that into prevenient and coöperating grace. All other divisions are based on a difference of function rather than of nature.(86)

a) The existence of prevenient grace (_gratia praeveniens s. excitans s. vocans_) may be inferred from the fact that the process of justification begins with the illumination of the intellect, which is by nature unfree, _i.e._ devoid of the power of choosing between good and evil. That there are also graces which consist in spontaneous, indeliberate motions of the will,(87) is clearly taught by the Council of Trent,(88) and evidenced by certain Biblical metaphors. Thus God is described as knocking at the gate (Apoc. III, 20), as drawing men to Him (John VI, 44), and men are said to harden their hearts against His voice (Ps. XCIV, 8), etc. Cfr. Jer. XVII, 23: “But they did not hear, nor incline their ear: but hardened their neck, that they might not hear me, and might not receive instruction.”

The Catholic tradition is voiced by St. Augustine, who says: “The will itself can in no wise be moved, unless it meets with something which delights or attracts the mind; but it is not in the power of man to bring this about.”(89) St. Prosper enumerates a long list of spontaneous emotions which he calls supernatural graces of the will.(90)

Prevenient grace is aptly characterized by the Patristic formula: “_Gratia est in nobis, sed sine nobis_,” that is, grace, as a vital act, is in the soul, but as a salutary act it proceeds, not from the free will, but from God. In other words, though the salutary acts of grace derive their vitality from the human will, they are mere _actus hominis_ (θέλησις), not _actus humani_ (βούλησις).(91) “God,” explains St. Augustine, “does many good things in man, which man does not do; but man does none which God does not cause man to do.”(92) And again: “[God] operates without us, in order that we may become willing; but when we once will so as to act, He coöperates with us. We can, however, ourselves do nothing to effect good works of piety without Him either working that we may will, or coöperating when we will.”(93) St. Bernard employs similar language.(94)

b) Coöperating grace (_gratia cooperans s. adiuvans s. subsequens_) differs from prevenient grace in this, that it supposes a deliberate act of consent on the part of the will (βούλησις, not θέλησις). St. Gregory the Great tersely explains the distinction as follows: “The divine goodness first effects something in us without our coöperation [_gratia praeveniens_], and then, as the will freely consents, coöperates with us in performing the good which we desire [_gratia cooperans_].”(95) That such free and consequently meritorious acts are attributable to grace is emphasized by the Tridentine Council: “So great is the bounty [of God] towards all men that He will have the things which are His own gifts to be their merits.”(96) Such free salutary acts are not only graces in the general sense, but real actual graces, in as far as they produce

other salutary acts, and their existence is as certain as the fact that many men freely follow the call of grace, work out their salvation, and attain to the beatific vision. It is only in this way, in fact, that Heaven is peopled with Saints.

α) St. Augustine embodies all these considerations in the following passage: “It is certain that we keep the commandments when we will; but because the will is prepared by the Lord, we must ask of Him that we may will so much as is sufficient to make us act in willing. It is certain that we will whenever we like, but it is He who makes us will what is good, of whom it is said (Prov. VIII, 35): ‘The will is prepared by the Lord,’ and of whom it is said (Ps. XXXVI, 32): ‘The steps of a [good] man are ordered by the Lord, and his way doth He will,’ and of whom it is said (Phil. II, 13): ‘It is God who worketh in you, even to will.’ It is certain that we act whenever we set to work; but it is He who causes us to act, by giving thoroughly efficacious powers to our will, who has said (Ezech. XXXVI, 27): ‘I will cause you to walk in my commandments, and to keep my judgments, and do them.’ When He says: ‘I will cause you … to do them,’ what else does He say in fact than (Ezech. XI, 19): ‘I will take away the stony heart out of their flesh,’ from which used to rise your inability to act, and (Ezech. XXXVI, 26): ‘I will give you a heart of flesh,’ in order that you may act.”(97)

β) The manner in which grace and free-will coöperate is a profound philosophical and theological problem. A salutary act derives its supernatural character from God, its vitality from the human will. How do these two factors conjointly produce one and the same act? The unity of the act would be destroyed if God and the free-will of man in each case performed, either two separate acts, or each half of the same act. To preserve the unity of a supernatural act two conditions are required: (1) the divine power of grace must be transformed into the vital strength of the will and (2) the created will, which by its own power can perform at most a naturally good act, must be equipped with the supernatural power of grace. These conditions are met (a) by the supernatural elevation of the will (_elevatio externa_), and (b) by the supernatural concurrence of God (_concursus supernaturalis ad actum secundum_). The supernatural elevation of the will is accomplished in this wise: God, by employing the illuminating and strengthening grace, works on the _potentia obœdientialis_, and thus raises the will above its purely natural powers and constitutes it a supernatural faculty _in actu primo_ for the free performance of a salutary act. The divine concursus supervenes to enable the will to perform the _actus secundus_ or salutary act proper. This special divine concurrence, in contradistinction to the natural concursus whereby God supports the created universe,(98) is a strictly supernatural and gratuitous gift. Consequently, God and the human will jointly perform one and the same salutary act—God as the principal, the will as the instrumental cause.(99)

6. EFFICACIOUS GRACE AND MERELY SUFFICIENT GRACE.—By efficacious grace (_gratia efficax_) we understand that divine assistance which with infallible certainty includes the free salutary act. Whether the certainty of its operation results from the physical nature of this particular grace, or from God’s infallible foreknowledge (_scientia media_), is a question in dispute between Thomists and Molinists.(100)

Merely sufficient grace (_gratia mere sufficiens_) is that divine assistance whereby God communicates to the human will full power to perform a salutary act (_posse_) but not the action itself (_agere_).

The division of grace into efficacious and merely sufficient is not identical with that into prevenient and coöperating. Coöperating grace does not _ex vi notionis_ include with infallible certainty the salutary act. It may indeed be efficacious, but in matter of fact frequently fails to attain its object because the will offers resistance.

a) The existence of efficacious graces is as certain as that there is a Heaven filled with Saints. God would be neither omnipotent nor infinitely wise if all His graces were frustrated by the free-will of man. St. Augustine repeatedly expresses his belief in the existence of efficacious graces. Thus he writes in his treatise on Grace and Free-Will: “It is certain that we act whenever we set to work; but it is He [God] who causes us to act, by giving thoroughly efficacious powers to the will.”(101) And in another treatise: “[Adam] had received the ability (_posse_) if he would [_gratia sufficiens_], but he had not the will to exercise that ability [_gratia efficax_]; for if he had possessed that will, he would have persevered.”(102)

b) Before demonstrating the existence of sufficient grace it is necessary, in view of certain heretical errors, carefully to define the term.

α) Actual grace may be regarded either in its intrinsic energy or power (_virtus_, _potestas agendi_) or in its extrinsic efficacy (_efficientia_, _efficacitas_). All graces are efficacious considered in their intrinsic energy, because all confer the physical and moral power necessary to perform the salutary act for the sake of which they are bestowed. From this point of view, therefore, and _in actu primo_, there is no real but a purely logical distinction between efficacious and merely sufficient grace. If we look to the final result, however, we find that this differs according as the will either freely coöperates with grace or refuses its coöperation. If the will coöperates, grace becomes truly efficacious; if the will resists, grace remains “merely sufficient.” In other words, merely sufficient grace confers full power to act, but is rendered ineffective by the resistance of the will.

The inefficacy of merely sufficient grace, therefore, is owing to the resistance of the will and not to any lack of intrinsic power. This is a truth to which all Catholic systems of grace must conform.

Merely sufficient grace may be subdivided into _gratia proxime sufficiens_ and _gratia remote sufficiens_.

Proximately sufficient grace (also called _gratia operationis_) confers upon the will full power to act forthwith, while remotely sufficient grace (also termed _gratia orationis_) confers only the grace of prayer, which in its turn brings down full power to perform other salutary acts.

The _gratia orationis_ plays a most important rôle in the divine economy of grace. God has not obliged Himself to give man immediately all the graces he needs. It is His will, in many instances, as when we are besieged by temptations, that we petition Him for further assistance. “God does not enjoin impossibilities,” says St. Augustine,

“but in His injunctions He counsels you both to do what you can for yourself, and to ask His aid in what you cannot do.”(103)

Hence, though grace may sometimes remain ineffective (_gratia inefficax_ = _gratia vere et mere sufficiens_), it is never insufficient (_insufficiens_), that is to say, never too weak to accomplish its purpose.

Calvinism and Jansenism, while retaining the name, have eliminated sufficient grace from their doctrinal systems.

Jansenius (+ 1638) admits a kind of “sufficient grace,” which he calls _gratia parva_, but it is really insufficient because no action can result from it unless it is supplemented by another and more powerful grace.(104) This heretic denounced sufficient grace in the Catholic sense as a monstrous conception and a means of peopling hell with reprobates.(105) Some of his followers even went so far as to assert that “in our present state sufficient grace is pernicious rather than useful to us, and we have reason to pray: From sufficient grace, O Lord, deliver us!”(106)

β) It is an article of faith that there is a merely sufficient grace and that it is truly sufficient even when frustrated by the resistance of the will. The last-mentioned point is emphasized by the Second Council of Orange (A. D. 529): “This also we believe, according to the Catholic faith, that all baptized persons, through the grace received in Baptism, and with the help and coöperation of Christ, are able and in duty bound, if they will faithfully do their share, to comply with all the conditions necessary for salvation.”(107) The existence of sufficient grace was formally defined by the Council of Trent as follows: “If any one saith that man’s free-will, moved and excited by God, ... no wise coöperates towards disposing and preparing itself for obtaining the grace of justification; that it cannot refuse its consent if it would, ... let him be anathema.”(108)

This dogma can be convincingly demonstrated both from Sacred Scripture and Tradition.

(1) God Himself complains through the mouth of the prophet Isaias: “What is there that I ought to do more to my vineyard, that I have not done to it? Was it that I looked that it should bring forth grapes, and it hath brought forth wild grapes?”(109) This complaint clearly applies to the Jews. Yahweh did for the Jewish nation whatever it behooved Him to do lavishly (_gratia vere sufficiens_), but His kindness was unrequited (_gratia mere sufficiens_). In the Book of Proverbs He addresses the sinner in these terms: “I called, and you refused: I stretched out my hand, and there was none that regarded.”(110) What does this signify if not the complete sufficiency of grace? The proffered grace remained inefficacious simply because the sinner rejected it of his own free will. Upbraiding the wicked cities of Corozain and Bethsaida, our Lord exclaims: “If in Tyre and Sidon had been wrought the miracles that have been wrought in you, they had long ago done penance in sackcloth and ashes.”(111) The omniscient God-man here asserts the existence of graces which remained inefficacious in Corozain and Bethsaida, though had they been given to the inhabitants of Tyre and Sidon, they would have proved effective. The conclusion evidently is: these graces remained ineffective, not because they were unequal to the

purpose for which they were conferred, but simply and solely because they were rejected by those whom God intended to benefit.(112)

(2) Though they did not employ the name, the Fathers were thoroughly familiar with the notion of sufficient grace.

Thus St. Irenaeus comments on our Lord's lamentation over the fate of the Holy City: "When He says: (Matth. XXIII, 37): 'How often would I have gathered together thy children, ... and thou wouldest not,' He manifests the ancient liberty of man, because God hath made him free from the beginning.... For God does not employ force, but always has a good intention. And for this reason He gives good counsel to all.... And those who do it [_gratia efficax_] will receive glory and honor, because they have done good, though they were free not to do it; but those who do not do good will experience the just judgment of God, because they have not done good [_gratia inefficax_], though they were able to do it [_gratia vere et mere sufficiens_]."(113) St. Augustine is in perfect agreement with ecclesiastical tradition, and the Jansenists had no right whatever to claim him for their teaching. "The grace of God," he expressly says in one place, "assists the will of men. If in any case men are not assisted by it, the reason lies with themselves, not God."(114) And again: "No one is guilty because he has not received; but he who does not do what he ought to do, is truly guilty. It is his duty to act if he has received a free will and amply sufficient power to act."(115)

READINGS:—St. Thomas, _Summa Theologica_, 1a 2ae, qu. 110, art. 1; qu. 111, art. 1-5.—J. Scheeben, _Natur und Gnade_, Mainz 1861.—M. Glossner, _Lehre des hl. Thomas vom Wesen der Gnade_, Mainz 1871.—Palmieri, _De Gratia Divina Actuali_, thes. 1-16, Gulpen 1885.—Oswald, _Die Lehre von der Heiligung_, 3rd ed., § 1-3, Paderborn 1885.—S. Schiffini, _De Gratia Divina_, disp. 1, sect. 2; disp. 3, sect. 1-5, Freiburg 1901.—Heinrich-Gutberlet, _Dogmatische Theologie_, Vol. VIII, pp. 3 sqq., Mainz 1897.—B. J. Otten, S. J., _A Manual of the History of Dogmas_, Vol. II, St. Louis 1918, pp. 234 sqq.

Chapter II. The Properties Of Actual Grace

Actual grace has three essential properties: (1) necessity, (2) gratuity, and (3) universality. The most important of these is necessity.

Section 1. The Necessity Of Actual Grace

In treating of the necessity of actual grace we must avoid two extremes. The first is that mere nature is absolutely incapable of doing any thing good. This error was held by the early Protestants and the followers of Baius and Jansenius. The second is that nature is able to perform supernatural acts by its own power. This was taught by the Pelagians and Semipelagians.

Between these two extremes Catholic theology keeps the golden mean. It defends the capacity of human nature against Protestants and Jansenists, and upholds its incapacity and impotence against Pelagians and Semipelagians. Thus our present Section naturally falls into three Articles.

Article 1. The Capacity Of Mere Nature Without Grace

The capacity of nature in its own domain may be considered with regard either to the intellect or to the will.

Thesis I: Man is capable by the natural power of his intellect to arrive at a knowledge of God from a consideration of the physical universe.

This proposition embodies an article of faith defined by the Vatican Council: “If any one shall say that the one true God, our Creator and Lord, cannot be certainly known by the natural light of human reason through created things, let him be anathema.”(116)

For a formal demonstration of this truth we must refer the reader to our treatise on _God: His Knowability, Essence, and Attributes_, pp. 17 sqq. The argument there given may be supplemented by the following considerations:

1. The Vatican Council vindicates the native power of the human intellect when it says: “The Catholic Church, with one consent, has ever held and does hold, that there is a twofold order of knowledge, distinct both in principle and in object: in principle, because our knowledge in the one is by natural reason, and in the other by divine faith; in object, because, besides those things to which natural reason can attain, there are proposed to our belief mysteries hidden in God, which, unless divinely revealed, cannot be known.”(117) This teaching, which the Church had repeatedly emphasized on previous occasions against the scepticism of Nicholas de Ultricuria,(118) the rationalistic philosophy of Pomponazzi, the “log-stick-and-stone” theory(119) of Martin Luther, the exaggerations of the Jansenists, and the vagaries of the Traditionalists,(120) is based on Revelation as well as on sound reason. Holy Scripture clearly teaches that we can gain a certain knowledge of God from a consideration of the created universe.(121) Reason tells us that a creature endowed with intelligence must be capable of acquiring natural knowledge, and that supernatural faith is based on certain _praeambula_, which are nothing else than philosophical and historical truths.(122) “The existence of God and other like truths,” says St. Thomas, “are not articles of faith, but preambles to the articles; for faith presupposes natural knowledge, even as grace presupposes nature, and perfection something that can be perfected.”(123) Luther denounced reason as the most dangerous thing on earth, because “all its discussions and conclusions are as certainly false and erroneous as there is a God in Heaven.”(124) The Church teaches, in accordance with sound philosophy and experience, that the original powers of human nature, especially free-will, though greatly weakened, have not been destroyed by original sin.(125) The Scholastics, it is true, reckoned ignorance among the four “wounds of nature” inflicted by original sin.(126) But this teaching must be regarded in the light in which the Church condemned Quesnel’s proposition that “All natural knowledge of God, even that found in pagan philosophers, can come from nowhere else than God, and without grace produces nothing but presumption, vanity, and opposition against God Himself, instead of adoration, gratitude, and love.”(127) The Traditionalist contention that the intrinsic weakness of the human intellect can be cured only by a primitive revelation handed down through the instrumentality of

speech and instruction, or by a special interior illumination, involves the false assumption that there can be a cognitive faculty incapable of knowledge,—which would ultimately lead to a denial of the essential distinction between nature and the supernatural, because it represents exterior revelation or interior grace as something positively due to fallen nature.(128) Following the lead of St. Thomas,(129) Catholic apologists, while maintaining the necessity of a supernatural revelation even with regard to the truths of natural religion and ethics, base their argument not on the alleged physical incapacity of reason to ascertain these truths, but on the moral impossibility (_i.e._ insuperable difficulty) of finding them unaided. “It is to be ascribed to this divine Revelation,” says the Vatican Council, “that such truths among things divine as are not of themselves beyond human reason, can, even in the present state of mankind, be known by every one with facility and firm assurance, and without admixture of error.”(130) In conformity with the teaching of Revelation and Tradition, the Church has always sharply distinguished between πίστις and γνῶσις,—faith and knowledge, revelation and philosophy,—assigning to reason the double rôle of an indispensable forerunner and a docile handmaid of faith. Far from antagonizing reason, as charged by her enemies, the Church has on the contrary always valiantly championed its rights against Scepticism, Positivism, Criticism, Traditionalism, Rationalism, Pantheism, and Modernism.(131)

2. As regards those purely natural truths that constitute the domain of science and art, Catholic divines are practically unanimous(132) in holding that, though man possesses the physical ability of knowing every single one of these truths, even the most highly gifted cannot master them all. Cardinal Mezzofanti had acquired a knowledge of many languages,(133) and undoubtedly was capable of learning many more; yet without a special grace he could not have learned all the languages spoken on earth, though their number is by no means infinite. The science of mathematics, which embraces but a limited field of knowledge, comprises an indefinite number of propositions and problems which even the greatest genius can not master. Add to these impediments the shortness of human life, the limitations of the intellect, the multitude and intricacy of scientific methods, the inaccessibility of many objects which are in themselves knowable, (_e.g._ the interior of the earth, the stellar universe)—and you have a host of limitations which make it physically impossible for the mind of man to encompass the realm of natural truths.(134)

Thesis II: Fallen man, whether pagan or sinner, is able to perform some naturally good works without the aid of grace.

This thesis may be technically qualified as _propositio certa_.

Proof. A man performing moral acts may be either in a state of unbelief, or of mortal sin, or of sanctifying grace. The question here at issue is chiefly whether all the works of pagans, that is all acts done without grace of any kind, are morally bad, or whether any purely natural works may be good despite the absence of grace. Baius and Jansenius affirmed this; nay more, they asserted that no man can perform good works unless he is in the state of grace and inspired by a perfect love of God (_caritas_). If this were true, all the works of pagans and of such Christians as have lost the faith, would be so many sins. But it is _not_ true. The genuine teaching of the

Church may be gathered from her official condemnation of the twenty-fifth, the twenty-sixth, and the thirty-seventh propositions of Baius. These propositions run as follows: “Without the aid of God’s grace free-will hath power only to sin;”(135) “To admit that there is such a thing as a natural good, _i.e._ one which originates solely in the powers of nature, is to share the error of Pelagius;”(136) “All the actions of unbelievers are sins and the virtues of philosophers vices.”(137) To these we may add the proposition condemned by Pope Alexander VIII, that “The unbeliever necessarily sins in whatever he does.”(138)

1. Sacred Scripture and the Fathers, St. Augustine included, admit the possibility of performing naturally good, though unmeritorious, works (_opera steriliter bona_) in the state of unbelief; and their teaching is in perfect conformity with right reason.

a) Our Divine Lord Himself says:(139) “If you love them that love you, what reward(140) shall you have? Do not even the publicans this? And if you salute(141) your brethren only, what do you more? Do not also the heathens(142) this?” The meaning plainly is: To salute one’s neighbor is an act of charity, a naturally good deed, common even among the heathens, and one which, not being done from a supernatural motive, deserves no supernatural reward. But this does not by any means imply that to salute one’s neighbor is sinful.

St. Paul(143) says: “For when the gentiles,(144) who have not the law,(145) do by nature(146) those things that are of the law; these having not the law are a law to themselves: who shew the work of the law written in their hearts.” By “gentiles” the Apostle evidently means genuine heathens, not converts from paganism to Christianity, and hence the meaning of the passage is that the heathens who know the natural law embodied in the Decalogue only as a postulate of reason, are by nature(147) able to “do those things that are of the law,”(148) _i.e._ observe at least some of its precepts. That St. Paul did not think the gentiles capable of observing the whole law without the aid of grace appears from his denunciation of their folly, a little further up in the same Epistle: “Because that, when they knew God, they have not glorified him as God, or given thanks; but became vain in their thoughts, and their foolish heart was darkened, etc.,”(149) and also from the hypothetic form of Rom. II, 14 in the original Greek text: “Ὅταν γὰρ ἔθνη ... τὰ τοῦ νόμου ποιῶσιν—_Si quando gentes, ... quae legis sunt, faciunt._”(150)

In Rom. XIV, 23: “For all that is not faith is sin,”(151) a text often quoted against our thesis, “faith” does not mean the theological habit of faith, but “conscience,”(152) as the context clearly shows.(153)

b) The teaching of the Fathers is in substantial harmony with Sacred Scripture.

α) Thus St. Jerome, speaking of the reward which Yahweh gave to Nabuchodonosor for his services against Tyre,(154) says: “The fact that Nabuchodonosor was rewarded for a good work shows that even the gentiles in the judgment of God are not passed over without a reward when they have performed a good deed.”(155) In his commentary on St. Paul’s Epistle to the Galatians the same holy Doctor observes: “Many who are without the faith and have not the Gospel of Christ, yet perform prudent and holy actions, _e.g._ by obeying their parents,

succoring the needy, not oppressing their neighbors, not taking away the possessions of others."(156)

β) The teaching of St. Augustine offers some difficulties. There can be no doubt that this Father freely admitted that pagans and infidels can perform naturally good works without faith and grace. Thus he says there is no man so wicked that some good cannot be found in him.(157) He extols the moderation of Polemo(158) and the purity of Alypius, who were both pagans.(159) He admires the civic virtues of the ancient Romans,(160) etc. Holding such views, how could Augustine write: "Neither doth free-will avail for anything except sin, if the way of truth is hidden."(161) And what did his disciple Prosper mean when he said: "The whole life of unbelievers is a sin, and nothing is good without the highest good. For wherever there is no recognition of the supreme and immutable truth, there can be no genuine virtue, even if the moral standard be of the highest."(162)

To understand these and similar passages rightly and to explain at the same time how it was possible for Baius and Jansenius to bolster their heretical systems with quotations from the writings of St. Augustine and his disciples, it is necessary to observe that the quondam rhetorician and Platonic idealist of Hippo delights in applying to the genus the designation which belongs to its highest species, and _vice versa_.(163) Thus, in speaking of liberty, he often means the perfect liberty enjoyed by our first parents in Paradise;(164) in using the term "children of God" he designates those who persevere in righteousness;(165) and in employing the phrase "a good work" he means one supernaturally meritorious. Or, _vice versa_, he designates the slightest good impulse of the will as "_caritas_," as it were by anticipation, and brands every unmeritorious work (_opus informe s. sterile_) as false virtue (_falsa virtus_), nay sin (_peccatum_). To interpret St. Augustine correctly, therefore, allowance must be made for his peculiar idealism and a careful distinction drawn between the real and the metaphorical sense of the terms which he employs. Baius neglected this precaution and furthermore paid no attention to the controversial attitude of the holy Doctor. Augustine's peculiar task was not to maintain the possibility of naturally good works without faith and grace, but to defend against Pelagius and Julian the impossibility of performing supernaturally good and meritorious works without the aid of grace. It is this essential difference in their respective points of view that explains how St. Augustine and Baius were able to employ identical or similar terms to express radically different ideas.(166)

c) It can easily be demonstrated on theological grounds that fallen man is able, of his own initiative, _i.e._ without the aid of grace, to perform morally good works, and that Baius erred in asserting that this is impossible without theological faith.

α) With regard to the first-mentioned point it will be well, for the sake of clearness, to adopt Palmieri's distinction between physical and moral capacity.(167) Man sins whenever he transgresses the law or yields to temptation. This would be impossible if he were physically unable to keep the whole law and resist temptation. Hence he must be physically able to do that which he is obliged to do under pain of sin, though in this or that individual instance the difficulties may be insuperable without the aid of grace. To put it somewhat differently: Baius and Jansenius hold that fallen man can

perform no morally good works because of physical or moral impotence on the part of the will. This assumption is false. Man is physically able to perform good works because they are enjoined by the moral law of nature under pain of sin; he is morally able because, in spite of numerous evil tendencies, not a few gentiles and unbelievers have led upright lives and thereby proved that man can perform good works without the aid of grace.(168) This is also the teaching of St. Thomas.(169)

β) It is an expressly defined dogma that the process of justification starts with theological faith (_fides_), preceded by the so-called grace of vocation, which prepares and effects conversion. To say, as Baius did, that all good works performed in a state of unbelief are so many sins, is tantamount to asserting that the preliminary acts leading up to faith, and which the unbeliever performs by the aid of prevenient grace, are sinful; in other words, that God requires the unbeliever to prepare himself for justification by committing sin. This is as absurd as it is heretical.(170)

The whole argument of this section applies _a fortiori_ to the theory that no act can be morally good unless prompted by both theological charity and theological faith.(171)

2. We must now define the limitations of fallen nature unaided by grace. Though the graces dispensed by Providence even for naturally good deeds are in the present economy _de facto_ nearly all supernatural, nothing prevents us from conceiving a different economy, consisting of purely natural helps, such as would have been necessary in the state of pure nature.(172)

As regards the limitations of man's moral power in the natural order, we may say, in a general way, that the will is able to keep the easier precepts of the moral law of nature without the assistance of grace (either supernatural or natural). However, as it is impossible in many instances to determine just where the easier precepts end and the more difficult ones begin, a broad field is left open for theological speculation.

a) Theologians are practically unanimous in holding that man cannot observe the natural law in its entirety for any considerable length of time without the aid of grace.

Suarez is so sure of this that he does not hesitate to denounce the contrary teaching,—which is (perhaps unjustly) ascribed to Durandus, Scotus, and Gabriel Biel—as "rash and verging on error."(173) In matter of fact the Church has formally defined that, because of concupiscence, no one, not even the justified man, much less the sinner, is able, without divine assistance (grace), to keep for any considerable length of time the whole Decalogue, which embodies the essentials of the moral law. "Nevertheless," says the Council of Trent, "let those who think themselves to stand take heed lest they fall, and with fear and trembling work out their salvation, ... for ... they ought to fear for the combat which yet remains with the flesh, with the world, with the devil, wherein they cannot be victorious unless they be with God's grace obedient to the Apostle, who says: 'We are debtors, etc.' "(174)

St. Paul, who lived, so to speak, in an atmosphere of grace, yet found reason to exclaim: "I am delighted with the law of God, according to the inward man, but I see another law in my members, fighting against the law of my mind, and captivating me

in the law of sin, that is in my members,"(175) and: "Unhappy man that I am, who shall deliver me from the body of this death? The grace of God, by Jesus Christ our Lord."(176) Surely it would be vain to expect the proud ideal of the Stoics or Pelagius' presumptuous claim of impeccability ever to be realized on earth except by a special privilege of grace, such as that bestowed upon the Blessed Virgin Mary.(177)

The Fathers follow St. Paul in describing the power of concupiscence, even after justification.(178)

b) A pertinent question, closely allied to the proposition just treated, is this: Can the human will, without the aid of grace, overcome all the grievous temptations to mortal sin by which it is besieged?

It is the common teaching of theologians that, without the aid of grace, man in the fallen state succumbs with moral (not physical) necessity to grievous temptations against the moral law, _i.e._ to mortal sin. This conclusion flows from the impossibility, which we have demonstrated above, of observing the whole law of nature for life or for any considerable length of time without the help of grace. If man were able to resist all violent temptations, he would be able to keep the whole law.

The theological teaching which we are here expounding may be formulated in two different ways: (1) No man can overcome all grievous temptations against the moral law without the aid of grace; (2) there is no man living who is not now and then assailed by temptations to which he would inevitably succumb did not God lend him His assistance.

In its first and rather indefinite form the proposition is attacked by Ripalda,(179) Molina,(180) and many later Scholastics. These writers argue as follows: It is impossible to deduce from Revelation or experience a definite rule by which man could determine the conditions on which the grievousness of a temptation depends. To say that a temptation is grievous when it cannot be resisted without the aid of grace, would be begging the question. Besides, the possibility always remains that there be men who, though in theory unable to withstand all grievous temptations without the aid of grace, _de facto_ never meet with such temptations, but only with the lighter kind which can be overcome without supernatural help.

The second and more specific formulation of our proposition is supported by Sacred Scripture, which explicitly declares that all men are subject to temptations which they could not resist if God did not uphold them.(181)

If the just are obliged to watch and pray constantly, lest they fall,(182) this must be true in an even higher degree of sinners and unbelievers. St. Augustine writes against the Pelagians: "Faithful men say in their prayer: 'Lead us not into temptation.' But if they have the capacity [of avoiding evil], why do they pray [for it]? Or, what is the evil which they pray to be delivered from, but, above all else, the body of this death?... the carnal lusts, whence a man is liberated only by the grace of the Saviour.... He may be permitted to pray that he may be healed. Why does he presume so strongly on the capability of his nature? It is wounded, hurt, harassed, destroyed; what it stands in need of is a true confession [of its weakness], not a false defense [of its

capacity].”(183)

c) Another question, on which Catholic divines disagree, is this: Can fallen man, unaided by grace, elicit an act of perfect natural charity (_amor Dei naturalis perfectus_)?

Scotus answers this question affirmatively,(184) and his opinion is shared by Cajetan,(185) Bañez,(186) Dominicus Soto,(187) and Molina.(188) Other equally eminent theologians, notably Suarez(189) and Bellarmine,(190) take the negative side.

In order to obtain a clear understanding of the question at issue we shall have to attend to several distinctions.

First and above all we must not lose sight of the important distinction between the _natural_ and the _supernatural_ love of God. Supernatural charity, in all its stages, necessarily supposes supernatural aid. The question therefore can refer only to the _amor Dei naturalis_.(191) That this natural charity is no mere figment appears from the ecclesiastical condemnation of two propositions of Baius.(192)

Another, even more important distinction is that between _perfect_ and _imperfect_ charity. Imperfect charity is the love of God as our highest good (_amor Dei ut summum bonum nobis_); perfect charity is the love of God for His own sake above all things (_amor Dei propter se et super omnia_). The holy Fathers and a number of councils(193) declare that it is impossible to love God perfectly without the aid of grace. The context and such stereotyped explanatory phrases as “_sicut oportet_” or “_sicut expedit ad salutem_,”(194) show that these Patristic and conciliary utterances apply to the _supernatural_ love of God. Hence the question narrows itself down to this: Can fallen man without the aid of grace love God for His own sake and above all things by a purely natural love? In answering this question Pesch,(195) Tepe,(196) and other theologians distinguish between _affective_ and _effective_ love. They hold that whereas the _amor affectivus_ in all its stages is possible without the aid of grace, not so the _amor effectivus_, since that would involve the observance of the whole natural law. This compromise theory can be demonstrated as highly probable from Scripture and Tradition. St. Paul says(197) that the gentiles knew God and should have glorified Him. This evidently supposes that it was possible for them to glorify God, and consequently to love Him affectively, as easily and with the same means by which they knew Him. Else how could the Apostle say of those gentiles who, “when they knew God, glorified him not as God,” that they “changed the truth of God into a lie, and worshipped and served the creature rather than the Creator”?(198) This interpretation of Rom. I, 21 sqq. is explicitly confirmed by St. Ambrose when he says: “For they were able to apprehend this by the law of nature, inasmuch as the fabric of the cosmos testifies that God, its author, is alone to be loved, as Moses hath set it down in his writings; but they were made impious by not glorifying God, and unrighteousness became evident in them when, knowing, they changed the truth into a lie and refused to confess the one God.”(199)

3. It follows, by way of corollary, that Vasquez's opinion,(200) that there can be no good work without supernatural aid in the shape of a _cogitatio congrua_, is untenable, as is also the assertion of Ripalda(201) that in the present economy purely natural good actions are so invariably connected with the prevenient grace of Christ that they practically never exist as such.

a) Vasquez, whose position in the matter is opposed by most other theologians, contends(202) that no man can perform a good work or resist any temptation against the natural law (Decalogue) without the help of supernatural grace derived from the merits of Christ. To avoid the heretical extreme of Baianism, however, he makes a twofold limitation. He assumes with the Scotists that there is such a thing as a morally indifferent act of the will,(203) and defines the grace which he holds to be necessary for the performance of every morally good deed, as _cogitatio congrua_. This "congruous thought," he says, is in itself, _i.e._ ontologically, natural, and can be regarded as supernatural only _quoad modum et finem_. The subtle argument by which Vasquez tries to establish this thesis is based principally on St. Augustine and may be summarized as follows: Whenever the Fathers and councils insist on the necessity of grace for the performance of good works, they mean _all_ good works, natural as well as supernatural. The only alternative they know is virtue or vice, good or evil. Consequently the grace of Christ, in some form or other, is a necessary requisite of all morally good deeds.

As we have already intimated, we regard this opinion of the learned Spanish divine as erroneous.(204) Three solid reasons militate against it. The first is that, to guard against Baianism, Vasquez is compelled to assume the existence of morally indifferent acts of the will, which is untenable, as "St. Augustine and St. Thomas, and theologians generally teach that there is no such thing in the concrete as a morally indifferent act of the free will, and consequently, if the will is able, without grace, to perform acts that are not evil, it is also able to perform good acts."(205) Second, Vasquez's theory counterfeits the notion of Christian grace. "Good thoughts" come so natural to man, and are so closely bound up with the grace of creation, that even Pelagius found no difficulty in admitting this sort of "grace."(206) Surely fallen nature is not so utterly corrupt that a good child is unable to honor and love his parents without the aid of "grace" (in the sense of _cogitatio congrua ex meritis Christi_). The third reason which constrains us to reject Vasquez's theory, is that it leaves no room for natural morality (_naturaliter honestum_) to fill the void between those acts that are naturally bad (_moraliter inhonesta_, _i.e._ _peccata_) and such as are supernaturally good (_supernaturaliter bona_, _i.e._ _salutaria_). The existence of such naturally good acts would seem to be a highly probable inference from the condemnation, by Pius VI, of a certain proposition taught by the pseudo-Council of Pistoia.(207)

b) Martinez de Ripalda (+1648) tried to improve Vasquez's theory by restoring the Christian concept of grace and adding that Providence invariably precedes all naturally good works, including those performed by heathens and sinners, with the entitatively supernatural grace of illumination and confirmation.(208) In this hypothesis the necessity of grace is not theological but purely historic.(209)

Despite the wealth of arguments by which Ripalda attempted to prove his theory,(210) it has not been generally accepted. While some, _e.g._ Platel(211) and Pesch,(212) regard it with a degree of sympathy, others, notably De Lugo(213) and Tepe,(214) are strongly opposed to it. Palmieri thinks it may be accepted in a restricted sense, _i.e._ when limited to the faithful.(215)

Ripalda's hypothesis of the universality of grace is truly sublime and would have to be accepted if God's salvific will could be demonstrated by revelation or some historic law to suffer no exceptions. But Ripalda has not been able to prove this from Revelation.(216) Then, too, his theory entails two extremely objectionable conclusions: (1) a denial, not indeed of the possibility (Quesnel), but of the existence of purely natural good works, and (2) the possibility of justification without theological faith. Neither of these difficulties probably occurred to Vasquez or Ripalda,(217) because at the time when they wrote Pius VI had not yet condemned the teaching of the pseudo-Council of Pistoia,(218) nor had Innocent XI censured the proposition that "Faith in a broad sense, as derived from the testimony of creatures or some other similar motive, is sufficient for justification."(219) If the love of God, even perfect love, (such as we have shown to be possible in the natural order), were of itself necessarily supernatural, as Ripalda contends, it would be possible for a pagan to receive the grace of justification without theological faith, which he does not possess, as is evident from the Vatican teaching that it is "requisite for divine faith that revealed truth be believed because of the authority of God who reveals it."(220)

Thesis III: Not all actions performed by man in the state of mortal sin are sinful on account of his not being in the state of grace.

This is _de fide_.

Proof. Though this thesis is, strictly speaking, included in Thesis II, it must be demonstrated separately on its own merits, because it embodies a formally defined dogma which has been denied by the Protestant Reformers and by the followers of Baius and Jansenius. Martin Luther taught,—and his teaching was adopted in a modified form by the Calvinists,—that human nature is entirely depraved by original sin, and consequently man necessarily sins in whatever he does,(221) even in the process of justification. Against this heresy the Tridentine Council defined: "If any one shall say that all the works done before justification ... are indeed sins, ... let him be anathema."(222)

The Protestant notion of grace was reduced to a theological system by Baius(223) and Jansenius,(224) whose numerous errors may all be traced to their denial of the supernatural order.

The Jansenist teaching was pushed to an extreme by Paschasius Quesnel, 101 of whose propositions were formally condemned by Pope Clement XI in his famous Constitution "_Unigenitus_."(225) The Jansenistic teachings of the Council of Pistoia were censured by Pius VI, A. D. 1794, in his Bull "_Auctorem fidei_." The quintessence of this heretical system is embodied in the proposition that whatever a man does in the state of mortal sin is necessarily sinful for the reason that he is not in the state of grace (_status caritatis_). Baius(226) and Quesnel(227) gave this teaching

an Augustinian turn by saying that there is no intermediate state between the love of God and concupiscence, and that all the works of a sinner must consequently and of necessity be sinful. This heretical teaching is sharply condemned in the Bull "_Auctorem fidei_."(228) Quesnel pushed it to its last revolting conclusion when he said: "The prayer of the wicked is a new sin, and that God permits it is but an additional judgment upon them."(229)

The teaching of Baius and Quesnel is repugnant to Revelation and to the doctrine of the Fathers.

a) The Bible again and again exhorts sinners to repent, to pray for forgiveness, to give alms, etc. Cfr. Ecclus. XXI, 1: "My son, thou hast sinned? Do so no more: but for thy former sins also pray that they may be forgiven thee." Ezech. XVIII, 30: "Be converted, and do penance for all your iniquities: and iniquity shall not be your ruin." Dan. IV, 24: "Redeem thou thy sins with alms, and thy iniquities with works of mercy to the poor: perhaps he will forgive thy offences." Zach. I, 3: "Thus saith the Lord of hosts: Turn ye to me, saith the Lord of hosts: and I will turn to you." If all the works thus enjoined were but so many sins, we should be forced to conclude, on the authority of Sacred Scripture, that God commands the sinner to commit new iniquities and that the process of justification with its so-called dispositions consists in a series of sinful acts. Such an assumption would be manifestly absurd and blasphemous.

Quesnel endeavored to support his heretical conceit by Matth. VII, 17 sq.: "Even so every good tree bringeth forth good fruit, and the evil tree bringeth forth evil fruit; a good tree cannot bring forth evil fruit, neither can an evil tree bring forth good fruit." But as our Lord in this passage speaks of prophets, the fruits he has in mind must obviously be doctrines not works.(230) And what if they were works? Are not doctrines and morals ultimately related, and may we not infer from the lives they lead (according to their doctrines) whether prophets are true or false? By their fruits (_i.e._ works) you shall know them (_i.e._ the soundness or unsoundness of the teaching upon which their works are based).

b) In appealing to the testimony of the Fathers the Jansenists were notoriously guilty of misinterpretation.

α) Origen plainly teaches that prayer before justification is a good work. "Though you are sinners," he says, "pray to God; God hears the sinners."(231) The seemingly contradictory text John IX, 31: "Now we know that God doth not hear sinners,"(232) is thus explained by St. Augustine: "He speaks as one not yet anointed; for God also hears the sinners. If He did not hear sinners, the publican would have cast his eyes to the ground in vain and vainly struck his breast saying: O God, be merciful to me, a sinner."(233) Moreover, since there is question here of extraordinary works and signs only (_viz._ miracles), the text is wholly irrelevant in regard to works of personal righteousness. St. Prosper teaches: "Human nature, created by God, even after its prevarication, retains its substance, form, life, senses, and reason, and the other goods of body and soul, which are not lacking even to those who are bad and vicious. But there is no possibility of seizing the true good by such things as may adorn this

mortal life, but cannot give [merit] eternal life."(234)

β) Baius and Quesnel succeeded in veiling their heresy by a phraseology of Augustinian color but with implications foreign to the mind of the Doctor of Grace. Augustine emphasized the opposition between "charity" and "concupiscence" so strongly that the intermediary domain of naturally good works was almost lost to view. Thus he says in his _Enchiridion_: "Carnal lust reigns where there is not the love of God."(235) And in his treatise on the Grace of Christ: "Here there is no love, no good work is reckoned as done, nor is there in fact any good work, rightly so called; because whatever is not of faith is sin, and faith worketh by love."(236) And again in his treatise on Grace and Free Will: "The commandments of love or charity are so great and such, that whatever action a man may think he does well, is by no means well done if done without charity."(237) We have purposely chosen passages in which the "Doctor of Grace" obviously treats of charity as theological love, not in the broad sense of _dilectio_.(238) At first blush these passages seem to agree with the teaching of Baius, who says: "Every love on the part of a rational creature is either sinful cupidity, by which the world is loved, and which is forbidden by St. John, or that praiseworthy charity which is infused into the heart by the Holy Spirit, and by which we love God;"—(239) and with the forty-fifth proposition of Quesnel: "As the love of God no longer reigns in the hearts of sinners, it is necessary that carnal lust should reign in them and vitiate all their actions."(240) Yet the sense of these propositions is anything but Augustinian. Augustine upholds free-will in spite of grace and concupiscence, whereas the Jansenists assert that the _carnalis cupiditas_ and the _caritas dominans_ produce their effects by the very power of nature, _i.e._ necessarily and of themselves.(241)

Besides this capital difference there are many minor discrepancies between the teaching of St. Augustine and that of Baius and Quesnel. Augustine, it is true, in his struggle with Pelagianism,(242) strongly emphasized the opposition existing between grace and sin, between love of God and love of the world; but he never dreamed of asserting that every act performed in the state of mortal sin is sinful for the reason that it is not performed in the state of grace. Scholasticism has long since applied the necessary corrective to his exaggerations. It is perfectly orthodox to say that there is an irreconcilable opposition between the state of mortal sin and the state of grace. "No one can serve two masters."(243) This is not, however, by any means equivalent to saying, as the Jansenists do, that the sinner, not being in the state of grace, of necessity sins in whatever he does. Augustine expressly admits that, no matter how deeply God may allow a man to fall, and no matter how strongly concupiscence may dominate his will, he is yet able to pray for grace, which is in itself a distinctly salutary act. "If a sin is such," he says in his _Retractationes_, "that it is itself a punishment for sin, what can the will under the domination of cupidity do, except, if it be pious, to pray for help?"(244) Compare this sentence with the fortieth proposition of Baius: "The sinner in all his actions serves the lust which rules him,"(245) and you will perceive the third essential difference that separates the teaching of St. Augustine from that of the Jansenists. The former, even when he speaks, not of the two opposing habits, but of their respective acts, does not, like Jansenism, represent the universality of sin without theological charity as a physical and fundamental

necessity, but merely as a historical phenomenon which admits of exceptions. Thus he writes in his treatise On the Spirit and the Letter: “If they who by nature do the things contained in the law, must not be regarded as yet in the number of those whom Christ’s grace justifies, but rather as among those whose actions (although they are those of ungodly men who do not truly and rightly worship the true God) we not only cannot blame, but actually praise, and with good reason, and rightly too, since they have been done, so far as we read or know or hear, according to the rule of righteousness; though were we to discuss the question with what motive they are done, they would hardly be found to be such as to deserve the praise and defense which are due to righteous conduct.”(246)

In conclusion we will quote a famous passage from St. Augustine which reads like a protest against the distortions of Baius and Jansenius. “Love,” he says, “is either divine or human; human love is either licit or illicit.... I speak first of licit human love, which is free from censure; then, of illicit human love, which is damnable; and in the third place, of divine love, which leads us to Heaven.... You, therefore, have that love which is licit; it is human, but, as I have said, licit, so much so that, if it were lacking, [the want of] it would be censured. You are permitted with human love to love your spouse, your children, your friends and fellow-citizens. But, as you see, the ungodly, too, have this love, _e.g._ pagans, Jews, heretics. Who among them does not love his wife, his children, his brethren, his neighbors, his relations and friends? This, therefore, is human love. If any one would be so unfeeling as to lose even human love, not loving his own children, ... we should no longer regard him as a human being.”(247) Tepe pertinently observes(248) that St. Augustine in this passage asserts not only the possibility but the actual existence of naturally good though unmeritorious works (_opera steriliter __ bona_), and that the theory of Ripalda(249) is untenable for this reason, if for no other, that the quoted passage is cited in Pius VI’s Bull “_Auctorem fidei_.”(250)

Article 2. The Necessity Of Actual Grace For All Salutary Acts

Salutary acts (_actus salutares_) are those directed to the attainment of sanctifying grace and the supernatural end of man.

According to this double purpose, salutary acts may be divided into two classes: (1) those that prepare for justification (_actus simpliciter salutares_), and (2) those which, following justification, gain merits for Heaven (_actus meritorii_).

In consequence of the supernatural character of the acts which they comprise, both these categories are diametrically opposed to that class of acts which are good only in a natural way,(251) and hence must be carefully distinguished from the latter. The Fathers did not, of course, employ the technical terms of modern theology; they had their own peculiar phrases for designating what we call salutary acts, _e.g._ _agere sicut oportet vel expedit, agere ad salutem, agere ad iustificationem, agere ad vitam aeternam_, etc.(252)

1. PELAGIANISM.—Pelagianism started as a reaction against Manichaeism, but fell into the opposite extreme of exaggerating the capacity of human nature at the expense of grace. It denied original sin(253) and grace.

As the necessity of grace for all salutary acts is a fundamental dogma of the Christian religion, the Church proceeded with unusual severity against Pelagian naturalism and condemned its vagaries through the mouth of many councils.

a) Pelagius was a British lay monk, who came to Rome about the year 400 to propagate his erroneous views.(254) He found a willing pupil in Celestius, who after distinguishing himself as a lawyer, had been ordained to the priesthood at Ephesus, about 411.

The Pelagian heresy gained another powerful champion in the person of Bishop Julian of Eclanum in Apulia. Its strongest opponent was St. Augustine. Under his powerful blows the Pelagians repeatedly changed their tactics, without however giving up their cardinal error in regard to grace. Their teaching on this point may be summarized as follows: The human will is able by its natural powers to keep all the commandments of God, to resist temptation, and to gain eternal life; in fact it can attain to a state of holiness and impeccability(255) in which the petition “Forgive us our trespasses” no longer has any meaning except perhaps as an expression of humility.(256) In so far, however, as free-will is itself a gift of the Creator, man can perform no good works without grace. At a later period of his career Pelagius admitted the existence of merely external supernatural graces, such as revelation and the example of Christ and the saints,—which led St. Augustine to remark: “This is the hidden and despicable poison of your heresy that you represent the grace of Christ as His example, not His gift, alleging that man is justified by imitating Him, not by the ministration of the Holy Spirit.”(257) But even this external grace, according to Pelagius, does not confer the strength necessary to perform good works; it merely makes it easier to keep the commandments. Pelagius did not deny that justification and adoptive sonship, considered in their ideal relation to the “kingdom of Heaven,” as distinguished from “eternal life,”(258) are not identical in adults with the grace of creation, but he denied their gratuity by asserting that the free will is able to merit all these graces by its own power.(259)

Whatever may have been the variations of Pelagianism, it is patent from the writings of St. Augustine that its defenders one and all rejected the necessity and existence of the immediate grace of the will.(260) Their attitude towards the illuminating grace of the intellect is in dispute. Some theologians(261) think the Pelagians admitted, others(262) that they denied its existence. No matter what they may have held on this point, there can be no doubt that the followers of Pelagius conceived the object of grace to be nothing more than to facilitate the work of salvation.

b) Within the short span of twenty years (A. D. 411 to 431) no less than twenty-four councils occupied themselves with this new heresy.

At first the wily heretic succeeded in deceiving the prelates assembled at Lydda (Diospolis), A. D. 415; but the bishops of Northern Africa, among them St. Augustine, roundly condemned his teaching at two councils held with the sanction of Pope Innocent I at Carthage and Mileve in 416. Shortly afterwards, deceived by the terms of the creeds and explanations which they circulated, Pope Zosimus (417-418)

declared both Pelagius and Celestius to be innocent. Despite this intervention, however, two hundred African bishops, at a plenary council held at Carthage, A. D. 418, reiterated the canons of Mileve and submitted them for approval to the Holy See. These proceedings induced Zosimus to adopt stronger measures. In his _Epistula Tractoria_ (418) he formally condemned Pelagianism and persuaded the Emperor to send Julian of Eclanum and seventeen other recalcitrant bishops into exile. The canons of Carthage and Mileve were subsequently received by the universal Church as binding definitions of the faith. The most important of them in regard to grace is this: “If anyone shall say that the grace of justification is given to us for the purpose of enabling us to do more easily by the aid of grace what we are commanded to do by free-will, as if we were able, also, though less easily, to observe the commandments of God without the help of grace, let him be anathema.”(263) The Ecumenical Council of Ephesus (A. D. 431), with the approval of Pope Celestine I, renewed the condemnation of Celestius, but it was not until nearly a century later that Pelagianism received its death-blow. In 529 the Second Council of Orange defined: “If any one assert that he is able, by the power of nature, and without the illumination and inspiration of the Holy Ghost, who grants to all men the disposition believingly to accept the truth, rightly (_ut expedit_) to think or choose anything good pertaining to eternal salvation, or to assent to salutary, _i.e._ evangelical preaching, such a one is deceived by a heretical spirit.”(264) This decision was reiterated by the Council of Trent: “If any one saith that the grace of God through Jesus Christ is given only for this, that man may be able more easily to live justly and to merit eternal life, as if by free-will without grace he were able to do both, though hardly indeed and with difficulty, let him be anathema.”(265)

2. PELAGIANISM REFUTED.—Sacred Scripture and the Fathers plainly teach that man is unable to perform any salutary act by his own power.

a) Among the many Biblical texts that can be quoted in support of this statement, our Lord’s beautiful parable of the vine and its branches is especially striking. Cfr. John XV, 4 sq.: “As the branch cannot bear fruit of itself, unless it abide in the vine, so neither can you, unless you abide in me. I am the vine; you the branches: he that abideth in me, and I in him, the same beareth much fruit: for without me you can do nothing.”(266)

α) The context shows that Jesus is not speaking here of purely natural works of the kind for which the _concursus generalis_ of God suffices, but that He has in mind salutary acts in the strictly supernatural sense; and the truth He wishes to inculcate is that fallen nature cannot perform such acts except through Him and with His assistance. This supernatural influence is not, however, to be understood exclusively of sanctifying or habitual grace, because our Divine Saviour refers to the fruits of justification and to salutary works. “Of these he does not say: ‘Without me you can do but little,’ but: ‘Without me you can do nothing.’ Be it therefore little or much, it cannot be done without Him, without whom nothing can be done.”(267) If this was true of the Apostles, who were in the state of sanctifying grace,(268) it must be true _a fortiori_ of sinners. Consequently, supernatural grace is absolutely necessary for the performance of any and all acts profitable for salvation.

β) Nowhere is this fundamental truth so clearly and insistently brought out as in the epistles of St. Paul, who is preëminently “the Doctor of Grace” among the Apostles.

There are, according to him, three categories of supernatural acts: salutary thoughts, holy resolves, and good works.

St. Paul teaches that all right thinking is from God. 2 Cor. III, 5: “Not that we are sufficient to think anything of ourselves, as of ourselves; but our sufficiency is from God.”(269)

He also declares that all good resolves come from above. Rom. IX, 15 sq.: “For he saith to Moses: I will have mercy on whom I will have mercy; and I will shew mercy to whom I will shew mercy. So then it is not of him that willeth, nor of him that runneth, but of God that sheweth mercy.”(270)

He furthermore asserts that all good works come from God. Phil. II, 13: “For it is God who worketh in you, both to will and to accomplish, according to his good will.”(271) 1 Cor. XII, 3: “No man can say: Lord Jesus, but by the Holy Ghost.”(272) Pronouncing the holy name of Jesus is obviously regarded as a salutary act, because mere physical utterance does not require the assistance of the Holy Ghost.(273) But the act as a salutary act is physically impossible without divine assistance, because it is essentially supernatural and consequently exceeds the powers of nature.(274)

b) The argument from Tradition is based almost entirely on the authority of St. Augustine, in whom, as Liebermann observes, God wrought a miracle of grace that he might become its powerful defender. There is no need of quoting specific texts because this whole treatise is interlarded with Augustinian dicta concerning the necessity of grace.

α) An important point is to prove that the early Fathers held the Augustinian, _i.e._ Catholic view. It stands to reason that if these Fathers had taught a different doctrine, the Church would not have so vehemently rejected Pelagianism as an heretical innovation. Augustine himself insists on the novelty of the Pelagian teaching. “Such is the Pelagian heresy,” he says, “which is not an ancient one, but has only lately come into existence.”(275) And this view is confirmed by Pope Celestine I, who declares in his letter to the Bishops of Gaul (A. D. 431): “This being the state of the question, novelty should cease to attack antiquity.”(276)

In fact the teaching of the Apostolic Fathers, although less explicit, agrees entirely with that of Augustine. Thus St. Irenaeus says: “As the dry earth, if it receives no moisture, does not bring forth fruit, so we, being dry wood, could never bear fruit for life without supernatural rain freely given.... The blessing of salvation comes to us from God, not from ourselves.”(277)

The necessity of grace is indirectly inculcated by the Church when she petitions God to grant salutary graces to all men—a most ancient and venerable practice, which Pope St. Celestine explains as follows: “The law of prayer should determine the law of belief. For when the priests of holy nations administer the office entrusted to them, asking God for mercy, they plead the cause of the human race, and together

with the whole Church ask and pray that the unbelievers may receive the faith, that the idolaters may be freed from the errors of their impiety, that the veil be lifted from the heart of the Jews, and they be enabled to perceive the light of truth, that the heretics may return to their senses by a true perception of the Catholic faith, that the schismatics may receive the spirit of reborn charity, that the sinners be granted the remedy of penance, and that the door of heavenly mercy be opened to the catechumens who are led to the sacraments of regeneration."(278) In matters of salvation prayer and grace are correlative terms; the practice of the one implies the necessity and gratuity of the other.(279)

β) That the Fathers not only conceived grace to be necessary for the cure of weakness induced by sin (_gratia sanans_) in a merely moral sense, but thought it to be metaphysically necessary for the communication of physical strength (_gratia elevans_), is evidenced by such oft-recurring similes as these: Grace is as necessary for salvation as the eye is to see, or as wings are to fly, or as rain is for the growth of plants.

It will suffice to quote a passage from the writings of St. Chrysostom. "The eyes," he says, "are beautiful and useful for seeing, but if they would attempt to see without light, all their beauty and visual power would avail them nothing. Thus, too, the soul is but an obstacle in its own way if it endeavors to see without the Holy Ghost."(280)

This view is strengthened by the further teaching of the Fathers that supernatural grace was as indispensable to the angels in their state of probation (in which they were free from concupiscence) and to our first parents in Paradise (gifted as they were with the _donum integritatis_), as it is to fallen man; the only difference being that in the case of the latter, grace has the additional object of curing the infirmities and overcoming the difficulties arising from concupiscence. In regard to the angels St. Augustine says; "And who made this will but He who created them with a good will, that is to say with a chaste love by which they should cleave to Him, in one and the same act creating their nature and endowing it with grace?... We must therefore acknowledge, with the praise due to the Creator, that not only of holy men, but also of the holy angels, it can be said that 'the love of God is shed abroad in their hearts by the Holy Ghost, who is given unto them.' "(281)

Equally convincing is the argument that Adam in Paradise was unable to perform any salutary acts without divine grace. "Just as it is in man's power to die whenever he will," says St. Augustine, "... but the mere will cannot preserve life in the absence of food and the other means of life; so man in Paradise was able of his mere will, simply by abandoning righteousness, to destroy himself; but to have led a life of righteousness would have been too much for his will, unless it had been sustained by the power of Him who made him."(282)

This is also the teaching of the Second Council of Orange (A. D. 529): "Even if human nature remained in the state of integrity, in which it was constituted, it would in no wise save itself without the help of its Creator. If it was unable, without the grace of God, to keep what it had received, how should it be able without the grace of God to regain what it has lost?"(283)

c) The theological argument for the metaphysical necessity of grace is based on the essentially supernatural character of all salutary acts.

α) St. Thomas formulates it as follows: “Eternal life is an end transcending the proportion of human nature, ... and therefore man, by nature, can perform no meritorious works proportioned to eternal life, but requires for this purpose a higher power,—the power of grace. Consequently, man cannot merit eternal life without grace. He is, however, able to perform acts productive of some good connatural to man, such as tilling the soil, drinking, eating, acts of friendship, etc.”(284) For the reason here indicated it is as impossible for man to perform salutary acts without grace as it would be to work miracles without that divine assistance which transcends the powers of nature.(285)

β) Catholic theologians are unanimous in admitting that all salutary acts are and must needs be supernatural; but they differ in their conception of this supernatural quality (_supernaturalitas_). The problem underlying this difference of opinion may be stated thus: A thing may be supernatural either entitatively, _quoad substantiam_, or merely as to the manner of its existence, _quoad modum_. The _supernaturale quoad substantiam_ is divided into the strictly supernatural and the merely preternatural.(286) The question is: To what category of the supernatural belong the salutary acts which man performs by the aid of grace? Undoubtedly there are actual graces which are entitatively natural, _e.g._ the purely mediate grace of illumination,(287) the natural graces conferred in the pure state of nature, the actual graces of the sensitive sphere,(288) and the so-called _cogitatio congrua_ of Vasquez.(289) The problem therefore narrows itself down to the _immediate_ graces of intellect and will. Before the Tridentine Council theologians contented themselves with acknowledging the divinely revealed fact that these graces are supernatural; it was only after the Council that they began to speculate on the precise character of this _supernaturalitas_.

Some, following the teaching of the Scotist school, ascribed the supernatural character of salutary acts to their free acceptation on the part of God, holding them to be purely natural in their essence and raised to the supernatural sphere merely _per denominationem extrinsecam_.(290) This view is untenable. For if nature, as such, possessed the intrinsic power to perform salutary acts, irrespective of their acceptation by God, the Fathers and councils would err in teaching that this power is derived from the immediate graces of illumination and strengthening.(291)

Others hold that the salutary acts which grace enables man to perform, are supernatural only _quoad modum_; because while it is the Holy Ghost Himself who incites the natural faculties to salutary thoughts and good resolves, He does not _eo ipso_ raise these thoughts and resolves to the supernatural plane. This theory, besides being open to the same objection which we have urged against the first, involves another difficulty. If all salutary acts were supernatural only _quoad modum_, sanctifying grace, which is as certainly supernatural in its essence as the beatific vision of God,(292) would cease to have an adequate purpose; for the intrinsic reason for its existence is precisely that it raises the nature of the justified into a permanent supernatural state of being.

A third school of theologians tries to solve the difficulty by adding to the natural operation of the intellect and the will some accidental supernatural _modus_. There are several such _modi_, which, though inhering in nature and really distinct therefrom, depend solely on the Holy Ghost, and consequently transcend the natural powers of man, _e.g._ the duration or intensity of a salutary act. This theory at first blush appears more plausible than the other two, but it cannot be squared with the teaching of Tradition. In the first place, the duration or intensity of a salutary act cannot affect its essence or nature. Then again, every such accidental supernatural _modus_ is produced either by grace alone, or by grace working conjointly with free-will. In the former hypothesis it would be useless, because it would not render the free salutary act, as such, supernatural; in the latter case it could do no more than aid the will to do what is morally impossible, whereas every salutary act is in matter of fact a physical impossibility, that is, impossible to unaided nature.(293)

There remains a fourth explanation, which ascribes to every salutary act an ontological, substantial, intrinsic _supernaturalitas_, whereby it is elevated to a higher and essentially different plane of being and operation. This theory is convincingly set forth by Suarez in his treatise on the Necessity of Grace.(294)

It may be asked: If the salutary acts which we perform are supernatural in substance, why are we not conscious of the fact? The answer is not far to seek. Philosophical analysis shows that the intrinsic nature of our psychic operations is no more a subject of immediate consciousness than the substance of the soul itself. Consequently, sanctifying grace cannot reveal its presence through our inner consciousness. Having no intuitive knowledge of our own Ego, we are compelled to specify the different acts of the soul by means of their respective objects and their various tendencies (cognition, volition). To our consciousness the supernatural love of God does not present itself as essentially different from the natural.(295)

Article 3. The Necessity Of Actual Grace For The States Of Unbelief, Mortal Sin, And Justification

Every adult man, viewed in his relation to actual grace, is in one of three distinct states:

(1) The state of unbelief (_status infidelitatis_), which may be either negative, as in the case of heathens, or positive, as in the case of apostates and formal heretics;

(2) The state of mortal sin (_status peccati mortalis_), when the sinner has already received, or not yet lost, the grace of faith, which is the beginning of justification;

(3) The state of justification itself (_status iustitiae sive gratiae sanctificantis_), in which much remains yet to be done to attain eternal happiness.

The question we have now to consider is: Does man need actual grace in every one of these three states, and if so, to what extent?

1. SEMIPELAGIANISM.—Semipelagianism is an attempt to effect a compromise between Pelagianism and Augustinism by attributing to mere nature a somewhat greater importance in matters of salvation than St. Augustine was willing to admit.

a) After Augustine had for more than twenty years vigorously combatted and finally defeated Pelagianism, some pious monks of Marseilles, under the leadership of John Cassian, Abbot of St. Victor,(296) tried to find middle ground between his teaching and that of the Pelagians. Cassian's treatise _Collationes Patrum_,(297) and the reports sent to St. Augustine by his disciples Prosper and Hilary, enable us to form a pretty fair idea of the Semipelagian system. Its principal tenets were the following:

α) There is a distinction between the "beginning of faith" (_initium fidei_, _affectus credulitatis_) and "increase in faith" (_augmentum fidei_). The former depends entirely on the will, while the latter, like faith itself, requires the grace of Christ.

β) Nature can merit grace by its own efforts, though this natural merit (_meritum naturae_) is founded on equity only (_meritum de congruo_), and does not confer a right in strict justice, as Pelagius contended.

γ) Free-will, after justification, can of its own power secure the gift of final perseverance (_donum perseverantiae_); which consequently is not a special grace, but a purely natural achievement.

δ) The bestowal or denial of baptismal grace in the case of infants, who can have no previous _merita de congruo_, depends on their hypothetical future merits or demerits as foreseen by God from all eternity.(298)

b) Informed of these errors by his disciples, St. Augustine energetically set to work, and in spite of his advanced age wrote two books against the Semipelagians, entitled respectively, _De Praedestinatione Sanctorum_ and _De Dono Perseverantiae_. The new teaching was not yet, however, regarded as formally heretical, and Augustine treated his opponents with great consideration, in fact he humbly acknowledged that he himself had professed similar errors before his consecration (A. D. 394).(299)

After Augustine's death, Prosper and Hilary went to Rome and interested Pope Celestine in their cause. In a dogmatic letter addressed to the Bishops of Gaul, the Pontiff formally approved the teaching of St. Augustine on grace and original sin, but left open such other "more profound and difficult incidental questions" as predestination and the manner in which grace operates in the soul.(300) But as this papal letter (called "_Indiculus_") was an instruction rather than an ex-cathedra definition, the controversy continued until, nearly a century later (A. D. 529), the Second Council of Orange, convoked by St. Caesarius of Arles, formally condemned the Semipelagian heresy. This council, or at least its first eight canons,(301) received the solemn approbation of Pope Boniface II (A. D. 530) and thus became vested with ecumenical authority.(302)

2. THE TEACHING OF THE CHURCH.—The Catholic Church teaches the absolute necessity of actual grace for all stages on the way to salvation. We shall demonstrate this in five separate theses.

Thesis I: Prevenient grace is absolutely necessary, not only for faith, but for the very beginning of faith.

This is _de fide_.

Proof. The Second Council of Orange defined against the Semipelagians: “If any one say that increase in faith, as well as the beginning of faith, and the very impulse by which we are led to believe in Him who justifies the sinner, and by which we obtain the regeneration of holy Baptism, is in us not as a gift of grace, that is to say, through the inspiration of the Holy Ghost, but by nature, … is an adversary of the dogmatic teaching of the Apostles….”(303)

a) This is thoroughly Scriptural doctrine, as St. Augustine(304) and Prosper(305) proved. St. Paul’s first epistle to the Corinthians had opened the eyes of Augustine, as he himself admits. 1 Cor. IV, 7: “For who distinguisheth(306) thee? Or what hast thou that thou hast not received? And if thou hast received, why dost thou glory, as if thou hadst not received it?” The Apostle means to say: In matters pertaining to salvation no man has any advantage over his fellow men, because all receive of the grace of God without any merits of their own. This statement would be false if any man were able to perform even the smallest salutary act without the aid of grace.

With a special view to faith the same Apostle teaches: “For by grace you are saved through faith,(307) and that not of yourselves,(308) for it is the gift of God;(309) not of works,(310) that no man may glory.”(311) This, too, would be false if faith could be traced to a purely natural instinct or to some _meritum de congruo_ in the Semipelagian sense.(312) Our Lord Himself, in his famous discourse on the Holy Eucharist, unmistakably describes faith and man’s preparation for it as an effect of prevenient grace. “No man can come to me, except the Father, who hath sent me, draw him.”(313) The metaphorical expression “come to me,” according to the context, means “believe in me;” whereas the Father’s “drawing” plainly refers to the operation of prevenient grace. Cfr. John VI, 65 sq.: “But there are some of you that believe not…. Therefore did I say to you, that no man can come to me, unless it be given him by the Father.” John VI, 29: “This is the work of God,(314) that you believe in him whom he hath sent.” According to our Saviour’s own averment, therefore, preaching is of no avail unless grace gives the first impulse leading to faith.

b) As regards the argument from Tradition, it will suffice to show that the Fathers who wrote before Augustine, ascribed the beginning of faith to prevenient grace.

α) In the light of the Augustinian dictum that “prayer is the surest proof of grace,”(315) it is safe to assume that St. Justin Martyr voiced our dogma when he put into the mouth of a venerable old man the words: “But thou pray above all that the gates of light may be opened unto thee; for no man is able to understand the words of the prophets [as _praeambula fidei_] unless God and His Christ have revealed their meaning.”(316) Augustine himself appeals to SS. Cyprian, Ambrose, and Gregory of Nazianzus, and then continues: “Such doctors, and so great as these, saying that there is nothing of which we may boast as of our own, which God has not given us; and that our very heart and our thoughts are not in our own power, … attribute these things to the grace of God, acknowledge them as God’s gifts, testify that they come to us from Him and are not from ourselves.”(317)

β) Like the Pelagians in their teaching on original sin,(318) the Semipelagians in their teaching on grace relied mainly on the authority of St. John Chrysostom, from whose writings they loved to quote such perplexing passages as this: “We must first select the good, and then God adds what is of His; He does not forestall our will because He does not wish to destroy our liberty. But once we have made our choice, He gives us much help. For while it rests with us to choose and to will antecedently, it lies with him to perfect and bring to an issue.”(319)

To understand St. Chrysostom’s attitude, and that of the Oriental Fathers generally, we must remember that the Eastern Church considered it one of its chief duties to safeguard the dogma of free-will against the Manichaeans, who regarded man as an abject slave of Fate. In such an environment it was of supreme importance to champion the freedom of the will(320) and to insist on the maxim: “Help yourself and God will help you.” If the necessity of prevenient grace was not sufficiently emphasized, the circumstances of the time explain, and to some extent excuse, the mistake. St. Augustine himself remarks in his treatise on the Predestination of the Saints: “What need is there for us to look into the writings of those who, before this heresy sprang up, had no necessity of dwelling on a question so difficult of solution as this, which beyond a doubt they would do if they were compelled to answer such [errors as these]? Whence it came about that they touched upon what they thought of God’s grace briefly and cursorily in some passages of their writings.”(321) Palmieri remarks(322) that it would be easy to cite a number of similar passages from the writings of the early Latin Fathers before Pelagius, who certainly cannot be suspected of Semipelagian leanings.(323)

The orthodoxy of St. Chrysostom can be positively established by a twofold argument. (1) Pope Celestine the First recommended him as a reliable defender of the Catholic faith against Nestorianism and Pelagianism.(324) (2) Chrysostom rejected Semipelagianism as it were in advance when he taught: “Not even faith is of ourselves; for if He [God] had not come, if He had not called, how should we have been able to believe?”(325) and again when he says in his explanation of the Pauline phrase ἀρχηγὸς τῆς πίστεως:(326) “He Himself hath implanted the faith in us, He Himself hath given the beginning.”(327) These utterances are diametrically opposed to the heretical teaching of the Semipelagians.(328)

c) The theological argument for our thesis is effectively formulated by Oswald(329) as follows: “It is faith which first leads man from the sphere of nature into a higher domain,—faith is the beginning of salutary action. That this beginning must come wholly from God, and that it cannot come from man, goes without saying. By beginning we mean the very first beginning. Whether we call this first beginning itself faith, or speak, as the Semipelagians did, of certain preambles of faith,—aspirations, impulses, desires leading to faith (_praeambula fidei: conatus, desideria, credulitatis affectus_), makes no difference. Wherever the supernatural domain of salutary action begins—and it is divided off from the natural by a very sharp line—there it is God who begins and not man, there it is grace which precedes,—_gratia praeveniens_, as it has come to be known by a famous term.”

Indeed, if man were able by his own power to merit for himself the first beginnings of grace, then faith itself, and justification which is based on faith, and the beatific vision, would not be strictly graces.

As for the precise moment when prevenient grace begins its work in the soul, the common opinion is that the very first judgment which a man forms as to the credibility of divine revelation (_iudicium credibilitatis_) is determined by the immediate grace of the intellect,(330) and that the subsequent _affectus credulitatis_ springs from the strengthening grace of the will. St. Augustine, commenting on 2 Cor. III, 5, demonstrates this as follows:

“Let them give attention to this, and well weigh these words, who think that the beginning of faith is of ourselves, and the increase of faith is of God. For who cannot see that thinking is prior to believing? For no one believes anything unless he has first thought that it is to be believed.... Therefore, in what pertains to religion and piety [of which the Apostle was speaking], if we are not capable of thinking anything as of ourselves, but our sufficiency is of God, we are certainly not capable of believing anything as of ourselves, since we cannot do this without thinking, but our sufficiency, by which we begin to believe, is of God.”(331)

Thesis II: The sinner, even after he has received the faith, stands in absolute need of prevenient and co-operating grace for every single salutary act required in the process of justification.

This proposition also embodies an article of faith.

Proof. The Semipelagians ascribed the dispositions necessary for justification to the natural efforts of the will, thereby denying the necessity of prevenient grace. This teaching was condemned as heretical by the Second Council of Orange (A. D. 529),(332) and again by the Council of Trent, which defined: “If any one saith that without the prevenient inspiration of the Holy Ghost, and without His help, man can believe, hope, love, or be penitent as he ought, so that the grace of justification may be bestowed upon him; let him be anathema.”(333)

a) The Scriptural texts which we have quoted against Pelagianism(334) also apply to the Semipelagian heresy.

Our Lord’s dictum: “Without me you can do nothing,”(335) proves the necessity of prevenient and co-operating grace, not only at the beginning of every salutary act, but also for its continuation and completion. St. Augustine clearly perceived this. “That he might furnish a reply to the future Pelagius,” he observes, “our Lord does not say: Without me you can with difficulty do anything; but He says: Without me you can do _nothing_.... He does not say: Without me you can _perfect_ nothing, but _do_ nothing. For if He had said _perfect_, they might say that God’s aid is necessary, not for beginning good, which is of ourselves, but for perfecting it.... For when the Lord says, Without me you can do nothing, in this one word He comprehends both the beginning and the end.”(336)

St. Paul expressly ascribes the salvation of man to grace when he says: “... with fear and trembling work out your salvation; for it is God who worketh in you, both to

will and to accomplish."(337)

The Tridentine Council, as we have seen, designates the four salutary acts of faith, hope, love, and penitence as a preparation for justification. Now St. Paul teaches: "The God of hope fill you with all joy and peace in believing, that you may abound in hope and in the power of the Holy Ghost;"(338) and St. John: "Charity is of God."(339)

b) The argument from Tradition is chiefly based on St. Augustine, who in his two treatises against the Semipelagians, and likewise in his earlier writings, inculcates the necessity of grace for all stages on the way to salvation.

Thus he writes in his _Enchiridion_: "Surely, if no Christian will dare to say this: It is not of God that showeth mercy, but of man that willeth, lest he should openly contradict the Apostle, it follows that the true interpretation of the saying (Rom. IX, 16): 'It is not of him that willeth, nor of him that runneth, but of God that showeth mercy,' is that the whole work belongs to God, who both prepares the good will that is to be helped, and assists it when it is prepared. For the good will of man precedes many of God's gifts, but not all; and it must itself be included among those which it does not precede. We read in Holy Scripture, both 'God's mercy shall prevent me' (Ps. LVIII, 11), and 'Thy mercy will follow me' (Ps. XXII, 6). It precedes the unwilling to make him willing; it follows the willing to render his will effectual. Why are we taught to pray for our enemies, who are plainly unwilling to lead a holy life, unless it be that God may work willingness in them? And why are we admonished to ask that we may receive, unless it be that He who has created in us the wish, may Himself satisfy the same? We pray, then, for our enemies, that the mercy of God may precede them, as it has preceded us; we pray for ourselves, that His mercy may follow us."(340)

That grace accompanies us uninterruptedly on the way to Heaven is also the teaching of St. Jerome: "To will and to run is my own act; but without the constant aid of God, even my own act will not be mine; for the Apostle says (Phil. II, 13): 'It is God who worketh in you, both to will and to accomplish.'... It is not sufficient for me that He gave it once, unless He gives it always."(341)

St. Ephraem Syrus prays in the name of the Oriental Church: "I possess nothing, and if I possess anything, Thou [O God] hast given it to me.... I ask only for grace and acknowledge that I shall be saved through Thee."(342)

The Second Council of Orange summarizes the teaching of Tradition on the subject under consideration.(343)

c) The theological argument for our thesis is based on the character of the adoptive sonship resulting from the process of justification.(344) This sonship (_filiatio adoptiva_) is essentially supernatural, and hence can be attained only by strictly supernatural acts, which unaided nature is both morally and physically incapable of performing.(345)

Thesis III: Even in the state of sanctifying grace man is not able to perform salutary acts, unless aided by actual graces.

This is likewise _de fide_.

Proof. The faculties of the just man are permanently kept in the supernatural sphere by sanctifying grace and by the habits of faith, hope, and charity. Hence the just man in the performance of salutary acts does not require the same measure of prevenient grace as the unregenerate sinner, who lacks all, or at least some, of the habits mentioned.

The question here at issue, therefore, can only be: Is actual grace (as _gratia excitans s. vocans_, not _elevans_) absolutely necessary to enable a man in the state of sanctifying grace to perform salutary acts? The answer is—Yes, and this teaching is so firmly grounded on Sacred Scripture and Tradition, and so emphatically sanctioned by the Church, that we do not hesitate to follow Perrone in qualifying it as _de fide_.(346) The councils in their teaching on the necessity of grace, assert that necessity alike for the justified and the unjustified. That of Trent expressly declares: “Whereas Jesus Christ Himself continually infuses His virtue into the justified,—as the head into the members, and the vine into the branches,—and this virtue always precedes and accompanies and follows their good works, which without it could not in any wise be pleasing and meritorious before God, we must believe that nothing further is wanting to the justified....”(347)

a) Our thesis can be easily proved from Holy Scripture. We have already shown that the Bible and Tradition make no distinction between the different stages on the way to salvation, or between different salutary acts, but indiscriminately postulate for all the illuminating grace of the intellect and the strengthening grace of the will. It follows that to perform salutary acts the justified no less than the unjustified need actual grace. Our Saviour’s pithy saying: “Without me you can do nothing,”(348) was not addressed to unbelievers or sinners, but to His Apostles, who were in the state of sanctifying grace.(349)

This interpretation is fully borne out by Tradition. St. Augustine, after laying it down as a general principle that “We can of ourselves do nothing to effect good works of piety without God either working that we may will, or co-operating when we will,”(350) says of justified man in particular: “The Heavenly Physician cures our maladies, not only that they may cease to exist, but in order that we may ever afterwards be able to walk aright,—a task to which we should be unequal, even after our healing, were it not for His continued help.... For just as the eye of the body, even when completely sound, is unable to see, unless aided by the brightness of light, so also man, even when fully justified, is unable to lead a holy life, unless he be divinely assisted by the eternal light of righteousness.”(351)

This agrees with the practice of the Church in exhorting all men without exception, saints as well as sinners, to pray: “Precede, we beseech Thee, O Lord, our actions by Thy holy inspiration, and carry them on by Thy gracious assistance, that every prayer and work of ours may begin always from Thee, and through Thee be happily ended.”(352)

b) Some theologians have been led by certain speculative difficulties to deny the necessity of actual grace in the state of justification.

Man in the state of justification, they argue, is endowed with sanctifying grace, the supernatural habits of faith, hope, and charity, and the infused moral virtues, and consequently possesses all those qualifications which are necessary to enable him to perform salutary acts with the supernatural concurrence of God. Why should the will, thus supernaturally equipped, require the aid of additional actual graces to enable it to perform strictly supernatural, and therefore salutary, actions?(353)

We reply: The necessity of actual grace in the state of justification is so clearly taught by divine Revelation that no theological theory is tenable which denies it. Besides, the objection we have briefly summarized disregards some very essential considerations, _e.g._ that there remains in man, even after justification, concupiscence, which is accompanied by a certain weakness that requires at least the _gratia sanans sive medicinalis_ to heal it.(354) Furthermore, a quiescent _habitus_ cannot set itself in motion, but must be determined from without; that is to say, in our case, it must be moved by the _gratia excitans_ to elicit supernatural thoughts and to will supernatural acts. Just as a seed cannot sprout without the aid of appropriate stimuli, so sanctifying grace is incapable of bearing fruit unless stimulated by the sunshine and moisture of actual graces. Man may perform purely natural acts even though he be in the supernatural state of grace; hence if any particular act of his is to be truly supernatural and conducive to eternal salvation, God must lend His special aid.(355)

Thesis IV: Except by a special privilege of divine grace, man, even though he be in the state of sanctifying grace, is unable to avoid venial sin throughout life.

This is likewise _de fide_.

Proof. The Pelagians held that man is able to avoid sin, nay to attain to absolute impeccability,(356) without supernatural assistance. Against this error the Second Council of Mileve (A. D. 416) defined: “It likewise hath pleased [the holy Synod] that whoever holds that the words of the Our Father: ‘Forgive us our trespasses,’ when pronounced by saintly men, are pronounced in token of humility, but not truthfully, should be anathema.”(357) Still more to the point is the following declaration of the Council of Trent: “If any one saith that a man once justified ... is able, during his whole life, to avoid all sins, even those that are venial, except by a special grace from God, as the Church holds in regard of the Blessed Virgin; let him be anathema.”(358)

To obtain a better understanding of this Tridentine definition it will be well to ponder the following considerations:

The Council declares that it is impossible for man, even in the state of sanctifying grace, to avoid all sins during his whole life, except by virtue of a special privilege such as that enjoyed by the Blessed Virgin Mary.(359) A venial sin is one which, because of the unimportance of the precept involved, or in consequence of incomplete consent, does not destroy the state of grace. Such a sin may be either deliberate or semi-deliberate. A semi-deliberate venial sin is one committed in haste or surprise. It is chiefly sins of this kind that the Tridentine Council had in view. For no one would seriously assert that with the aid of divine grace a saint could not avoid at least all deliberate venial sins for a considerable length of time. The phrase “_in

tota vita_" indicates a period of some length, though its limits are rather difficult to determine. Were a man to die immediately after justification, the Tridentine canon would _per accidens_ not apply to him. As the Council says in another place that "men, how holy and just soever, at times fall into at least light and daily sins, which are also called venial,"(360) it is safe practically to limit the period of possible freedom from venial sin to one day. Theoretically, of course, it may be extended much farther. The phrase "_omnia peccata_" must be interpreted collectively, not distributively, for a sin that could not be avoided would cease to be a sin. For the same reason the term "_non posse_" must be understood of (moral, not physical) disability; in other words, the difficulty of avoiding sin with the aid of ordinary graces for any considerable length of time, is insuperable even for the just. This moral impossibility of avoiding sin can be removed only by a special privilege, such as that enjoyed by the Blessed Virgin Mary. It may incidentally be asked whether this privilege was also granted to other saints, notably St. Joseph and St. John the Baptist. Suarez lays it down as a theological conclusion that no human being has ever been or ever will be able entirely to avoid venial sin except by a special privilege, which must in each case be proved. Palmieri maintains that the moral impossibility of leading an absolutely sinless life without the special assistance of grace is taught by indirection in the canons of Mileve (416) and Carthage (418), which declare that no such life has ever been led by mortal man without that assistance.(361)

a) The Scriptural argument for our thesis was fully developed by the councils just mentioned. The careful student will note, however, that those texts only are strictly conclusive which positively and exclusively refer to venial sins. Thus when St. James says: "In many things we all offend,"(362) he cannot mean that all Christians now and then necessarily commit mortal sin. For St. John expressly declares that "Whosoever abideth in him [Christ], sinneth not."(363)

It follows that not even the just can wholly avoid venial sin. Hence the most devout and pious Christian may truthfully repeat the petition of the Lord's Prayer which says: "Forgive us our trespasses,(364) as we forgive those who trespass against us."(365) Profoundly conscious of the sinfulness of the entire human race, the author of the Book of Proverbs exclaims: "Who can say, My heart is clean, I am pure from sin?"(366)

Other Scripture texts commonly cited in confirmation of our thesis lack cogency, because they either deal exclusively with mortal sin or do not refer to sin at all. Thus Prov. XXIV, 16: "A just man shall fall seven times and shall rise again," is meant of temporal adversities.(367) Eccles. VII, 21: "There is no just man upon earth, that doth good and sinneth not,"(368) can scarcely be understood of venial sin, because the sacred writer continues: "For thy conscience knoweth that thou also hast often spoken evil of others."(369) 1 John I, 8: "If we say that we have no sin, we deceive ourselves, and the truth is not in us,"(370) would be a splendid argument for our thesis, could it be shown that the Apostle had in mind only the venial sins committed in the state of justification. This is, however, unlikely, as the term _peccatum_ throughout St. John's first Epistle(371) is obviously employed in the sense of mortal sin.(372)

b) Tradition is again most effectively voiced by St. Augustine, who writes: “There are three points, as you know, which the Catholic Church chiefly maintains against them [the Pelagians]. One is, that the grace of God is not given according to our merits.... The second, that no one lives in this corruptible body in righteousness of any degree without sins of any kind. The third, that man is born obnoxious to the first man’s sin....”(373) To Pelagius’ objection: “If all men sin, then the just must die in their sins,” the holy Doctor replies: “With all his acuteness he [Pelagius] overlooks the circumstance that even righteous persons pray with good reason: ‘Forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors.’... Even if we cannot live without sin, we may yet die without sin, whilst the sin committed in ignorance or infirmity is blotted out in merciful forgiveness.”(374) In another chapter of the same treatise he says: “If ... we could assemble all the afore-mentioned holy men and women, and ask them whether they lived without sin, ... would they not all exclaim with one voice: ‘If we say we have no sin, we deceive ourselves, and the truth is not in us’?”(375)

c) We come to the theological argument. The moral impossibility of avoiding venial sin for any considerable length of time results partly from the infirmity of human nature (_infirmitas naturae_), partly from God’s pre-established plan of salvation (_ordo divinae providentiae_).

α) The infirmity of human nature flows from four separate and distinct sources: (1) concupiscence (_fomes peccati_); (2) imperfection of the ethical judgment (_imperfectio iudicii_); (3) inconstancy of the will (_inconstantia voluntatis_); and (4) the weariness caused by continued resistance to temptation. In view of these agencies and their combined attack upon the will, theologians speak of a _necessitas antecedens peccandi_;—not as if the will were predestined to succumb to any one temptation in particular, but in the sense that it is morally unable to resist the whole series (_suppositione disiunctâ_). The will simply grows weaker and weaker, and in course of time fails to resist sin with sufficient energy.

Let us exemplify. The proofsheets of a book are scrutinized by several trained readers, yet in spite of the greatest care and many ingenious devices for the elimination of error, a perfect book, _i.e._ one entirely free from mistakes, is a practical impossibility. How much harder must it be for man to avoid moral lapses throughout his whole life, considering that he cannot choose his own time for meeting temptations, but must keep his mind and will under constant control and be prepared to resist the enemy at any moment.(376)

St. Thomas Aquinas says: “Man cannot avoid all venial sin, because his sensual appetite is depraved. True, reason is able to suppress the individual stirrings of this appetite. In fact, it is on this account that they are voluntary and partake of the nature of sin. But reason is not able to suppress them all [collectively], because, while it tries to resist one, there perhaps arises another, and, furthermore, reason is not always in a condition to exercise the vigilance necessary to avoid such impulses.”(377)

It follows that the _necessitas peccandi antecedens_ does not destroy the liberty of the will or the moral imputability of those venial sins which a man actually commits;

for it is merely a _necessitas indeterminata_, which refers not to certain particular instances, but to the one or other indeterminately. It follows further that God does not command the impossible when He insists that we should avoid venial sin, for He does not in each single case command something which is physically or morally impossible,(378) but merely demands a perfection which in itself is not entirely unattainable _hic et nunc_ with the assistance of ordinary grace.(379)

β) The second theological reason for the impossibility of avoiding venial sin for any considerable time is based on the eternal scheme of salvation decreed by Divine Providence. This scheme of salvation must not, of course, be conceived as a divine precept to commit venial sins. It is merely a wise toleration of sin and a just refusal, on the part of the Almighty, to restore the human race to that entirely unmerited state of freedom from concupiscence with which it was endowed in Paradise, and which alone could guarantee the moral possibility of unspotted innocence. Both factors in their last analysis are based upon the will of God to exercise those whom He has justified in humility and to safeguard us against pride, which is the deadliest enemy of our salvation.(380) In making this wise decree God, of course, infallibly foresaw that no man (with the sole exception of those to whom He might grant a special privilege) would _de facto_ be able to pass through life without committing venial sins. This infallible foreknowledge is based not alone on the _scientia media_, but also on the infirmity of human nature.

Hence Suarez was entirely justified in rejecting the singular opinion of de Vega,(381) that the Tridentine definition does not exclude the possibility of exceptions.(382)

Nevertheless the faithful are wisely warned against both indifference and despondency. “Let no one say that he is without sin, but let us not for this reason love sin. Let us detest sin, brethren. Though we are not without sins, let us hate them; especially let us avoid grievous sins, and venial sins, too, as much as we can.”(383)

Thesis V: No man can persevere in righteousness without special help from God.

This proposition is also _de fide_.

Proof. The Semipelagians asserted that man is able by his own power to persevere in righteousness to the end.(384) Against this teaching the Second Council of Orange defined: “Even those who are reborn and holy must implore the help of God, in order that they may be enabled to attain the good end, or to persevere in the good work.”(385) This definition was repeated in substance by the Council of Trent: “If any one saith that the justified either is able without the special help of God to persevere in the justice received, or that, with that help, he is not able; let him be anathema.”(386)

Perfect perseverance is the preservation of baptismal innocence, or, in a less strict sense, of the state of grace, until death. Imperfect perseverance is a temporary continuance in grace, _e.g._ for a month or a year, until the next mortal sin. Imperfect perseverance, according to the Tridentine Council, requires no special divine assistance (_speciale auxilium_).(387)

Final perseverance is either passive or active, according as the justified dies in the state of grace irrespective of his will (as baptized children and insane adults),(388) or actively coöperates with grace whenever the state of grace is imperilled by grievous temptation. The Council of Trent has especially this latter case in view when it speaks of the necessity of a _speciale auxilium_, because the special help extended by God presupposes coöperation with grace, and man cannot strictly speaking coöperate in a happy death. The Council purposely speaks of an _auxilium_, not a _privilegium_, because a privilege is by its very nature granted to but few, while the special help of grace extends to all the elect. This _auxilium_ is designated as _speciale_, because final perseverance is not conferred with sanctifying grace, nor is it a result of the mere power of perseverance (_posse perseverare_). The state of sanctifying grace simply confers a claim to ordinary graces, while the power of perseverance of itself by no means insures actual perseverance (_actu perseverare_). The power of perseverance is assured by those merely sufficient graces which are constantly at the command of the righteous. Actual perseverance, on the other hand, implies a series of efficacious graces. God is under no obligation to bestow more than sufficient grace on any man; consequently, final perseverance is a special grace, or, more correctly, a continuous series of efficacious graces. The Council of Trent is therefore justified in speaking of it as “a great gift.”(389)

a) Sacred Scripture represents final perseverance as the fruit of prayer and as a special gift not included in the bare notion of justification.

α) Our Divine Saviour Himself says in His prayer for His disciples, John XVII, 11: “Holy Father, keep them in thy name whom thou hast given me, that they may be one, as we also are.”(390) St. Paul teaches in his Epistle to the Colossians: “Epaphras saluteth you … who is always solicitous for you in prayers, that you may stand perfect and full in all the will of God.”(391) Hence the necessity of constantly watching and praying: “Watch ye and pray that ye enter not into temptation.”(392)

β) That perseverance is not included in the bare notion of justification appears from such passages as these: Phil. I, 6: “Being confident of this very thing, that he who hath begun a good work in you, will perfect it unto the day of Christ Jesus.”(393) 1 Pet. I, 5: “Who, by the power of God, are kept by faith unto salvation, ready to be revealed in the last time.”(394)

b) The threads of Tradition run together in the hands of St. Augustine, who has written a special treatise On the Gift of Perseverance.(395)

His main argument is based on the necessity of prayer. “Why,” he asks, “is that perseverance asked for from God, if it is not given by God? Is it a mocking petition inasmuch as that is asked of Him which it is known He does not give, but, although He gives it not, is in man’s power?... Or is not that perseverance, perchance, asked for from Him? He who says this, is not to be rebuked by my arguments, but must be overwhelmed with the prayers of the saints. Is there indeed one among them who do not ask for themselves from God that they may persevere in Him, when in that very prayer which is called the Lord’s—because the Lord taught it—whenever it is prayed by the saints, scarcely anything else is understood to be prayed for but

perseverance?”(396) He then proceeds to show, in accordance with St. Cyprian’s little treatise On the Lord’s Prayer, that the seven petitions of the “Our Father” are all prayers for perseverance, and concludes as follows: “Truly in this matter let not the Church look for laborious disputations, but consider her own daily prayers. She prays that the unbelieving may believe; therefore God converts to the faith. She prays that believers may persevere; therefore God gives perseverance to the end.”(397) And again: “For who is there that would groan with a sincere desire to receive what he prays for from the Lord, if he thought that he received it from himself and not from the Lord?”(398)

c) From this teaching flows a corollary of great practical importance, to wit: The grace of final perseverance cannot be merited by good works, but it can be obtained by pious and unremitting prayer.

“This gift of God,” says St. Augustine, speaking of final perseverance, “may be obtained suppliantly [by prayer], but when it has been given, it cannot be lost contumaciously.”(399) And again: “Since it is manifest that God has prepared some things to be given even to those who do not pray for them, such as the beginning of faith, and other things not to be given except to those who pray for them, such as perseverance unto the end, certainly he who thinks that he has this latter from himself, does not pray to obtain it.”(400)

Between merit (_meritum_) and prayer (_oratio, preces_) there is this great difference, that merit appeals to God’s justice, prayer to His mercy. If man were able to merit final perseverance by good works (_meritum de condigno_), God would be in justice bound to give him this precious grace. But this is plainly incompatible with the Catholic conception of final perseverance.

It may be asked: Is God determined by the _meritum de congruo_ inherent in all good works to grant the gift of final perseverance as a reward to the righteous? Theologians are at variance on this point. Ripalda(401) thinks that this is the case at least with the more conspicuous good works performed in the state of grace. Suarez modifies this improbable contention somewhat by saying that prayer alone can infallibly guarantee final perseverance.(402) Our prayers are infallibly heard if we address the Father through Jesus Christ, because Christ has promised: “If you ask the Father anything in my name, he will give it you.”(403) To insure its being infallibly heard, prayer for perseverance must be made in the state of grace and unremittingly. True, Christ did not make sanctifying grace a necessary condition of efficacious prayer. But, as Suarez points out, prayer cannot be infallibly efficacious unless it proceeds from one who is in the state of grace, because the moral conditions that render it efficacious are found only in that state.(404) As to the second point, if we say that prayer for perseverance must be unremitting, we mean, in the words of the same eminent theologian, that it must continue throughout life and must be made with becoming trustfulness and zeal, especially when there is a duty to be fulfilled or a temptation to be overcome.(405)

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Section 2. The Gratuity Of Actual Grace

All grace _ex vi termini_ is a free gift.(406) This applies particularly to Christian grace, which is so absolutely gratuitous that its gratuity, together with its necessity, may be called the groundwork of the Catholic religion.

1. STATE OF THE QUESTION.—To show what is meant by “gratuity” (_gratuitas_) we must first explain the technical term “merit.”

a) “Merit” (_meritum_=that which is earned) is that property of a good work which entitles the performer to receive a reward from him to whose advantage the work redounds.

α) An analysis of this definition shows that (1) merit is found only in such works as are positively good; (2) merit and reward are correlative terms which postulate each other; (3) merit supposes two distinct persons, one who deserves and another who awards; (4) the relation between merit and reward is based on justice, not on benevolence or mercy. The last-mentioned determination is by far the most important of the four.(407)

β) Ethics and theology clearly distinguish two kinds of merit: (1) condign merit,(408) which is merit in the strict sense (_meritum adaequatum sive de condigno_), and (2) congruous merit (_meritum inadaequatum sive de congruo_), so called because of the congruity, or fitness, that the claim should be recognized. Condign merit presupposes some proportion between the work done and the reward given in compensation for it (_aequalitas s. condignitas dati et accepti_). It is measured by commutative justice and thus confers a real claim to a reward. For example, a conscientious workman has a strict claim to his wage. Owing to the lack of intrinsic proportion between service and reward, congruous merit can claim a remuneration only on grounds of fairness.

A distinction between these two kinds of merit was already made by the Fathers, though not in the terms of present-day theology. It was known to the older Scholastics and emphasized anew by Luther’s famous adversary Johann Eck.(409)

No relation of strict justice is conceivable between the Creator and His creatures. On the part of God there can only be question of a gratuitous promise to reward certain good works,—which promise He is bound to keep because He is veracious and faithful.(410)

b) Two other terms must also be clearly defined in order to arrive at a true conception of the gratuity of Christian grace. They are prayer for grace,(411) and a capacity or disposition to receive it.(412) To pray means to incite God’s liberality or mercy by humble supplication.

α) Despite the contrary teaching of Vasquez(413) and a few other theologians, congruous merit and prayer are really distinct because one can exist without the other. As the angels in Heaven are able to pray for us without earning a _meritum de

congruo_, so conversely, all salutary works are meritorious even without prayer. Moreover, humble supplication does not involve any positive service entitled to a reward.

There is another important and obvious distinction, _viz._: between purely natural prayer (_preces naturae_) and supernatural prayer inspired by grace (_oratio supernaturalis_).

β) Capacity or disposition, especially when it takes the form of preparation, may be either positive or negative. Positive capacity is defined as “that real mode by which a subject, in itself indifferent, becomes apt to receive a new form.” Such a capacity or disposition always entails a claim to its respective form.

Positive capacity or disposition differs from both prayer or quasi-merit (_meritum de congruo_). Quasi-merit is entitled to a reward on the ground of fairness, whereas the _capacitas s. dispositio positiva_ is at most the fulfilment of an expectation based upon purely teleological considerations. Again, a reward can be bestowed upon some subject other than the one by whom the service was rendered, whereas the introduction of a new form necessarily supposes a subject disposed for or prepared to receive it. Thus only he who is hungry is disposed for the reception of food and entitled to have his craving satisfied.

Negative capacity consists in the absence or removal of obstacles that impede the reception of a new form, as when green wood is dried to become fit for burning.

c) There arises the important question whether or not divine grace is an object of merit, and if so, to what extent it can be merited by prayer and preparation.

It is of faith that the just man, by the performance of supernaturally good deeds, can merit _de condigno_ an increase in the state of grace and eternal glory, and that the sinner is able to earn justification _de congruo_. On the other hand, it is also an article of faith that divine grace is strictly gratuitous.(414) The two dogmas seem incompatible, but they are not, as will become evident if we consider that the good works of the just and the salutary works of the sinner are entirely rooted in divine grace and consequently the merits which they contain are strictly merits of grace in no wise due to nature.(415) When we speak of the absolute gratuity of grace, therefore, we mean the very first or initial grace (_gratia prima vocans_), by which the work of salvation is begun. Of this initial grace the Church explicitly teaches that it is absolutely incapable of being merited; whence it follows that all subsequent graces, up to and including justification, are also gratuitous,(416) _i.e._ unmerited by nature in strict justice, in so far as they are based on the _gratia prima_.

2. THE GRATUITY OF GRACE PROVED FROM REVELATION.—Keeping the above explanation well in mind we now proceed to demonstrate the gratuity of divine grace in five systematic theses.

Thesis I: Mere nature cannot, in strict justice (de condigno), merit initial grace (gratia prima), nor, consequently, any of the series of subsequent graces in the order of justification.

This proposition embodies an article of faith.

Proof. It was one of the fundamental errors of Pelagius that grace can be merited by purely natural acts.(417) When, at the instance of the bishops assembled at Diospolis (A. D. 415), he retracted his proposition that “the grace of God is given according to our merits,”(418) he employed the term _gratia Dei_ dishonestly for the grace of creation. The Second Council of Orange (A. D. 529) formally defined that grace cannot be merited, but is purely and strictly gratuitous.(419) And the Council of Trent declared: “In adults the beginning of justification is to be derived from the prevenient grace of God through Jesus Christ, that is to say, from His vocation, whereby, without any merits existing on their parts, they are called....”(420) The non-existence of merits prior to the bestowal of the _prima gratia vocans,_ so positively asserted in this definition, plainly excludes any and all natural merit _de condigno._

a) St. Paul demonstrates in his Epistle to the Romans that justification does not result from obedience to the law, but is a grace freely bestowed by God.

The Apostle regards the merciful dispensations of Providence in favor of the Chosen People, and of the entire sinful race of men in general, as so many sheer graces. Rom. IX, 16: “So then it is not of him that willeth, nor of him that runneth, but of God that showeth mercy.”(421) The gratuity of grace is asserted in terms that almost sound extravagant two verses further down in the same Epistle: “Therefore he hath mercy on whom he will; and whom he will, he hardeneth.”(422) The same truth is emphasized in Rom. XI, 6: “And if by grace, it is not now by works: otherwise grace is no more grace.”(423) Lest any one should pride himself on having obtained faith, which is the root of justification, by his own merits, St. Paul declares in his Epistle to the Ephesians: “For by grace you are saved through faith, and that not of yourselves, for it is the gift of God; not of works, that no man may glory. For we are his workmanship, created in Christ Jesus in good works, which God hath prepared that we should walk in them.”(424) These and many similar passages(425) make it plain that grace cannot be merited without supernatural aid.

b) The leading champion of the dogma of the gratuity of grace among the Fathers is St. Augustine, who never tires of repeating that “Grace does not find merits, but causes them,”(426) and substantiates this fundamental principle thus: “Grace has preceded thy merit; not grace by merit, but merit by grace. For if grace is by merit, thou hast bought, not received gratis.”(427)

c) The theological argument is based (1) on the disproportion between nature and grace and (2) on the absolute necessity of grace for the performance of salutary works.

There is no proportion between the natural and the supernatural, and it would be a contradiction to say that mere nature can span the chasm separating the two orders. To assume the existence of a strict _meritum naturae_ for it, would be to deny the gratuity as well as the supernatural character of grace. To deny these would be to deny grace itself and with it the whole supernatural order that forms the groundwork of Christianity. We know, on the other hand,(428) that grace is absolutely indispensable for the performance of salutary acts. Hence, to deny the gratuity of

grace would be to credit nature with the ability to perform salutary acts by its own power, or at least to merit grace by the performance of naturally good deeds. In the first hypothesis grace would no longer be necessary for salvation; in the second, it would be proportionate to natural goodness, and therefore no grace at all. Consequently, the gratuity of grace cannot be consistently denied without at the same time denying its necessity.(429)

Thesis II: There is no naturally good work by which unaided nature could acquire even so much as an equitable claim to supernatural grace.

This proposition may be technically qualified as _fidei proxima saltem_.

Proof. The Semipelagians held that, though nature cannot merit grace in strict justice, it can merit it at least congruously, _i.e._ as a matter of fitness or equity.(430) This contention was rejected by the Second Council of Orange (A. D. 529), which defined that “God works many good things in man that man does not work, but man works no good deeds that God does not give him the strength to do.”(431) And again: “[God] Himself inspires us with faith and charity without any preceding [natural] merits [on our part].”(432) The phrase “without any preceding merits” (_nullis praecedentibus meritis_) excludes both the _meritum de condigno_ and the _meritum de congruo_.

a) The Scriptural argument given above for thesis I also covers this thesis.

The Semipelagians quoted Matth. XXV, 15 in support of their teaching: “To one he gave five talents, and to another two, and to another one, to every one according to his proper ability.”(433) But this text is too vague to serve as an argument in such an important matter. Not a few exegetes treat it as a kind of rhetorical figure. Others, following the example of the Fathers, take “talents” to mean purely natural gifts, or _gratiae gratis datae_, while by “ability” (_virtus_) they understand the already existing grace of faith or a certain definite measure of initial grace.(434) But even if _virtus_ meant natural faculty or talent, it cannot be identical with “merit.” Considering the common teaching of theologians that the angels were endowed with grace according to the measure of their natural perfection,(435) we may well suppose that man receives grace likewise according to his natural constitution (_gratia sequitur naturam_)—a predisposition or aptitude which God ordained in His infinite wisdom to be the instrument through which His graces should operate either for personal sanctification or the good of others.

b) St. Augustine and his disciples, in defending the orthodox faith against the Semipelagians, strongly insisted on the gratuity of the grace of faith, and above all of the initial _gratia praeveniens_.

α) St. Augustine comments on 1 Cor. IV, 7 as follows: “Nothing is so opposed to this feeling as for any one to glory concerning his own merits in such a way as if he himself had made them for himself, and not the grace of God,—a grace, however, which makes the good to differ from the wicked, and is not common to the good and the wicked.”(436) And in another place he says: “For it would not in any sense be the grace of God, were it not in every sense gratuitous.”(437)

β) Certain of the Greek Fathers have been suspected of Semipelagian leanings because they appear to assign the chief rôle in the business of salvation to nature.(438) A careful study of their writings, however, shows that these authors had in mind co-operating, not prevenient grace. The general teaching of the Orientals on the gratuity of grace is sufficiently indicated by the demand made at the Council of Lydda (A. D. 415), that Pelagius be compelled to retract the proposition: "_Gratiam Dei secundum merita nostra dari._" The Fathers who have been accused of Semipelagian sympathies merely wished to emphasize free-will and to incite the morally indifferent to co-operate heartily with divine grace.

St. Chrysostom, in particular, expressly asserts the absolute gratuity of grace when he says of faith: "That which is a merit of faith, may not be ascribed to us, for it is a free gift of God,"(439) and directly contradicts Cassian and the Massilians when he declares: "Thou hast it not of thyself, thou hast received it from God. Hence thou hast received whatever thou hast, not only this or that, but all thou hast. For it is not thine own merit, but the grace of God. Although thou allegest the faith, thou hast received it by vocation."(440)

c) The theological argument for our thesis may be succinctly stated thus: The grace of God is the cause of our merits, and hence cannot be itself merited. Being the cause, it cannot be an effect.(441)

Thesis III: Nature cannot merit supernatural grace even by natural prayer.

This thesis, like the preceding one, may be technically qualified as _fidei proxima saltem_.

Proof. Let us first clearly establish the state of the question. Our thesis refers to that particular kind of prayer (_preces naturae_) which by its intrinsic value, so to speak, obliges Almighty God to grant what the petitioner asks for, as is undoubtedly the case with supernatural prayer, according to our Saviour's own promise: "Ask and ye shall receive."(442) The inefficacy of natural prayer asserted in our thesis, is not, as in the case of merit,(443) due to any intrinsic impossibility, but to a positive divine decree to grant supernatural prayer.

The Second Council of Orange defined against the Semipelagians: "If any one says that the grace of God can be obtained by human [_i.e._ natural] prayer, and that it is not grace itself which causes us to invoke God, he contradicts the prophet Isaias and the Apostle who say: I was found by them that did not seek me; I appeared openly to them that asked not after me."(444)

a) Sacred Scripture teaches that, unless we are inspired by the Holy Ghost, we cannot pray efficaciously. It follows that to be efficacious, prayer must be an effect of prevenient grace. We should not even know for what or how to pray, if the Holy Ghost did not inspire us. Cfr. Rom. VIII, 26: "For we know not what we should pray for as we ought; but the Spirit himself asketh for us [inspires us to ask] with unspeakable groanings."(445) 1 Cor. XII, 3: "No man can say: Lord God, but by the Holy Ghost."(446) Supernatural union with Christ is an indispensable condition of all efficacious prayer. John XV, 7: "If you abide in me, and my words abide in you, you shall ask whatever you will, and it shall be done unto you."(447)

b) This is also the teaching of the Fathers. “Who would truly groan, desiring to receive what he prays for from the Lord,” says St. Augustine,(448) “if he thought that he received it from himself, and not from God? ... We understand that this is also itself the gift of God, that with a true heart and spiritually we cry to God. Let them, therefore, observe how they are mistaken who think that our seeking, asking, knocking is of ourselves, and is not given to us; and say that this is the case because grace is preceded by our merits; that it follows them when we ask and receive, and seek and find, and it is opened to us when we knock.”(449)

c) From the theological point of view the inefficacy of purely natural prayer in matters pertaining to salvation can be demonstrated thus: Revelation tells us that the work of salvation requires for its beginning an initial supernatural grace. Now prayer, that is to say, efficacious prayer, is in itself a salutary act. Consequently, there can be no efficacious prayer without prevenient grace, and purely natural prayer is inefficacious for salvation.

Ripalda holds that, in an economy different from the present, natural prayer would have a claim to be heard. This opinion can be defended without prejudice to the dogma of the gratuity of grace. No doubt God might condescend to hear such petitions if He would, though, of course, He is not bound to do so by any intrinsic power inherent in natural prayer. Unlike merit, prayer appeals to the mercy of God, not to His justice. Ripalda’s theory, however, rests upon an unprovable assumption, namely, that man in the state of pure nature would be able to know of the existence, or at least the possibility, of a supernatural order and to strive for the beatific vision as his final end.(450)

Thesis IV: Man cannot move God to the bestowal of supernatural grace by any positive disposition or preparation on his part.

This thesis may be qualified as _propositio certa_.

Proof. Positive preparation or disposition for grace (_capacitas sive praeparatio positiva_) is practically on a level with natural prayer. The positive disposition for a natural good sometimes includes a certain demand to satisfaction, as _e.g._ thirst demands to be quenched. This is still more the case when the disposition has been acquired by a positive preparation for the good in question. Thus a student, by conscientiously preparing himself for examination, acquires a claim to be admitted to it sooner or later. Can this also be said of grace? Does there exist in man a positive disposition for grace in the sense that the withholding of it would grievously injure and disappoint the soul? Can man, without supernatural aid, positively dispose himself for the reception of supernatural grace, confident that God will reward his efforts by bestowing it on him? Both these questions must be answered in the negative.

a) If there were something in the natural make-up of man which would move the Almighty to give him grace, the bestowal of grace would no longer be a free act of God. But to assert the consequent would be Semipelagian, hence the antecedent must be false.

b) This truth can easily be deduced from the teaching of the Fathers in the Semipelagian controversy. They declare, in perfect conformity with St. Paul, that grace is bestowed gratuitously because God can give or withhold it as He pleases. St. Augustine says(451) that the grace of Baptism is granted freely, that is, without regard to any positive disposition on the part of the baptized infant. It should be remembered, moreover, that nature never existed in its pure form, and is now tainted by original sin.(452) Surely a nature tainted by sin cannot possibly possess the power of meriting divine grace.

c) The contention of the so-called Augustinians, that pure nature needs actual grace to save itself, and consequently has a claim to such grace at least _ex decentia Creatoris_ and _ex lege iustissimae providentiae_, perilously resembles Baius' condemned proposition that the state of pure nature is impossible.(453)

Thesis V: Man may prepare himself negatively for the reception of supernatural grace by not putting any obstacles in its way.

This proposition is held by a majority of Catholic theologians (_sententia communior_).

Proof. The solution of this question is intimately connected with the famous Scholastic axiom: "_Facienti quod est in se Deus non denegat gratiam_," that is, to the man who does what he can, God does not refuse grace. This axiom is susceptible of three different interpretations.

a) It may mean: _Facienti quod est in se cum auxilio gratiae Deus confert ulteriorem gratiam_, _i.e._, to him who does what he can with the help of supernatural grace, God grants further and more powerful graces up to justification. This is merely another way of stating the indisputable truth that, by faithfully coöperating with the grace of God, man is able to merit additional graces, and it holds true even of infidels and sinners. The first freely performed salutary act establishes a _meritum de congruo_ towards other acts disposing a man for justification. And since the first as well as all subsequent salutary acts, in this hypothesis, are pure graces, this interpretation of our axiom is entirely compatible with the dogma of the gratuity of grace.(454)

b) _Facienti quod est in se ex viribus naturalibus Deus non denegat gratiam_ (to him who does what he can with his natural moral strength, God does not refuse grace.) This does not mean that, in consequence of the efforts of the natural will, God may not withhold from anyone the first grace of vocation. In this sense the axiom would be Semipelagian, and has been rejected by a majority of the Schoolmen. It is said of Molina that he tried to render it acceptable by the hypothesis that God bound Himself by a contract with Christ to give His grace to all men who would make good use of their natural faculties. But how could the existence of this imaginary contract be proved? In matter of fact Molina taught, with a large number of other divines,(455) that God in the bestowal of His graces freely bound Himself to a definite rule, which coincides with His universal will to save all mankind. In the application of this law He pays no regard to any positive disposition or preparation, but merely to the presence or absence of obstacles which would prove impediments to grace. In

other words, God, generally speaking, is more inclined to offer His grace to one who puts no obstacles in its way than to one who wallows in sin and neglects to do his share.(456)

c) _Facienti quod est in se ex viribus naturae negative se disponendo [i.e. obicem non ponendo] Deus non denegat gratiam_ (to the man who does what he can with his natural moral strength, disposing himself negatively [_i.e._, by not placing any obstacle] God does not deny grace. In this form the axiom is identical with our thesis. The question arises: Can it be made to square with the dogma of the absolute gratuity of grace? Vasquez,(457) Glossner,(458) and some others answer this question in the negative, whereas the great majority of Catholic theologians hold with Suarez(459) and Lessius,(460) that there is no contradiction between the two. Though Lessius did not succeed in proving his famous contention that the axiom _Facienti quod est in se Deus non denegat gratiam_, was for three full centuries understood in this sense by the schools,(461) there is no doubt that many authorities can be cited in favor of his interpretation.(462)

The theological argument for our thesis may be formulated thus: The gratuity of grace does not imply that the recipient must have no sort of disposition. It merely means that man is positively unworthy of divine favor. Otherwise the Church could not teach, as she does, that the grace bestowed on the angels and on our first parents in Paradise was absolutely gratuitous, nor could she hold that the Hypostatic Union of the two natures in Christ, which is the pattern and exemplar of all true grace,(463) was a pure grace in respect of the humanity of our Lord. The dogma of the gratuity of grace is in no danger whatever so long as the relation between negative disposition and supernatural grace is conceived as actual (_facienti=qui facit_), not causal (_facienti=quia facit_). The motive for the distribution of grace is to be sought not in the dignity of human nature, but in God’s will to save all men. We must, however, guard against the erroneous notion that grace is bestowed according to a fixed law or an infallible norm regulating the amount of grace in accordance with the condition of the recipient. Sometimes great sinners are miraculously converted, while others of fairly good antecedents perish. Yet, again, who could say that to the omniscient and all-wise God the great sinner did not appear better fitted to receive grace than the “decent” but self-sufficient pharisee?

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Section 3. The Universality Of Actual Grace

The gratuity of grace does not conflict with its universality. Though God distributes His graces freely, He grants them to all men without exception, because He wills all to be saved.

This divine “will to save” (_voluntas Dei salvifica_) may be regarded in relation either to the wayfaring state or to the _status termini_. Regarded from the first-mentioned point of view it is a merciful will (_voluntas misericordiae_) and is generally called first or antecedent will (_voluntas prima s. antecedens_) or God’s salvific will (_voluntas Dei salvifica_) in the strict sense of the word. Considered in relation to the _status termini_, it is a just will, as God rewards or punishes each creature according to its deserts. This second or consequent will (_voluntas secunda s. consequens_) is called “predestination” in so far as it rewards the just, and “reprobation” in so far as it punishes the wicked.

God’s “will to save” may therefore be defined as an earnest and sincere desire to justify all men and make them supernaturally happy. As _voluntas antecedens_ it is conditional, depending on the free co-operation of man; as _voluntas consequens_, on the other hand, it is absolute, because God owes it to His justice to reward or punish every man according to his deserts.(464)

Hence we shall treat in four distinct articles, (1) Of the universality of God’s will to save; (2) Of the divine _voluntas salvifica_ as the will to give sufficient graces to all adult human beings without exception; (3) Of predestination, and (4) Of reprobation.

Article 1. The Universality Of God’s Will To Save

Although God’s will to save all men is practically identical with His will to redeem all,(465) a formal distinction must be drawn between the two, (a) because there is a difference in the Scriptural proofs by which either is supported, and (b) because the latter involves the fate of the fallen angels, while the former suggests a question peculiar to itself, _viz._ the fate of unbaptized children.

Thesis I: God sincerely wills the salvation, not only of the predestined, but of all the faithful without exception.

This proposition embodies an article of faith.

Proof. Its chief opponents are the Calvinists and the Jansenists, who heretically maintain that God wills to save none but the predestined. Against Calvin the Tridentine Council defined: “If any one saith that the grace of justification is attained only by those who are predestined unto life, but that all others who are called, are called indeed, but receive not grace, as being, by the divine power, predestined unto evil; let him be anathema.”(466)

The teaching of Jansenius that Christ died exclusively for the predestined,(467) was censured as “heretical” by Pope Innocent X. Hence it is of faith that Christ died for others besides the predestined. Who are these “others”? As the Church obliges all her children to pray: “[Christ] descended from heaven for us men and for our salvation,”(468) it is certain that at least all the faithful are included in the saving will of God. We say, “at least all the faithful,” because in matter of fact the divine _voluntas salvifica_ extends to all the descendants of Adam, as we shall show further on.(469)

a) Holy Scripture positively declares in a number of passages that God wills the salvation of all believers, whether predestined or not. Jesus Himself says in regard to

the Jews: Matth. XXIII, 37: “Jerusalem, Jerusalem, thou that killest the prophets, and stonest them that are sent unto thee, how often would I (_volui_) have gathered together thy children, as the hen doth gather her chickens under her wings, and thou wouldst not (_noluisti_).” Two facts are stated in this text: (1) Our Lord’s earnest desire to save the Jewish people, anciently through the instrumentality of the prophets, and now in His own person; (2) the refusal of the Jews to be saved. Of those who believe in Christ under the New Covenant we read in the Gospel of St. John (III, 16): “God so loved the world, as to give his only begotten Son; that whosoever believeth in him(470) may not perish, but may have life everlasting.” However, since many who believe in Christ do actually perish,(471) the divine _voluntas salvifica_, in principle, extends not only to the predestined, but to all the faithful, _i.e._ to all who have received the sacrament of Baptism.

b) The teaching of the Fathers can be gathered from the quotations given under Thesis II, _infra_.

c) The theological argument may be briefly summarized as follows: God’s will to save is co-extensive with the grace of adoptive sonship (_filiatio adoptiva_), which is imparted either by Baptism or by perfect charity. Now, some who were once in the state of grace are eternally lost. Consequently, God also wills the salvation of those among the faithful who do not actually attain to salvation and who are, therefore, not predestined.

Thesis II: God wills to save every human being.

This proposition is _fidei proxima saltem_.

Proof. The existence of original sin is no reason why God should exclude some men from the benefits of the atonement, as was alleged by the Calvinistic “Infralapsarians.” Our thesis is so solidly grounded on Scripture and Tradition that some theologians unhesitatingly call it an article of faith.

a) We shall confine the Scriptural demonstration to two classical passages, Wisd. XI, 24 sq. and 1 Tim. II, 1 sqq.

α) The Book of Wisdom, after extolling God’s omnipotence, says of His mercy: “But thou hast mercy upon all, because thou canst do all things, and overlookest the sins of men for the sake of repentance. For thou lovest all things that are, and hatest none of the things which thou hast made.... Thou sparest all, because they are thine, O Lord, who lovest souls.”(472)

In this text the mercy of God is described as universal. _Misereris omnium, parcis omnibus_. This universality is based (1) on His omnipotence (_quia omnia potes_), which is unlimited. His mercy, being equally boundless, must therefore include all men without exception. The universality of God’s mercy is based (2) on His universal over-lordship and dominion (_quoniam tua sunt; diligis omnia quae fecisti_). As there is no creature that does not belong to God, so there is no man whom He does not love and to whom He does not show mercy. The universality of God’s mercy in the passage quoted is based (3) on His love for souls (_qui amas animas_). Wherever there is an immortal soul (be it in child or adult, Christian, pagan or Jew), God is at work to save

it. Consequently the divine _voluntas salvifica_ is universal, not only in a moral, but in the physical sense of the term, that is, it embraces all the descendants of Adam.

β) 1 Tim. II, 2 sqq.: “I desire therefore, first of all, that supplications, prayers, intercessions, and thanksgivings be made for all men.... For this is good and acceptable in the sight of God our Saviour, who will have all men to be saved, and to come to the knowledge of the truth. For there is one God, and one mediator of God and men, the man Christ Jesus, who gave himself a redemption for all.”(473)

The Apostle commands us to pray “for all men,” because this practice is “good and acceptable in the sight of God.” Why is it good and acceptable? Because God “will have all men to be saved and to come to the knowledge of the truth.” In other words, God’s will to save is universal.

The question arises: Is the universality of the divine _voluntas salvifica_, as inculcated by St. Paul, merely moral, or is it physical, admitting of no exceptions? The answer may be found in the threefold reason given by the Apostle: the oneness of God, the mediatorship of Christ, and the universality of the Redemption. (1) “For there is [but] one God.”(474) As truly, therefore, as God is the God of all men without exception, is each and every man included in the divine _voluntas salvifica_. (2) “There is [but] ... one mediator of God and men, the man Christ Jesus.” The human nature which Christ assumed in the Incarnation is common to all men. Hence, whoever is a man, has Jesus Christ for his mediator.(475) (3) Christ “gave himself a redemption [_i.e._ died] for all.” That is to say, God’s will to save is co-extensive with His will to redeem. The latter is universal,(476) consequently also the former.(477)

b) The Fathers and early ecclesiastical writers were wont to base their teaching in this matter on the above-quoted texts, and clearly intimated that they regarded the truth therein set forth as divinely revealed. Passaglia(478) has worked out the Patristic argument in detail, quoting no less than two hundred authorities.

α) We must limit ourselves to a few specimen citations. St. Ambrose declares that God wills to save all men. “He willed all to be His own whom He established and created. O man, do not flee and hide thyself! He wants even those who flee, and does not will that those in hiding should perish.”(479) St. Gregory of Nazianzus holds God’s _voluntas salvifica_ to be co-extensive in scope with original sin and the atonement. “The law, the prophets, and the sufferings of Christ,” he says, “by which we were redeemed, are common property and admit of no exception: but as all [men] are participators in the same Adam, deceived by the serpent and subject to death in consequence of sin, so by the heavenly Adam all are restored to salvation and by the wood of ignominy recalled to the wood of life, from which we had fallen.”(480) St. Prosper concludes that, since all men are in duty bound to pray for their fellowmen, God must needs be willing to save all without exception. “We must sincerely believe,” he says, “that God wills all men to be saved, since the Apostle solicitously prescribes supplication to be made for all.”(481) The question why so many perish, Prosper answers as follows: “[God] wills all to be saved and to come to the knowledge of truth, ... so that those who are saved, are saved because He wills them to be saved, while those who perish, perish because they deserve to perish.”(482) In his

Responsiones ad Capitula Obiectionum Vincentianarum the same writer energetically defends St. Augustine against the accusation that his teaching on predestination is incompatible with the orthodox doctrine of the universality of God's saving will.(483)

β) St. Augustine aroused suspicion in the camp of the Semipelagians by his general teaching on predestination and more particularly by his interpretation of 1 Tim. II, 4. The great Bishop of Hippo interprets this Pauline text in no less than four different ways. In his treatise _De Spiritu et Litera_ he describes the divine _voluntas salvifica_ as strictly universal in the physical sense.(484) In his _Enchiridion_ he restricts it to the predestined.(485) In his _Contra Iulianum_ he says: "No one is saved unless God so wills."(486) In his work _De Correptione et Gratia_: "God wills all men to be saved, because He makes us to will this, just as He sent the spirit of His Son [into our hearts], crying: Abba, Father, that is, making us to cry, Abba, Father."(487) How did St. Augustine come to interpret this simple text in so many different ways? Some think he chose this method to overwhelm the Pelagians and Semipelagians with Scriptural proofs. But this polemical motive can hardly have induced him to becloud an obvious text and invent interpretations which never occurred to any other ecclesiastical writer before or after his time. The conundrum can only be solved by the assumption that Augustine believed in a plurality of literal senses in the Bible and held that over and above (or notwithstanding) the _sensus obvius_ every exegete is free to read as much truth into any given passage as possible, and that such interpretation lay within the scope of the inspiration of the Holy Ghost quite as much as the _sensus obvius_. In his _Confessions_(488) he actually argues in favor of a _pluralitas sensuum_. He was keen enough to perceive, however, that if a Scriptural text is interpreted in different ways, the several constructions put upon it must not be contradictory. As he was undoubtedly aware of the distinction between _voluntas antecedens_ and _consequens_,(489) his different interpretations of 1 Tim. II, 4 can be reconciled by assuming that he conceived God's _voluntas salvifica_ as _antecedens_ in so far as it is universal, and as _consequens_ in so far as it is particular. St. Thomas solves the difficulty in a similar manner: "The words of the Apostle, 'God will have all men to be saved, etc.,' can be understood in three ways: First, by a restricted application, in which case they would mean, as Augustine says, 'God wills all men to be saved that are saved, not because there is no man whom he does not wish to be saved, but because there is no man saved whose salvation He does not will.' Secondly, they can be understood as applying to every class of individuals, not of every individual of each class; in which case they mean that 'God wills some men of every class and condition to be saved, males and females, Jews and Gentiles, great and small, but not all of every condition.' Thirdly, according to the Damascene, they are understood of the antecedent will of God, not of the consequent will. The distinction must not be taken as applying to the divine will itself, in which there is nothing antecedent or consequent; but to the things willed. To understand which we must consider that everything, so far as it is good, is willed by God. A thing taken in its strict sense, and considered absolutely, may be good or evil, and yet when some additional circumstance is taken into account, by a consequent consideration may be changed into its contrary. Thus, that men should live is good; and that men

should be killed is evil, absolutely considered. If in a particular case it happens that a man is a murderer or dangerous to society, to kill him becomes good, to let him live an evil. Hence it may be said of a just judge that antecedently he wills all men to live, but consequently he wills the murderer to be hanged. In the same way God antecedently wills all men to be saved, but consequently wills some to be damned, as His justice exacts. Nor do we will simply what we will antecedently, but rather we will it in a qualified manner; for the will is directed to things as they are in themselves, and in themselves they exist under particular qualifications. Hence we will a thing simply in as much as we will it when all particular circumstances are considered; and this is what is meant by willing consequently. Thus it may be said that a just judge wills simply the hanging of a murderer, but in a qualified manner he would will him to live, inasmuch as he is a man. Such a qualified will may be called a willingness rather than an absolute will. Thus it is clear that whatever God simply wills takes place; although what He wills antecedently may not take place."(490)

Thesis III: The lot of unbaptized infants, though difficult to reconcile with the universality of God's saving will, furnishes no argument against it.

Proof. The most difficult problem concerning the divine _voluntas salvifica_—a real _crux theologorum_—is the fate of unbaptized children. The Church has never uttered a dogmatic definition on this head, and theologians hold widely divergent opinions.

Bellarmine teaches that infants who die without being baptized, are excluded from the divine _voluntas salvifica_, because, while the non-reception of Baptism is the proximate reason of their damnation, its ultimate reason must be the will of God.

a) This rather incautious assertion needs to be carefully restricted. It is an article of faith that God has instituted the sacrament of Baptism as the ordinary means of salvation for all men. On the other hand, it is certain that He expects parents, priests, and relatives, as his representatives, to provide conscientiously for its proper and timely administration. Sinful negligence on the part of these responsible agents cannot, therefore, be charged to Divine Providence, but must be laid at the door of those human agents who fail to do their duty. In exceptional cases infants can be saved even by means of the so-called Baptism of blood (_baptismus sanguinis_), _i.e._ death for Christ's sake. On the whole it may be said that God has, in principle, provided for the salvation of little children by the institution of infant Baptism.

b) But there are many cases in which either invincible ignorance or the order of nature precludes the administration of Baptism. The well-meant opinion of some theologians(491) that the responsibility in all such cases lies not with God, but with men, lacks probability. Does God, then, really will the damnation of these innocents? Some modern writers hold that the physical order of nature is responsible for the misfortune of so many innocent infants; but this hypothesis contributes nothing towards clearing up the awful mystery.(492) For God is the author of the natural as well as of the supernatural order. To say that He is obliged to remove existing obstacles by means of a miracle would disparage His ordinary providence.(493) Klee's assumption that dying children become conscious long enough to enable them to receive the Baptism of desire (_baptismus flaminis_), is scarcely compatible with

the definition of the Council of Florence that “the souls of those who die in actual mortal sin, or only in original sin, forthwith descend to hell.”(494) A still more unsatisfactory supposition is that the prayer of Christian parents acts like a baptism of desire and saves their children from hell. This theory, espoused by Cardinal Cajetan, was rejected by the Fathers of Trent,(495) and Pope Pius V ordered it to be expunged from the Roman edition of Cajetan’s works.(496)

A way out of the difficulty is suggested by Gutberlet and others, who, holding with St. Thomas that infants that die without Baptism will enjoy a kind of natural beatitude, think it possible that God, in view of their sufferings, may mercifully cleanse them from original sin and thereby place them in a state of innocence.(497) This theory is based on the assumption that the ultimate fate of unbaptized children is deprivation of the beatific vision of God and therefore a state of real damnation (_poena damni, infernum_), and that the remission of original sin has for its object merely to enable these unfortunate infants to enjoy a perfect natural beatitude, which they could not otherwise attain. It is reasonable to argue that, as these infants are deprived of celestial happiness through no guilt of their own, the Creator can hardly deny them some sort of natural beatitude, to which their very nature seems to entitle them. “Hell” for them probably consists in being deprived of the beatific vision of God, which is a supernatural grace and as such lies outside the sphere of those prerogatives to which human nature has a claim by the fact of creation. This theory would seem to establish at least some manner of salvation for the infants in question, and consequently, to vindicate the divine _voluntas salvifica_ in the same measure. Needless to say, it can claim no more than probability, and we find ourselves constrained to admit, at the conclusion of our survey, that there is no sure and perfect solution of the difficulty, and theologians therefore do well to confess their ignorance.(498)

c) The difficulty of which we have spoken does not, of course, in any way impair the certainty of the dogma. The Scriptural passages cited above(499) clearly prove that God wills to save all men without exception. In basing the universality of God’s mercy on His omnipotence, His universal dominion, and His love of souls, the Book of Wisdom(500) evidently implies that the unbaptized infants participate in that mercy in all three of these respects. How indeed could Divine Omnipotence exert itself more effectively than by conferring grace on those who are inevitably and without any fault of their own deprived of Baptism? Who would deny that little children, as creatures, are subject to God’s universal dominion in precisely the same manner as adults? Again, if God loves the souls of men, must He not also love the souls of infants?

1 Tim. II, 4(501) applies primarily to adults, because strictly speaking only adults can “come to the knowledge of the truth.” But St. Paul employs certain middle terms which undoubtedly comprise children as well. Thus, if all men have but “one God,” this God must be the God of infants no less than of adults, and His mercy and goodness must include them also. And if Jesus Christ as God-man is the “one mediator of God and men,” He must also have assumed the human nature of children, in order to redeem them from original sin. Again, if Christ “gave himself a redemption for all,” it is impossible to assume that millions of infants should be directly excluded

from the benefits of the atonement.(502)

Article 2. God’s Will To Give Sufficient Grace To All Adult Human Beings In Particular

In relation to adults, God manifests His saving will by the bestowal of sufficient grace upon all.(503) The bestowal of sufficient grace being evidently an effluence of the universal _voluntas salvifica_, the granting of such grace to all who have attained the use of reason furnishes another proof for the universality of grace.

God gives all men sufficient graces. But He is not obliged to give to each _efficacious_ graces, because all that is required to enable man to reach his supernatural destiny is coöperation with sufficient grace, especially with the _gratia prima vocans_, which is the beginning of all salutary operation.

To prove that God gives sufficient grace to all adult human beings without exception, we must show that He gives sufficient grace (1) to the just, (2) to the sinner, and (3) to the heathen. This we shall do in three distinct theses.

Thesis I: God gives to all just men sufficient grace to keep His commandments.

This is _de fide_.

Proof. The Tridentine Council teaches: “If any one saith that the commandments of God are, even for one that is justified and constituted in grace, impossible to keep; let him be anathema.”(504)

A contrary proposition in the writings of Jansenius(505) was censured by Pope Innocent the Tenth as “foolhardy, impious, blasphemous, and heretical.”

The Church does not assert that God gives to the just sufficient grace at all times. She merely declares that sufficient grace is at their disposal whenever they are called upon to obey the law (_urgente praecepto_). Nor need God always bestow a _gratia proxime sufficiens_; in many instances the grace of prayer (_gratia remote sufficiens_) fully serves the purpose.(506)

This dogma is clearly contained in Holy Scripture. We shall quote the most important texts.

a) 1 John V, 3 sq.: “For this is the charity of God, that we keep his commandments, and his commandments are not heavy. For whatsoever is born of God, overcometh the world.”(507) According to this text the “charity of God” manifests itself in “keeping his commandments” and “overcoming the world.” This is declared to be an easy task. Our Lord Himself says: “My yoke is sweet and my burden light.”(508) Hence it must be possible to keep His commandments, and therefore God does not withhold the absolutely necessary graces from the just.

St. Paul consoles the Corinthians by telling them that God will not suffer them to be tempted beyond their strength, but will help them to a happy issue, provided they faithfully coöperate with His grace. 1 Cor. X, 13: “God is faithful, who will not suffer you to be tempted above that which you are able, but will make also with temptation issue, that you may be able to bear it.”(509) As it is impossible even for the just to

overcome grievous temptations without supernatural aid,(510) and as God Himself tells us that we are able to overcome them, it is a necessary inference that He bestows sufficient grace. The context hardly leaves a doubt that St. Paul has in mind the just, for a few lines further up he says: “Therefore he that thinketh himself to stand, let him take heed lest he fall.”(511) But there is no exegetical objection to applying the text to all the faithful without exception.(512)

b) This dogma is clearly set forth in the writings of the Fathers. Some of them, it is true, when combating the Pelagians and Semipelagians, defended the proposition that “grace is not given to all men,”(513) but they meant _efficacious_ grace.

α) A typical representative of this group of ecclesiastical writers is the anonymous author of the work _De Vocatione Omnium Gentium_,(514) whom Pope Gelasius praised as “_probatus Ecclesiae magister_.” This fifth-century writer, who was highly esteemed by his contemporaries, discusses the question whether and in what sense all men are called, and why some are not saved. He begins by drawing a distinction between God’s general and His special providence.(515) “It so pleased God,” he says, “to give His efficacious grace to many, and to withhold His sufficient grace from none, in order that it might appear from both [actions] that what is conferred upon a portion is not denied to the entire race.”(516)

β) The Jansenists appealed in favor of their teaching to such Patristic passages as the following: “After the withdrawal of the divine assistance he [St. Peter] was unable to stand;”(517) and: “He had undertaken more than he was able to do.”(518) But the two Fathers from whose writings these passages are taken (SS. Chrysostom and Augustine) speak, as the context evinces, of the withdrawal of efficacious and proximately sufficient grace in punishment of Peter’s presumption. Had St. Peter followed our Lord’s advice(519) and prayed instead of relying on his own strength, he would not have fallen. That this was the mind of St. Augustine clearly appears from the following sentence in his work _De Unitate Ecclesiae_: “Who shall doubt that Judas, had he willed, would not have betrayed Christ, and that Peter, had he willed, would not have thrice denied his Master?”(520)

c) The theological argument for our thesis may be formulated as follows: Since the state of grace confers a claim to supernatural happiness, it must also confer a claim to those graces which are necessary to attain it.

To assert that God denies the just sufficient grace to observe His commandments, to avoid mortal sin, and to persevere in the state of grace, would be to gainsay His solemn promise to His adopted children: “This is the will of my Father that sent me: that every one who seeth the Son and believeth in him, may have life everlasting, and I will raise him up in the last day.”(521) Consequently, God owes it to His own fidelity to bestow sufficient graces upon the just.

Again, according to the plain teaching of Revelation, the just are obliged, under pain of sin, to observe the commandments of God and the precepts of His Church.(522) But this is impossible without the aid of grace. Consequently, God grants at least sufficient grace to his servants, for _ad impossibile nemo tenetur_.(523)

Thesis II: In regard to Christians guilty of mortal sin we must hold: (1) that ordinary sinners always receive sufficient grace to avoid mortal sin and do penance; (2) that God never entirely withdraws His grace even from the obdurate.

The first part of this thesis embodies a theological conclusion; the second states the common teaching of Catholic theologians.

1. _Proof of the First Part._ The distinction here drawn between “ordinary” and “obdurate” sinners has its basis in revelation and is clearly demanded by the different degrees of certainty attaching to the two parts of our thesis.

An “ordinary” sinner is a Christian who has lost sanctifying grace by a grievous sin. An “obdurate” sinner is one who, by repeatedly and maliciously transgressing the laws of God, has dulled his intellect and hardened his will against salutary inspirations. A man may be an habitual sinner (_consuetudinarius_) and a backslider, without being obdurate, or, which comes to the same, impenitent. Weakness is not malice, though sinful habits often beget impenitence, which is one of the sins against the Holy Ghost and the most formidable obstacle in the way of conversion.

With regard to ordinary sinners, our thesis asserts that they always receive sufficient grace to avoid mortal sin and do penance.

a) Experience teaches that a man falls deeper and deeper if he does not hasten to do penance after committing a mortal sin. But this is not the fault of Almighty God, who never withholds His grace; it is wholly the fault of the sinner who fails to coöperate with the proffered supernatural assistance.

α) A sufficient Scriptural argument for this part of our thesis is contained in the texts cited in support of Thesis I. If it is true that God suffers no one to be tempted beyond his strength,(524) this must surely apply to Christians who have had the misfortune of committing mortal sin. St. John says that the commandments of God “are not heavy” and that faith is “the victory which overcometh the world.”(525) Faith in Christ remains in the Christian, even though he be guilty of mortal sin, and consequently if he wills, he is able, by the aid of sufficient grace, to overcome the “world,” _i.e._ the temptations arising from concupiscence,(526) and thus to cease committing mortal sins.

β) As for the teaching of Tradition, St. Augustine lays down two theological principles which apply to saint and sinner alike.

“God does not enjoin impossibilities,” he says, “but in His injunctions counsels you both to do what you can for yourself, and to ask His aid in what you cannot do.”(527) It follows that the sinner always receives at least the grace of prayer, which Augustine therefore calls _gratia initialis sive parva_, and of which he says that its right use ensures the _gratia magna_.

The second principle is this: “_Cum lege coniuncta est gratia, quâ lex observari possit._” That is, every divine law, by special ordinance, carries with it the grace by which it may be observed. In other words, the laws of God can always be obeyed because the lawgiver never fails to grant sufficient grace to keep them.(528)

b) That the sinner always receives sufficient grace to be converted, follows from the Scriptural injunction of conversion. If conversion to God is a duty, and to comply with this duty is impossible without the aid of grace,(529) the divine command obviously implies the bestowal of sufficient grace.

That conversion is a duty follows from such Scriptural texts as these: “As I live, saith the Lord God, I desire not the death of the wicked, but that the wicked turn from his way and live. Turn ye, turn ye from your evil ways!”(530) “The Lord delayeth not his promise, as some imagine, but dealeth patiently for your sake, not willing that any should perish, but that all should return to penance.”(531)

This teaching is faithfully echoed by Tradition.

2. _Proof of the Second Part._ Obduracy is a serious obstacle to conversion because the obdurate sinner has confirmed his will in malice(532) and by systematic resistance diminished the influence of grace. The question here is whether or not God in such cases eventually withdraws His grace altogether.

Some rigorists hold that He does so, with the purpose of sparing the sinner greater tortures in hell.(533) Though this assertion cannot be said to contravene the dogma of the universality of God’s salvific will, (its defenders do not deny that He faithfully does His share to save these unfortunate reprobates), we prefer to adopt the _sententia __ communis_, that God grants even the most obdurate sinner—at least now and then, _e.g._ during a mission or on the occasion of some terrible catastrophe—sufficient grace to be converted. The theological reasons for this opinion, which we hold to be the true one, coincide in their last analysis with those set forth in the first part of our thesis.

a) Sacred Scripture, in speaking of the duty of repentance, makes no distinction between ordinary and obdurate sinners. On the contrary, the Book of Wisdom points to one of the most wicked and impenitent of nations, the Canaanites, as a shining object of divine mercy and patience.(534) According to St. Paul, God calls especially upon hardened and impenitent sinners to do penance. Rom. II, 4 sq.: “Or despisest thou the riches of his goodness, and patience, and long suffering? Knowest thou not that the benignity of God leadeth thee to penance? But according to thy hardness and impenitent heart, thou treasurest up to thyself wrath, against the day of wrath, and revelation of the just judgment of God, who will render to every man according to his works.”(535)

There are some Scriptural passages which seem to imply that God withdraws His grace from those who are obdurate, nay, that He Himself hardens their hearts in punishment of sin. Thus the Lord says of Pharao: “I shall harden his heart,”(536) and Moses tells us: “The Lord hardened Pharao’s heart, and he harkened not unto them.”(537) But it would be wrong to assume that this denotes a positive action on the part of God. Pharao, as we are told further on, “hardened his own heart” (_ingravavit cor suum_).(538) The fault in all cases lies with the sinner, who obstinately resists the call of grace. God’s co-operation in the matter is merely indirect. The greater and stronger graces which He grants to ordinary sinners, He withholds from the obdurate in punishment of their malice. This is, however, by no

means tantamount to a withdrawal of sufficient grace.(539)

b) The Fathers speak of God's way of dealing with obdurate sinners in a manner which clearly shows their belief that He never entirely withdraws His mercy. They insist that the light of grace is never extinguished in the present life. "God gave them over to a reprobate mind," says St. Augustine, "for such is the blindness of the mind. Whosoever is given over thereunto, is shut out from the interior light of God: but not wholly as yet, whilst he is in this life. For there is 'outer darkness,' which is understood to belong rather to the day of judgment; that he should rather be wholly without God, whosoever, whilst there is time, refuses correction."(540)

It follows that no sinner, how desperate soever his case may appear, need be despaired of. As long as there is life there is hope.(541) The Fathers consistently teach that the reason why reprobates are lost is not lack of grace but their own malice. Thus St. Chrysostom comments on Isaias' prophecy regarding the impenitence of the Jews: "The reason they did not believe was not that Isaias had predicted their unbelief, but his prediction was based on the fact that they would not believe. They were unable to believe, _i.e._ they had not the will to believe."(542)

c) The theological argument for our thesis is well stated by St. Thomas. He distinguishes between _obstinatio perfecta_ and _obstinatio imperfecta_ and says: Perfect obstinacy exists only in hell. Imperfect obstinacy is that of a sinner who has his will so firmly set on evil that he is incapable of any but the faintest impulses towards virtue, though even these are sufficient to prepare the way for grace.(543) "If any one falls into sin after having received Baptism," says the Fourth Lateran Council, "he can always be restored by sincere penance."(544) As the power of the keys comprises all sins, even those against the Holy Ghost, so divine grace is held out to all sinners. The Montanistic doctrine of the unforgivableness of the "three capital sins" (apostasy, murder, and adultery) was already condemned as heretical during the life-time of Tertullian. The sinner can obtain forgiveness only by receiving the sacrament of Penance or making an act of perfect contrition.(545) Justly, therefore, does the Church regard despair of God's mercy as an additional grievous sin. If the rigorists were right in asserting that God in the end absolutely abandons the sinner, there could be no hope of forgiveness, and despair would be justified.

Thesis III: The heathens, too, receive sufficient graces for salvation.

This proposition may be qualified as _certa_.

Proof. The "heathens" are those whom the Gospel has not yet reached. They are called _infideles negativi_ in contradistinction to the _infideles positivi_, _i.e._ apostates and formal heretics who have fallen away from the faith. We assert that God gives to the heathens sufficient grace to know the truth and be saved. Pope Alexander VIII, on December 7, 1690, condemned Arnauld's Jansenistic proposition that "pagans, Jews, heretics, and others of the same kind experience no influence whatever from Christ, and it may therefore be rightly inferred that there is in them a nude and helpless will, lacking sufficient grace."(546) A proposition of similar import, set up by Quesnel, was censured by Clement XI.(547) Though not formally defined, it is a certain truth—deducible from the infallible teaching of the Church—that God

does not permit any one to perish for want of grace.

a) The Biblical argument for our thesis is based on the dogma that God wills all men to be saved. 1 Tim. II, 4: “[God] will have all men to be saved, and to come to the knowledge of the truth [_i.e._ the true faith].” In speaking of the “day of wrath,” St. Paul emphasizes the fact that the Almighty Judge “will render to every man according to his works,”—eternal life to the good, wrath and damnation to the wicked.(548) And he continues: “But glory, and honor, and peace to every one that worketh good, to the Jew first, and also to the Greek; for there is no respect of persons with God.”(549) “Greek” is here evidently synonymous with gentile or heathen. It follows that the heathens are able to perform supernatural salutary acts with the aid of grace, and that they will receive the reward of eternal beatitude if they lead a good life.

In another passage (1 Tim. IV, 10) the Apostle calls Christ “the Saviour of all men, especially of the faithful.”(550) Consequently, Christ is the Saviour also of unbelievers and heathens.(551)

b) St. Paul’s teaching is faithfully echoed by the Fathers. Thus St. Clement of Rome,(552) in commenting on the penitential sermons of Noë and the prophet Jonas, says: “We may roam through all the ages of history and learn that the Lord in all generations(553) gave opportunity for penance to all who wished to be converted, ... even though they were strangers to him.”(554)

St. Chrysostom says in explanation of John I, 9: “If He enlightens every man that comes into this world, how is it that so many are without light? For not all know Christ. Most assuredly He illumines, so far as He is concerned.... For grace is poured out over all. It flees or despises no one, be he Jew, Greek, barbarian or Scythian, freedman or slave, man or woman, old or young. It is the same for all, easily attainable by all, it calls upon all with equal regard. As for those who neglect to make use of this gift, they should ascribe their blindness to themselves.”(555)

Similar expressions can be culled from the anonymous work _De Vocatione Omnium Gentium_(556) and from the writings of SS. Prosper and Fulgentius, and especially from those of Orosius, who says that grace is given to all men, including the heathen, without exception and at all times.(557)

c) Catholic theologians have devoted considerable thought to the question how God provides for the salvation of the heathen.

To the uncivilized tribes may be applied what has been said regarding the fate of unbaptized infants. The real problem is: How does the merciful Creator provide for those who are sufficiently intelligent to be able to speculate on God, the soul, the future destiny of man, etc.? Holy Scripture teaches: “Without faith it is impossible to please God, for he that cometh to God must believe that he is, and is a rewarder to them that seek him.”(558) Faith here means, not any kind of religious belief, but that theological faith which the Tridentine Council calls “the beginning, the foundation, and the root of all justification.”(559) Mere intellectual assent to the existence of God, immortality, and retribution would not be sufficient for salvation, even if elevated to the supernatural sphere and transfigured by grace. This is evident from the condemnation, by Pope Innocent XI, of the proposition that “Faith in a wide sense,

based on the testimony of the created universe, or some other similar motive, is sufficient unto justification."(560) The only sort of faith that results in justification, according to the Vatican Council, is "a supernatural virtue, whereby, inspired and assisted by the grace of God, we believe that the things which He has revealed are true; not because of the intrinsic truth of the things, viewed by the natural light of reason, but because of the authority of God Himself, who reveals them, and who can neither be deceived nor deceive."(561) Of special importance is the following declaration by the same Council: "Since without faith it is impossible to please God and to attain to the fellowship of His children, therefore without faith no one has ever attained justification...."(562)

The Catechism demands of every one who desires to be saved that he have a supernatural belief in six distinct truths: the existence of God, retribution in the next world, the Blessed Trinity, the Incarnation, the immortality of the soul, and the necessity of grace. The first two are certainly necessary for salvation, both _fide explicitâ_ and _necessitate medii_. With regard to the other four there is a difference of opinion among theologians. We base our argumentation on the stricter, though not absolutely certain view, that all six articles must be believed _necessitate medii_. On this basis God's method of providing sufficient graces for the heathen may be explained in one of two ways, according as a _fides explicita_ is demanded from them with regard to all the above-mentioned dogmas, or a _fides implicita_ is deemed sufficient in regard to all but the first two. By _fides explicita_ we understand the express and fully developed faith of devout Christians; by _fides implicita_, an undeveloped belief of desire or, in other words, general readiness to believe whatever God has revealed.

α) The defenders of the _fides explicita_ theory are compelled to assume that God must somehow reveal to each individual heathen who lives according to the dictates of his conscience, the six truths necessary for salvation. "Faith cometh by hearing, and hearing by the word of Christ."(563)

But how can the gentiles believe in a revelation that has never been preached to them? Here is an undeniable difficulty. Some theologians say: God enlightens them interiorly about the truths necessary for salvation; or He miraculously sends them an apostle, as He sent St. Peter to Cornelius;(564) or He instructs them through the agency of an angel.(565) None of these hypotheses can be accepted as satisfactory. "Interior illumination" of the kind postulated would practically amount to private revelation. That God should grant a special private revelation to every conscientious pagan is highly improbable. Again, an angel can no more be the _ordinary_ means of conversion than the miraculous apparition of a missionary. Nevertheless, these three hypotheses admirably illustrate the firm belief of the Church in the universality of God's saving will, inasmuch as they express the conviction of her theologians that He would work a miracle rather than deny His grace to the poor benighted heathen.(566) The difficulties to which we have adverted constitute a strong argument in favor of another theological theory which regards explicit belief in the Trinity and the Incarnation merely as a _necessitas praecepti_, from which one may be dispensed.

β) The _fides implicita_ theory is far more plausible, for it postulates no miracles, implicit faith (or _fides in voto_) being independent of the external preaching of the Gospel, just as the baptism of desire (_baptismus in voto_) is independent of the use of water.

Cardinal Gotti regards the first-mentioned of the two theories as safer (_tutior_), but admits that the other is highly probable, because it has the support of St. Thomas.(567) However, a great difficulty remains. Though it may suffice to hold the dogmas of the Trinity and the Incarnation, and _a fortiori_ those of the immortality of the soul and the necessity of grace, with an implicit faith, it is the consentient teaching of Revelation, the Church, and Catholic divines that the two principal truths of religion, _viz._: the existence of God and retribution, must be held _fide explicitâ_ and _necessitate medii_, because a man cannot be converted to God unless He knows Him. But how is he to acquire a knowledge of God? Does this not also necessitate a miracle (_e.g._ the sending of an angel or of a missionary, which we have rejected as improbable)? There can be but one answer to this question. Unaided reason may convince a thoughtful pagan of the existence of God and of divine retribution, and as these two fundamental truths have no doubt penetrated to the farthest corners of the earth also as remnants of primitive revelation, their promulgation may be said to be contained in the traditional instruction which the heathen receive from their forebears. This external factor of Divine Revelation, assisted by interior grace, may engender a supernatural act of faith, which implicitly includes belief in Christ, Baptism, etc., and through which the heathen are eventually cleansed from sin and attain to justification.(568)

Some theologians hold that those to whom the Gospel has never been preached, may be saved by a quasi-faith based on purely natural motives.(569)

For the rest, no one will presume to dictate to Almighty God how and by what means He shall communicate His grace to the heathen. It is enough, and very consoling, too, to know that all men receive sufficient grace to save their souls, and no one is eternally damned except through his own fault.(570)

READINGS:—*Didacus Ruiz, _De Voluntate Dei_, disp. 19 sqq.—Petavius, _De Deo_, X, 4 sqq.; _De Incarnatione_, XIII, 1 sqq.—Fontana, _Bulla __“__Unigenitus__”__ Dogmatice Propugnata_, prop. 12, c. 5, Rome 1717.—Passaglia, _De Partitione Voluntatis Divinae in Primam et Secundam_, Rome 1851.—*Franzelin, _De Deo Uno_, thes. 49-51, Rome 1883.—*Palmieri, _De Gratia Divina Actuali_, thes. 59-62, Gulpen 1885.—A. Fischer, _De Salute Infidelium_, Essen 1886.—*J. Bucceroni, _De Auxilio Sufficiente Infidelibus Dato_, Rome 1890.—Fr. Schmid, _Die ausserordentlichen Heilswege für die gefallene Menschheit_, Brixen 1899.—Chr. Pesch, _Praelectiones Dogmaticae_, Vol. II, 3rd ed., pp. 144 sqq., Freiburg 1906.—L. Capéran, _Le Problème du Salut des Infidèles_, Paris 1912.—A. Wagner, _Doctrina de Gratia Sufficiente_, Graz 1911.—J. Bainvel, S. J., _Is There Salvation Outside the Catholic Church?_ (tr. J. L. Weidenhan), St. Louis 1917.

Article 3. The Predestination Of The Elect

1. WHAT IS MEANT BY PREDESTINATION.—We have shown that God antecedently wills to save all men,(571) and that He gives to all sufficient grace to work out their eternal salvation.

On the other hand, Sacred Scripture assures us that some are lost through their own fault. Cfr. Matth. XXV, 41: “Depart from me, you cursed, into everlasting fire.”

It follows that God’s will to save, considered as _voluntas consequens_, remains ineffective with regard to a portion of the human race, and consequently, in this respect, is no longer universal but particular.

Being omniscient, God has foreseen this from all eternity and disposed His decrees accordingly. It is in this sense that Catholic theology teaches the existence of a twofold predestination: one to Heaven, for those who die in the state of grace, another to hell, for those who depart this life in mortal sin.

Present-day usage reserves the term _predestination_ for the election of the blessed.

a) Rightly does the Council of Trent call predestination a “hidden mystery.”(572) For in the last analysis it rests solely with God, who are to be admitted to Heaven and who condemned to hell. But why does God give to some merely sufficient grace, with which they neglect to coöperate, while on others He showers efficacious graces that infallibly lead to eternal salvation? In this unequal distribution of efficacious grace lies the sublime mystery of predestination, as St. Augustine well knew, for he says in his treatise On the Gift of Perseverance: “Therefore, of two infants equally bound by original sin, why the one is taken and the other left; and of two wicked men already mature in years, why one should be so called that he follows Him that calleth, while the other is either not called at all, or is not called in such a manner,—are unsearchable judgments of God.”(573)

b) What is meant by “predestination of the elect”? In view of the many errors that have arisen with regard to this important dogma, it is necessary to start with clearly defined terms.

Predestination may mean one of three different things. A man may be simply predestined to receive certain graces (_praedestinatio ad gratiam tantum_); or he may be predestined to enjoy eternal happiness without regard to any merits of his own (_praedestinatio ad gloriam tantum_); or, again, he may be predestined to both grace and glory, glory as the end, grace as a means to that end—vocation, justification, and final perseverance. When the concepts of grace and glory are considered separately, and each is made the object of a special predestination, we have what is called incomplete or inadequate predestination (_praedestinatio incompleta sive inadaequata_). It is this incomplete predestination that St. Paul(574) and St. Augustine(575) have in mind when they apply the term to the vocation of men to grace, faith, and justification. Theologians speak of _praedestinatio ad gloriam tantum_, that is, _ante praevisa merita_, as a true predestination, but disagree as to its existence.(576)

The dogma of predestination, which mainly concerns us here, has for its sole object predestination in the complete or adequate sense of the term, which is explained by St. Augustine as follows: “Predestination is nothing else than the foreknowledge and the preparation of those gifts of God whereby they who are delivered are most certainly delivered [_i.e._ saved].”(577) St. Thomas expresses himself more succinctly: “Predestination is the preparation of grace in the present, and of glory in the future.”(578)

2. THE DOGMA.—Complete predestination involves: (a) the first grace of vocation (_gratia prima praeveniens_), especially faith as the beginning, foundation, and root of justification; (b) a number of additional actual graces for the successful accomplishment of the process; (c) justification itself as the beginning of the state of grace; (d) the grace of final perseverance; (e) eternal happiness in Heaven.

The question arises; Do men really seek and find their eternal salvation with infallible certainty by passing through these successive stages—not merely in the foreknowledge of God (_praescientia futurorum_), but by virtue of an eternal decree (_decretum praedestinationis_)?

The Pelagians asserted that man works out his eternal salvation of his own free will, and that consequently God merely foreknows but does not fore-ordain who shall be saved. The Semipelagians held that the beginning of faith (_initium fidei_) and final perseverance (_donum perseverantiae_) are not pure graces but may be obtained by natural means, without special aid from above. Against these heretics the Catholic Church has always taught the eternal predestination of the elect as an article of faith.(579)

a) St. Paul says explicitly: “We know that to them that love God, all things work together unto good, to such as, according to his purpose, are called to be saints. For whom he foreknew, he also predestinated to be made conformable to the image of his Son; that he might be the firstborn amongst many brethren. And whom he predestinated, them he also called. And whom he called, them he also justified. And whom he justified, them he also glorified.”(580) Here we have all the elements of complete predestination: God’s eternal foreknowledge (_praescivit_, προέγνω), an eternal decree of the divine will (_praedestinavit_, προώρισε), and the various stages of justification, beginning with vocation (_vocavit_, ἐκάλησε) up to justification proper (_iustificavit_, ἐδικαίωσε), and eternal beatitude (_glorificavit_, ἐδόξασεν).(581)

b) The Fathers of the fifth century undoubtedly taught the predestination of the elect as an article of faith. Thus St. Augustine says: “There never was a time when the Church of Christ did not hold this faith in predestination, which is now defended with fresh solicitude against the new heretics.”(582) His faithful disciple St. Prosper writes: “No Catholic denies predestination by God.”(583) And again: “It would be as impious to deny predestination as to oppose grace itself.”(584)

c) Several important theological corollaries follow from the dogma of predestination.

α) The first is the immutability of the divine decree of predestination. This immutability is based on God’s infallible foreknowledge that certain individuals will

die in the state of grace, and on His unchangeable will to reward them with eternal happiness.

St. Augustine says: “If any one of these [the predestined] perishes, God is mistaken; but none of them perish because God is not mistaken.”(585)

God’s unerring foreknowledge is symbolized by the “Book of Life.”(586) Christ Himself said to His Apostles: “Rejoice in this, that your names are written in heaven.”(587) The “Book of Life” admits neither addition nor erasure. This does not, however, mean that a man is unable to change God’s hypothetical decree of predestination with regard to himself into an absolute one. He can do this by prayer, good works, and faithful co-operation with grace.(588) Whatever promotes our salvation is included in the infallible foreknowledge of God, and consequently also in the scope of predestination. In this sense, but in no other, can we accept the somewhat paradoxical maxim: “If you are not predestined, conduct yourself so that you may be predestined.” Sacred Scripture occasionally refers to another “Book of Life,” which contains the names of all the faithful, irrespective of their predestination. This “book,” of course, is capable of alterations. Cfr. Apoc. III, 5: “I will not blot out his name out of the book of life.”(589) Finally, there is the “Book of Reprobation,” which records the wicked deeds of men and by which the unrepentant sinners will be judged. This is the “_liber scriptus_” of the “_Dies Irae_”:

“_Liber scriptus proferetur._ _In quo totum continetur._”(590)

β) If the divine decree of predestination is immutable, the number of the elect must be definitively fixed. “The number [of those who are predestined to the kingdom of God] is so certain,” says St. Augustine, “that no one can either be added to or taken from them.”(591) We must distinguish between the absolute and the relative number of the predestined.

God, being omniscient, knows not only the abstract number of the elect, but every individual predestined to Heaven. To us the number of the elect is wrapped in impenetrable mystery. St. Thomas justly observes: “Some say that as many men will be saved as angels fell; some, so many as there were angels left; others, in fine, so many as the number of angels who fell, added to that of all the angels created by God. It is, however, better to say that ‘God alone knows the number for whom is reserved eternal happiness,’ as the prayer for the living and the dead expresses it.”(592) Whether God will round out the number of the elect by suddenly precipitating the end of the world or by a sort of “natural selection,” is an open question. To assume the latter could hardly be reconciled with the dogma of the universality of His saving will. St. Augustine seems to favor the former.(593)

As regards the relative number of the elect, some writers (_e.g._ Massillon) represent it as so infinitesimally small that it would almost drive a saint to despair,—“as if the Church had been established for the express purpose of populating hell.”(594) Even St. Thomas held that relatively few are saved.(595) But the arguments adduced in support of this contention are by no means convincing.(596) Recently, the Jesuit Father Castelein(597) impugned the rigorist theory with weighty arguments. He was sharply attacked by the Redemptorist

Godts,(598) who marshalled a great number of authorities in favor of the sterner view. The controversy cannot be decided either on Scriptural or traditional grounds. In our pessimistic age it is more grateful and consoling to assume that the majority of Christians, especially Catholics, will be saved.(599) If we add to this number not a few Jews, Mohammedans, and heathens, it is probably safe to estimate the number of the elect as at least equal to that of the reprobates. Were it smaller, "it could be said to the shame and offense of the divine majesty and mercy, that the [future] kingdom of Satan is larger than the kingdom of Christ."(600)

3. THE MOTIVE OF PREDESTINATION.—The efficient cause of predestination is God; its instrumental cause, grace; its final cause, the divine glory; its primary meritorious cause, the merits of our Lord and Saviour Jesus Christ. On these points all theologians are agreed. Not so as to the motive that induced God to predestine certain individuals to the exclusion of others. The question narrows itself down to this: What influence, if any, do the merits of a man exert on the eternal decree of predestination?—and may be formulated in three different ways.

a) What influence do the merits of a man exert on his predestination to the initial grace of vocation? Recalling the dogma of the absolute gratuity of grace, our answer must be: None. For whatever merits one may have acquired before he receives the initial grace of vocation, must be purely natural, and consequently worthless in the eyes of God for supernatural predestination. "To assume," says St. Thomas, "that there is on our part some merit, the foreknowledge of which [on the part of God] would be the cause [motive] of our predestination, would be to assume that grace is given to us [as a reward] of our [natural] merits."(601)

b) What influence do the merits of a man exert on his predestination to grace and glory? Catholic theologians are unanimous in holding that, since grace is absolutely gratuitous and inseparably connected with glory as its effect, the union of both can no more be based upon _natural_ merit than the initial grace of vocation itself, which transmits the quality of gratuitousness to each and every one of the graces that follow in its wake, up to and including justification and eternal beatitude. Those among the Fathers who defended the gratuity of predestination against the Pelagians and Semipelagians, really aimed at safeguarding the gratuity of initial grace, in order not to be constrained to say with Pelagius that "the grace of God is given as a reward of merit."(602) "What compelled me in this work of mine [_De Dono Perseverantiae_] to defend more abundantly and clearly those passages of Scripture in which predestination is commended," says St. Augustine, "if not the Pelagian assertion that God's grace is given according to our [natural] merits?"(603) Obviously these Fathers did not have in view the _praedestinatio ad gloriam tantum_, as the champions of the _praedestinatio ante praevisa merita_ mistakenly assert, but what they meant was that complete predestination which comprises grace and glory as one whole. Similarly, the early Schoolmen, when they speak of the "gratuity of predestination," usually mean complete predestination.(604) D'Argentré's researches show how necessary it is to draw sharp distinctions and carefully to establish the real state of the question before claiming the common teaching of the Scholastics in favor of any particular theory of predestination.

c) What influence do the _supernatural_ merits of a man exert on his predestination to glory as such? Here the controversy begins. Predestination may be considered either as the cause of supernatural merit or as its effect. If it is considered as the cause, the problem takes this shape: Did God, by an absolute decree, and without any regard to their future supernatural merits, eternally predestine certain men to the glory of heaven, and only subsequently decide to give them the efficacious graces necessary to reach that end, particularly final perseverance? If, on the other hand, predestination be considered as an effect of supernatural merit, the question will be: Did God predestine certain men to the glory of Heaven by a merely hypothetical decree, making His will to save them dependent on His infallible foreknowledge of their supernatural merits? The lack of decisive Scriptural and Patristic texts on this subject has led to a division of Catholic opinion, some theologians favoring absolute predestination _ante praevisa merita_, others hypothetical predestination _post praevisa merita_. Without concealing our conviction that absolute predestination is untenable, we shall set forth both theories impartially and examine the arguments on which they rely.

4. ORTHODOX PREDESTINATIONISM, OR THE THEORY OF PREDESTINATION ANTE PRAEVISA MERITA.—Some theologians conceive the divine scheme of salvation in this wise: (a) _In ordine intentionis_, God, by an absolute decree, first predestines certain men to eternal salvation, and then, in consequence of this decree, decides to give them all the graces necessary to be saved; (b) in time, however, or _in ordine executionis_, He observes the reverse order, that is to say, He first bestows the pre-appointed graces and subsequently the glory of heaven as a reward of supernatural merit acquired by the aid of those graces.

This theory reverses the relation of grace and glory. While it correctly(605) represents glory as the fruit and reward of supernatural merit in the order of execution, it wrongly represents it in the order of intention as the cause of supernatural merit, whereas it is merely an effect. This opinion is championed by most Thomists,(606) some Augustinians,(607) and a few Molinists.(608) Their arguments may be sketched as follows:

a) In innumerable passages of Sacred Scripture predestination to eternal happiness is represented as a work of pure mercy, nay, even as an arbitrary act of God. Take, _e.g._, Matth. XXIV, 22 sqq.: “And unless those days had been shortened, no flesh should be saved: but for the sake of the elect those days shall be shortened.... For there shall arise false Christs and false prophets, and shall show great signs and wonders, insomuch as to deceive (if possible) even the elect.”(609) Here, it is claimed, the elect are represented as so thoroughly confirmed in faith and in good works as to be proof against error.

This conclusion is unwarranted. The phrase “those days” manifestly refers either to the destruction of Jerusalem or to the end of the world. If it refers to the destruction of Jerusalem, the “elect,” according to Biblical usage,(610) are the faithful Christian inhabitants of the Holy City, for whose sake God promises to shorten the terrible siege. If it referred to the end of the world, _electi_ would indeed stand for _praedestinati_, but the context would not forbid us to interpret their

predestination hypothetically, as merely indicating the immutability of the divine decree, which is not denied by the opponents of the theory.

Another text quoted in favor of absolute predestination _ante praevisa merita_, is Acts XIII, 48: “As many as were ordained (_praeordinati_, τεταγμένοι) to life everlasting, believed.” Here, we are told, predestination to eternal life is given as the motive why many believed. But the text really says nothing at all about predestination. Τεταγμένοι is not synonymous with προτεταγμένοι or προωρισμένοι. The more probable explanation is the following: As many believed as were disposed to receive the faith. It is wellnigh impossible to assume that all who received the faith at that time were predestined, while those that refused to be converted were without exception reprobates. But even if _praeordinati_ were synonymous with _praedestinati_, the text would merely say that certain predestined souls embraced the faith, without affording any clue as to the relation between conversion and predestination.

The ninth chapter of St. Paul’s Epistle to the Romans is the main reliance of the advocates of absolute predestinationism, though the passage is unfit to serve as a _locus classicus_ because of its obscurity. Let us examine a few of the verses most frequently quoted. Rom. IX, 13: “Jacob I have loved, but Esau I have hated,” is alleged to prove the absolute predestination of Jacob and the negative reprobation of Esau. But many theologians hold that Esau was saved, and, besides, the Apostle is not dealing with predestination to glory, but with Jacob’s vocation to be the progenitor of the Messias. Esau, who was not an Israelite but an Idumaean, was simply passed over in this choice (_odio habere __ minus diligere_; cfr. Matth. X, 37). If the passage is interpreted typically, it should be done in harmony with the context, that is to say, as referring to the gratuity of grace, not to predestination.

The same may be said of Rom. IX, 16 and 18: “It is not of him that willeth, nor of him that runneth, but of God that showeth mercy.... He hath mercy on whom he will, and whom he will he hardeneth.”(611)

The strongest text alleged by the advocates of absolute predestination is Rom. IX, 20 sq.: “O man, who art thou that repliest against God? Shall the thing formed say to him that formed it: Why hast thou made me thus? Or hath not the potter power over the clay, of the same lump to make one vessel unto honor and another unto dishonor?” Here the Apostle really seems to have thought of predestination. But the simile must not be pressed, lest we arrive at the Calvinistic blasphemy that God positively predestined some men to heaven and others to hell. The _tertium comparationis_ is not the act of the Divine Artificer, but the willingness of man to yield his will to God like clay in the hands of a potter.

Nor is it admissible to read into the Apostle’s thought even a _negative_ reprobation of certain men. For the primary intention of the Epistle to the Romans is to insist on the gratuity of man’s vocation to Christianity and to reject the presumption that the Mosaic law and their bodily descent from Abraham gave the Jews preference over the heathens. The Epistle to the Romans has no bearing whatever on the speculative question whether or not the free vocation of grace is a

necessary result of eternal predestination to glory.(612)

b) Among the Fathers the only one to whom the advocates of absolute predestinationism can appeal with some show of justice is St. Augustine, who, with the possible exception of Prosper and Fulgentius, was the most rigorous among early ecclesiastical writers,—so rigorous, in fact, that Oswald does not hesitate to call him "the head and front of all rigorists in the Church."(613)

However, this is saying too much. Augustine's genuine teaching is still in dispute among our ablest theologians. Some(614) deny that he broke with the almost unanimous teaching of his predecessors, while others think that in the treatises _De Dono Perseverantiae_ and _De Praedestinatione Sanctorum_, and in several of his letters, the Saint frankly taught absolute predestinationism. The latter group of writers is split into two classes. A number of Thomists and Cardinal Bellarmine not only assert that Augustine taught absolute predestination, but boldly adopt his supposed teaching. Petavius, Maldonatus, Cercià, Oswald, and others censure this view. Franzelin(615) undoubtedly strikes the right note when he says: "If there were a manifest discrepancy between Augustine's teaching and that of the other Fathers, I should not hesitate to follow Pighius, Catharinus, Osorius, Camerarius, Maldonatus,(616) Toletus,(617) and Petavius(618) in reverently departing from his doctrine, because in that case we should be dealing merely with a private opinion."(619) Under these circumstances the Patristic argument for the theory of absolute predestination evidently lacks convincingness.(620)

c) It was probably because they felt its weakness that some of the later champions of the theory attempted to prove absolute predestination _ante praevisa merita_ by philosophical arguments. Gonet reasons as follows: "He who proceeds in an orderly way, wills the end before he wills the means necessary to attain it. But God proceeds in an orderly way. Therefore he wills the end before the means. Now, glory is an end, and merits are means to attain that end. Consequently, God wills glory before He wills merits, and a man's preëlection to glory cannot be based on foreknowledge of his merits."(621) This argument, if it proved anything, would prove the logical impossibility of conditional predestination. But it overshoots the mark and consequently proves nothing at all. _Qui nimium probat, nihil probat._

Gonet moreover assumes what he sets out to prove, namely, that God _voluntate antecedente_ decreed the glory of certain men to the exclusion of others. This _petitio principii_ vitiates the entire polysyllogism. God's will to save is universal. He wills the eternal happiness of all men _antecedenter_, and the reprobation of some only _consequenter_; hence eternal predestination is not absolute, but hypothetical, that is, it depends on merit. That the divine scheme of grace can take a different course _in ordine intentionis_ from that _in ordine executionis_ is a mere fiction. If eternal salvation in the order of temporal execution is given only as a reward of merit, it must be a reward of merit also in the order of intention. In both cases predestination depends upon a future condition.

Perhaps the worst feature of the theory of absolute predestination is the fact that it involves the absolute reprobation of those not predestined to glory. "If it could be

validly argued," says Gutberlet, "that, since the end must be willed before the means, salvation must be decreed before the means to its attainment (_i.e._ merits), the argument would be applicable also to the damned. If God _voluntate antecedente_ wills to lead only a few to salvation, and if this intention must precede every other, then He must likewise _voluntate antecedente_ have in view the end of the reprobates, which is His own glorification through the manifestation of His justice and mercy. Hence He must also decree the means necessary to obtain this end, _i.e._ He must cause these unfortunate creatures to sin, in order that they may reach the end for which He has predestined them; in other words, He must pre-ordain them to sin and eternal damnation,"(622) which is what Calvin teaches. The advocates of the theory naturally shrink from adopting such a blasphemous conclusion, and fall back upon the theory of _negative_ reprobation, which, however, amounts practically to the same thing.(623)

5. THE THEORY OF HYPOTHETICAL PREDESTINATION POST PRAEVISA MERITA.—Predestination, like God's will to save all men, is based on a hypothetical decree. Those only are predestined to eternal happiness who shall merit it as a reward. It is solely by reason of His infallible foreknowledge of these merits that God's hypothetical decree of predestination becomes absolute. Or, as Becanus puts it, "God first prepared the gifts of grace, and then elected to eternal life those whose good use of the gifts He foresaw."(624)

This view, which strongly appeals to us for the reason that it sets aside the cruel theory of "negative reprobation," was defended by such earlier Scholastics as Alexander of Hales and Albertus Magnus, and by many eminent later writers, _e.g._ Toletus, Lessius, Frassen, Stapleton, Tournely, and is held to-day by nearly all theologians outside the Thomist school. What gave it special authority in modern times was the recommendation of St. Francis de Sales, who, in a letter to Lessius (Aug. 26, 1618) described the theory of conditional predestination _post praevisa merita_ as "more in harmony with the mercy and grace of God, truer and more attractive."(625) This view has a solid basis both in Scripture and Tradition.

a) Holy Scripture clearly teaches the universality of God's saving will. Now if God _voluntate antecedente_ wills the eternal salvation of all men without exception,(626) He cannot possibly intend that only some shall be saved.

It is further to be noted that the Bible makes not only the temporal realization but likewise the eternal promise of glory dependent on the performance of good works. St. Paul, whose Epistle to the Romans is cited as a _locus classicus_ by the advocates of the theory,(627) wrote towards the end of his life to Timothy: "I have fought a good fight, I have finished my course, I have kept the faith. As to the rest, there is laid up for me a crown of justice, which the Lord the just judge will render to me in that day."(628) In writing these lines the Apostle no doubt had in mind the sentence of the Universal Judge: "Come, ye blessed of my Father, possess you the kingdom prepared for you from the foundation of the world,"(629)—which may with far greater reason be termed a "classical" text than the obscure ninth chapter of the Epistle to the Romans. To prepare for men the kingdom of heaven from the foundation (_i.e._ beginning) of the world, is to predestine them to eternal happiness. Now, God has

“prepared” the kingdom of heaven for men in view of their foreseen merits, that is to say, conditionally. The causal conjunction _enim_ in the sentence following the one just quoted (Matth. XXVI, 25): “_Esurivi enim et dedistis mihi manducare_, etc.,” refers to the entire preceding sentence, not only to the _possidete_ in time, but also to the _paratum_ in eternity. Consequently, the eternal decree of predestination itself, like its temporal execution, depends on good works or merit. This interpretation of Matth. XXV, 34-36 is confirmed by the sentence pronounced upon the reprobates, Matth. XXV, 41 sqq.: “Depart from me, you cursed, into everlasting fire, which was prepared for the devil and his angels. For I was hungry, and you gave me not to eat, etc.” The “everlasting fire” is manifestly decreed from all eternity in the same sense in which it is inflicted in time, namely, _propter et post praevisa merita_. Billuart’s contention(630) that hell has been prepared solely for “the devil and his angels” is untenable, because in several other Scriptural passages(631) the reprobates are expressly classed among the followers of Satan. If we add to this that our Divine Lord, in foretelling the last judgment, had naturally to formulate his prediction so as not only to show its absolute justice but likewise to intimate that, had they so willed, the damned might have had their place on the right hand of the Great Judge, we must admit that the theory of predestination _post praevisa merita_ has a solid foundation in Scripture.(632)

b) The Greek Fathers unanimously favor hypothetical predestination, which fact has caused the theory to be commonly referred to as “_sententia Graecorum_.”(633)

Thus St. Chrysostom interprets the judgment of the Son of Man as follows: “Possess ye the kingdom [of heaven] as your own by heredity, as a paternal heritage, as a gift long due to you; for it was prepared and arranged for you before you came into existence, because I knew beforehand that you would be what you are.”(634) Theodoret says: “He did not simply predestine [men], but He predestined them because He foreknew [their merits].”(635)

The Latin Fathers before St. Augustine all without exception taught hypothetical predestination. St. Hilary says: “Many are called, but few are chosen.... Hence election is not a matter of indiscriminate choice, but a selection based on merit.”(636) And St. Ambrose: “Therefore the Apostle says: ‘Whom he foreknew he also predestined’ (Rom. VIII, 29); for He did not predestine before He foreknew, but He predestined a reward to those whose merits He foresaw.”(637)

The question cannot, as Bellarmine contends,(638) be decided on the sole authority of St. Augustine, because he is claimed by both parties to the controversy.(639)

On account of the existing differences of opinion it is impossible to establish the theory of hypothetical predestination on the basis of Scholastic teaching.(640) The opinion of St. Thomas is in dispute;(641) likewise that of St. Bonaventure. Scotus in his controversy with Henry of Ghent shows a disposition to favor absolute predestination, but leaves the question open. “Let every one,” he says,(642) “choose whichever opinion suits him best, without prejudice to the divine liberty, which must be safeguarded against injustice, and to the other truths that are to be held in respect

of God."(643)

6. A COMPROMISE THEORY.—For the sake of completeness we will add a few words on a theory which takes middle ground between the two just reviewed, holding that, while the common run of humanity is predestined hypothetically, a few exceptionally favored Saints enjoy the privilege of absolute predestination.

Among the champions of this "eclectic" theory may be mentioned: Ockam,(644) Gabriel Biel,(645) Ysambert,(646) and Ambrosius Catharinus.(647) The Saints regarded by these writers as absolutely predestined to eternal glory are: the Blessed Virgin Mary, the prophets and Apostles, St. Joseph, St. Aloysius, and a few others, as well as all infants dying in the grace of Baptism. Billuart,(648) Dominicus Soto, and certain other divines attack this theory on the ground that it makes the salvation of the great majority of the elect a matter of chance and thereby imperils the dogmatic teaching of the Church. This objection is unfounded. For though the "eclectic" theory has little or no support either in Revelation or in reason, it sufficiently safeguards the dogma of predestination by admitting that _voluntate consequente_ none but the predestined can attain to eternal beatitude.

Only with regard to the Blessed Virgin Mary are we inclined to make an exception. It is probable that she was predestined to eternal glory _ante praevisa merita_, because, in the words of Lessius, the privileges she enjoyed "exceed all measure and must not be extended to any other human being."(649)

Article 4. The Reprobation Of The Damned

The reprobation of the damned is sometimes called _praedestinatio ad gehennam_, though, as we have remarked, the term "predestination" should properly be restricted to the blessed.

There can be no absolute and positive predestination to eternal punishment, and the pains of hell can be threatened only in view of mortal sin. Hence reprobation may be defined, in the words of Peter Lombard, as "God's foreknowledge of the wickedness of some creatures and the preparation of their damnation."(650)

A distinction must, however, be made (at least in theory), between _positive_ and _negative_ reprobation. To teach positive reprobation would be heretical. Negative reprobation, on the other hand, is defended by all those Catholic theologians who advocate the theory of absolute predestination _ante praevisa merita_.(651)

1. HERETICAL PREDESTINARIANISM OR THE THEORY OF THE POSITIVE REPROBATION OF THE DAMNED.—Heretical Predestinarianism was taught by Lucidus, Gottschalk, Wiclif, Hus, the younger Jansenius, and especially by Calvin. The latter asserted that the salvation of the elect and the damnation of the reprobate are the effects of an unconditional divine decree.(652)

According to this abominable heresy, the sin of Adam and the spiritual ruin which it entailed upon his descendants are attributable solely to the will of God. God produces in the reprobate a "semblance of faith," only to make them all the more deserving of damnation. In the beginning of the seventeenth century Arminius and a few other theologians of the Dutch Reformed Church, repelled by Calvin's _decretum

horribile_, ascribed the positive reprobation of the damned to original sin (_lapsus_). These writers, called Infralapsarians or Postlapsarians, were opposed by the strict school of Calvinist divines under the leadership of Gomarus. The great Calvinist Synod of Dordrecht (1618-1619) condemned the principles of Arminius, and subsequently his adherents were driven from Holland.

The Catholic Church condemned Predestinarianism as early as 529 at the Second Council of Orange, which among other things declared: “We not only refuse to believe that some men are by divine power predestined to evil, but if there be any who hold such a wicked thing, we condemn them with utter detestation.”(653)

The Tridentine Council defined against Calvin: “If any one saith that the grace of justification is attained to only by those who are predestined unto life, but that all others who are called, are called indeed, but receive not grace, as being by divine power predestined unto evil; let him be anathema.”(654)

Calvinism, both supra- and infra-lapsarian, is easily refuted from Revelation and Tradition.

a) It runs counter to all those texts of the Bible which assert the universality of God’s saving will,(655) the bestowal of sufficient grace on all sinners,(656) and the divine attribute of holiness.(657)

Calvin endeavored to prove his blasphemous doctrine chiefly from the ninth chapter of St. Paul’s Epistle to the Romans.(658) His disciple Beza relied mainly on 1 Pet. II, 7 sq.: “But to them that believe not, the stone which the builders rejected, the same is made the head of the corner: and a stone of stumbling, and a rock of scandal, to them who stumble at the word, neither do believe, whereunto also they are set,”(659) _i.e._, according to Beza, predestined not to believe.(660) But this interpretation is obviously wrong. For we know from Is. VIII, 14(661) and Matth. XXI, 44,(662) that those who fall on this stone are ground to powder as a punishment for the sin of unbelief.(663)

b) The Fathers, especially those of the East, are unanimous in upholding the orthodox teaching of the Church. The only one whom adherents of Predestinarianism have dared to claim is St. Augustine.

Yet the “Doctor of Grace” expressly teaches: “God is good, God is just. He can deliver some without merits because He is good; but He cannot damn any one without demerits, because He is just.”(664) St. Prosper re-echoes this teaching when he says of the reprobates: “Of their own will they went out; of their own will they fell; and because their fall was foreknown, they were not predestined. They would, however, be predestined if they were to return and persevere in holiness; hence God’s predestination is for many the cause of perseverance, for none the cause of falling away.”(665) St. Fulgentius expresses himself in similar language.(666)

2. THE THEORY OF “NEGATIVE REPROBATION.”—Negative reprobation is defined by its defenders as an eternal decree by which God excludes from Heaven those not absolutely predestined, in other words, determines not to save them.

a) Gonet explains the difference between negative and positive reprobation in Scholastic terminology as follows: “_... quod haec [i.e. positiva] habet non solum terminum a quo, nempe exclusionem a gloria, sed etiam terminum ad quem, scil. poenam sive damni sive sensus; illa vero [i.e. negativa] solum habet terminum a quo, nempe exclusionem a gloria ut beneficio indebito, non vero terminum ad quem, quia ex vi exclusionis ut sic praecise et ut habet rationem purae negationis, non intelligitur reprobus esse damnandus aut ulli poenae sive damni sive sensus deputandus._”(667)

The general principle laid down in this quotation is variously developed by Thomist theologians.

The rigorists (Alvarez, John a S. Thoma, Estius, Sylvius) assign as the motive of reprobation the sovereign will of God. God, they say, without taking into account possible sins and demerits, determined _a priori_ to exclude from Heaven those who are not predestined. De Lemos, Gotti, Gonet, Gazzaniga, and others condemn this view as incompatible with the teaching of St. Thomas, and, appealing to St. Augustine’s doctrine of the _massa damnata_, find the ultimate reason for the exclusion of the reprobates from heaven in original sin, in which God, without being unjust, could leave as many as He saw fit. Goudin, Graveson, Billuart, and others assume that the reprobates are not directly excluded from eternal glory but merely from “effective election” thereunto, God simply having decreed _ante praevisa merita_ to leave them to their weakness.(668)

While the Thomists found no difficulty in harmonizing this view with their theory of physical premotion, the few Molinists who espoused it were hard put in trying to square it with the _scientia media_.(669) On the whole these Molinists endorse the third and mildest of the above-quoted opinions, which differs only theoretically from the rigoristic view described in the first place. Practically it makes no difference whether God directly excludes a man from heaven or refuses to give him the graces necessary to attain it.

Surveying all three of the theories under consideration we cannot but regard the first and third as heartless and cruel, because they attribute eternal reprobation to a positive decree that takes effect independently of sin; the second, (which ascribes reprobation to original sin), is open to the serious dogmatic objection that it contradicts the teaching of St. Paul and the Tridentine declaration that “there is no condemnation (_nihil damnationis_) in those who are truly buried together with Christ by baptism into death.”(670)

b) Negative reprobation is rightly regarded as the logical counterpart of absolute predestination.(671) If Almighty God, by an absolute decree, without regard to any possible merits, merely to reveal His divine attributes and to “embellish the universe,” had determined that only those could enter the “Heavenly Jerusalem” who were antecedently predestined thereto, it would inevitably follow that the unfortunate remainder of humanity by the very same decree were “passed over,” “omitted,” “overlooked,” “not elected,” or, as Gonet honestly admits, “excluded from Heaven,” which is the same thing as being negatively condemned to hell.

The logical distinction between positive and negative reprobation, therefore, consists mainly in this, that the former signifies absolute damnation to hell, the latter (equally absolute) non-election to Heaven. To protect the Catholic champions of negative reprobation against unjust aspersions, however, it is necessary to point out certain fundamental differences between their theory and the heresy of Calvin.

Calvin and the Jansenists openly deny the universality both of God's saving will and of the atonement; they refuse to admit the actual bestowal of sufficient grace upon those fore-ordained to eternal damnation; and claim that the human will loses its freedom under the predominance of efficacious grace or concupiscence. The Catholic defenders of negative reprobation indignantly reject the charge that their position logically leads to any such heretical implications.

c) The theory of negative reprobation can be sufficiently refuted by showing that it is incompatible with the universality of God's will to save all men. For if God willed absolutely and antecedently to "exclude some men from Heaven," as Gonet asserts, or "not to elect them to eternal glory," as Suarez contends, then it would be His absolute will that they perish.

α) For one thus negatively reprobated it is metaphysically impossible to attain eternal salvation. To hold otherwise would be tantamount to assuming that an essentially absolute decree of God can be frustrated. This consideration led certain Thomists(672) to describe the divine _voluntas salvifica_ as rather an ineffectual _velleitas_.(673) But this conflicts with the obvious teaching of Revelation.(674) Suarez labors in vain to reconcile the sincerity of God's salvific will with the theory of negative reprobation. The two are absolutely irreconcilable. How could God sincerely will the salvation of all men if it were true, as Suarez says, that "it is not in man's power to work out his eternal salvation in case he falls under non-election, non-predestination, or, which amounts to the same thing, negative reprobation"?(675)

β) The cruel absurdity of the theory of negative reprobation becomes fully apparent when we consider the attitude it ascribes to God. Gonet writes: "Foreseeing that the whole human race would be depraved by original sin, God, in view of the merits of Christ who was to come, elected some men to glory and, in punishment of original sin and to show His justice towards them and His greater mercy towards the elect, permitted others to miss the attainment of beatitude, in other words, He positively willed that they should not attain it.... In virtue of this efficacious intention He devised appropriate means for the attainment of His purpose, and seeing that some would miss beatitude by simply being left in the state of original sin, and others by being permitted to fall into actual sins and to persevere therein, He formally decreed this permission, and finally ... by a command of His intellect ordained these means towards the attainment of the aforesaid end."(676) Translated into plain every-day language this can only mean that God tries with all His might to prevent the reprobate from attaining eternal salvation and sees to it that they die in the state of sin. Suarez is perfectly right in characterizing Gonet's teaching as "incompatible with sound doctrine."(677) But his own teaching is equally unsound and cruel. For he, too, is compelled to assert: "Predestination to glory is the motive for which

efficacious or infallible means towards attaining that end are bestowed. Hence to refuse to predestine a man for glory is to deny him the means which are recognized as fit and certain to attain that end."(678)

Holy Scripture fortunately speaks a different language. It describes God as a loving Father, who "wills not that any should perish, but that all should return to penance."(679)

γ) Practically it makes no difference whether a man is positively condemned to eternal damnation, as Calvin and the Jansenists assert, or negatively excluded from Heaven, as held by the orthodox theologians whom we have just quoted. The alleged distinction between positive and negative reprobation is "a distinction without a difference." For an adult to be excluded from Heaven simply means that he is damned. There is no such thing as a middle state or a purely natural beatitude. Lessius justly says that to one reprobated by God it would be all the same whether his reprobation was positive or negative, because in either case he would be inevitably lost.(680)

READINGS:—*Ruiz, _De Praedestinatione et Reprobatione_, Lyons 1628.—Ramirez, _De Praedestinatione et Reprobatione_, 2 vols., Alcalá 1702.—*Lessius, _De Perfectionibus Moribusque Divinis_, XIV, 2.—*IDEM, _De Praedestinatione et Reprobatione_ (_Opusc._, Vol. II, Paris 1878).—Tournely, _De Deo_, qu. 22 sqq.—Schrader, _Commentarii_, I-II, _De Praedestinatione_, Vienna 1865.—J. P. Baltzer, _Des hl. Augustinus Lehre über Prädestination und Reprobation_, Vienna 1871.—Mannens, _De Voluntate Dei Salvifica et Praedestinatione_, Louvain 1883.—O. Rottmanner, O. S. B., _Der Augustinismus_, München 1892.—O. Pfülf, S. J., "_Zur Prädestinationslehre des hl. Augustinus_," in the Innsbruck _Zeitschrift für kath. Theologie_, 1893, pp. 483 sqq.—B. J. Otten, S. J., _A Manual of the History of Dogmas_, Vol. I, St. Louis 1917, pp. 281, 378, 382 sqq.

Chapter III. Grace In Its Relation To Free-Will

When we speak of the relation of grace to free-will, we mean efficacious grace; merely sufficient grace, as such, does not involve consent.

The Protestant reformers and the Jansenists denied the freedom of the human will under the influence of efficacious grace.

Catholic theologians have always staunchly upheld both the freedom of the will and the efficacy of grace, but they disagree in explaining the mutual relations between grace and free-will.

Section 1. The Heresy of The Protestant Reformers And The Jansenists

1. THE HERETICAL ERRORS OF LUTHER, CALVIN, AND JANSENIUS CONTRASTED WITH THE ORTHODOX TEACHING OF THE CHURCH.—Luther and Calvin asserted that the freedom of the will was irretrievably lost by original sin. Jansenius taught

that the will is overcome by efficacious grace in exactly the same way as it is overpowered by concupiscence in the absence of grace. Against both these heresies the Church has always maintained that the will remains free under the influence of efficacious grace.

a) Luther taught(681) that original sin has so completely annihilated man's free-will that he resembles a horse compelled to go in whatever direction it is driven (according as "God or the devil rides him"),(682) and that the grace of Christ, far from restoring man's liberty, compels him to act with intestine necessity.

Calvin(683) carried this teaching to its logical conclusions by asserting: (1) that the will of our first parents was free in Paradise, but lost its freedom by original sin; (2) that we cannot be delivered from the slavery of Satan except by the grace of Christ, which does not, however, restore liberty, but simply compels the will to do good; (3) that, though the will under the influence of grace is passive, and must needs follow the impulse to which it is subjected, yet its acts are vital and spontaneous.(684)

Against these heresies the Council of Trent maintained the existence of free-will both in the state of original sin(685) and under the influence of efficacious grace: "If any one saith that man's free-will, moved and excited by God, by assenting to God exciting and calling, ... cannot refuse its consent if it would, but that, as something inanimate, it does nothing whatever and is merely passive: let him be anathema."(686)

b) Jansenius differed from Luther and Calvin mainly in drawing a sharper distinction between freedom from external constraint (_libertas a coactione_) and freedom from internal compulsion (_libertas a necessitate_), and maintaining that the will, when under the influence of grace, is exempt from external constraint, though not from interior compulsion, and that the _libertas a coactione_ is entirely sufficient to gain merit or demerit in the fallen state.(687)

The Jansenist teaching on the subject of grace may be outlined as follows: (1) By original sin man lost the moral liberty which he had enjoyed in Paradise and became subject to a twofold delectation—_delectatio coelestis victrix_ and _delectatio terrena sive carnalis victrix_. (2) These two delectations are continually contending for the mastery; the stronger always defeats the weaker, (3) and the will, unable to offer resistance, is alternately overpowered now by the one and then by the other.(688) (4) In each case the _delectatio coelestis_ is either stronger than the _delectatio terrena_, or it is weaker, or it is of equal strength. When it is stronger, the will is overcome by grace, which in that case becomes _efficax_ or _irresistibilis_. When it is weaker, the will simply _must_ sin, because the _delectatio coelestis_ is too weak to overcome the _delectatio terrena_. The grace given to a man under such conditions is called by the Jansenists _gratia parva sive sufficiens_. When the two delectations are equally strong, the will finds itself unable to come to a definite decision.

This false teaching inspired the famous "five propositions" of Jansenius, to-wit: (1) Man is unable to keep some of God's commandments for want of grace; (2) In the state of fallen nature no one ever resists interior grace; (3) To merit or demerit in the state of fallen nature it is sufficient to be free from external constraint; (4) The

Semipelagian heresy consisted in assuming the existence of a grace which man may either obey or resist; and (5) Christ did not die for all men, but solely for the predestined.

These propositions were condemned as heretical by Pope Innocent X in his dogmatic Bull "_Cum occasione_," of May 31, 1653. All five are implicitly contained in the second, _viz._: In the state of fallen nature no one ever resists interior grace. "If it is true that fallen man never resists interior grace (second proposition), it follows that a just man who violates a commandment of God has not had the grace to observe it, that he therefore transgressed it through inability to fulfil it (first proposition). If, however, he has sinned and thus incurred demerit, it is clear that the liberty of indifference is not a requisite condition of demerit, and what is said of demerit is likewise true of its correlative, merit (third proposition). On the other hand, if grace is wanting to the just whenever they fall, it is wanting still more to sinners; it is therefore impossible to maintain that the death of Jesus Christ assured to every man the graces necessary for salvation (fifth proposition). As a further consequence, the Semipelagians were in error in admitting the universal distribution of a grace which may be resisted (fourth proposition)."(689)

2. THE TEACHING OF THE CHURCH PROVED FROM REVELATION.—Far from favoring the determinism of the Reformers and of Jansenius, the Bible and Tradition positively contradict the contention that free-will is overpowered by grace.

a) The operation of grace and the liberty of the will never appear in Sacred Scripture as mutually exclusive, but invariably as coöperating factors, though sometimes the one is emphasized, and sometimes the other, according to the purpose the sacred writer happens to have in view.

The Council of Trent expressly calls attention to this:(690) "When it is said in the sacred writings, 'Turn ye to me, and I will turn to you,'(691) we are admonished of our liberty; and when we answer: 'Convert us, O God, to thee, and we shall be converted,'(692) we confess that we are forestalled by the grace of God."

St. Paul, it is true, asks: "Who resisteth his [God's] will?"(693) But he also admonishes his favorite disciple Timothy: "Exercise thyself unto godliness."(694) St. Stephen testifies that the grace of the Holy Ghost does not compel the will. "You always resist the Holy Ghost," he tells the Jews; "as your fathers did, so do you also."(695) Our Lord Himself teaches that grace exerts no interior compulsion but invites free coöperation: "If thou wilt enter into life, keep the commandments."(696) The exhortations, promises, and threats uttered in various portions of Holy Writ would be meaningless if it were true that grace destroys free-will.(697)

b) As regards Tradition, the Greek Fathers who wrote before St. Augustine defended the freedom of the will so energetically that they were subsequently accused of harboring Pelagian and Semipelagian errors.(698) Calvin himself admits that with but one exception the Fathers are unanimously opposed to his teaching.(699)

The one exception noted is St. Augustine, to whom both Calvin and Jansenius appeal with great confidence. It should be noted, however, that the point which

chiefly concerned St. Augustine in his controversies with the Pelagians and Semipelagians, was the necessity and gratuity of grace, not its relation to free-will. Where he incidentally touches upon the latter, he shows by the manner in which he formulates his sentences that he regards the relation of grace to free-will as a great mystery. But he does not try to solve this mystery in the manner in which Alexander the Great cut the Gordian knot. He does not declare: Grace is everything, free-will is nothing. If the power of grace destroyed the freedom of the human will, their mutual relation would be no problem.(700) Possibly St. Augustine in the heat of controversy now and then expressed himself in language open to misinterpretation, as when he said: “Therefore aid was brought to the infirmity of the human will, so that it might be unchangeably and invincibly influenced by divine grace.”(701) But this and similar phrases admit of a perfectly orthodox interpretation. As the context shows, Augustine merely wished to assert the hegemony of grace in all things pertaining to salvation, and to emphasize the fact that free-will, strengthened by grace, is able to resist even the most grievous temptations.(702) At no period of his life did the Saint deny the freedom of the will under the influence of grace. We will quote but two out of many available passages in proof of this statement. “To yield consent or to withhold it, whenever God calls, is the function of one’s own will.”(703) “For the freedom of the will is not destroyed because the will is aided; but it is aided precisely for the reason that it remains free.”(704) St. Bernard of Clairvaux echoes this teaching when, in his own ingenious way, he summarizes the Catholic dogma as follows: “Take away free will and there will be nothing left to save; take away grace and there will be no means left of salvation.”(705)

READINGS:—*Bellarmine, _De Gratia et Libero Arbitrio_ (_Opera Omnia_, ed. Fèvre, Vols. V and VI, Paris 1873).—*Dechamps, S. J., _De Haeresi Ianseniana_, Paris 1645.—F. Wörter, _Die christliche Lehre über das Verhältnis von Gnade und Freiheit bis auf Augustinus_, Freiburg 1856.—*Palmieri, _De Gratia Divina Actuali_, thes. 39-48, Gulpen 1885.—S. Schiffini, _De Gratia Divina_, pp. 357 sqq., 377 sqq., Freiburg 1901.—B. J. Otten, S. J., _A Manual of the History of Dogmas_, Vol. II, St. Louis 1918, pp. 507 sqq.

Section 2. Theological Systems Devised To Harmonize The Dogmas Of Grace And Free-Will

The relation of grace to free-will may be regarded from a twofold point of view. We may take grace as the primary factor and trace it in its action on the human will; or, starting from the latter, we may endeavor to ascertain how free-will is affected by grace.

The first-mentioned method has given birth to two closely related theological systems, Thomism and Augustinianism; the latter to Molinism and Congruism, which are almost identical in substance.

Besides these there is a fifth theory, which tries to reconcile the two extremes and may therefore be called eclectic.

That the human will is free, yet subject to the influence of grace, is an article of faith unhesitatingly accepted by all Catholic theologians. It is in trying to explain how

grace and free-will coöperate, that the above-mentioned schools differ.

In approaching this extremely difficult and obscure problem we consider it our duty to warn the student against preconceived opinions and to remind him that the different systems which we are about to examine are all tolerated by the Church. To-day, when so many more important things are at stake and the faith is viciously assailed from without, the ancient controversy between Thomism and Molinism had better be left in abeyance.

Article 1. Thomism And Augustinianism

Thomism and Augustinianism both hinge on the concept of _gratia efficax ab intrinseco s. per se_, whereas Molinism and Congruism will not admit even the existence of such a grace.

1. THE THOMISTIC THEORY OF GRACE.—The true founder of the Thomistic system is not St. Thomas Aquinas, who is also claimed by the Molinists, but the learned Dominican theologian Bañez (1528-1604). His teaching may be summarized as follows:

a) God is the First Cause (_causa prima_) and Prime Mover (_motor primus_) of all things, and all created or secondary causes (_causae secundae_) derive their being and faculties, nay, their very acts from Him. If any creature could act independently of God, God would cease to be _causa prima_ and _motor primus_.(706)

The influence of the First Cause is universal, that is to say, it produces all creatural acts without exception,—necessary and free, good and bad,—because no secondary cause has power to act unless it is set in motion by the _motor primus_.

In influencing His creatures, however, God adapts himself to the peculiar nature of each. The necessary causes He determines to act necessarily, the free causes, freely. All receive from Him their substance and their mode of action.(707) The rational creature, therefore, though subject to His determining influence, acts with perfect freedom, just as if it were not moved.

b) In spite of free-will, however, the influence which God exerts on His rational creatures is irresistible because it proceeds from an absolute and omnipotent Being whose decrees brook no opposition. What God wills infallibly happens.(708)

Nevertheless, God is not the author of sin. He moves the sinner to perform an act; but He does not move Him to perform a sinful act. The malice of sin derives solely from the free will of man.(709)

c) Since the divine influence causally precedes all creatural acts, God’s concurrence with creatural causes (_concursus generalis_) must be conceived as prevenient, not simultaneous. The Divine Omnipotence not only makes the action possible, but likewise effects it by moving the will from potentiality to actuality.(710) Consequently, the causal influence which the Creator exerts upon His creatures is not a mere _motio_, but a _praemotio_,—and not merely moral, but physical (_praemotio physica_).(711) It is by physical premotion that God’s prevenient influence effects the free actions of His creatures, without regard to their

assent.(712) Free-will is predetermined by God before it determines itself.(713)

d) If we analyse God's physical predeterminations in so far as they are created entities, we find that they are nothing else than the effect and execution of His eternal decrees, embodied in the _praedeterminatio physica_. It is the temporal execution of the latter that is called _praemotio physica_. Hence we are justified in speaking, not only of a temporal _praemotio_, but of an eternal _praedeterminatio_, in fact the terms are often used synonymously.(714)

Viewed in its relation to rational creatures, this eternal predetermination is nothing but a temporal premotion of the free will to determine itself. Since God has from all eternity made absolute and conditional decrees, which possess the power of physical predetermination without regard to the free consent of His creatures, physical predetermination constitutes an infallible medium by which He can foreknow their future free actions, and hence there is no need of a _scientia media_. If God knows His own will, He must also know the free determinations included therein. To deny this would be to destroy the very foundation of His foreknowledge.(715)

This is merely the philosophical basis of the Thomistic system. Its champions carry the argument into the theological domain by reasoning as follows: What is true in the natural must be equally true in the supernatural sphere, as we know from reason and Revelation.(716)

e) To physical predetermination or premotion in the order of nature, there corresponds in the supernatural sphere the _gratia efficax_, which predetermines man to perform salutary acts in such wise that he acts freely but at the same time with metaphysical necessity (_necessitate consequentiae_, not _consequentis_). It would be a contradiction to say that efficacious grace given for the purpose of eliciting consent may co-exist with non-consent, _i.e._, may fail to elicit consent.(717) The will freely assents to the divine impulse because it is effectively moved thereto by grace. Consequently, efficacious grace does not derive its efficacy from the consent of the will; it is efficacious of itself and intrinsically (_gratia efficax ab intrinseco sive per se_).(718)

It follows that efficacious grace must be conceived as a _praedeterminatio ad unum_.(719)

f) If efficacious grace is intrinsically and of its very nature inseparably bound up with the consent of the will, it must differ essentially from merely sufficient grace (_gratia mere sufficiens_), which confers only the power to act (_posse operari_), not the act itself (_actu operari_). Efficacious grace, by its very definition, includes the free consent of the will, while merely sufficient grace lacks that consent, because with it, it would cease to be merely sufficient and would become efficacious.(720)

Here the question naturally arises: How, in this hypothesis, can sufficient grace be called truly sufficient? The Thomists answer this question in different ways. Gazzaniga says that sufficient grace confers the power to perform a good deed, but that something more is required for the deed itself.(721) De Lemos ascribes the inefficacy of merely sufficient grace to a defect of the will.(722) If the will did not

resist, God would promptly add efficacious grace.(723)

CRITICAL ESTIMATE OF THE THOMISTIC THEORY.—The Thomistic system undoubtedly has its merits. It is logical in its deductions, exalts divine grace as the prime factor in the business of salvation, and magnificently works out the concept of God as _causa prima_ and _motor primus_ both in the natural and the supernatural order.

But Thomism also has its weak points.

A. The Thomistic conception of efficacious grace is open to two serious theological difficulties.

(1) To draw an intrinsic and substantial distinction between efficacious and merely sufficient grace destroys the true notion of sufficient grace.

(2) The Thomistic theory of efficacious grace is incompatible with the dogma of free-will.

Though in theory the Thomists defend the sufficiency of grace and the freedom of the will as valiantly as their opponents, they fail in their attempts at squaring these dogmas with the fundamental principles of their system.

a) Sufficient grace, as conceived by the Thomists, is not truly sufficient to enable a man to perform a salutary act, because _ex vi notionis_ it confers merely the power to act, postulating for the act itself a substantially new grace (_gratia efficax_). A grace which requires to be entitatively supplemented by another, in order to enable a man to perform a salutary act, is clearly not sufficient for the performance of that act. “To be truly sufficient for something” and “to require to be complemented by something else” are mutually exclusive notions, and hence “sufficient grace” as conceived by Thomists is in reality insufficient.

Many subtle explanations have been devised to obviate this difficulty. Billuart and nearly all the later Thomists say that if any one who has received sufficient grace (in the Thomistic sense of the term) is denied the _gratia efficax_, it must be attributed to a sinful resistance of the will.(724) But this explanation is incompatible with the Thomistic teaching that together with the _gratia sufficiens_ there co-exists in the soul of the sinner an irresistible and inevitable _praemotio physica_ to the entity of sin, with which entity formal sin is inseparably bound up.(725) If this be true, how can the will of man be held responsible so long as God denies him the _gratia ab intrinseco efficax_?

Speaking in the abstract, the will may assume one of three distinct attitudes toward sufficient grace. It may consent, it may resist, or it may remain neutral. It cannot consent except with the aid of a predetermining _gratia efficax_, to merit which is beyond its power. If it withstands, it _eo ipso_ renders itself unworthy of the _gratia efficax_. If it takes a neutral attitude, (which may in itself be a sinful act), and awaits efficacious grace, of what use is sufficient grace?

To resist sufficient grace involves an abuse of liberty. Now, where does the right use of liberty come in? If coöperation with sufficient grace moves God to bestow the

gratia per se efficax, as the Thomists contend, then the right use of liberty must lie somewhere between the _gratia sufficiens_ and the _gratia efficax per se_. But there is absolutely no place for it in the Thomistic system. The right use of liberty for the purpose of obtaining efficacious grace is attributable either to grace or to unaided nature. To assert that it is the work of unaided nature would lead to Semipelagianism. To hold that it is owing to grace would be moving in a vicious circle, thus: “Because the will offers no resistance, it is efficaciously moved to perform a salutary act; that it offers no sinful resistance is owing to the fact that it is efficaciously moved to perform a salutary act.”(726)

It is impossible to devise any satisfactory solution of this difficulty which will not at the same time upset the very foundation on which the Thomistic system rests, viz.: “_Nulla secunda causa potest operari, nisi sit efficaciter determinata a prima [scil. per applicationem potentiae ad actum]_,” that is to say, no secondary cause can act unless it be efficaciously determined by the First Cause by an application of the latter to the former as of potency to act.

b) The Thomistic _gratia efficax_, conceived as a _praedeterminatio ad unum_, inevitably destroys free-will.

α) It is important to state the question clearly: Not physical premotion as such,(727) but the implied connotation of _praevia determinatio ad unum_, is incompatible with the dogma of free-will. The freedom of the will does not consist in the pure contingency of an act, or in a merely passive indifference, but in active indifference either to will or not to will, to will thus or otherwise. Consequently every physical predetermination, in so far as it is a _determinatio ad unum_, must necessarily be destructive of free-will. Self-determination and physical predetermination by an extraneous will are mutually exclusive. Now the Thomists hold that the _gratia per se efficax_ operates in the manner of a supernatural _praedeterminatio ad unum_. If this were true, the will under the influence of efficacious grace would no longer be free.

To perceive the full force of this argument it is necessary to keep in mind the Thomistic definition of _praemotio physica_ as “_actio Dei, quâ voluntatem humanam, priusquam se determinet, ita ad actum movet insuperabili virtute, ut voluntas nequeat omissionem sui actus cum illa praemotione coniungere_.”(728) That is to say: As the non-performance of an act by the will is owing simply and solely to the absence of the respective _praemotio physica_, so conversely, the performance of an act is conditioned simply and solely by the presence of a divine premotion; the will itself can neither obtain nor prevent such a premotion, because this would require a new premotion, which again depends entirely on the divine pleasure. If the will of man were thus inevitably predetermined by God, it could not in any sense of the term be called truly free.

β) The Thomists meet this argument with mere evasions. They make a distinction between _necessitas consequentis_ (_antecedens_), which really necessitates, and _necessitas consequentiae_ (_subsequens_), which does not. A free act, they say,

necessarily proceeds from a physical premotion, but it is not on that account in itself necessary. But, we answer, a _determinatio ad unum_, which precedes a free act and is independent of the will, is more than a _necessitas consequentiae_—it is a _necessitas consequentis_ destructive of free-will. The Thomists reply: Considered as a created entity, physical premotion may indeed be incompatible with free-will; not so if regarded as an act of God, who, being almighty, is able to predetermine the will without prejudice to its freedom.(729) The obvious rejoinder is that an intrinsic contradiction cannot be solved by an appeal to the divine omnipotence, because even God Himself cannot do what is intrinsically impossible.(730) He can no more change a _determinatio ad unum_ into a _libertas ad utrumque_ than He can create a square circle, because the two notions involve an intrinsic contradiction. Furthermore, if the Almighty wished intrinsically to compel a man to perform some definite act, would He not choose precisely that _praemotio physica_ which, the Thomists claim, also produces free acts? Not so, replies Alvarez; "for the will remains free so long as the intellect represents to it an object as indifferent."(731) That is to say: Liberty remains as long as its root, _i.e._ an indifferent judgment, is present. But this new rejoinder, far from solving the riddle, simply begs the question. Liberty of choice resides _formaliter_ in the will, not in the intellect, and consequently the will, as will, cannot be truly free unless it possesses within itself the unimpeded power to act or not to act. This _indifferentia activa ad utrumlibet_, as it is technically termed, is absolutely incompatible with the Thomistic _praemotio ad unum_. What would it avail the will to enjoy the _indifferentia iudicii_ if it had to submit to compulsion from some other quarter?

γ) To escape from this quandary the Thomists resort to the famous distinction between the _sensus compositus_ and the _sensus divisus_. The Molinists argue: "_Liberum arbitrium efficaciter praemotum a gratia non potest dissentire; ergo non est liberum._" The Thomists reply: "_Distinguo:—non potest dissentire in sensu diviso, nego; non potest dissentire in sensu composito, concedo._" They explain this distinction by certain well-known examples taken from dialectics. Thus Billuart says: "_Ut si dicas, sedens potest stare, significat in sensu composito, quod possit sedere simul et stare; ... in sensu diviso, quod sedens sub sessione retinet potentiam standi, non tamen componendi stationem cum sessione. Uno verbo: sensus compositus importat potentiam simultaneitatis, sensus divisus simultaneitatem __ potentiae._"(732) As one who sits cannot at the same time stand (_sensus compositus_), although he is free to rise (_sensus divisus_), so the consent of the will effected by efficacious grace, cannot become dissent (_sensus compositus_), though the will retains the power to dissent instead of consenting (_sensus divisus_), and this is sufficient to safeguard its freedom.

Is the distinction between _sensus compositus_ and _sensus divisus_ correctly applied here? Can the will, under the predetermining influence of the _gratia efficax_, change its consent into dissent at any time and as easily as a man who is sitting on a chair can rise and thereby demonstrate that his sitting was an absolutely free act? Alvarez(733) describes the Thomistic _potentia dissentiendi_ as a faculty which can never under any circumstances become active. But such a _potentia_ is really no _potentia_ at all. A man tied to a chair is not free to stand; his natural _potentia

standi_ is neutralized by external restraint. Similarly, the will, under the influence of the Thomistic _gratia efficax_, no longer enjoys the power to dissent, and the alleged _potentia resistendi_, by which the Thomists claim to save free-will, is a chimera.

δ) It is at this decisive point in the controversy that the Molinists triumphantly bring in the declaration of the Council of Trent that “man ... while he receives that inspiration [_i.e._ efficacious grace], ... is also able to reject it.” And again: “If any one saith that man’s free-will, moved and excited by God, by assenting to God exciting and calling, does in no wise coöperate towards disposing and preparing itself for obtaining the grace of justification; that it cannot refuse its consent if it would, but that, as something inanimate, it does nothing whatever and is merely passive; let him be anathema.”(734) To adjust their system to this important dogmatic decision, the older Thomists claimed that the Tridentine Council had in mind merely the _gratia sufficiens_, to which the will can refuse its consent. But this interpretation is untenable. The Council plainly refers to that grace with which the will coöperates by giving its consent (_cooperatur assentiendo_) and which it can render inefficacious by withdrawing its consent, in other words, with the grace which disposes and prepares a sinner for justification, and under the influence of which, according to Luther and Calvin, the will remains inanimate and merely passive. This can only be the _gratia efficax_. Other Thomist theologians, not daring to contradict the obvious sense of the Tridentine decree, assert that the Council intentionally chose the term _dissentire_ (_sensus divisus_) rather than _resistere_ (_sensus compositus_), in order to indicate that under the predetermining influence of grace it is possible for the will to refuse its consent (_posse dissentire_) but not to offer resistance (_posse resistere_).(735) This interpretation is no longer tenable since the Vatican Council has defined that “Faith, even when it does not work by charity, is in itself a gift of God, and the act of faith is a work appertaining to salvation, by which man yields voluntary obedience to God Himself, by assenting to and coöperating with His grace, which he is able to resist.”(736) If efficacious grace can be successfully resisted, it can not possess that “irresistible” influence which the Thomists ascribe to it.(737)

B. The Thomistic system is open to two serious objections also from the philosophical point of view. One of these concerns the medium by which God foreknows the future free acts of His rational creatures; the other, His relation to sin.

a) In regard to the first-mentioned point we do not, of course, underestimate the immense difficulties involved in the problem of God’s foreknowledge of the free acts of the future.

The Molinistic theory also has its difficulties, and they are so numerous and weighty that in our treatise on God(738) we made no attempt to demonstrate the _scientia media_ by stringent arguments, but merely accepted it as a working hypothesis which supplies some sort of scientific basis for the dogmas of divine omnipotence and free-will in both the natural and the supernatural order.

b) A more serious objection than the one just adverted to is that the Thomistic hypothesis involves the blasphemous inference that God predetermines men to sin.

α) Under a rigorous application of the Thomistic principles God would have to be acknowledged as the cause of sin. As the predetermination of the will to justification can take no other form than the _gratia per se efficax_, so sin, considered as an act, necessarily postulates the predetermining influence of the _motor primus_.(739) Without this assumption it would be impossible in the Thomistic system to find in the absolute will of God an infallible medium by which He can foreknow future sins. Bañez says on this point: “God knows sin with an intuitive knowledge, because His will is the cause of the sinful act, as act, at the same time permitting free-will to concur in that act by failing to observe the law.”(740) Though the Thomists refuse to admit that God Himself is the immediate author of sin, the conclusion is inevitable from their premises. And this for two reasons. First, because the alleged _praemotio ad malum_ is as irresistible as the _praemotio ad bonum_; and secondly, because the material element of sin must be inseparable from its formal element; otherwise God would foreknow sin merely _materialiter_ as an act but not _formaliter_ as a sin. The teaching of the Church on this point was clearly defined by the Council of Trent: “If any one saith that it is not in man’s power to make his ways evil, but that the works that are evil God worketh as well as those that are good, not permissibly only, but properly and of Himself, in such wise that the treason of Judas is no less His own proper work than the vocation of Paul; let him be anathema.”(741)

If the rational creature were compelled to perform a sinful act, as act, resistance would be impossible. And if it were true that the malice of an act practically cannot be separated from its physical entity, then in the Thomistic hypothesis God would be the author not only of the _entitas_ but likewise of the _malitia peccati_. The devil tempts us only by moral means, _i.e._ by suggestion; are we to assume that God tempts us physically by inducing sin as an act and simultaneously withholding the _praemotio ad bonum_, thus making sin an inevitable fatality? This consideration may be supplemented by another. So-called “sins of malice” are comparatively rare. Most sins are committed for the sake of some pleasure or imaginary advantage. It is for this reason that moral theology in forbidding sin forbids its physical entity. How gladly would not those who are addicted to impurity, for instance, separate the malice from the entity of their sinful acts, in order to be enabled to indulge their passion without offending God!

β) Against the logic of this argument some Thomist theologians defend themselves by a simile. The soul of a lame man, they say, enables him indeed to move his disabled limb; however, the cause of limping is not the soul but a crooked shinbone. Father Pesch wittily disposes of such reasoning as follows: “The will of Adam before the fall was not a crooked shinbone, but it was absolutely straight, and became crooked through physical premotion.”(742)

Another and more plausible contention of the Thomist school is that Molinism, too, is compelled to ascribe sin somehow to God. “It is impossible for a man to sin unless God lends His coöperation. Do not, therefore, the Molinists also make God the author of sin?” Those who argue in this wise overlook the fact that there is a very large

distinction between the _concursus simultaneus_ of the Molinists and the _praemotio physica_ of the Thomists. The _praemotio physica_ predetermines the sinful act without regard to the circumstance whether or not the will is able to offer resistance. The _concursus simultaneus_, on the other hand, begins as a mere _concursus oblatus_, which is in itself indifferent and awaits as it were the free consent of the will before it coöperates with the sinner as _concursus collatus_ in the performance of the sinful act.(743) For this reason the distinction between _actus_ and _malitia_ has a well-defined place in the Molinistic system, whereas it is meaningless in that of the Thomists.(744)

2. AUGUSTINIANISM.—This system, so called because its defenders pretend to base it on the authority of St. Augustine, has some points of similarity with Thomism but differs from the latter in more than one respect, especially in this that the Augustinians,(745) though they speak with great deference of the _gratia per se efficax_, hold that the will is not physically but only morally predetermined in its free acts. Hence Augustinianism may fitly be described as the system of the _praedeterminatio moralis_. Its most eminent defender is Lawrence Berti, O. S. A. (1696-1766), who in a voluminous work _De Theologicis Disciplinis_(746) so vigorously championed the Augustinian theory that Archbishop Jean d'Yse de Saléon, of Vienne,(747) and other contemporary theologians combated his teaching as a revival of Jansenism. Pope Benedict XIV instituted an official investigation, which resulted in a decree permitting Augustinianism to be freely held and taught.

a) Whereas Thomism begins with the concept of _causa prima_ and _motor primus_, Augustinianism is based on the notion of _delectatio coelestis_ or _caritas_. Berti holds three principles in common with Jansenius: (1) Actual grace consists essentially in the infusion of celestial delectation. (2) This heavenly delectation (_i.e._ grace) causally precedes free-will in such wise that its relative intensity in every instance constitutes the law and standard of the will's disposition to do good.

(3) Simultaneously with this celestial delectation, concupiscence (_delectatio carnalis, concupiscentia_) is doing its work in fallen man, and the two powers constantly contend for the mastery. So long as celestial delectation (_i.e._ grace) is weaker than, or equipollent with, concupiscence, the will inevitably fails to perform the salutary act to which it is invited by the former. It is only when the _delectatio coelestis_ overcomes concupiscence (_delectatio coelestis victrix_) that free-will can perform the act inspired by grace. There is a fourth principle, and one, too, of fundamental importance, which brings out the essential difference between Augustinianism and Jansenism, _viz._: the _delectatio coelestis_ never overpowers the will but leaves it free to choose between good and evil.(748)

b) The relation between merely sufficient and efficacious grace in the Augustinian system, therefore, may be described as follows: Merely sufficient grace imparts to the will the _posse_ but not the _velle_, or at best only such a weak _velle_ that it requires the _delectatio victrix_ (_gratia efficax_) to become effective. Efficacious grace (_delectatio coelestis victrix_), on the other hand, impels the will actually to perform the good deed. Hence there is between the two an essential and specific difference, and the efficacy of that grace which leads to the performance of salutary acts does

not lie with free-will but depends on the _delectatio coelestis_, which must consequently be conceived as _gratia efficax ab intrinseco sive per se_.(749)

c) Nevertheless, the necessity of the _gratia efficax ab __ intrinseco_, according to the Augustinian theory, is not due to the subordination of the _causa secunda_ to the _causa prima_, as the Thomists contend, but to a constitutional weakness of human nature, consisting in this that its evil impulses can be overcome solely by the _delectatio coelestis victrix_ (_gratia efficax, adiutorium quo_. The case was different before the Fall, when the _gratia versatilis_ (_gratia sufficiens, adiutorium sine quo non_) sufficed for the performance of salutary acts.(750)

d) However, the Augustinians insist against the Jansenists, that the delectatio _coelestis_ (_i.e._ efficacious grace) does not intrinsically compel the will, but acts merely as a _praemotio moralis_, and that while the will obeys the inspiration of grace infallibly (_infallibiliter_) it does not do so necessarily (_non necessario_). With equal certainty, though not necessarily, the will, when equipped solely with sufficient grace, succumbs to concupiscence. The ultimate reason for the freedom of the will is to be found in the _indifferentia iudicii_.(751) By way of exemplification the Augustinians cite the case of a well-bred man who, though physically free and able to do so, would never turn summersaults on a public thoroughfare or gouge out his own eyes.

CRITICAL ESTIMATE OF AUGUSTINIANISM.—On account of its uncritical methods Augustinianism has found but few defenders and deserves notice only in so far as it claims to base its teaching on St. Augustine.

Like the Bible, the writings of that holy Doctor have been quoted in support of many contradictory systems.(752) If the use of Augustinian terms guaranteed the possession of Augustinian ideas, Jansenius would have a strong claim to be considered a faithful disciple of St. Augustine. Yet how widely does not the “Augustinus Iprensis,” as he has been called, differ from the “Augustinus Hipponensis”! Augustinianism, too, utterly misconceives the terms which it employs. Space permits us to call attention to one or two points only.

a) In the first place Augustinianism labors under an absolutely false conception of sufficient grace.

How can that grace be sufficient for justification which is first described in glowing colors as _parva et invalida_ and then in the same breath is declared to be insufficient except when reinforced by a _gratia magna_ in the shape of _delectatio victrix_? What kind of “grace” can that be which in its very nature is so constituted that the will, under the prevailing influence of concupiscence, infallibly does the opposite of that to which it is supernaturally impelled? It is quite true that the distinction between _gratia parva_ and _gratia magna_(753) is found in St. Augustine. However, he understands by _gratia parva_ not sufficient grace, but the grace of prayer (_gratia remote sufficiens_), and by _gratia magna_, not efficacious grace as such, but grace sufficient to perform a good act (_gratia proxime sufficiens_).(754)

b) Augustinianism is unable to reconcile its theory of a _praemotio moralis_ with the dogma of free-will.

Under the Augustinian system the influence of efficacious grace can be conceived in but two ways. Either it is so strong that the will is physically unable to withhold its consent; or it is only strong enough that the consent of the will can be inferred with purely moral certainty. In the former alternative we have a prevenient necessity which determines the will _ad unum_ and consequently destroys its freedom. In the latter, there can be no infallible foreknowledge of the future free acts of rational creatures on the part of God, because the Augustinians reject the _scientia media_ of the Molinists and expressly admit that the same grace which proves effective in one man remains ineffective in another because of the condition of his heart.(755)

c) Finally, the three fundamental principles of the Augustinian system are false and have no warrant in the writings of St. Augustine.

It is not true that pleasure (_delectatio_) is the font and well-spring of all supernaturally good deeds. Such deeds may also be inspired by hatred, fear, sorrow, etc.(756) With many men the fear of God or a sense of duty is as strong an incentive to do good as the sweet consciousness of treading the right path. St. Augustine did not regard “celestial delectation” as the essential mark of efficacious grace, nor concupiscence as the characteristic note of sin.(757)

The second and third principles of the Augustinian system are likewise false. If delectation is only one motive among many, its varying intensity cannot be the standard of our conduct; and still less can it be said that the will is morally compelled in each instance to obey the relatively stronger as against the weaker delectation; for any necessitation that does not depend on the free will excludes the _libertas a coactione_, but not that _libertas a necessitate_ which constitutes the notion of liberty. There can be no freedom of the will unless the will is able to resist delectation at all times. Consequently, the fourth principle of the Augustinians, by which they pretend to uphold free-will, is also false.(758)

READINGS:—The literature on the different systems of grace is enormous. We can mention only a few of the leading works.

On the Thomist side: *Bañez, O. P., _Comment. in S. Theol. S. Thom._, Salamanca 1584 sqq.—*Alvarez, O. P., _De Auxiliis Gratiae et Humani Arbitrii Viribus_, Rome 1610.—IDEM, _Responsionum Libri Quatuor_, Louvain 1622.—Ledesma, O. P., _De Divinae Gratiae Auxiliis_, Salamanca 1611.—*Gonet, O. P., _Clypeus Theologiae Thomisticae_, 16 vols., Bordeaux 1659-69.—Contenson, O. P., _Theologia Mentis et Cordis_, Lyons 1673.—De Lemos, O. P., _Panoplia Divinae Gratiae_, 4 vols., Liège 1676.—Goudin, O. P., _De Scientia et Voluntate Dei_, new ed., Louvain 1874.—*Gotti, O. P., _Theologia Scholastico-Dogmatica iuxta Mentem __ Divi Thomae_, Venice 1750.—Gazzaniga, O. P., _Theologia Dogmatica in Systema Redacta_, 2 vols., Vienne 1776.—*Billuart, _De Gratia_, diss. 5 (ed. Lequette, t. III, pp. 123 sqq.).—IDEM, _Le Thomisme Triomphant_, Paris 1725.—*Fr. G. Feldner, O. P., _Die Lehre des hl. Thomas über die Willensfreiheit_, Prague 1890.—IDEM, in Commer’s _Jahrbuch für Philosophie und spekulative Theologie_, 1894 sqq.—*Dummermuth, O. P., _S. Thomas et Doctrina Praemotionis Physicae_, Paris 1886.—I. A. Manser, _Possibilitas Praemotionis Physicae Thomisticae_, Fribourg (Switzerland) 1895.—Joh. Ude,

Doctrina Capreoli de Influxu Dei in Actus Voluntatis Humanae, Graz 1905.—Del Prado, _De Gratia et Libero Arbitrio_, 3 vols., Fribourg (Switzerland) 1907.—P. Garrigou-Lagrange, _S. Thomas et le Néomolinisme_, Paris 1917.

On the Augustinian side: Card. Norisius, _Vindiciae Augustinianae,_ Padua 1677.—*Berti, _De Theologicis Disciplinis_, 8 vols., Rome 1739 sqq.—Bellelli, _Mens Augustini de Modo Reparationis Humanae Naturae_, 2 vols., Rome 1773.—L. de Thomassin, _Mémoires sur la Grâce, etc._, Louvain 1668.

For a list of Molinistic and Congruistic authors see pp. 269 sq.

Article 2. Molinism And Congruism

The point in which these two systems meet, and in regard to which they differ from Thomism and Augustinianism, is the definition of efficacious grace as _efficax ab extrinseco sive per accidens_.

This conception was violently attacked by the Spanish Dominican Bañez and other divines. About 1594, the controversy between the followers of Bañez and the Molinists waxed so hot that Pope Clement VIII appointed a special commission to settle it. This was the famous _Congregatio de Auxiliis_, consisting of picked theologians from both the Dominican and the Jesuit orders. It debated the matter for nine full years without arriving at a decision. Finally Pope Paul V, at the suggestion of St. Francis de Sales, declared both systems to be orthodox and defensible, and strictly forbade the contending parties to denounce each other as heretical.(759)

While Thomism devoted its efforts mainly to the defense of grace, Molinism made it its chief business to champion the dogma of free-will.

1. MOLINISM.—Molinism takes its name from the Jesuit Luis de Molina, who published a famous treatise under the title _Concordia Liberi Arbitrii cum Gratiae Donis_ at Lisbon, in 1588. His teaching may be outlined as follows:

a) In _actu primo_ there is no intrinsic and ontological but merely an extrinsic and accidental distinction between efficacious and sufficient grace, based upon their respective effects. Sufficient grace becomes efficacious by the consent of the will; if the will resists, grace remains inefficacious (_inefficax_) and _merely_ sufficient (_gratia mere sufficiens_). Consequently, one and the same grace may be efficacious in one case and inefficacious in another. It all depends on the will.(760)

b) This theory involves no denial of the priority and superior dignity of grace in the work of salvation. The will, considered as a mere faculty, and _in actu primo_, is raised to the supernatural order by prevenient grace (_gratia praeveniens_), which imparts to it all the moral and physical power necessary to perform free salutary acts. Neither can the _actus secundus_ be regarded as a product of the unaided will; it is the result of grace coöperating with free-will.(761) Consequently, the will by giving its consent does not increase the power of grace, but it is grace which makes possible, prepares, and aids the will in performing free acts. To say that the influence of grace goes farther than this would be to assert that it acts independently of the will, and would thereby deny the freedom of the latter.(762)

c) The infallibility with which efficacious grace works its effects is to be explained not by God’s absolute will, but by His infallible foreknowledge through the _scientia media_,—a Molinistic postulate which was first defined and scientifically demonstrated by Father Fonseca, S. J., the teacher of Suarez.(763) God foreknows not only the absolutely free acts (_futura_) of His rational creatures by the _scientia visionis_, but likewise their hypothetically free acts (_futuribilia_) by means of the _scientia media_, and hence He infallibly knows from all eternity what attitude the free-will of man would assume in each case if grace were given him. Consequently, when God, in the light of this eternal foreknowledge, actually bestows a grace, this grace will prove efficacious or inefficacious according as He has foreknown whether the will will give or withhold its consent. Thus can the infallibility of efficacious grace be reconciled with the dogma of free-will without prejudice to such other dogmas as final perseverance and the predestination of the elect, because God by virtue of the _scientia media_ has it absolutely in His power to give or withhold His graces in each individual case.(764)

CRITICAL ESTIMATE OF MOLINISM.—Even the most determined opponents of Molinism admit that this system possesses three important advantages.

a) First, it gives a satisfactory account of the sufficiency of “merely sufficient grace,” which in its physical nature does not differ essentially from efficacious grace.

Second, Molinism safeguards free-will by denying that efficacious grace either physically or morally predetermines the will to one course of action.

Third, Molinism explains in a fairly satisfactory manner why efficacious grace is infallibly efficacious. God in virtue of the _scientia media_ knows with metaphysical certainty from all eternity which graces in each individual case will prove efficacious through the free consent of the will and which will remain inefficacious, and is thereby enabled to bestow or withhold grace according to His absolute decrees.

b) The question may justly be raised, however, whether, in endeavoring to safeguard freewill, the Molinists do not undervalue grace, which is after all the primary and decisive factor in the work of salvation.

There is something incongruous in the notion that the efficacy or inefficacy of divine grace should depend on the arbitrary pleasure of a created will. If sufficient grace does not become efficacious except by the consent of the will, how can the resultant salutary act be said to be an effect of grace? St. Paul, St. Augustine, and the councils of the Church do not say: “_Deus facit, si volumus_,” but they declare: “_Deus facit, ut faciamus_,” “_Deus ipse dat ipsum velle et facere et perficere_,” and so forth. What can this mean if not: Divine grace need not concern itself with external circumstances, occasions, humors, etc., but it takes hold of the sinner and actually converts him, without regard to anything except the decree of the Divine Will. On account of this and similar difficulties Cardinal Bellarmine, who was a champion and protector of P. Molina, seems to have rejected Molinism(765) in favor of Congruism.(766)

c) The same reasons that induced Bellarmine to embrace Congruism probably led the Jesuit General Claudius Aquaviva, in 1613, to order all teachers of theology in the

Society to lay greater emphasis on the Congruistic element in the notion of efficacious grace. This measure was quite in harmony with the principles defended by the Jesuit members of the _Congregatio de Auxiliis_ before Clement VIII and Paul V. Aquaviva's order is of sufficient importance to deserve a place in the text of this volume: "_Nostri in posterum omnino doceant, inter eam gratiam quae effectum re ipsâ habet atque efficax dicitur, et eam quam sufficientem nominant, non tantum discrimen esse in actu secundo, quia ex usu liberi arbitrii etiam cooperantem gratiam habentis effectum sortiatur, altera non item; sed in ipso actu primo, quod positâ scientiâ conditionalium [scientiâ mediâ] ex efficaci Dei proposito atque intentione efficiendi certissime in nobis boni, de industria ipse ea media seligit atque eo modo et tempore confert, quo videt effectum, infallibiliter habitura, aliis usurus, si haec inefficacia praevidisset. Quare semper moraliter et in ratione beneficii plus aliquid in efficaci, quam in sufficienti gratia est, in actu primo contineri: atque hac ratione efficere Deum, ut re ipsâ faciamus, non tantum quia dat gratiam quâ facere possimus. Quod idem dicendum est de perseverantia, quae procul dubio donum est._" This modified, or perhaps we had better say, more sharply determined form of Molinism is called Congruism.(767)

2. CONGRUISM.—The system thus recommended by Aquaviva in its fundamental principles really originated with Molina himself. It was developed by the great Jesuit theologians Suarez, Vasquez, and Lessius, and became the official system of the Society of Jesus under Muzio Vitelleschi (d. 1645) and Piccolomini (d. 1651).

a) The distinction between _gratia congrua_ and _gratia incongrua_ is founded on the writings of St. Augustine, who speaks of the elect as "_congruenter vocati_."(768) The Congruists maintain against the extreme Molinists that the efficacy of grace is not attributable solely to a free determination of the will, but, at least in part, to the fact that grace is bestowed under circumstances favorable to its operation, _i.e._ "congruous" in that sense. When the circumstances are comparatively adverse (_incongrua_), grace remains merely sufficient. A prudent father who knows how to govern his children without physical force will speak the right word to each at the proper time. Similarly God adapts His grace, if it is to prove efficacious, to the circumstances of each individual case, thereby attaining His purpose without fail. Thus the reckless youth on the city streets needs more powerful graces than the pious nun in her secluded convent cell, because he is exposed to stronger temptations and his environment is unfavorable to religious influences. Since grace is conferred with a wise regard to temperament, character, inclinations, prejudices, time and place, there exists between it and free-will a sort of intrinsic affinity, which in the hands of God becomes an infallible means of executing His decrees.(769)

b) The actual bestowal of congruous grace, considered _in actu primo_, is undoubtedly a special gift of God, and hence the _gratia congrua_ possesses a higher value than the _gratia incongrua sive inefficax_. An entitatively weaker impulse of grace, if conferred under comparatively favorable conditions, is more precious than a stronger impulse which fails in its purpose by reason of unfavorable circumstances created by inclination, training, or environment. Little David accomplished more with a handful of pebbles in his scrip than had he been heavily armed.(770)

c) Congruism assigns a far more important rôle to grace than extreme Molinism. It makes the will depend on efficacious grace, not the efficacy of grace upon the will. Bellarmine illustrates this difference by the example of a sermon which, under an entirely equal distribution of internal grace, converts one sinner while it leaves another untouched.(771)

CRITICAL ESTIMATE OF CONGRUISM.—Among the different systems devised for the purpose of harmonizing the dogmas of grace and free-will, Congruism probably comes nearest the truth. It strikes a golden mean between the two extremes of Pelagianism and Semipelagianism on the one hand, and Calvinism and Jansenism on the other, and its principal theses can be supported by clear and unmistakable passages from the writings of St. Augustine.

a) Other points in its favor are the following: “Sufficient grace,” in the Congruist hypothesis, is truly sufficient so far as God is concerned, because its inefficaciousness is attributable solely to the human will. That free-will is properly safeguarded under the influence of efficacious grace (_gratia congrua_) is admitted even by theologians of the opposing schools. True, Congruism does not regard the will as an abstract notion, but as a factor closely interwoven with the concrete circumstances of daily life. As favorable circumstances (education, association, temperament) merely influence the will but do not compel it, so supernatural grace (_gratia congrua s. efficax_) may soften the will and occasionally even break down its resistance, but (rare cases excepted)(772) will never compel it to do good. Congruism marks a distinct advance over extreme Molinism also in this, that it bases the difference between _gratia efficax_ (_congrua_) and _gratia inefficax_ not entirely on the will of man, but likewise on the will of God, whereby it is able to explain such formulas as “_Deus facit, ut faciamus_,” “_Deus est, qui discernit_,” _etc._, in a manner entirely compatible with the dogmatic teaching of the Church.(773)

The _modus operandi_ of the _gratia congrua_ (efficacious grace) is explained by Congruism, in common with Molinism, as follows: There is a threefold efficacy: the efficacy of power (_efficacia virtutis_), the efficacy of union (_efficacia connexionis_), and the efficacy of infallible success (_efficacia infallibilitatis_). Grace (both efficacious and sufficient) does not derive its _efficacia virtutis_ from the free-will of man, nor from the knowledge of God (_scientia media_), but from itself. The _efficacia connexionis_ (of union between act and grace) on the other hand, depends entirely on the free-will, since, according to the Council of Trent as well as that of the Vatican, efficacious grace does not operate irresistibly but can be “cast off.” The _efficacia infallibilitatis_ springs from God’s certain foreknowledge (_scientia media_), which cannot be deceived.(774)

b) Nevertheless, it would be unreasonable to contend that Congruism solves all difficulties. The mystery surrounding both the unequal distribution of efficacious grace and the _scientia media_ still remains. Moreover, the theory that God adjusts himself slavishly to all the circumstances of His creatures, can hardly be reconciled with His dignity and omnipotence. It would no doubt be far worthier of His majesty to seize upon the free will of man and compel it to perform the salutary act which He wishes it to perform. Whoever has studied the lives of saints and eminent converts

knows that the sudden and seemingly unaccountable changes of heart which many of them have experienced can hardly be regarded as miracles in the strict sense, though on the other hand it seems certain that grace worked in them with little or no regard to the “congruity” of circumstances. Again, it is one of the highest and most sublime missions of grace not to be balked by unfavorable circumstances but to re-shape them by changing a man’s temperament, dulling concupiscence, weakening the power of temptation, and so forth. In other words, grace does not depend on but controls and fashions the circumstances of the recipient.

After all is said, therefore, the relation of grace and free-will still remains an unsolved mystery.(775)

3. SYNCRETISM.—Seeing that each of the different systems which we so far reviewed contains grains of truth, some theologians(776) have adopted the good points of all four and combined them into a fifth, called Syncretism.

These authors begin by assuming the existence of two quite distinct sorts of efficacious grace, the (Thomistic-Augustinian) _gratia efficax ab intrinseco_, and the (Molinistic-Congruistic) _gratia efficax ab extrinseco_. The former, they contend, is bestowed for the performance of more difficult good works, such as resisting grievous temptations, observing onerous precepts, exercising patience in severe tribulation, etc.; while the latter enables man to accomplish less difficult acts, such as short prayers, slight mortifications, etc. The connecting link between the two is prayer, which has been instituted for the purpose of enabling man to obtain that _gratia efficax ab intrinseco_ which is necessary for the performance of the more difficult works of salvation. Sacred Scripture teaches that prayer originates in grace, that it is binding upon all men, and that it accomplishes its purpose infallibly.(777)

CRITICAL ESTIMATE OF SYNCRETISM.—The outstanding characteristic of Syncretism is its insistence on prayer as a highly important, not to say the most important, factor in the work of salvation.

a) In this the Syncretistic school is undoubtedly right. Sacred Scripture and Tradition both strongly emphasize the importance and necessity of prayer, so much so that one naturally expects to find prayer playing an essential and indispensable rôle in every complete and orthodox system of grace. “The present economy of grace is essentially and intrinsically an economy of prayer,” is a theological axiom which cannot be too strongly insisted upon. To have brought out this great truth forcibly and luminously is the merit of Syncretism.

b) We do not mean to intimate, however, that the Syncretistic theory has solved the problem of the relation between free-will and grace. On the contrary, by adopting two such heterogeneous concepts as _gratia efficax ab intrinseco_ and _gratia efficax ab extrinseco_ it has actually increased the difficulties found in the other systems. For now we are put before the dilemma:—the Thomistic _gratia efficax_ either supposes free-will or it does not: if it does, there is no reason to limit this grace to the more difficult works of salvation; if it does not, then the _gratia efficax_ can be of no assistance in the performance of more difficult works, because these too, to be meritorious, require the coöperation of free-will.

The Syncretists try to evade this dilemma by contending that prayer, as the connecting link, communicates its own liberty and meritoriousness to the salutary acts performed through its agency, in other words, that these acts are the effect of prayer (_effectus orationis_). But aside from the fact that prayer itself is quite often a difficult act, the more arduous works of salvation would in the Syncretist hypothesis be stripped of their meritoriousness and degraded to the level of a _voluntarium in causa_, which is an untenable assumption.(778) Finally, there is something illogical and unsatisfactory in admitting on equal terms, as it were, two such incompatible notions as the Thomistic _cognitio Dei in decretis praedeterminantibus_ and the Molinistic _scientia media_.

Thus in the end all attempts to harmonize the dogmas of grace and free-will fail to solve the mystery, and we are compelled to exclaim with St. Paul: “O the depth of the riches of the wisdom and of the knowledge of God! How incomprehensible are His judgments, and how unsearchable His ways!”(779)

READINGS:—Molinistic and Congruistic works of importance are: *Molina, S. J., _Concordia Liberi Arbitrii cum Gratiae Donis_, Lisbon 1588 (repr. Paris 1876).—Platel, S. J., _Auctoritas contra Praedeterminationem Physicam pro Scientia Media_, Douai 1669.—Henao, S. J., _Scientia Media Historice Propugnata_, Lyons 1655.—IDEM, _Scientia Media Theologice Defensa_, Lyons 1674-6.—De Aranda, S. J., _De Deo Sciente, Praedestinante et Auxiliante seu Schola Scientiae Mediae_, Saragossa 1693.—*Suarez, S. J., _De Concursu, Motione et Auxilio Dei_, new ed., Paris 1856.—IDEM, _De Auxilio Efficaci_, Paris ed., 1856, t. XI.—IDEM, _De Vera Intelligentia Auxilii Efficacis_ (_Op. Posthum._, t. X, Appendix).—*Lessius, S. J., _De Gratia Efficaci_ (_Opusc._, t. II, Paris 1878).—Sardagna, S. J., _Theologia Dogmatico-Polemica_, Ratisbon 1771.—Wirceburgenses (Kilber, S. J.), _De Gratia_, new ed., Paris 1853.—Murray, _De Gratia_, Dublin 1877.—B. Jungmann, S. J., _De Gratia_, 6th ed., Ratisbon 1896.—Th. de Régnon, S. J., _Bañez et Molina, Histoire, Doctrines, Critique, Métaphysique_, Paris 1883.—Card. Mazzella, S. J., _De Gratia Christi_, 3rd ed., Rome 1882.—Palmieri, S. J., _De Gratia Divina Actuali_, thes. 49-58, Gulpen 1885.—*V. Frins, S. J., _S. Thomae Doctrina de Cooperatione Dei cum Omni __ Natura Creata, Praesertim Libera, seu S. Thomas Praedeterminationis Physicae Adversarius_, Paris 1890.—*Schiffini, S. J., _De Gratia Divina_, disp. 5, Freiburg 1901.—Card. Billot, S. J., _De Gratia Christi et Libero Hominis Arbitrio_, I, Rome 1908.—Limbourg, S. J. “_Selbstzeichnung der thomistischen Gnadenlehre_,” in the Innsbruck _Zeitschrift für kath. Theologie_, 1877.—B. J. Otten, S. J., _A Manual of the History of Dogmas_, Vol. II, St. Louis 1918, pp. 493 sqq.

Among the theologians who have tried to harmonize Thomism and Molinism we may mention, besides Ysambert and St. Alphonsus de’ Liguori, *Tournely, _De Gratia_, Venice 1755.—Card. Jos. Pecci, _Sentenza di S. Tommaso circa l’Influsso di Dio sulle Azioni delle Creature Ragionevoli e sulla Scienza Media_, Rome 1885.—A. Adeodatus, J. _Pecci’s Schrift: Lehre des hl. Thomas über den Einfluss Gottes, etc., analysiert_, Mainz 1888.—C. Krogh-Tonning, _De Gratia Christi et de Libero Arbitrio S. Thomae Doctrina_, Christiania 1898.—J. Herrmann, C. SS. R., _De Divina Gratia_, Rome 1904.

The history of the great controversy between Thomism and Molinism can be studied in H. Serry, O. P., _Historia Congregationum de Auxiliis Divinae Gratiae_, Louvain 1700 and Antwerp 1709.—Livinus de Meyer, S. J., _Historia Controversiarum de Divinae Gratiae Auxiliis_, Antwerp 1705.—*Schneemann, S. J., _Entstehung der thomistisch-molinistischen Controverse_, Freiburg 1879.—*IDEM, _Weitere Entwicklung der thomistisch-molinistischen Controverse_, Freiburg 1880.—*IDEM, _Controversiarum de Divinae Gratiae Liberique Arbitrii Concordia Initia et Progressus_, Freiburg 1881.

PART II. SANCTIFYING GRACE

The grace of justification, commonly called sanctifying grace, is related to actual grace as an end to its means. Actual grace introduces the state of sanctifying grace or preserves and augments it where it already exists.

This fact makes it advisable to consider the genesis of sanctifying grace before studying its nature and effects.

We shall therefore treat in three chapters: (1) of the Process of Justification (_iustificatio in fieri_); (2) of the State of Justification (_iustificatio in esse_), and (3) of the Fruits of Justification (_iustificatio in facto esse_), or the Merit of Good Works.

Chapter I. The Genesis Of Sanctifying Grace, Or The Process Of Justification

The justification of an adult human being does not take place suddenly, but runs through certain well-defined stages, which in their totality are called the process of justification.

Being a “regeneration in God,” justification bears a striking resemblance to the development of the fœtus in the maternal womb. Like physical birth, spiritual regeneration is preceded by travailing, _i.e._ fear and painful contrition.

The dogmatic teaching of the Catholic Church on justification is formally defined by the Tridentine Council, whose decrees(780) contain a masterly analysis of this most interesting of psychological processes. The holy Synod puts faith at the beginning. “Faith,” it says, “is the beginning of human salvation, the foundation and the root of all justification.”(781) The nature of faith and the part it plays in justification were the chief points in dispute between the Church and the so-called Reformers. Luther and his followers denatured the traditional Catholic teaching by basing justification solely on faith, which they falsely defined as mere confidence or trust in the mercy of God.

Section 1. The Necessity Of Faith For Justification

1. THE LUTHERAN HERESY VS. THE TEACHING OF THE CHURCH.—The Protestant Reformers, notably Luther and Calvin, did not deny that justification is wrought by faith, but they defined justifying faith in a manner altogether foreign to the mind of the Church.

a) They distinguished three kinds of faith: (1) belief in the existence of God and the historical fact that Christ has come on earth, suffered, and ascended (_fides historica_); (2) the sort of trust which is required for exercising the gift of miracles (_fides miraculorum_); and (3) faith in the divine promises with regard to the remission of sin (_fides promissionum_). The last-mentioned species of faith they subdivided into general and particular. _Fides generalis_ is that by which we believe that the righteousness of Christ "covers" (but does not wipe out) our sins. _Fides specialis_ or fiduciary faith (_fiducia_) is that by which a man applies to himself the righteousness of the Redeemer, firmly trusting that his sins are for Christ's sake not imputed to him. Thus the Reformers erroneously transferred the seat of justifying faith from the intellect to the will and completely subverted the Catholic notion of faith as an intellectual assent to revealed truth.

b) To this fundamental error the Fathers of Trent opposed the orthodox doctrine that (adults) "are disposed unto justice when, excited and assisted by divine grace, receiving faith by hearing, they are freely moved towards God, believing those things to be true which God has revealed and promised, ..."(782) and they solemnly anathematized those who assert "that justifying faith is nothing else but confidence in the divine mercy which remits sin for Christ's sake, or that this confidence alone is that whereby we are justified."(783)

Hence it is _de fide_ that the faith whereby man is justified, is not a confident persuasion of being esteemed righteous in the sight of God, but a dogmatic or theoretical belief in the truths of Divine Revelation.

2. REFUTATION OF THE LUTHERAN DOCTRINE OF FIDUCIARY FAITH.—Whenever Sacred Scripture and Tradition speak of justifying faith, they mean a dogmatic belief in the truths of Revelation,—that faith which the Protestants call _fides historica_.

a) Christ Himself solemnly commanded His Apostles and their successors to preach the Gospel to all nations, and before baptizing them to convert them to a firm belief in certain specified truths which no man may reject except at the peril of his eternal salvation.

α) Mark XVI, 15 sq.: "Go ye into the whole world, and preach the gospel(784) to every creature: He that believeth [_i.e._ in the Gospel] and is baptized, shall be saved; but he that believeth not shall be condemned." Agreeable to this injunction St. John declares it to be the object of his Gospel "that you may believe that(785) Jesus is the Christ, the Son of God, and that believing, you may have life in his name."(786) The Gospel is written "that we may believe." What must we believe? That "Jesus is the Christ, the Son of God." This is a revealed truth by firmly believing which we shall be saved. When the treasurer of Queen Candace begged to be baptized, Philip the deacon said to him: "If thou believest with all thy heart, thou mayest." The eunuch replied: "I believe that Jesus Christ is the Son of God," whereupon Philip baptized him.(787)

β) St. Paul in his Epistles to the Romans and the Galatians eloquently insists on the necessity of faith, not a mere _fides fiducialis_, but a believing acceptance of Divine

Revelation. Cfr. Rom. X, 9 sq.: “For if thou confess with thy mouth the Lord Jesus, and believe in thy heart that God hath raised him up from the dead, thou shalt be saved. For with the heart we believe unto justice, but with the mouth confession is made unto salvation.”(788) We must confess with the mouth and believe with the heart. External profession and internal faith go together and have for their common object a certain truth open to our knowledge, _viz._: the resurrection of Christ,—a dogma in which the whole teaching of the atonement lies imbedded.

The character of justifying faith is still more plainly evident from Heb. XI, 6: “Without faith it is impossible to please God. For he that cometh to God [he that is to be justified], must believe that He is [the existence of God], and is a rewarder to them that seek Him.”(789) The Apostle here clearly asserts both the necessity of justifying faith and the minimum of doctrine to be explicitly “believed,” _viz._: the existence of God and eternal retribution.(790)

γ) The Lutherans appeal chiefly to Matth. IX, 2, Luke XVII, 19, Rom. IV, 5, and Heb. XI, 1. But not a single one of these texts represents fiduciary faith as the instrumental cause of justification. The word πίστις occurs no less than eighty times in the Synoptic Gospels and in St. Paul’s Epistle to the Romans, but there are only six passages in which it could possibly be construed as synonymous with _fiducia_, and in none of these is the interpretation entirely certain. Not once does the New Testament employ πίστις in the sense of “fiduciary faith,” _i.e._ a confident persuasion of one’s own righteousness.(791)

b) Tradition is in such perfect agreement with Scripture on this point that the Reformers did not venture to deny that their doctrine ran counter to the time-honored teaching of the Church. The Fathers unanimously insist on the necessity of dogmatic faith as a requisite of justification.

α) St. Fulgentius of Ruspe, who is regarded as “the best theologian of his time” (468-533),(792) in his golden booklet _De Fide seu de Regula Verae Fidei ad Petrum_, says: “I rejoice that you take care to preserve the true faith without which conversion is useless, nay, impossible. Apostolic authority tells us that we cannot please God without faith. For faith is the foundation of all good [works]; it is the beginning of human salvation, and without it no one can obtain a place among the children of God, because without it no one can obtain the grace of justification in this world or possess eternal life in the next.”(793) St. Fulgentius was a faithful disciple of St. Augustine, and the whole trend of his treatise shows that by _vera fides_ he understands not the Lutheran _fiducia propriae iustificationis_, but Catholic belief in revealed truth.(794)

β) This teaching is corroborated by the ancient practice of instructing the catechumens in the truths of revelation and requiring them to make a public profession of faith before Baptism. It was because they believed and professed the true faith that the early Christians, who knew nothing of the Lutheran _fides fiducialis_, were called “faithful” (_fideles_, πιστοί), to distinguish them from false believers or heretics (_haeretici_, αἱρητικοὶ, from αἱρεῖσθαι to choose), who denied some portion or other of the orthodox creed.

c) In analyzing the notions of _fides_ and _necessitas_ theologians distinguish between _fides explicita_ and _fides implicita_, and between _necessitas medii_ and _necessitas praecepti_.

Fides explicita is an express and fully developed belief in the truths of revelation; _fides implicita_, a virtual belief in whatever may be contained in a dogma explicitly professed. I make an act of implicit faith when I say, for instance: “I believe whatever the Church teaches,” or: “I heartily accept whatever God has revealed.”

The _necessitas medii_ is based on the objective relation of means to an end, and consequently binds all men, even the ignorant and those who are in error without their own fault. Such, for example, is the necessity of the eye for seeing, of wings for flying, of grace for performing salutary acts, of the _lumen gloriae_ for the beatific vision. The _necessitas praecepti_, on the other hand, is founded entirely on the will of God, who positively commands or forbids under pain of grievous sin, but is willing to condone non-compliance with his precepts when it is owing to guiltless ignorance. This applies to all positive divine precepts, _e.g._ the law of fasting and abstinence. It is to be noted that the _necessitas medii_ always involves the _necessitas praecepti_, because God must needs will and impose upon us by positive precept whatever is objectively necessary as a means of salvation.

α) The first question that arises with regard to this twofold faith and necessity is: Are sinners preparing for justification, and the faithful in general, obliged by necessity of precept to believe explicitly all revealed truths? The answer is, No; because this is practically impossible, and God does not demand the impossible.

Generally speaking, it is sufficient to have an explicit knowledge of, and give one’s firm assent to, the more important dogmas and moral precepts—the twelve articles of the Apostles’ Creed, the Commandments of God and the Church, the Sacraments (as needed), and the Our Father. All other revealed truths need be held only _fide implicitâ_.(795) More is of course demanded of educated persons and those who are in duty bound to instruct others, such as priests and teachers.(796)

β) A more important and more difficult question is this: Are there any dogmas, and if so how many, which must be believed by all men _fide explicitâ_ and _necessitate medii_? St. Paul says: “Without faith it is impossible to please God, for he that cometh to God, must believe that He is, and is a rewarder to them that seek Him.”(797)

With but few exceptions,(798) Catholic theologians maintain that the Apostle in this passage means theological faith, based upon supernatural motives. This interpretation is borne out by the context, by such parallel texts as John III, 11 sqq., 32 sqq., 2 Tim. I, 12, 1 John V, 9 sq., and by the decisions of several councils.(799) There can be no reasonable doubt that all men, to be justified and saved, must have an explicit belief in at least two dogmas, _viz._: the existence of God and eternal retribution. Pope Innocent XI condemned the Jansenist proposition that explicit belief in divine retribution is not necessary for salvation.(800)

Are there any other dogmas which must be explicitly believed _necessitate medii_? The only dogmas which might come in question are: the Trinity, the Incarnation, the immortality of the soul, and the necessity of grace. The last-mentioned two may be

omitted from the list, because St. Paul does not mention them,(801) and for the additional reason that belief in immortality is included in the dogma of eternal retribution, while the necessity of grace is inseparably bound up with the dogma of Divine Providence, which in its turn is but a particular aspect of eternal retribution.(802) Hence the only two dogmas in regard to which the question at the beginning of this paragraph can reasonably be asked, are the Blessed Trinity and the Incarnation.

Theologians are divided in the matter. Some maintain that no human being can or could ever be saved without explicit belief in both the Trinity and the Incarnation. Others(803) hold that this _necessitas medii_ did not exist under the Old Covenant. A third school(804) avers that no such necessity can be proved either for the Old or the New Dispensation.

The first of these three opinions is excessively rigorous and intrinsically improbable. The Jews had no clearly revealed knowledge of the Trinity and the Incarnation, and consequently were under no obligation to believe them. As the divinely constituted guardians of the Messianic prophecies, they were bound to believe in the Redeemer, though only _necessitate praecepti_. The gentiles were dispensed even from this.

The second opinion, which limits the _necessitas medii_ to the New Testament, lacks solid proof. The Scripture texts cited in its support merely prove the efficaciousness of belief in Christ,(805) or the duty of embracing that belief on the strength of the Apostolic preaching,(806) or, finally, the impossibility of redemption except through the mediation of Jesus;(807)—all truths which in themselves have nothing to do with the question under discussion.

The third and most probable opinion is that even under the New Covenant, explicit faith in Christ, and _a fortiori_ in the Divine Trinity, cannot be regarded as an indispensable medium of justification and salvation, (1) because St. Paul does not mention these two dogmas in the decisive passage, Heb. XI, 6; and (2) because a supernatural act of justifying love and contrition may be inspired by belief in the existence of God and divine retribution; and (3) because this latter belief implicitly, by way of desire (_fides in voto_), includes belief in Christ and the Trinity.(808) Nevertheless it must be held that an adult who desires to be received into the Church and is baptized in the name of the Most Holy Trinity, is bound to believe in the Trinity and the Incarnation by more than a mere _necessitas praecepti_, namely, by what is technically called _necessitas medii per accidens_, a necessity from which God dispenses only in exceptional cases, when it is either physically or morally impossible to elicit an act of explicit faith.(809) It is for this reason that the Sacred Congregation of the Holy Office decided, February 28, 1703, that missionaries are bound to explain to all adult converts who have the use of reason, even though they be near death, those mysteries of the faith which are necessary for salvation _necessitate medii_, especially the Trinity and the Incarnation.(810)

Section 2. The Necessity Of Other Preparatory Acts Besides Faith

1. HERETICAL ERRORS AND THE TEACHING OF THE CHURCH.—Martin Luther, to quiet his conscience, evolved the notion that faith alone justifies and that the Catholic doctrine of the necessity of good works is pharisaical and derogatory to the merits of Jesus Christ. This teaching was incorporated into the symbolic books of the Lutherans(811) and adopted by Calvin.(812) It has been called one of the two basic errors of Protestantism. The Tridentine Council solemnly condemns it as follows: “If anyone saith that by faith alone the impious is justified, in such wise as to mean that nothing else is required to coöperate in order to obtain the grace of justification, and that it is not in any way necessary that he be prepared and disposed by the movement of his own will; let him be anathema.”(813) Other acts that dispose or prepare the soul for justification, according to the same Council, are: the fear of divine justice; hope in God’s mercy; charity, which is the font of all righteousness; detestation of sin, and penitence.(814)

2. REFUTATION OF THE SOLA FIDES THEORY.—The Lutheran theory involves an open rupture with the traditional teaching of the Church and is positively unscriptural. Luther himself felt this, as appears from his interpolation of the word “alone” in Rom. III, 28 and his rejection of the entire canonical Epistle of St. James.(815)

a) The teaching of the Bible in regard to the rôle played by good works in the process of justification may be summarized as follows:

(1) A man may believe all that the Church teaches and yet be lost for want of good works or because he has not the love of God; consequently, faith alone does not justify or insure eternal salvation. Our Divine Saviour Himself declares: “Not every one that saith to me, Lord, Lord, shall enter into the kingdom of heaven, but he that doeth the will of my Father who is in heaven, he shall enter into the kingdom of heaven.”(816) St. James says: “Do you not see that by works a man is justified, and not by faith only?”(817) And St. Paul: “If I should have all faith, so that I could remove mountains, and have not charity, I am nothing.”(818)

(2) Besides faith, justification requires certain other preparatory or dispositive acts. There is, for example, the fear of divine justice. Cfr. Ecclus. I, 28: “He that is without fear cannot be justified.”(819) Also, hope in God’s mercy. Cfr. Rom. VIII, 24: “For we are saved by hope.”(820) Again, charity. Cfr. Luke VII, 47: “Many sins are forgiven her because she hath loved much.”(821) Furthermore, contrition or penitence. Cfr. Luke XIII, 3: “Unless you shall do penance, you shall all likewise perish.”(822) Finally, good works in general. Cfr. St. James II, 17: “So faith also, if it have not works, is dead in itself.”(823) No one who ponders these and similar texts can maintain, as Calvin and Melanchthon did, that the good works mentioned merely accompany justification, for they are unmistakably described as causes which dispose and prepare the sinner for it.

(3) It is not faith alone that justifies, but faith informed and actuated by charity. Cfr. Gal. V, 6: “For in Christ Jesus neither circumcision availeth anything, nor uncircumcision: but faith that worketh by charity.”(824) The Greek text shows that the word _operatur_ in the Vulgate must be taken passively, so that a more correct translation would be: “... but faith effected or formed by charity.” But even if ἐνεργουμένη were used as a deponent (ἐνεργεῖσθαι=_agere_, _operari_) the meaning would be substantially the same, _i.e._ a dead faith, without charity, avails nothing. Cfr. St. James II, 26: “For even as the body without the spirit is dead, so also faith without works is dead.”(825)

In Rom. III, 28: “For we account a man to be justified by faith, without the works of the law,”(826) Luther deliberately inserted the word “alone.” The context shows that this is a falsification. The Apostle contrasts justifying faith, not with those preparatory acts of salvation which spring from it, but with the sterile “works of the law” (_i.e._ the Old Testament), which, as such, possessed no more power to justify than the good works of the heathen. Keeping this contrast in mind, it would not be incorrect to say, and St. Paul might well have said, that “supernatural faith alone (_i.e._ only) justifies, while the works of the law do not.” But if faith be taken in contradistinction to the other acts operative in the process of justification, such as fear, hope, contrition, love,—and this is the sense in which Luther takes it,—then it is false and contrary to the mind of St. Paul to say: “Faith alone justifies, nothing else is required.” For in this sense faith is merely the beginning, the foundation, the root of justification and cannot justify the sinner until it has absorbed the other preparatory acts required by Holy Scripture and transformed them into perfect love. This fact was already pointed out by St. Augustine. “Unintelligent persons,” he says, “with regard to the Apostle’s statement: ‘We conclude that a man is justified by faith without the works of the law,’ have thought him to mean that faith is sufficient for a man, even if he leads a bad life and has no good deeds to allege. It is impossible that such a character should be deemed ‘a vessel of election’ by the Apostle, who, after declaring that ‘in Christ Jesus neither circumcision availeth anything nor uncircumcision,’ adds the important remark: ‘but faith that worketh by charity.’ It is such faith which separates the faithful children of God from unclean devils,—for even these ‘believe and tremble,’ as the Apostle James says, but they do no good works. Therefore they possess not the faith by which the just man lives,—the faith which operates through love in such wise that God recompenses it according to its works with eternal life.”(827)

There is another sense in which faith alone may be said to justify, _viz._: if the term be taken to include all those things which God has ordained for our salvation, that is to say, the sum-total of “revelation” or “the true religion” as opposed to “heresy.” The term πίστις (_fides_) is sometimes employed in this sense by the Fathers, but never in Sacred Scripture.(828)

b) There is a unanimous and unbroken tradition in favor of the Catholic doctrine. St. Polycarp writes in his Epistle to the Philippians: “... the faith (πίστις) given you, which is the mother of us all when hope (ἐλπίς) follows and love (ἀγάπη) goes before.”(829) St. Augustine teaches that while faith is _per se_ separable from hope and love, it is ineffective without them. “Man begins with faith, but the demons, too,

believe and tremble; to faith, therefore, must be added hope, and to hope, love."(830) And again: "Without love, faith can indeed exist, but it availeth nothing."(831) St. Gregory the Great, paraphrasing St. James, says: "Perhaps some one will say to himself: I have believed, I shall be saved. He speaks truly if he sustains faith by works. For that is true faith which does not contradict by deeds what it asserts in words."(832)

c) This teaching is in perfect conformity with reason.

α) No supernatural enlightenment is needed to perceive the intrinsic propriety of a moral preparation for justification. Not only must the sinner learn to know God as His supernatural end and the source of all righteousness, but he must also be persuaded that it is his duty, with the help of sufficient grace, to direct his will towards this final end.

Every tendency or movement presupposes a _terminus a quo_, from which it starts, and a _terminus ad quem_, to which it tends. The movement of the will in the process of justification, besides faith, demands a voluntary withdrawal from sin (contrition, good resolutions) and an approach to righteousness (hope, love, desire).(833)

This argument would have made no impression on Luther, since he bluntly denied free-will in the moral order and regarded human nature as so radically depraved by original sin as to be incapable of coöperating with divine grace. In fact he compared man to a "log, stick or stone." This view was shared by Amsdorf, Flacius, and others, whereas Osiander and Butzer admitted that "inherent righteousness" is at least a partial factor in justification. Melanchthon, in an endeavor to reconcile the contradictions of this discordant system, unwittingly gave rise to the so-called Synergist dispute. When Pfeffinger(834) undertook the defence of free-will, many Lutheran theologians, especially of the University of Jena, boldly attacked the log-stick-and-stone theory(835) and tried to force their adversaries to admit that man is able to coöperate with grace. The "Half-Melanchthonians," as they were called, succeeded in smuggling Synergism into the "Book of Torgau;"(836) but before the "Formulary of Concord" was finally printed in the monastery of Bergen, near Magdeburg (A. D. 1577), the strict Lutherans had eliminated that article as heterodox and substituted for it the log-stick-and-stone theory as it appears in the official symbols of the Lutheran Church. In the Syncretist dispute, and through the efforts of the Pietists, this harsh teaching was afterwards moderated. But what probably contributed most to the crumbling of the system was the rapid growth of Socinianism and Rationalism among the Lutherans in the seventeenth and eighteenth centuries. To-day, with the exception of a small band of "orthodox" Lutherans in Saxony and the United States, Protestants no longer hold the log-stick-and-stone theory. The school of Luther proclaimed it as the distinguishing tenet of Protestantism, as "the criterion of a standing or falling church,"(837)—and by this criterion the Lutheran Church has indeed fallen. Common sense has led modern Protestants to admit that contrition and penance are quite as necessary for justification as faith, an opinion which, in the words of Dorner,(838) "comes dangerously near the Catholic system." In Scandinavia, according to Dr. Krogh-Tonning,(839) the Lutheran Church has experienced a "quiet reformation" and now unconsciously defends the Catholic

doctrine of justification.(840)

β) As the sufficiency of the Bible without Tradition is the formal principle of "orthodox" Protestantism, so justification by faith alone may be said to be its material principle. The absurdity of the Lutheran position is evident from the fact that these two principles are mutually destructive. So far from teaching justification by faith alone, the Bible inculcates the exact contrary, while its sufficiency as the source of faith could be proved from its own pages, if at all, only by a vicious circle.(841) Thus the whole Protestant system is based on contradiction.

The _sola fides_ theory is open to serious objection also from the ethical point of view. It cannot be put into practice without grave danger. "Sin lustily," writes Luther, "but be yet more lusty in faith."(842) The first part at least of this injunction was promptly obeyed by his followers, and the rapid deterioration of morals which followed was but a natural sequel of the _sola fides_ theory. If faith alone were sufficient for justification, it would make no difference what kind of life a man led, for unbelief, _i.e._ the loss of fiduciary faith, would be the only sin. No wonder this ethical antinomism of the Lutheran system, so radically opposed to the teaching of St. James, was rejected by Hugo Grotius, George Buller, and other honest Protestants.

Another weighty objection against the Lutheran theory of justification is that it disregards the law of causation. According to Luther a man is justified by the firm belief and trust that his sins are forgiven. This "belief" is either true or false. If it is false, I can have no certainty with regard to my salvation, but am deceiving myself. If true, it presupposes that which it is to effect, in other words, it puts the cause before the effect. An orthodox Lutheran theologian of the old school would probably retort: My sins are actually forgiven by virtue of the atonement, because all men without exception are redeemed through the merits of Jesus Christ. If this be true, then why not be consistent and say: All men are justified because all are redeemed, consequently there is no need of faith and sacraments, and keeping the commandments is a matter of indifference! It is at this point that the incompatibility of Luther's teaching with the Bible and sound ethics becomes most glaringly apparent. True, Luther himself at times emphasized the necessity of good works; but this merely proves that he had lucid intervals when his honest nature rebelled against the inconsistency of his teaching.(843)

3. EXPLANATION OF THE CATHOLIC DOCTRINE.—The Council of Trent assigned to faith its proper place in the process of justification,(844) and gave a luminous and profound analysis of the process itself.(845) Scholastic theology, in elaborating the teaching of Scripture and Tradition, drew a distinction between _fides formata_, which truly justifies, and _fides informis_, which falls short of justification.

a) As regards the intrinsic relation of (dogmatic) faith to other preparatory acts in the process of justification, the Tridentine Council declares: "Faith is the beginning of human salvation, the foundation and the root of all justification."(846) Supernatural faith, therefore, is the beginning of salvation, and not, as Harnack makes Luther say, "at once the beginning, the middle, and the end," because no man can be converted unless he has believingly embraced God as his final goal. This faith is preceded by

certain preliminary conditions, of which the first is an illumination of the intellect and a strengthening of the will, which results in the _affectus credulitatis_ (_initia fidei_). For justifying faith does not flash forth suddenly, like a _deus ex machina_, but requires time for its development, as the history of many conversions proves.(847)

Faith is called the “foundation” of justification because it not only marks its beginning, but constitutes the basis upon which all subsequent stages of the process rest. To exclude the mistaken notion that the process of justification is a series of mechanical and disconnected acts, the Council calls faith the “root” of justification, from which the other preparatory acts spring organically, as the trunk of a tree from its root.

The psychological description of the whole process given by the Tridentine Fathers, which even Harnack admits to be “a masterly piece of work,” runs as follows: “Now they [adults] are disposed unto justice when, excited and assisted by divine grace, conceiving faith by hearing, they are freely moved towards God, believing those things to be true which God has revealed and promised,—and this especially, that God justifies the impious by His grace through the redemption that is in Jesus Christ; and when, understanding themselves to be sinners, they, by turning themselves from the fear of divine justice, whereby they are profitably agitated, to consider the mercy of God, are raised unto hope, confiding that God will be propitious to them for Christ’s sake; and they begin to love Him as the fountain of all justice, and are therefore moved against sins by a certain hatred and detestation, to wit: by that penitence which must be performed before Baptism; lastly, when they purpose to receive Baptism, to begin a new life, and to keep the commandments of God….”(848) The four ordinary stages in the process of justification, therefore, are: (1) From faith to fear of divine justice; (2) from fear to hope; (3) from hope to initial love;(849) (4) from initial love to contrition and a firm purpose of amendment.(850) If contrition is dictated and transfused by perfect love,(851) and the sinner has an explicit or at least implicit desire for the Sacrament,(852) justification takes place at once. If, on the other hand, the sinner’s sorrow is imperfect (_attritio_), he attains justification only by actual reception of the Sacrament (Baptism or Penance).(853)

b) Does conversion always follow this conciliary schema? No. The Council did not mean to define that these acts must follow one another in strict sequence or that they are one and all absolutely indispensable for justification. It is certain, however, that the process invariably begins with faith and ends with contrition accompanied by a firm purpose of amendment. In exceptional cases (_e.g._ the Prodigal Son, Mary Magdalen) perfect charity seems immediately to follow faith, and may then be said virtually to include the intermediate stages of fear, hope, and contrition. Yet this is not the usual way. Ordinarily faith elicits fear, which in turn produces two kinds of hope—hope of forgiveness (_spes veniae_) and hope in God (_spes theologica_), which marks the beginning of charity (_amor concupiscentiae_). Contrition is always a _conditio sine qua non_, because there can be no forgiveness of sin without sorrow for it.(854) It is for this reason that, according to St. Thomas, explicit contrition for mortal sins is necessary for justification even when there is perfect charity, and the sufficiency of the so-called _poenitentia virtualis_ is limited to venial offenses and

such grievous sins as cannot be remembered.(855) Fear, while not absolutely indispensable, is seldom absent. Holy Scripture tells us that “the fear of God is the beginning of wisdom,” and it is natural for the sinner seeking forgiveness to detest his sins out of fear of divine justice before he attains to the motive of perfect charity.(856)

c) Certain utterances of Scripture and the Fathers with regard to the possibility of a “dead” faith(857) have led theologians to distinguish between _fides informis_ and _fides formata_. _Fides informis_ is a dead faith, devoid of charity, and without justifying power. The only faith that can justify a man is that which is animated by charity and productive of good works.(858) This is the _fides formata_ of the Schoolmen, which includes all the preparatory acts enumerated by the Tridentine Council, from fear to perfect charity. These acts, however, though united in the _fides formata_, retain their respective independence, and can disappear singly, one after another, as they came. Zwingli’s assertion that faith, hope, and charity are identical, or at least inseparable, has been expressly condemned by the Tridentine Council: “If any one saith that, grace being lost through sin, faith also is always lost with it; or that the faith which remains, though it be no live faith, is not a true faith; or that he who has faith without charity is not a Christian; let him be anathema.”(859)

READINGS:—Besides the respective chapters in the various text-books, the student may consult: *A. Vega, _De Iustificatione Doctrina Universa Libris XV Absolute Tradita_, Venice 1548 (reprinted at Cologne, 1572).—*Bellarmine, _De Iustificatione Impii_, 1. V (ed. Fèvre, Vol. VI, pp. 149 sqq. Paris 1873).—*Suarez, _De Gratia_, 1. VI sqq.—Becanus, _Theol. Scholast._, “_De Gratia Habituali_,” Rouen 1658.—L. Nussbaum, _Die Lehre der kath. Kirche über die Rechtfertigung_, München 1837.—C. von Schätzler, _Neue Untersuchungen über das Dogma von der Gnade und das Wesen des christl. Glaubens_, Mainz 1867.—Oswald, _Die Lehre von der Heiligung_, § 5, 3rd ed., Paderborn 1885.—B. Bartmann, _St. Paulus und St. Jakobus und die Rechtfertigung_, Freiburg 1897.—L. Galey, _La Foi et les Oeuvres_, Montauban 1902.—W. Liese, _Der heilsnotwendige Glaube, sein Begriff und Inhalt_, Freiburg 1902.—Card. Newman, _Lectures on the Doctrine of Justification_, 8th impression, London 1900.—Hugh Pope, O. P., art. “Faith” in the _Catholic Encyclopedia_, Vol. V.—J. Mausbach, _Catholic Moral Teaching and its Antagonists_ (tr. by A. M. Buchanan), pp. 150 sqq., New York 1914.—L. Labauche, S. S., _God and Man_, pp. 203 sqq., N. Y. 1916.

On the teaching of the Reformers cfr. *Möhler, _Symbolik_, § 18 sqq., 11th ed., Mainz 1890 (English tr. by James Burton Robertson, pp. 82 sqq., 5th ed., London 1906); Ad. Harnack, _Lehrbuch der Dogmengeschichte_, Vol. III, 4th ed., Freiburg 1910; Denifle-Weiss, O. P., _Luther und Luthertum in der ersten Entwicklung_, Vol. II, Mainz 1909; H. Grisar, S. J., _Luther_, Vol. I, Freiburg 1911 (English tr., Vols. I and II, London 1913).

Chapter II. The State Of Justification

Though the term “justification” may be extended to the preparatory acts that lead up to the state of justice, strictly speaking it signifies only that decisive moment in which the sinner is cleansed from mortal sin by an infusion of sanctifying grace. Hence a careful distinction must be made between justification as an act (_actus iustificationis_) and justification as an habitual state (_habitus iustificationis s. status gratiae sanctificantis_). The transient act introduces a permanent state, just as the Sacrament of Holy Orders constitutes a man in the sacerdotal state or priesthood.

Both as an act and as a state justification possesses three distinct properties; it is uncertain, unequal, and capable of being lost.

This gives us the basis for a division of the present Chapter into three Sections: (1) On the Nature of Justification, (2) On Justifying, _i.e._ Sanctifying Grace, and (3) On the Properties of that Grace.

Section 1. The Nature Of Justification

Justification in the active sense (_iustificatio_, δικαίωσις) is defined by the Tridentine Council as “a translation from that state wherein man is born a child of the first Adam, to the state of grace and of the adoption of the sons of God through the second Adam, Jesus Christ, our Saviour.”(860)

Justification, therefore, has both a negative and a positive element. The positive element is interior sanctification through the merits of Jesus Christ. The negative element consists in the forgiveness of sin. Though these elements are objectively inseparable, the forgiveness of sin being practically an effect of interior sanctification, yet we must treat them separately in order to be able to refute more effectively the Lutheran heresy that sin is not wiped out but merely “covered,” and that justification consists in an external “imputation” of the righteousness of Christ.

Article 1. The Negative Element Of Justification

1. THE HERESY OF THE PROTESTANT REFORMERS AND THE TEACHING OF THE CHURCH.—Luther held that human nature was radically depraved by original sin(861) and that justification consists in this, that sin (original and mortal) is no longer “imputed” to the sinner; that is to say, it is not blotted out but merely “covered” by the merits of Christ.

a) Forgiveness of sins, therefore, according to Luther, consists simply in their being no longer imputed.(862) This heresy was incorporated in the Formula of Concord and other symbolical books of the Lutheran Church,(863) and subsequently adopted by Calvin.(864)

b) The Catholic Church has always maintained that justification is a renewal of the soul by which a man’s sins are blotted out and he becomes truly just. This applies first of all to original sin. “If,” says the Council of Trent, “anyone denies that by the grace of our Lord Jesus Christ, which is conferred in Baptism, the guilt of original sin is remitted, or even asserts that the whole of that which has the true and proper nature of sin is not taken away, but says that it is only raised or not imputed, let him be anathema.”(865) What it here defines in regard to original sin, the Council elsewhere

reaffirms in respect of mortal sin.(866)

2. REFUTATION OF THE LUTHERAN THEORY.—The theory thus solemnly condemned by the Tridentine Fathers is unscriptural and opposed to Catholic Tradition.

a) The teaching of the Bible on this point may be reduced to four distinct heads.

(1) The remission of sin granted in the process of justification is a real annihilation of guilt; that is to say, the sins remitted cease to exist in the moral (though not, of course, in the historical) order. Cfr. Ps. L, 3: “Have mercy on me, O God, according to thy great mercy; and according to the multitude of thy tender mercies blot out my iniquity.”(867) Is. XLIII, 25: “I am he that blot out thy iniquities.”(868) After God has blotted out a sin, it no longer exists. Cfr. Is. XLIV, 22: “I have blotted out thy iniquities as a cloud, and thy sins as a mist.”(869) Acts III, 19: “Be penitent, therefore, and be converted, that your sins may be blotted out.”(870) Elsewhere God is said to “take away” sin. Cfr. 2 Kings XII, 13: “The Lord also hath taken away thy sin.”(871) 1 Paral. XXI, 8: “I beseech thee, take away the iniquity of thy servant.”(872) When He takes away sin, it is really and truly blotted out. Cfr. Mich. VII, 18 sq.: “Who is a God like to thee, who takest away iniquity?... He will put away our iniquities, and he will cast all our sins into the bottom of the sea.”(873) Ps. X, 15: “His sin shall be sought, and shall not be found.”(874) Ps. CII, 12: “As far as the east is from the west, so far hath he removed our iniquities from us.”(875) Consequently, when our Divine Saviour said of Mary Magdalen: “Many sins are forgiven her,”(876) He meant that her sins were completely blotted out and taken away.

(2) Justification washes the soul from iniquity and purifies the heart. Cfr. Ps. L, 4: “Wash me yet more from my iniquity, and cleanse me from my sin.”(877) Is. I, 16: “Wash yourselves, be clean.”(878) After one’s sins are washed away, the heart is clean and pure. Cfr. Ez. XXXVI, 25 sq.: “And I will pour upon you clean water, and you shall be cleansed from all your filthiness, ... and I will give you a new heart.”(879) 1 Cor. VI, 11: “And such [fornicators, etc.] some of you were; but you are washed, but you are sanctified, but you are justified.”(880) Spotless purity takes the place of the impurity that previously defiled the soul of the sinner. Cfr. Ps. L, 9: “Thou shalt sprinkle me with hyssop, and I shall be cleansed: thou shalt wash me, and I shall be made whiter than snow.”(881) Is. I, 18: “If your sins be as scarlet, they shall be made as white as snow: and if they be red as crimson, they shall be white as wool.”(882) No trace of sin remains in the soul after it has been washed in the Precious Blood of Christ. Apoc. I, 5: “... Jesus Christ, ... hath loved us, and washed us from our sins in his own blood.”(883) 1 John I, 7: “... the blood of Jesus Christ ... cleanseth us from all sin.”(884)

(3) Justification is an awakening of the sinner from death to life, a transition from darkness to light. Cfr. 1 John III, 14: “We know that we have passed from death to life, because we love the brethren; he that loveth not, abideth in death.”(885) Col. II, 13: “And you, when you were dead in your sins, ... he hath quickened together with him, forgiving you all offences.”(886) Eph. V, 8: “For you were heretofore darkness, but now light in the Lord.”(887)

(4) Baptism, in particular, completely removes all guilt. Cfr. Acts XXII, 16: “Rise up, and be baptized, and wash away thy sins.”(888) Hence, though concupiscence remains, the soul has no longer in it anything damnable, _i.e._ any trace of original or mortal sin. Cfr. Rom. VIII, 1: “There is now therefore no condemnation to them that are in Christ Jesus.”(889)

It requires no special acuteness to perceive that this Biblical teaching is irreconcilably opposed to the Protestant theory of non-imputation. If, as the Lutherans allege, God merely _declared_ the believer just, justification would not blot out or take away sin, nor could it be truthfully said that light and life take the place of death and darkness; something deserving of condemnation would still remain in those that are in Christ Jesus.(890)

There are a few Scriptural texts that seem to favor the Lutheran view, but they must be interpreted in conformity with the general teaching of the Bible as outlined above. Among these texts is Ps. XXXI, 1 sq.: “Blessed are they whose iniquities are forgiven, and whose sins are covered. Blessed is the man to whom the Lord hath not imputed sin, and in whose spirit there is no guile.”(891) The parallelism apparent in this verse allows us to conclude that “covered” is used in the sense of “remitted” and that “he to whom the Lord hath not imputed sin” is identical with the man “in whose spirit there is no guile.” The text manifestly refers to a real _forgiveness_ of sins, for any sin that God “covers” and ceases to “impute,” must be blotted out and swept away, because “all things are naked and open to the eyes” of the omniscient Creator.(892)

Another favorite text of the Lutheran theologians is Rom. VII, 17: “Now then it is no more I that do it, but sin that dwelleth in me.”(893) This passage clearly refers to concupiscence, which remains in the sinner after justification, but, according to Rom. VIII, 1 and James I, 14 sq., is not truly and properly sin but merely called “sin”(894) by metonymy, “because,” in the words of the Tridentine Council, “it is of sin and inclines to sin.”(895)

b) The Fathers of the Church, both Greek and Latin, unanimously teach that justification effects the forgiveness of sins.

St. Justin Martyr says: “By doing penance, all who desire it can obtain mercy from God, and Scripture calls them blessed in saying: ‘Blessed is he to whom God hath not imputed sin,’ which means that he receives forgiveness of his sins from God, not as you, deceiving yourselves, and others like you aver, that God does not impute [their] sin to them, though they are [still] sinners.”(896) Clement of Alexandria likens Baptism to “a bath in which sins are washed off.”(897) St. Gregory Nazianzen says: “It is called Baptism [βαπτισμός, from βάπτειν, to immerse] because the sin is buried in water, ... and a bath (λουτρόν), because it washes off.”(898) St. Augustine indignantly opposes the erroneous opinion of the Pelagians that Baptism does not take away sins but merely “trims them off.” “Who but an unbeliever,” he exclaims, “can affirm this against the Pelagians? We say, therefore, that Baptism gives remission of all sins and takes away crimes, not merely trims them off (_radere_) in such wise that the roots of all sins may be preserved in an evil flesh, as of hair

trimmed on the head, when the sins cut down may grow again."(899) Pope St. Gregory the Great seems almost to have foreseen the heresy of the Protestant Reformers, for he says: "But if there are any who say that in Baptism sins are forgiven as to outward appearance only, what can be more un-Catholic than such preaching?... He who says that sins are not completely forgiven in Baptism might as well say that the Egyptians did not perish in the Red Sea. But if he admits that the Egyptians actually died [in the Red Sea], let him also admit that of necessity sins completely die in Baptism."(900)

c) The theological argument may be briefly formulated as follows: We can imagine but two reasons why God should not truly forgive us our sins in the process of justification: inability and unwillingness. To say that He is _unable_ to forgive us our sins would be to assert that the remission of sin involves a metaphysical impossibility. This no Protestant will admit, because all believe that "nothing defiled shall enter into heaven."(901) To assert that God is _unwilling_ to forgive our sins would be to contradict the plain teaching of Scripture, as set forth above. Consequently there is no reason whatever for assuming that God does not truly forgive us our sins in the process of justification. Furthermore, it would be incompatible with His veracity and holiness to assume that He merely declares the sinner to be "free from sin," without actually cleansing his soul. It would be a contradiction to assert that a man whom the truthful and all-holy God has declared free from sin, remains steeped in iniquity. Cfr. Prov. XVII, 15: "He that justifieth the wicked [_i.e._ absolves him from his sins], and he that condemneth the just, both are abominable before God."

According to Revelation the justification of the sinner is not a mere change, with a privation for its _terminus a quo_(902) and an indifferent form for its _terminus ad quem_, but involves a movement from extreme to extreme, and hence the genesis of the one extreme must coincide with the destruction of the other. Sin, being in contrary opposition to righteousness, must depart when righteousness enters the soul.(903)

Article 2. The Positive Element Of Justification

1. HERETICAL ERRORS AND THE CHURCH.—Calvin held that justification consists essentially and exclusively in the remission of sins.(904) The other "Reformers" maintained that there must also be a positive element in the process, but differed in determining its nature.

a) The ambiguous language employed by Luther and Melanchthon gave rise to many different opinions, which agreed only in one point, that is, in holding, contrary to Catholic teaching, that the positive element of justification is not inward sanctification or inherent righteousness (_i.e._ sanctifying grace). Probably the view most common among the supporters of the Augsburg Confession was that the sinner, by a "fiduciary apprehension" of God's mercy, as proclaimed in the Gospel, "apprehends" the extrinsic justice of Christ, and with it covers his sins, which are thereupon no longer "imputed" to him. In other words, he is outwardly accounted and declared righteous in the sight of God, though inwardly he remains a sinner. With the exception of "_sola fides_" there was probably no shibboleth in the sixteenth century

so persistently dinned into the ears of Catholics and Protestants alike as "_iustitia Christi extra nos_." It is found in the _Apologia_ written in defence of the Augsburg Confession(905) and recurs in the Formula of Concord.(906) According to the "orthodox" Lutheran view, therefore, justification on its positive side is a purely forensic and outward imputation of the righteousness of Christ, which the sinner seizes with the arm of faith and puts on like a cloak to hide the wounds of his soul.(907)

b) Against this dismal heresy the Tridentine Council solemnly declared that "Justification ... is not remission of sins merely, but also the sanctification and renewal of the inward man through the voluntary reception of the grace and of the gifts,"(908) and anathematized all those who say that "men are justified either by the sole imputation of the justice of Christ or by the sole remission of sins, to the exclusion of the grace and the charity which is poured forth in their hearts by the Holy Ghost and is inherent in them, or even that the grace whereby we are justified is only the favor of God."(909)

In thus defining the doctrine of the Church, the Council did not, however, mean to deny that the sinner is in a true sense "justified by the justice of Christ,"—in so far namely, as our Lord has merited for us the grace of justification. He merely wished to emphasize the fact that a sinner is not _formaliter_ justified by the imputation of Christ's justice. For the sake of greater clearness the various "causes" of justification are enumerated as follows: "Of this justification the causes are these: the final cause indeed is the glory of God and of Jesus Christ, and life everlasting; while the efficient cause is a merciful God, who washes and sanctifies gratuitously; ... but the meritorious cause is His most beloved only-begotten Son, our Lord Jesus Christ, who ... merited justification for us by His most holy Passion on the wood of the Cross; ... the instrumental cause is the Sacrament of Baptism, which is the sacrament of faith, without which no man was ever justified; lastly, the sole formal cause is the justice of God, not that whereby He Himself is just, but that whereby He maketh us just, that, to wit, with which we being endowed are renewed in the spirit of our mind, and are not only reputed, but are truly called, and are, just."(910)

So important did the distinction between the _causa meritoria_ and the _causa formalis_ of justification appear to the Fathers of Trent, that they made it the subject of a separate canon, to wit: "If anyone saith that men are just without the justice of Christ, whereby He merited for us to be justified; or that it is by that justice itself that they are formally just; let him be anathema."(911) Justification in the Catholic sense, therefore, is not a mere outward imputation of the justice of Christ, but a true inward renewal and sanctification wrought by a grace intrinsically inhering in the soul. This grace theologians call the "grace of justification."

2. REFUTATION OF THE LUTHERAN THEORY OF IMPUTATION.—Nothing is so foreign to both the spirit and the letter of Holy Scripture as the idea that justification merely covers a man's sins with a cloak of justice and leaves him unsanctified within.

Justification is described in the Bible not only as a remission of sins,(912) but likewise as the beginning of a new life,(913) a renewal of the spirit,(914) a new

creation,(915) a regeneration,(916) a supernatural likeness of God,(917) etc. All these similes point to a permanent state of sanctity in the soul of the just.

α) The Lutheran theory of imputation can be most effectively refuted by an analysis of the Scriptural term “regeneration” (_regeneratio_, ἀναγέννησις, παλιγγενεσία). “Unless a man be born again of water and the Holy Ghost,” says our Divine Lord, “he cannot enter into the kingdom of God.”(918) This spiritual rebirth wipes out sin and inwardly sanctifies the soul. The regenerate sinner receives a new and godlike nature. That this nature can be conceived in no other way than as a state of sanctity and justice appears clearly from Tit. III, 5 sqq.: “Not by the works of justice which we have done, but according to His mercy, He saved us, by the laver of regeneration and renovation of the Holy Ghost, whom he hath poured forth upon us abundantly, through Jesus Christ our Saviour: that, being justified by His grace, we may be heirs, according to the hope of life everlasting.”(919) Both text and context show that the Apostle is here speaking of the justification of adult sinners in Baptism, which he describes as a “laver of regeneration and renovation” resulting in an “outpouring of the Holy Ghost.” These phrases plainly denote a positive quality of the soul as well as a permanent interior grace. Regeneration consists in the remission of sin through Baptism, and also, more particularly, in man being made like God, _i.e._ becoming a child of God,(920) while “renovation” means “putting off the old man”(921) and “putting on the new.”(922) The “outpouring of the Holy Ghost” effected by Baptism is not, of course, an outpouring of the Hypostasis of the Third Person of the Trinity, but of created grace, which re-forms the sinner and makes him just.(923) This justifying grace must not be conceived as an actual grace, much less as a series of actual graces, for it is not given us merely as an aid in the performance of some particular act, but as a new nature. Regeneration and renovation denote a state of being, as we can plainly see in the case of baptized infants. It is for this reason that the Apostle speaks of it as a lasting state;—that which theologians call the _status gratiae sanctificantis_.(924)

Closely akin to the notion of “regeneration” is that of “re-creation.” Justification renews the sinner inwardly and makes of him, so to speak, a new creature, which has sloughed off sin and become just and holy in the sight of God. Cfr. 2 Cor. V, 17: “If then any be in Christ a new creature, the old things are passed away, behold all things are made new.”(925) This is all the more true since re-creation effects an “incorporation of man with Christ,” and is closely connected with “regeneration of God.” Cfr. James I, 18: “For of his own will hath he begotten us by the word of truth, that we might be some beginning of his creature.”(926) A comparison with Gal. VI, 15 and Gal. V, 6 fully establishes it as a Biblical truth that in the process of justification the sinner, through faith informed by charity, is changed into a new creature. “For in Christ Jesus,” says St. Paul, “neither circumcision availeth anything, nor uncircumcision, but a new creature.”(927) And again: “In Christ Jesus neither circumcision availeth anything, nor uncircumcision, but faith that worketh by charity.”(928) In both these texts the Jewish rite of circumcision is rejected as useless and contrasted with justification, which by means of the _fides formata_ gives birth to a “new creature.” This is incompatible with the Protestant notion that a man is justified by being declared righteous in the sight of God, though he remains inwardly

unchanged.(929)

β) The Lutherans vainly appeal to the fact that Holy Scripture employs the word "justify"(930) for the purpose of declaring a man to be just in a purely forensic sense, as in Is. V, 23: "Who justify the wicked for gifts." This proves nothing against the Catholic doctrine, which is based entirely on texts that exclude the judicial meaning of the term and plainly refer to inward sanctification.(931)

The word "justification" also occurs in two other meanings in the Bible. Ps. CXVIII, 8 and 26 it stands in the plural for the "law": "I will keep thy justifications;"(932) and "Teach me thy justifications."(933) Apoc. XXII, 11 and in a few other passages it signifies "growth" in interior holiness, which theologians call _iustificatio secunda_.(934)

The Lutherans are equally unfortunate in maintaining that St. Paul countenances their theory when he speaks of "putting on Christ." Cfr. Gal. III, 27: "For as many of you as have been baptized in Christ, have put on Christ."(935) The Apostle in employing this simile does not mean to say that justification consists in putting on an outward cloak of grace to cover sins which inwardly endure, but precisely the contrary, _viz._: that the sinner by being justified is inwardly cleansed from sin and becomes a new creature and a child of God. This interpretation is supported by various parallel texts(936) and by the staple of St. Paul's teaching.

Another passage which the Lutherans cite in their favor is 1 Cor. I, 30: "... who [Christ Jesus] of God is made unto us wisdom, and justice, and sanctification, and redemption."(937) Christ is made unto us justice and sanctification, in what sense? Manifestly in the same sense in which He is made unto us wisdom of God, that is to say, in so far as He imparts to us wisdom, which thereupon becomes our own, but not in the sense that the wisdom of Christ is outwardly imputed to us. Note that St. Paul in this and many other passages of his Epistles merely wishes to emphasize the gratuity of the Redemption and of grace to the exclusion of all natural merit on the part of man.(938)

b) As regards the teaching of the Fathers, the "Reformers" themselves admitted that it was against them.(939)

We read in the Epistle of Barnabas, which was probably composed about A. D. 100:(940) "Since then He made us new by the remission of sins, he made us another type, that we should have the soul of children, as though He were creating us afresh."

The reason why St. Paul calls Baptism the "laver of regeneration" rather than the laver of forgiveness, is explained by St. John Chrysostom(941) as follows: "Because it [Baptism] not only remits our sins and wipes out our misdeeds, but accomplishes all this in such a way as if we were born anew;(942) for it entirely re-creates and re-forms us."(943)

St. Ambrose regards innocence as the positive element of justification: "After this [_i.e._ Baptism] you received a white robe, to indicate that you stripped off the vesture of sin and put on the chaste garments of innocence."(944)

Harnack claims that St. Augustine first stemmed the current dogmatic tradition and reshaped it by going back to St. Paul. Bellarmine(945) refuted this audacious assertion long before it was rehashed by the German rationalist. The Council of Trent was so thoroughly imbued with the teaching of Augustine that its decrees and canons on justification read as though they were lifted bodily from his writings. The great "Doctor of Grace" flatly contradicts the Protestant theory of imputation in such utterances as these: "He [St. Paul] does not say, 'the righteousness of man,' … but 'the righteousness of God,'—meaning not that whereby He is Himself righteous, but that with which He endows man when He justifies the ungodly…. The righteousness of God is by faith of Jesus Christ, that is, by the faith wherewith one believes in Christ. For _here_ is not meant the faith with which Christ Himself believes, just as _there_ was not meant the righteousness whereby God is Himself righteous. Both no doubt are ours; but yet they are called [in one case] God's, and [in the other] Christ's, because it is by their bounty that these gifts are bestowed upon man."(946) Again: "When righteousness is given to us, it is not called our own righteousness, but God's, because it becomes ours only so that we have it from God."(947) Again: "The grace of God is called the righteousness of God through our Lord Jesus Christ, not that by which the Lord is just, but that by which He justifies those whom from unrighteous He makes righteous."(948) Again: "The love of God is said to be shed abroad in our hearts, not because He loves us, but because He makes us lovers of Himself; just as the righteousness of God is used in the sense of our being made righteous by His gift."(949) According to St. Augustine, therefore, justification culminates in a true sanctification of the soul. "When he [St. Paul] says: 'We are transformed into the same image,' he assuredly means to speak of the image of God; and by calling it 'the same,' he means that very image which we see in the glass,… and that we pass from a form that is obscure to a form that is bright,… and this [human] nature, being the most excellent among things created, is changed from a form that is defaced into a form that is beautiful, when it is justified by its Creator from ungodliness."(950)

The Augustinian passages which we have quoted (and they are not by any means all that could be quoted) enumerate the distinguishing marks of sanctifying grace in so far as it is the formal cause of justification.(951)

c) The argument from Revelation can be reinforced by certain philosophical considerations which show the absurdity of the imputation theory from the standpoint of common sense.

A man outwardly justified but inwardly a sinner would be a moral monster, and Almighty God would be guilty of an intrinsic contradiction were He to regard and treat such a one as just. This contradiction is not removed but rather intensified by the Lutheran appeal to the extraneous justice of Christ.(952)

The incongruity of the Lutheran doctrine of justification becomes fully apparent from the consequences which it involves, to wit: (1) all Christians without distinction would possess exactly the same degree of sanctity and justice; (2) justification once obtained by fiduciary faith could not be lost except by the sin of unbelief; and (3) children would not be justified by Baptism because they are not sufficiently advanced in the use of reason to enable them to "apprehend" the external righteousness of

Christ. The first of these inferences runs counter to common sense and experience. The second, which Luther clothed in the shameful exhortation, "_Pecca fortiter et crede fortius et nihil nocebunt centum homicidia et mille stupra_,"(953) is repugnant to the teaching of Scripture and destructive of morality.(954) The third consistently led to the rejection of infant baptism by the Anabaptists, the Mennonites, and other Protestant sects.

3. SANCTIFYING GRACE THE SOLE FORMAL CAUSE OF JUSTIFICATION.—In declaring that "inherent grace" is the "sole formal cause of justification," the Council of Trent(955) defined it as an article of faith that sanctifying grace of itself is able to produce all the formal effects of justification, _e.g._ forgiveness of sins, the sanctification of the sinner, his adoption by God, etc.,(956) and consequently requires no supplementary or contributory causes. In other words, justification is wholly and fully accomplished by the infusion of sanctifying grace.

a) It appears from the discussions preceding its sixth session that the Tridentine Council not only meant to condemn the heretical contention of Butzer that "inherent grace" must be supplemented by the "imputed justice of Christ" as the really essential factor of justification,(957) but also wished to reject the view of divers contemporary Catholic theologians(958) that "intrinsic righteousness" is inadequate to effect justification without a special _favor Dei externus_.(959) In this the Fathers of the Council were on Scriptural ground. The principal effects of justification,—forgiveness of sins and internal sanctification,—are both produced by sanctifying grace. Sacred Scripture is perfectly clear on this point. It represents sin as opposed to grace in the same way in which darkness is opposed to light,(960) life to death,(961) the new man to the old.(962) The one necessarily excludes the other. Sanctifying grace and sin cannot co-exist in the same subject.

Internal sanctification may be defined as a permanent, vital union with God, by which the soul becomes righteous and holy in His sight and obtains a claim to Heaven. That this is also a function of sanctifying grace appears from those Scriptural texts which treat of the positive element of justification.(963) With this doctrine Tradition is in perfect accord, and consequently the Fathers of Trent were right in teaching as they did, in fact they could not have taught otherwise.(964)

b) While all Catholic theologians admit the incompatibility of grace and sin in the same subject, they differ as to the kind and degree of opposition existing between the two. Some hold that this opposition is purely moral, others that it is physical, again others that it is metaphysical.

α) Nominalists(965) and Scotists(966) before the Tridentine decision maintained that the distinction between sanctifying grace and (original or mortal) sin is based on a free decree of the Almighty, and therefore purely moral. God, they held, by a _favor externus superadditus_, externally supplies what sanctifying grace internally lacks, just as a government's stamp raises the value of a coin beyond the intrinsic worth of the bullion. Followed to its legitimate conclusions, this shallow theory means that sanctifying grace is of itself insufficient to wipe out sin, and that, but for the superadded divine favor, grace and sin might co-exist in the soul. This is tantamount

to saying that justification requires a twofold formal cause, _viz._: sanctifying grace and a _favor Dei superadditus_,—which runs counter to the teaching of Trent. Henno tries to escape this objection by explaining that the _favor Dei acceptans_ appertains not to the formal but merely to the efficient cause of justification. But this contention is manifestly untenable. Sanctifying grace is either able to wipe out sin, or it is unable: if it is unable to produce this effect, the _favor Dei acceptans_ must be part of the _causa formalis_ of justification, and then, in Henno's hypothesis, we should have a _duplex causa formalis_, which contradicts the Tridentine decree. If, on the other hand, sanctifying grace is able to wipe out sin without any _favor superadditus_, then the Scotistic theory has no _raison d'être_.

β) From what we have said it follows that there must be at least a physical contrariety between grace and sin. The difference between physical and metaphysical opposition may be illustrated by the example of fire and water. These two elements are incompatible by a law of nature. But as there is no metaphysical contradiction between them, Almighty God could conceivably bring them together. It is this physical kind of opposition that Suarez and a few of his followers assume to exist between grace and sin. Absolutely speaking, they say, there is no intrinsic contradiction in the assumption that God could preserve the physical entity of sanctifying grace in a soul guilty of mortal sin.(967) In so far as this school admits the existence of an internal opposition, which actually prevents original or mortal sin from ever co-existing in the soul with justifying grace, its teaching may be said to be acceptable to all Catholic theologians. The Scotistic view, on account of its incompatibility with the teaching of the Tridentine Council, is no longer held.

It may be questioned, however, whether Suarez goes far enough in this matter, and whether the opposition between grace and sin could really be overcome by a miracle. The simultaneous co-existence of grace and sin seems to involve an absolute, _i.e._ metaphysical, contradiction.

γ) This is what the Thomists maintain with the majority of Jesuit theologians.(968) As some subtle objections have been raised against this view, it cannot be accepted as theologically certain; but it undoubtedly corresponds better than its opposite to the spirit and letter of Scripture. The Bible, as we have already pointed out, likens the opposition existing between grace and sin to that between life and death,(969) justice and injustice, Christ and Belial, God and an idol.(970) But these are contradictories, _ergo_.(971) The same conclusion can be reached by arguing from the character of sanctifying grace as a _participatio divinae naturae_.(972) If grace is a participation in the divine nature, it must be opposed to sin in the same way in which God Himself is opposed to it. Now God as the All-Holy One is metaphysically opposed to sin; consequently, the same kind of opposition must exist between sanctifying grace and sin.

It is alleged against this teaching that between habitual grace and habitual sin there is merely a disparate opposition, _i.e._ that of a physical to a moral form, the concepts of which are not mutually exclusive. But sanctifying grace is more than a physical ornament of the soul; it is an ethical form which has for its essential function to render the soul holy and righteous in the sight of God.(973)

READINGS:—St. Thomas, _Summa Theol._, 1a 2ae, qu. 113, and the commentators, especially Billuart, _De Gratia_, diss. 7, art. 1 sqq.; *Bellarmine, _De Iustificatione_, l. II (_Opera Omnia_, ed. Fèvre, Vol. VI, pp. 208 sqq., Paris 1873).

Besides the current text-books cfr. *Jos. Wieser, _S. Pauli Apostoli Doctrina de Iustificatione_, Trent 1874; H. Th. Simar, _Die Theologie des hl. Paulus_, 2nd ed., §33 sqq. Freiburg 1883.

On the Protestant notion of justification cfr. Möhler, _Symbolik_, §10 sqq., Mainz 1890 (Robertson's translation, pp. 82 sqq., 5th ed., London 1906); _Realenzyklopädie für prot. Theologie_, Vol. XVI, 3rd ed., pp. 482 sqq., Leipzig 1905 (summarized in English in the _New Schaff-Herzog Encyclopedia of Religious Knowledge_, Vol. VI, pp. 275 sqq., New York 1910); Card. Newman, _Lectures on the Doctrine of Justification_, 8th impression, London 1900; J. Mausbach, _Catholic Moral Teaching and its Antagonists_, New York 1914, pp. 150 sqq.—B. J. Otten, S. J., _A Manual of the History of Dogmas_, Vol. II, St. Louis 1918, pp. 246 sqq., 464 sq., 470 sqq.

Section 2. Justifying Or Sanctifying Grace

Sanctifying grace is defined by Deharbe as "an unmerited, supernatural gift, imparted to the soul by the Holy Ghost, by which we are made just, children of God, and heirs of Heaven." As it makes sinners just, sanctifying grace is also called justifying, though this appellation can not be applied to the sanctification of our first parents in Paradise or to that of the angels and the sinless soul of Christ. Justification, as we have shown, consists in the infusion of sanctifying grace, and hence it is important that we obtain a correct idea of the latter. We will therefore consider (1) The Nature of Sanctifying Grace, (2) Its Effects in the Soul, and (3) Its Supernatural Concomitants.

Article 1. The Nature Of Sanctifying Grace

1. SANCTIFYING GRACE A "PERMANENT QUALITY" OF THE SOUL.—Having no intuitive knowledge of sanctifying grace, we are obliged, in order to obtain an idea of its true nature, to study its effects, as made known to us by Revelation. Sacred Scripture and the teaching of the Church do, however, enable us to form certain well-defined conclusions, of which the most important is that sanctifying grace must be conceived as a permanent quality (_qualitas permanens_) of the soul. If it is a permanent quality, sanctifying grace cannot be identical with actual grace or with "uncreated grace," _i.e._ the Person of the Holy Ghost.

a) In conformity with such Biblical expressions as "the new life," "renovation of the spirit," "regeneration," "divine sonship," etc., the Council of Trent defines justifying grace as a supernatural something "infused" into and "inherent" in the soul. Both ideas denote a permanent state, not a mere transient act or the result of such acts. "The charity of God is poured forth by the Holy Spirit in the hearts of those that are justified, and is inherent therein."(974) "That justice which is called ours, because we are justified from its being inherent in us, that same is (the justice of God) because it is infused into us by God, through the merit of Christ."(975) "If any one saith that

men are justified ... to the exclusion of the grace and the charity which is poured forth in their hearts by the Holy Ghost and is inherent in them,... let him be anathema."(976) Hence Justification is defined by the Fathers of Trent as "a translation ... to the state of grace and adoption of the sons of God."(977)

Before the Tridentine Council a number of theologians held that sanctifying grace consists in some particular actual grace or in a consecutive series of actual graces. This view is incompatible with the definition just quoted; in fact Suarez, Bellarmine, Ripalda, and others regard it as positively heretical or at least intolerably rash. During the preliminary debates at Trent some of the Fathers asked for an express declaration of the Council to the effect that justification is wrought by the instrumentality of an infused habit; but their request was set aside on the ground that the nature of justifying grace as a stable habit is sufficiently indicated by the word "_inhaeret_."(978)

That sanctifying grace is a permanent state of the soul may also be inferred from the Catholic teaching that the grace which Baptism imparts to children does not differ essentially from that which it imparts to adults. True, this teaching was not always regarded as certain;(979) but at the Ecumenical Council of Vienne, A. D. 1311, Pope Clement V declared it to be "the more probable opinion,"(980) and it was rendered absolutely certain by the Tridentine decision that infant Baptism results not only in the remission of sins, but likewise in an infusion of sanctifying grace. This being so, there can be no essential difference between the justification of children and that of adults. Now it cannot be actual grace which renders children righteous in the sight of God, for they are unable to avail themselves of actual grace on account of the undeveloped state of their intellect. The grace that Baptism imparts to them is consequently a _gratia inhaerens et informans_, that is, a permanent state of grace; and it must be the same in adults.(981)

Peter Lombard(982) identified sanctifying grace with the _gratia increata_, _i.e._ the Person of the Holy Ghost. This notion was combatted by St. Thomas(983) and implicitly rejected by the Tridentine Council when it declared that sanctifying grace inheres in the soul and may be increased by good works.(984) To say that the Holy Ghost is poured forth in the hearts of men, or that He may be increased by good works, would evidently savor of Pantheism. The Holy Ghost pours forth sanctifying grace and is consequently not the formal but the efficient cause of justification.(985)

b) The _gratia inhaerens permanens_ is not a mere relation or _denominatio extrinseca_, but a positive entity productive of real effects,(986) and must consequently be conceived either as a substance or as an accident. We have shown that it is not identical with the uncreated substance of the Holy Ghost. Neither can it be a created substance. The idea of an intrinsically supernatural created substance involves a contradiction.(987) Moreover, sanctifying grace in its nature and purpose is not an entity independently co-existing with the soul but something physically inherent in it. Now, a thing which has its existence by inhering in some other thing is in philosophic parlance an "accident." St. Thomas expressly teaches that, "since it transcends human nature, grace cannot be a substance nor a substantial form, but is an accidental form of the soul itself."(988) Agreeable to this conception is the further

Thomistic teaching that sanctifying grace is not directly created by God, but drawn (_educta_) from the _potentia obedientialis_ of the soul.(989) Not even the Scotists, though they held grace to be created out of nothing(990) claimed that it was a new substance.

An accident that inheres in a substance permanently and physically is called a quality (_qualitas_, ποιότης). Consequently, sanctifying grace must be defined as a supernatural quality of the soul. This is the express teaching of the Roman Catechism: “Grace ... is a divine quality inherent in the soul, and, as it were, a certain splendor and light that effaces all the stains of our souls and renders the souls themselves brighter and more beautiful.”(991)

2. SANCTIFYING GRACE AN INFUSED HABIT.—Sanctifying grace may more specifically, though with a lesser degree of certainty, be described as a habit (_habitus_). Being entitatively supernatural, this habit must be infused or “drawn out” by the Holy Ghost.

a) Aristotle(992) distinguishes four different sets of qualities: (1) habit and disposition; (2) power and incapacity; (3) _passio_ (the power of causing sensations) and _patibilis qualitas_ (result of the modification of sense); (4) figure and circumscribing form (of extended bodies). As sanctifying grace manifestly cannot come under one of the three last-mentioned heads, it must be either a habit or a disposition. Habit denotes a permanent and comparatively stable quality, by which a substance, considered as to its nature or operation, is well or ill adapted to its natural end.(993) As a permanently inhering quality, sanctifying grace must be a habit. Hence its other name, “habitual grace.” The Scholastics draw a distinction between entitative and operative habits. An operative habit (_habitus operativus_) gives not only the power (_potentia_) to act, but also a certain facility, and may be either good, bad, or indifferent. An entitative habit (_habitus entitativus_) is an inherent quality by which a substance is rendered permanently good or bad, _e.g._ beauty, ugliness, health, disease.

Philosophy knows only operative habits. But sanctifying grace affects the very substance of the soul. Hence the supplementary theological category of entitative habits. “Grace,” says St. Thomas, “belongs to the first species of quality, though it cannot properly be called a habit, because it is not immediately ordained to action, but to a kind of spiritual being, which it produces in the soul.”(994) There is another reason why grace cannot be called a habit in the philosophical sense of the term:—it supplies no acquired facility to act. This consideration led Suarez to abstain altogether from the use of the term “habit” in connection with grace,(995) and induced Cardinal Bellarmine to describe sanctifying grace as a _qualitas per modum habitus_,(996) by which phrase he wished to indicate that it imparts a supernatural perfection of being rather than a facility to act. To obviate these and similar subtleties the Council of Trent defined sanctifying grace simply as a permanent quality.

Nevertheless scientific theology employs the term _habitus_ because it has no other philosophical category ready to hand. This defect in the Aristotelian system is

somewhat surprising in view of the fact that besides the supernatural, there are distinctly natural qualities which “belong to the first species,” though they impart no facility to act but merely a disposition to certain modes of being, _e.g._ beauty, health, etc.

There is also a positive reason which justifies the definition of sanctifying grace as a habit. It is that grace imparts to the soul, if not the facility, at least the power to perform supernaturally meritorious acts, so that it is really more than a _habitus entitativus_, namely, a _habitus_ (at least remotely) _operativus_.(997)

b) The Scholastic distinction between native and acquired habits does not apply in the supernatural domain, because the supernatural by its very definition can never be either a part or an acquisition of mere nature.(998) It follows from this that supernatural habits, both entitative and operative, can be imparted to the human soul in no other way than by infusion (or excitation) from above. Hence the name _habitus infusus_. When the Holy Ghost infuses sanctifying grace, the _habitus entitativus_ imparts to the soul a supernatural principle of being, while the _habitus operativus_ confers upon it a supernatural power, which by faithful coöperation with (actual) grace may be developed into a facility to perform salutary acts. Hence, if we adopt the division of habits into entitative and operative, sanctifying grace must be defined first as an entitative habit (_habitus entitativus_), because it forms the groundwork of permanent righteousness, sanctity, divine sonship, etc.; and, secondly, as an infused habit, because it is not born in the soul and cannot be acquired by practice. This view is in accord with Sacred Scripture, which describes the grace of justification as a divine seed abiding in man,(999) a treasure carried in earthen vessels,(1000) a regeneration by which the soul becomes the abode of God(1001) and a temple of the Holy Ghost.(1002)

3. THE CONTROVERSY REGARDING THE ALLEGED IDENTITY OF SANCTIFYING GRACE AND CHARITY.—As justifying grace and theological love (charity) are both infused habits, the question arises as to their objective identity. The answer will depend on the solution of the problem, just treated, whether sanctifying grace is primarily an entitative or an operative habit. Of theological love we know that it is essentially an operative habit, being one, and indeed the chief of the “three theological virtues.” What we have said in the preceding paragraph will enable the reader to perceive, at the outset, that there is a real distinction between grace and charity, and that consequently the two can not be identical.

a) Nevertheless there is an imposing school of theologians who maintain the identity of grace with charity. They are Scotus(1003) and his followers,(1004) Cardinal Bellarmine,(1005) Molina, Lessius, Salmeron, Vasquez, Sardagna, Tournely, and others. Their principal argument is that Holy Scripture ascribes active justification indiscriminately to theological love and sanctifying grace, and that some of the Fathers follow this example. Here are a few of the Scriptural texts quoted in favor of this opinion. Luke VII, 47: “Many sins are forgiven her, because she hath loved much.”(1006) 1 Pet. IV, 8: “Charity covereth a multitude of sins.”(1007) 1 John IV, 7: “Every one that loveth is born of God.”(1008) St. Augustine seems to identify the two habits in such passages as the following: “Inchoate love, therefore, is

inchoate righteousness; ... great love is great righteousness; perfect love is perfect righteousness."(1009) According to the Tridentine Council, "the justification of the impious" takes place when "the charity of God is poured forth ... in the hearts of those that are justified, and is inherent therein."(1010) It is argued that, if charity and grace produce the same effects, they must be identical as causes, and there can be at most a virtual distinction between them. This argument is strengthened by the observation that sanctifying grace and theological love constitute the supernatural life of the soul and the loss of either entails spiritual death.

These arguments prove that grace and charity are inseparable, but nothing more. All the Scriptural and Patristic passages cited can be explained without recourse to the hypothesis that they are identical. Charity is not superfluous alongside of sanctifying grace, because the primary object of grace is to impart supernatural being, whereas charity confers a special faculty which enables the intellect and the will to elicit supernatural salutary acts.

b) The majority of Catholic theologians(1011) hold with St. Thomas(1012) and his school that grace and charity, while inseparable, are really distinct, sanctifying grace as a _habitus entitativus_ imparting to the soul a supernatural being, whereas charity, being purely a _habitus operativus_, confers a supernatural power.

Let us put the matter somewhat differently. Grace inheres in the substance of the soul, while charity has its seat in one of its several faculties. Inhering in the very substance of the soul, grace, by a physical or moral power, produces the three theological virtues—faith, hope, and love. "As the soul's powers, which are the wellsprings of its acts, flow from its essence," says the Angelic Doctor, "so the theological virtues flow from grace into the faculties of the soul and move them to act."(1013) And St. Augustine: "Grace precedes charity."(1014)

This is a more plausible view than the one we have examined a little farther up, and it can claim the authority of Scripture, which, though it occasionally identifies the effects of grace and charity, always clearly distinguishes the underlying habits. Cfr. 2 Cor. XIII, 13: "The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ and the charity of God."(1015) 1 Tim. I 14: "The grace of our Lord hath abounded exceedingly with faith and love."(1016) Furthermore, "regeneration" and "new-creation" in Biblical usage affect not only the faculties of the soul, but its substance. Finally, many councils consistently distinguish between _gratia_ and _caritas_ (_dona_, _virtutes_)—a distinction which has almost the force of a proof that grace and charity are not the same thing.(1017) These councils cannot have had in mind a purely virtual distinction, because theological love presupposes sanctifying grace in exactly the same manner as a faculty presupposes a substance or nature in which it exists. The Roman Catechism expressly designates the theological virtues as "concomitants of grace."(1018)

The question nevertheless remains an open one, as neither party can fully establish its claim, and the Church has never rendered an official decision either one way or the other.(1019)

4. SANCTIFYING GRACE A PARTICIPATION OF THE SOUL IN THE DIVINE NATURE.—The highest and at the same time the most profound conception of sanctifying grace is that it is a real, though of course only accidental and analogical, participation of the soul in the nature of God. That sanctifying grace makes us "partakers of the divine nature" is of faith, but the manner in which it effects this participation admits of different explanations.

a) The fact itself can be proved from Sacred Scripture. Cfr. 2 Pet. I, 4: "By whom [Christ] He [the Father] hath given us great and precious promises: that by these you may be made partakers of the divine nature."(1020) To this text may be added all those which affirm the regeneration of the soul in God, because regeneration, being a new birth, must needs impart to the regenerate the nature of his spiritual progenitor. Cfr. John I, 13: "Who are born, not of blood, ... but of God."(1021) John III, 5: "Unless a man be born again of water and the Holy Ghost, he cannot enter into the kingdom of heaven."(1022) St. James I, 18: "For of his own will hath he begotten us by the word of truth."(1023) 1 John III, 9: "Whosoever is born of God, committeth no sin."(1024)

The Fathers of the Church again and again extol the deification (_deificatio_, θείωσις) of man effected by sanctifying grace and compare the union of the soul with God to the commingling of water with wine, the penetration of iron by fire, etc. St. Athanasius(1025) begins his Christological teaching with the declaration: "He was not, therefore, first man and then God, but first God and then man, in order that He might rather deify us."(1026) St. Augustine describes the process of deification as follows: "He justifies who is just of Himself, not from another; and He deifies who is God of Himself, not by participation in another. But He who justifies also deifies, because He makes [men] sons of God through justification.... We have been made sons of God and gods; but this is a grace of the adopting [God], not the nature of the progenitor. The Son of God alone is God; ... the others who are made gods are made gods by His grace; they are not born of His substance, so as to become that which He is, but in order that they may come to Him by favor and become co-heirs with Christ."(1027) The idea underlying this passage has found its way into the liturgy of the Mass,(1028) and Ripalda is justified in declaring that it cannot be denied without rashness.(1029)

b) In trying to explain in what manner grace enables us to partake of the divine nature, it is well to keep in view the absolutely supernatural character of sanctifying grace and the impossibility of any deification of the creature in the strict sense of the term. The truth lies between these two extremes.

A few medieval mystics(1030) and modern Quietists(1031) were guilty of exaggeration when they taught that grace transforms the human soul into the substance of the Godhead, thus completely merging the creature in its Creator. This contention(1032) leads to Pantheism. How can the soul be merged in the Creator, since it continues to be subject to concupiscence? "We have therefore," says St. Augustine, "even now begun to be like Him, as we have the first-fruits of the Spirit; but yet even now we are unlike Him, by reason of the old nature which leaves its remains in us. In as far, then, as we are like Him, in so far are we, by the

regenerating Spirit, sons of God; but in as far as we are unlike Him, in so far are we the children of the flesh and of this world."(1033)

On the other hand it would be underestimating the power of grace to say that it effects a merely external and moral participation of the soul in the divine nature, similar to that by which those who embraced the faith of Abraham were called "children of Abraham," and those who commit heinous crimes are called "sons of the devil." According to the Fathers(1034) and theologians, to "partake of the divine nature" means to become internally and physically like God and to receive from Him truly divine gifts, _i.e._ such as are proper to God alone and absolutely transcend the order of nature.(1035) Being self-existing, absolutely independent, and infinite, God cannot, of course, be regarded as the formal cause of created sanctity; yet the strictly supernatural gifts which He confers on His creatures, especially the beatific vision and sanctifying grace, can be conceived only _per modum causae formalis_ (not _informantis_), because through them God gives Himself to the creature in such an intimate way that the creature is raised up to and transfigured by Him.(1036) Consequently, the so-called _deificatio_ of the soul by grace is not a real deification, but an assimilation of the creature to God.(1037)

c) Which one of God's numerous attributes forms the basis of the supernatural communication made to the soul in the bestowal of grace, is a question on which theologians differ widely. The so-called incommunicable attributes, (self-existence, immensity, eternity, etc.), of course, cannot be imparted to the creature except by way of a hypostatic union.(1038)

Gonet(1039) misses the point at issue, therefore, when He declares the essential characteristic of deification to be the communication to the creature of the divine attributes of self-existence and infinity. Self-existence is absolutely incommunicable.(1040) Somewhat more plausible, though hardly acceptable, is Ripalda's opinion that deification formally consists in the participation of the creature in the holiness of the Creator, particularly in the supernatural vital communion of the soul with God in faith, hope, and charity, thus making sanctifying grace the _radix totius honestatis moralis_.(1041) While it is perfectly true that the supernatural life of the soul is a life in and through God, and that the very concept of sanctifying grace involves a peculiar and special relation of the soul to God, the Biblical term κοινωνία θείας φύσεως points to a still deeper principle of the sanctifying _vita deiformis_. This principle, as some of the Fathers intimate, and St. Thomas expressly teaches,(1042) is the absolute intellectuality of God. Hence the object of sanctifying grace is to impart to the soul in a supernatural manner such a degree of intellectuality as is necessary to perceive the absolute Spirit—here on earth in the obscurity of faith, and in the life beyond by the _lumen gloriae_.(1043) This view is to a certain extent confirmed by Sacred Scripture, which describes the regeneration of the sinner as a birth of spirit from spirit.(1044) It is also held by some of the Fathers, who attribute to sanctifying grace both a deifying and a spiritualizing power. Thus St. Basil(1045) says: "The spirit-bearing souls, illuminated by the Holy Ghost, themselves become spiritual(1046) and radiate grace to others. Hence ... to become like unto God,(1047) is the highest of all goals: to become God."(1048) Finally, since the Holy Ghost, as the

highest exponent of the spirituality of the divine nature, by His personal indwelling crowns and consummates both the regeneration of the soul and its assimilation to God, there is a strong theological probability in favor of Suarez's view. Of course the process does not attain its climax until the creature is finally admitted to the beatific vision in Heaven. Cfr. 1 John III, 2: "We are now the sons of God, and it hath not yet appeared what we shall be. We know that, when He shall appear, we shall be like to Him, because we shall see Him as He is."(1049)

Article 2. The Effects Of Sanctifying Grace

We shall better understand the nature of sanctifying grace by studying what are known as its "formal effects." As the _causa efficiens_ of a thing is commonly farther removed from our mental grasp than its effects, we are ordinarily more familiar with the latter than with the former. For this reason the glories of divine grace can be best explained to children and to the faithful in general by describing the effects it produces in the soul.(1050)

1. SANCTITY.—The first among the formal effects of sanctifying grace (an effect connoted by its very name) is sanctity. Eph. IV, 24: "Put on the new man, who according to God is created in justice and holiness of truth."(1051) The Tridentine Council explicitly mentions sanctity as an effect of sanctifying grace: "Justification ... is not remission of sins merely, but also the sanctification and renewal of the inward man through the voluntary reception of the grace and of the gifts whereby man from unjust becomes just."(1052) It follows that the two elements of active justification, _viz._: remission of sin and sanctification, are also constitutive elements of habitual or sanctifying grace. For it is precisely by the infusion of sanctifying grace that sin is wiped out and sanctity established in its place.(1053)

a) By sanctifying grace the justified man becomes a living member (_membrum vivum_) of the mystical body of Christ. His sins, it is true, did not forfeit membership in the Church, so long as he preserved the faith, but by sinning he became a dead member who can regain life only by returning to the state of grace. Grace is the life of the soul, sin its death. Hence the evil of mortal sin can be most effectively illustrated by contrast with the glory of divine grace, and _vice versa_. Cfr. Gal. II, 20: "And I live, now not I, but Christ liveth in me."(1054)

b) He who hates mortal sin and faithfully obeys the will of God, enjoys peace of heart,(1055) whereas the sinner is incessantly harassed by qualms of conscience. The faithful Christian rejoices in serving His Master and combats the flesh, the world, and the devil with a fortitude that not infrequently rises to heroic proportions, as the example of many holy men and women proves.

c) Sanctifying grace entails a particular providence, inasmuch as, by means of it, God grants man His special assistance towards preserving the state of grace, without, of course, interfering with free-will. Cfr. Is. XLIX, 16: "Behold, I have graven thee in my hands."(1056) Rom. VIII, 28: "... to them that love God, all things work together unto good."(1057) Mediately, God also proves his special love for the just man by shielding him from bodily and spiritual danger.

2. SUPERNATURAL BEAUTY.—Though we can quote no formal ecclesiastical definition to prove that sanctifying grace beautifies the soul, the fact is sufficiently certain from Revelation. If, as is quite generally held by Catholic exegetes, the Spouse of the Canticle typifies the human soul endowed with sanctifying grace, all the passages describing the beauty of that Spouse must be applicable to the souls of those whom Christ embraces with His tender love. The Fathers of the Church frequently extol the supernatural beauty of the soul in the state of grace. Ambrose calls it "a splendid painting made by God Himself;" Chrysostom compares it to "a statue of gold;" Cyril, to "a divine seal;" Basil, to "a shining light," and so forth. St. Thomas says: "Divine grace beautifies [the soul] like light,"(1058) and the Roman Catechism declares: "Grace ... is a certain splendor and light that effaces all the stains of our souls and renders the souls themselves brighter and more beautiful."(1059)

In defining beauty as "the representation of an idea in a sensual form," modern aesthetics has eliminated the spiritual element and in consequence is unable to appreciate the spiritual beauty of God and of the soul. Being composed of body and soul, man is naturally most impressed by beauty when it appears in a material guise. But this does not prove that there is no spiritual beauty, or that true beauty abides solely in matter. Some present-day writers strongly emphasize the need of realism as against an idealism which, they claim, is not truly human because it exalts the spiritual at the expense of the material. In its last conclusions this perverted realism harks back to the sophistry of Protagoras who held that "man is the measure of all things."(1060) Idealism, on the other hand, is based on the true Platonic doctrine that God is the measure of all things.(1061) St. Augustine defines beauty as "unity in variety," which is a correct definition, because it is adaptable to both the spiritual and the material order.(1062) Applying this definition we find that the soul is not only naturally beautiful by the substantial unity and simplicity which shines forth in the variety of its faculties and powers, but also supernaturally by virtue of sanctifying grace, which transfuses nature into a new unity with the supernatural,—at the same time producing a variety of theological and moral virtues and the seven gifts of the Holy Ghost, and thus creating a true work of art. Moreover, by enabling man to participate in the Divine Nature,(1063) grace produces in the soul a physical reflection of the uncreated beauty of God, a likeness of the creature with its Creator, which far transcends the natural likeness imprinted by creation. True, only God and the Elect in Heaven perceive and enjoy this celestial beauty; but we terrestrial pilgrims can, as it were, sense it from afar and indulge the hope that we may one day be privileged to contemplate and enjoy the divine beauty that envelops the souls endowed with grace.

The beauty produced by sanctifying grace must be conceived not merely as a reflection of the absolute nature of God, who is the pattern-exemplar of all beauty, but more specifically as an image of the Trinity impressed upon the soul. St. Paul teaches that the soul is transformed into an image of the Divine Logos, to whom, as the holy Fathers tell us, beauty is appropriated in an especial manner.(1064) Cfr. Rom. VIII, 29: "Whom he foreknew, he also predestinated to be made conformable to the image of his Son."(1065) Gal. IV, 19: "My little children, of whom I am in labor

again, until Christ be formed in you."(1066) In virtue of the adoptive sonship effected by grace,(1067) the soul becomes a true "temple of the Holy Ghost."(1068)

3. THE FRIENDSHIP OF GOD.—Closely connected with the beauty which sanctifying grace confers, is the supernatural friendship it establishes between God and the soul. True beauty elicits love and benevolence. By nature man is merely a servant of God; in fact, since the fall, he is His enemy. Sanctifying grace transforms this hostile relation into genuine friendship. By grace, says the Council of Trent, "man of unjust becomes just, and of an enemy a friend."(1069) And again: "Having been thus justified and made the friends and domestics of God."(1070) God loves the just man as His intimate friend and enables and impels him, by means of habitual grace and habitual charity, to reciprocate that love with all his heart. Here we have the two constituent elements of friendship. The Bible frequently speaks of friendship existing between God and the just. Cfr. Wisd. VII, 14: "They [the just] become the friends of God."(1071) John XV, 14 sq.: "I will not now call you servants, ... but I have called you friends."(1072) This friendship is sometimes compared to a mystic marriage. Cfr. Matth. IX, 15: "And Jesus said to them: Can the children of the bridegroom mourn, as long as the bridegroom is with them?"(1073) Apoc. XIX, 7: "The marriage of the Lamb is come, and his wife hath prepared herself."(1074)

a) Friendship (φιλία), according to Aristotle,(1075) is "the conscious love of benevolence of two persons for each other." Hence, to constitute friendship, there must be (1) two or more distinct persons; (2) pure love of benevolence _(amor benevolentiae_, not _concupiscentiae_), because only unselfish love can truly unite hearts; (3) mutual consciousness of affection, because without a consciousness of the existing relation on both sides there would be merely one-sided benevolence, not friendship. It follows that true friendship is based on virtue and that a relation not based on virtue can be called friendship in a qualified or metaphorical sense only (_amicitia utilis, delectabilis_).

From what we have said it is easy to deduce the essential characteristics of true friendship. They are: (1) benevolence; (2) love consciously entertained by both parties; (3) a mutual exchange of goods or community of life; (4) equality of rank or station. The first condition is based on the fact that a true friend will not seek his own interest, but that of his friend. It is to be noted, however, that one's joy at the presence or prosperity of a friend must not be inspired by selfishness or sensual desire, for in that case there would be no true friendship.(1076) The second condition is based on the necessity of friendship being mutual love, for friendship is not a one-sided affection, nor does it spend itself in mutual admiration. The third condition is necessary for the reason that love, if it is to be more than "Platonic," must result in acts of benevolence and good will.(1077) Of the fourth condition St. Jerome says: "Friendship finds men equal or makes them equal."(1078)

b) All these conditions are found in the friendship with which Almighty God deigns to honor those who are in the state of sanctifying grace.

(1) That God loves the just man with a love of pure benevolence and eagerly seeks his companionship, is proved by the mysteries of the Incarnation and the Holy

Eucharist. Cfr. Prov. VIII, 31: “And my delight [is] to be with the children of men.”(1079)

(2) The just man is enabled to return God’s love by the habit of theological charity, which is inseparably bound up with and spontaneously flows from sanctifying grace.(1080) God’s consciousness of this mutual love is, of course, based on certain knowledge, whereas man can have merely a probable conjecture. This, however, suffices to establish a true friendship, as the example of human friends shows.(1081)

(3) There is also community of life and property between God and man when the latter is in the state of sanctifying grace; for not only is he indebted to God for his very nature and all natural favors which he enjoys, but likewise and especially for the supernatural blessings bestowed upon him.(1082) On his own part, it is true, he cannot give his Benefactor anything in return which that Benefactor does not already possess; but the just man is ever eager to further God’s external glorification, agreeable to the first petition of the Our Father: “Hallowed by Thy name.”(1083) God has furthermore given him a kind of substitute for operative charity in the love of his neighbor, which has precisely the same formal object as the love of God. Cfr. 1 John III, 17: “He that hath the substance of this world, and shall see his brother in need, and shall shut up his bowels from him: how doth the charity of God abide in him?”(1084)

(4) There can be no real equality between God and the human soul, but God in His infinite goodness, elevating the soul to a higher plane and allowing it to participate in His own nature,(1085) makes possible an _amicitia excellentiae s. eminentiae_, which is sufficient to constitute a true relation of friendship. Without this elevation of the soul by grace there could be no friendship between God and man.(1086)

4. ADOPTIVE SONSHIP.—The formal effects of sanctifying grace culminate in the elevation of man to the rank of an adopted child of God (_filius Dei adoptivus_), with a claim to the paternal inheritance, _i.e._ the beatific vision in Heaven. This truth is so clearly stated in Scripture and Tradition that its denial would be heretical. The Tridentine Council summarily describes justification as “the state of grace and of the adoption of the sons of God,”(1087) The teaching of Holy Scripture can be gathered from such texts as the following. Rom. VIII, 15 sqq.: “... You have received the spirit of adoption of sons, whereby we cry: Abba (Father). For the spirit himself giveth testimony to our spirit, that we are the sons of God. And if sons, heirs also; heirs indeed of God, and joint heirs with Christ.”(1088) 1 John III, 1 sq.: “Behold what manner of charity the Father hath bestowed upon us, that we should be called, and should be the sons of God.... Dearly beloved, we are now the sons of God.”(1089) Gal. IV, 5: “... that we might receive the adoption of sons.”(1090) That the just become the adopted sons of God follows likewise as a corollary from the doctrine of regeneration so frequently taught by Scripture. This regeneration is not a procession of the soul from the divine essence, but a kind of accidental and analogical procreation substantially identical with adoption (_filiatio adoptiva_, υἱοθεσία). Cfr. John I, 12 sq.: “... He gave them power to be made the sons of God, ... who are born ... of God.”(1091)

a) St. Thomas defines adoption as “the gratuitous acceptance of a child of other parents to be the same as one’s own child and heir.”(1092) Adoption implies (1) that the adopted child be a stranger to the adopting father; (2) that it have no legal claim to adoption; (3) that it give its consent to being adopted; (4) that it be received by the adopting father with parental love and affection. All these elements are present, in a far higher and more perfect form, in the adoption of a soul by God.

(1) The rational creature, as such, is not a “son” but merely a “servant of God,”(1093) and, if he be in the state of mortal sin, His enemy.

(2) That adoption is a gratuitous favor on the part of the Almighty, follows from the fact that the adopted creature is His enemy and that grace is a free supernatural gift, to which no creature has a natural claim. Adoption furthermore implies the right of inheritance.(1094) The heritage of the children of God is a purely spiritual possession which can be enjoyed simultaneously by many, and consequently excels every natural heritage. Men, as a rule, do not distribute their property during life, while, after their death, it is usually divided up among several heirs.(1095)

(3) Whereas adoption among men owes its existence to the desire of offspring on the part of childless parents, the adoption of the soul by God springs from pure benevolence and unselfish love, and for this reason presupposes (in the case of adults) the free consent of the adopted. No one can become an adopted son of God against his will.(1096)

(4) Whereas human adoption supposes substantial equality between father and child, and therefore at best amounts to no more than a legal acceptance, adoption by God elevates the soul to a higher level by allowing it to participate in the Divine Nature, and consequently is a true (even though merely an accidental and analogical) regeneration in God.

b) From what we have said it follows—and this is a truth of considerable speculative importance—that there are essential points of difference as well as of resemblance between Jesus Christ, the true Son of God, and the justified sinner adopted by the Heavenly Father.

α) The difference between the “natural Son of God” and an “adopted son” is exactly like that between God and creature. The Logos-Son, engendered by eternal generation from the divine substance, is the true natural Son of the Father, the Second Person of the Divine Trinity, and Himself God.(1097) The just man, on the other hand, is a child of God merely by the possession of sanctifying grace,(1098) which can be lost by mortal sin and consequently is founded upon a free relation that may be terminated by man as freely as it was entered into between himself and God.

Intimately related to this distinction is another:—Christ is the Son of the Father alone, the just man is an adopted child of the whole Trinity.(1099) This fact does not, however, prevent us from “appropriating” adoptive sonship to each of the three Divine Persons according to His peculiar hypostatic character:—the Father as its author, the Son as its pattern, and the Holy Ghost as its conveyor.(1100) Now, if Christ, as the true Son of God, is the efficient cause (_causa efficiens_) of that adoptive sonship of which, as God, He is also the pattern-exemplar (_causa

exemplaris_), it follows that He cannot be an adopted son of God. "_Christus est incapax adoptionis_," as Suarez puts it.(1101) To say that He is both the natural and an adopted Son of God would be heretical.(1102) Consequently, sanctifying grace, in Him, did not exercise one of the functions it invariably exercises in the souls of men, _i.e._ it did not make Him an adopted son of God.

β) It is to be noted, however, that the unique position enjoyed by our Lord gives rise, not only to essential distinctions but also to an equal number of analogies between the Only-begotten Son of God and His adopted sons. The first and most fundamental of these analogies is the attribution of the common appellation "son of God" both to Christ and to the just. Though Christ is the only true Son of God, the Heavenly Father has nevertheless charitably "bestowed upon us, that we should be called, and should be, the sons of God."(1103) According to John I, 13, Christ "gave power to be made the sons of God" to them "who are born ... of God." Hence divine sonship formally consists in an impression of the hypostatic likeness of the Only-begotten Son of God, by which the soul in a mysterious manner becomes an image of the Trinity, and especially of the Only-begotten Son of God, who is the archetype and pattern-exemplar of adoptive sonship. This hypostatic propriety and exemplariness was the reason why the Second Person of the Trinity became man.(1104) That the soul of the justified is transformed into "an image of the Son of God" is expressly taught by the Greek Fathers. Thus St. Cyril of Alexandria says: "Christ is truly formed in us, inasmuch as the Holy Ghost impresses on us a certain divine likeness by means of sanctity and justice.... But if any one is formed in Christ, he is formed into a child of God."(1105)

These considerations also explain the points of resemblance between the adoptive sonship of God and the Holy Eucharist. Being our Father by adoption, God is bound to provide us with food worthy of a divine progenitor. The food He gives us (the Holy Eucharist) corresponds to our dignity as His children, sustains us in this sublime relation, and at the same time constitutes the pledge of a glorious resurrection and an eternal beatitude.

c) Is the adoptive sonship of the children of God constituted entirely by sanctifying grace, or does it require for its full development the personal indwelling in the soul of the Holy Ghost?(1106) This subtle question formed the subject of an interesting controversy between Joseph Scheeben and Theodore Granderath, S. J. Father Granderath claimed on the authority of the Tridentine Council that divine sonship is an inseparable function of sanctifying grace, and through that grace alone, without the _inhabitatio Spiritus Sancti_, constitutes the _unica causa formalis_ of justification. Against this theory Dr. Scheeben maintained with great acumen and, we think, successfully, that sanctifying grace of itself alone, without the aid of any other factor, not only completely justifies the sinner but raises him to the rank of an adopted son of God, though there is nothing to prevent us from holding that the indwelling of the Holy Ghost forms the climax of the process, and develops and perfects the already existing _filiatio adoptiva_.(1107)

Petavius had contended(1108) that the just men of the Old Testament, though in the state of sanctifying grace, were not adopted children of God, because the _filiatio

adoptiva_ is an exclusive privilege of those living under the Christian Dispensation. This theory became untenable when the Tridentine Council defined sanctity and adoptive sonship as inseparable formal effects of sanctifying grace. There can no longer be any doubt, therefore, that the patriarchs, together with sanctifying grace also enjoyed the privilege of adoptive sonship, though, as Suarez observes,(1109) adoptive sonship under the Old Covenant depended both as to origin and value upon the adoptive sonship of the New Testament, and therefore was inferior to it in both respects.(1110)

READINGS:—Scheeben, _Lehrbuch der Dogmatik_, Vol. II, § 168 sqq., Freiburg 1878.—J. Kirschkamp, _Gnade und Glorie in ihrem inneren Zusammenhang_, Würzburg 1878.—P. Hagg, _Die Reichtümer der göttlichen Gnade und die Schwere ihres Verlustes_, Ratisbon 1889.—Card. Katschthaler, _De Gratia Sanctificante_, 3rd ed., Salzburg 1886.—P. Einig, _De Gratia Divina_, Part II, Treves 1896.—Heinrich-Gutberlet, _Dogmatische Theologie_, Vol. VIII, pp. 575 sqq., Mainz 1897.—Scheeben, _Die Herrlichkeiten der göttlichen Gnade_, 8th ed., by A. M. Weiss, O. P., Freiburg 1908 (English translation, _The Glories of Divine Grace_, 3rd ed., New York _s. a._).—Th. Bourges, O. P., _L'Ordre Surnaturel et le Devoir Chrétien_, Paris 1901.—*B. Terrien, _La Grâce et la Gloire ou la Filiation Adoptive des Enfants de Dieu Etudiée dans sa Réalité, ses Principes, son Perfectionnement et son Couronnement Final_, 2 vols., Paris 1897.—*P. Villada, _De Effectibus Formalibus Gratiae Habitualis_, Valladolid 1899.—L. Hubert, _De Gratia Sanctificante_, Paris 1902.

Article 3. The Supernatural Concomitants Of Sanctifying Grace

Besides producing the effects described in the preceding Article, sanctifying grace also confers certain supernatural privileges, which, though not of the essence of grace, are, in the present economy at least, inseparably connected with it and may therefore be regarded as its regular concomitants.

The existence of these privileges is established by the fact that certain councils (_e.g._ those of Vienne and Trent), couple "grace and gifts" in their official definitions.(1111) The doctrine is clearly stated by the Roman Catechism as follows: "To this [sanctifying grace] is added a most noble accompaniment of all virtues, which are divinely infused into the soul together with grace."(1112)

We will treat of the supernatural concomitants of sanctifying grace in four theses.

Thesis I: The three divine virtues of faith, hope, and charity are infused into the soul simultaneously with sanctifying grace.

Some theologians (notably Suarez, Ripalda, and De Lugo) declare this thesis to be _de fide_, while others (Dom. Soto, Melchior Cano, and Vasquez) hold it merely as certain. Under the circumstances it will be safest to take middle ground by characterizing it as _fidei proxima_.

Proof. The Council of Trent teaches: "Man through Jesus Christ, in whom he is ingrafted, receives, in the said justification, together with the remission of sins, all these [gifts] infused at once—faith, hope, and charity."(1113)

a) That theological charity, as a habit, is infused together with sanctifying grace can be convincingly demonstrated from Holy Scripture. Cfr. Rom. V, 5: "… the charity of God is poured forth in our hearts by the Holy Ghost, who is given to us."(1114) In connection with charity, Holy Scripture frequently mentions faith. Cfr. 1 Cor. XIII, 2: "And if I should have … all faith, so that I could remove mountains, and have not charity, I am nothing."(1115) All three of the theological virtues are expressly enumerated in 1 Cor. XIII, 13: "And now there remain faith, hope, and charity, these three: but the greatest of these is charity."(1116) Unlike certain other texts, the one last quoted leaves no doubt that faith, hope, and charity are to be conceived as _dona inhaerentia_, _i.e._ habits or qualities inherent in the soul. This interpretation is approved by the Fathers and Scholastics.

b) St. Thomas proves the necessity of the three theological virtues for salvation as follows: "In order that we be properly moved towards our end [God], that end must be both known and desired. Desire of an end includes two things: first, hope of attaining it, because no prudent man will aspire to that which he cannot attain; and secondly, love, because nothing is desired that is not loved. And hence there are three theological virtues,—faith, by which we know God; hope, by which we trust to obtain Him; and charity, by which we love Him."(1117)

When are the three theological virtues infused into the soul? This is an open question so far as faith and hope are concerned. Of charity we know that it is always infused with habitual grace. Suarez contends that, when the soul is properly disposed, faith and hope are infused before justification proper, that is to say, in the process leading up to it. St. Thomas and St. Bonaventure, on the other hand, hold that faith and hope, like charity, are infused at the moment when justification actually takes place in the soul. This last-mentioned opinion is favored by the Tridentine Council.(1118)

Mortal sin first destroys sanctifying grace together with the habit of charity that is inseparable from it. Faith and hope may continue to exist in the soul, and if hope, too, departs, faith may remain alone. But the loss of faith invariably entails the destruction of hope and charity.

Thesis II: Together with sanctifying grace there are also infused the supernatural moral virtues.

This proposition may be characterized as _sententia communior et probabilior_. Though denied by some theologians, it can claim a high degree of probability.(1119)

Proof. The infused moral virtues (_virtutes morales infusae_) differ from the theological virtues in that they have for their immediate formal object, not God Himself, but the creature in its relation to the moral law.

The moral virtues may be reduced to four, _viz._: prudence, justice, fortitude, and temperance. These are called the "cardinal" virtues; first, because they perfect the principal faculties of the soul; secondly, because all the other virtues may be scientifically deduced from them.(1120) In the supernatural order the infusion of the cardinal virtues and of the other virtues subordinate to them has for its object the government of intellect and will in their relation towards created things and the

guidance of these faculties to their supernatural end.

a) The existence of supernaturally infused moral virtues is intimated in Wis. VIII, 7: “And if a man love justice: her labors have great virtues; for she teacheth temperance, and prudence, and justice, and fortitude, which are such things as men can have nothing more profitable in life.”(1121) The teacher of the three cardinal virtues here mentioned is “Divine Wisdom,” _i.e._ God Himself, and we may assume that He inculcates them by the same method which He employs in infusing the theological virtues of faith, hope, and charity.

Another relevant text is Ezechiel XI, 19 sq.: “... and I will take away the stony heart out of their flesh, and give them a heart of flesh, that they may walk in my commandments, and keep my judgments.”(1122) Here Yahweh promises to give the just men of the New Covenant a “heart of flesh” as opposed to the “stony heart” of the Jews. The meaning evidently is that a disposition to do good will be a characteristic of the New Testament Christians in contradistinction to the hardhearted Old Testament Jews. He who has a “heart of flesh” will walk in God’s commandments and keep His judgments. Hence “heart” signifies the sum-total of all those habits which impel and enable a man to lead a good life. Since it is God Himself who gives the “heart of flesh,” _i.e._ the moral virtues, it follows that they are supernaturally infused.(1123)

b) Some of the Fathers ascribe the moral virtues directly to divine infusion.

Thus St. Augustine observes that the cardinal virtues “are given to us through the grace of God.”(1124) And St. Gregory the Great says that the Holy Ghost does “not desert the hearts of those who are perfect in faith, hope, and charity, and in those other goods without which no man can attain to the heavenly fatherland.”(1125) St. Thomas shows the theological reason for this by pointing to the parallel that exists between nature and the supernatural. “Effects,” he says, “must always be proportionate to their causes and principles. Now all virtues, intellectual and moral, which we acquire by our acts, proceed from certain natural principles preëxisting in us.... In lieu of these natural principles God confers on us the theological virtues, by which we are directed to a supernatural end.... Hence there must correspond to these theological virtues, proportionally, other habits caused in us by God, and which bear the same relation to the theological virtues that the moral and intellectual virtues bear to the natural principles of virtue.”(1126)

Thesis III: The seven gifts of the Holy Ghost are also infused with sanctifying grace.

This proposition may be qualified as “_probabilis_.”

Proof. The Church’s teaching with regard to the seven gifts of the Holy Ghost is based on Isaias XI, 2 sq.: “And the spirit of the Lord shall rest upon him: the spirit of wisdom, and of understanding, the spirit of counsel, and of fortitude, the spirit of knowledge, and of godliness. And he shall be filled with the spirit of the fear of the Lord.” Four of these supernatural gifts (wisdom, understanding, counsel, and knowledge) perfect the intellect in matters pertaining to salvation, while the remaining three (fortitude, godliness, and the fear of the Lord) direct the will to its

supernatural end. Are these seven gifts, (or some of them), really distinct from the infused moral virtues? Are they habits or habitual dispositions, or merely transient impulses or inspirations? What are their mutual relations and how can they be divided off from one another? These and similar questions are in dispute among theologians. The prevailing opinion is that the gifts of the Holy Ghost are infused habitual dispositions, _realiter_ distinct from the theological and moral virtues, by which the soul is endowed with a supernatural capacity for receiving the inspirations of the Holy Ghost and a supernatural readiness to obey His impulses in all important matters pertaining to salvation.(1127)

That the gifts of the Holy Ghost are infused into the soul simultaneously with sanctifying grace, can be demonstrated as follows: Christ, as the mystical head, is the pattern of justification for the members of His spiritual body, who are united to Him by sanctifying grace.(1128) Now the Holy Ghost dwelled in Christ with all His gifts as permanent habits.(1129) Consequently, these gifts are imparted by infusion to those who receive the grace of justification. This is manifestly the belief of the Church, for she prays in the "_Veni Sancte Spiritus_":

"Shed upon thy faithful fold, By unbounded hope controlled, Thy seven gifts."(1130)

Thesis IV: The process of justification reaches its climax in the personal indwelling of the Holy Ghost in the soul of the just.

This thesis embodies what is technically called a _propositio certa_.

Proof. There are two ways in which God may dwell in the soul, either by virtue of His created grace (_inhabitatio per dona accidentalia_, ἐνοίκησις κατ᾽ ἐνέργειαν) or by virtue of His uncreated substance (_inhabitatio substantialis sive personalis_, ἐνοίκησις κατ᾽ οὐσίαν). The personal indwelling of the Holy Ghost, therefore, may consist in a twofold grace: _gratia creata_ and _gratia increata_, of which the former is the groundwork and necessary condition of the latter, while the latter may be described as the climax and consummation of the former.(1131) The indwelling of the Holy Ghost in the souls of the just is taught by Holy Scripture and attested by the Fathers.

a) Holy Scripture draws a clear-cut distinction between the accidental and the substantial indwelling of the Holy Ghost.

α) Our Lord Himself, in addition to the charismata, promised His Apostles the Holy Ghost in Person. John XIV, 16 sq.: "... the Father ... shall give you another Paraclete, that he may abide with you for ever, ... but you shall know him, because he shall abide with you, and shall be in you."(1132) This promise was made to all the faithful. Cfr. Rom. V, 5: "... the charity of God is poured forth in our hearts by the Holy Ghost, who is given to us."(1133) Hence the Holy Ghost abides in the just and sets up His throne in their souls. Cfr. Rom. VIII, 11: "And if the spirit of him that raised up Jesus from the dead, dwell in you; he that raised up Jesus Christ from the dead shall quicken also your mortal bodies, because of his Spirit that dwelleth in you."(1134) By His indwelling our souls become temples of God. 1 Cor. III, 16 sq.: "Know you not that you are the temple of God, and that the Spirit of God dwelleth in you?... For the

temple of God is holy, which you are."(1135) 1 Cor. VI, 19: "Or know you not that your members are the temple of the Holy Ghost, who is in you, whom you have from God; and you are not your own?"(1136)

β) Agreeable to this teaching of Scripture the Fathers, especially those of the East, assert the substantial indwelling of the Holy Ghost in the souls of the just.

The fact that no one but God can dwell substantially and personally in a creature was cited by the Greek Fathers in their controversies with the Pneumatomachians to prove the divinity of the Holy Ghost. St. Athanasius writes to Serapion:(1137) "If we by receiving the Holy Ghost are allowed to participate in the Divine Nature, no one but a fool will assert that the Holy Ghost is not of divine but of human nature. For all those in whom He abides become deified(1138) for no other reason. But if He constitutes them gods, there can be no doubt that His nature is divine." St. Basil comments as follows on Ps. LXXXI, 6 (_Ego dixi, dii estis_): "But the Spirit that causes the gods to be gods, must be divine, and from God, ... and God."(1139) St. Cyril of Alexandria(1140) glowingly describes the soul inhabited by the Holy Ghost as inlaid with gold, transfused by fire, filled with the sweet odor of balsam, and so forth.

The Latin Fathers, with one exception, are less definite on this point. St. Augustine says that the Holy Ghost "is given as a gift of God in such a way that He Himself also gives Himself as being God,"(1141) and that "the grace of God is a gift of God, but the greatest gift is the Holy Spirit Himself, who therefore is called a grace."(1142) Again: "... the Holy Spirit is the gift of God, the gift being Himself indeed equal to the giver, and therefore the Holy Ghost also is God, not inferior to the Father and the Son."(1143)

b) While theologians are unanimous in accepting the doctrine of the personal indwelling of the Holy Ghost in the just as clearly contained in Sacred Scripture and Tradition, they differ in explaining the manner in which He dwells in the soul.

α) The great majority hold that the Holy Ghost can not dwell in the soul, as the human soul dwells in the body, _per modum informationis_, nor yet by a hypostatic union, as godhead and manhood dwell together in the Person of Christ; and that consequently His indwelling is objectively an indwelling of the whole Trinity, which is appropriated to the Third Person merely because the Holy Ghost is "hypostatic holiness" or "personal love." This view is based on what is called "the fundamental law of the Trinity," _viz._: "In God all things are one except where there is opposition of relation."(1144) Sacred Scripture speaks of the personal indwelling of the Father and the Son as well as of the Holy Ghost. Cfr. John XIV, 23: "If any one love me, he will keep my word, and my Father will love him, and we will come to him and will make our abode with him."(1145) St. Athanasius concludes from these words that "the _energia_ of the Trinity is one.... Indeed when the Lord says: I and the Father will come, the Spirit also comes, to dwell in us in precisely the same manner in which the Son dwells in us."(1146) And St. Augustine teaches: "Love, therefore, which is of God and is God, is properly the Holy Spirit, by whom the love of God is shed abroad in our hearts,—that love by which the whole Trinity dwells in us."(1147) Accordingly, the personal indwelling of the Holy Ghost consists in the state of grace as bearing a

special relation to the Third Person of the Trinity; the “higher nature” which sanctifying grace imparts to the soul is not an absolute but a relative form (σχέσις), by which the soul is mysteriously united with the Three Divine Persons and, by appropriation, with the Holy Ghost, thereby becoming a throne and temple of God. It is in this sense that the indwelling of the Holy Ghost in the soul is called the climax of justification.(1148)

β) Other eminent theologians (Petavius, Passaglia, Schrader, Scheeben, Hurter, _et al._) regard the explanation just given as unsatisfactory. They contend that the Fathers, especially those of the East, conceived the indwelling of the Holy Ghost in the souls of the just, not as an indwelling (ἐνοίκησις) of the Trinity, appropriated to the Holy Ghost, but as a union (ἕνωσις) of the Holy Ghost Himself with the soul.(1149) This union, they say, is neither physical nor hypostatic, but an altogether unique and inexplicable relation by which the soul is morally, accidentally, and actively united to the person of the Holy Ghost.(1150)

γ) Unfortunately this exalted and mystic theory cannot be squared with the theological principles underlying the Catholic teaching on the Trinity, especially that portion of it which concerns the appropriations and missions of the three Divine Persons.(1151) It is true that sanctifying grace culminates in a communication of the Divine Nature, and that this θείωσις is effected by imprinting upon the soul an image of the divine processes of generation and spiration,—the first by adoptive filiation, the second by an indwelling of the Holy Ghost.(1152) In fact all the Trinitarian relations are reflected in the justification of the sinner. Thus regeneration corresponds to the generation of the Logos by the Father; adoptive sonship and the accompanying participation of the soul in the Divine Nature corresponds to our Lord’s natural sonship and his consubstantiality with the Father; the indwelling of the Holy Ghost and His union with the soul, on the other hand, corresponds to the divine process of Spiration, inasmuch as it is preëminently a supernatural union of love and effects a sort of mutual inexistence or perichoresis of the soul in the Holy Ghost or the three Divine Persons respectively.(1153) Since, however, this union of the soul with the substance of the three Divine Persons in general, and the Holy Ghost in particular, is not a substantial and physical but only an accidental and moral union, the regeneration of the sinner must be conceived as generation in a metaphorical sense only, divine sonship as adoptive sonship, the deification of man as a weak imitation of the divine _homoousia_, and the indwelling of the Holy Spirit in the soul as a shadowy analogue of the Divine Perichoresis.(1154)

READINGS:—Deharbe, _Die vollkommene Liebe Gottes nach dem hl. Thomas von Aquin_, Ratisbon 1856.—Marchant, _Die theologischen Tugenden_, Ratisbon 1864.—Mazzella, _De Virtutibus Infusis_, 4th ed., Rome 1894.—G. Lahousse, S. J., _De Virtutibus Theologicis_, Louvain 1890.—S. Schiffini, S. J., _Tractatus de Virtutibus Infusis_, Freiburg 1904.—J. Kirschkamp, _Der Geist des Katholizismus in der Lehre vom Glauben und von der Liebe_, Paderborn 1894.—C. Weiss, _S. Thomae Aquinatis de Septem Donis Spiritus Sancti Doctrina Proposita et Explicata_, Vienna 1895.

On the indwelling of the Holy Ghost in the souls of the just see A. Scholz, _De Inhabitatione Spiritus Sancti_, Würzburg 1856.—*Franzelin, _De Deo Trino_, pp. 625

sqq., Rome 1881.—Oberdörffer, _De Inhabitatione Spiritus Sancti in Animabus Iustorum_, Tournai 1890.—* B. Froget, O. P., _De l'Inhabitation du S. Esprit dans les Âmes Justes d'après la Doctrine de S. Thomas d'Aquin_, Paris 1901.—De Bellevue, _L'Oeuvre du S. Esprit ou la Sanctification des Âmes_, Paris 1901.

On the historic development of the dogma see Schwane, _Dogmengeschichte_, 2nd ed., Vol. II, § 56-75, Freiburg 1895.

Section 3. The Properties Of Sanctifying Grace

By a property (_proprium_, ἴδιον) we understand a quality which, though not part of the essence of a thing, necessarily flows from that essence by some sort of causation and is consequently found in all individuals of the same species.(1155) A property, as such, is opposed to an accident (_accidens_, συμβεβηκός), which is neither part of, nor necessarily attached to, the essence, but may or may not be present in the individual. Thus the ability to laugh is a property of human nature, whereas the color of the skin is an accident.

How do the properties of grace differ from its formal effects, and from its supernatural concomitants? The formal effects of grace, as we have seen, are the elements constituting its nature, the properties are determinations necessarily flowing from that nature, while the supernatural concomitants are free gifts superadded by God.

According to the Protestant theory, justification is absolutely certain, equal in all men, and incapable of being lost. The Catholic Church, on the contrary, teaches that justification is (1) uncertain, (2) unequal, and (3) amissible. We will explain this teaching in three theses.

Thesis I: No man knows with certainty of faith whether he is justified or not.

This proposition is _de fide_.

Proof. The Tridentine Council rejected the "fiduciary faith"(1156) of Luther as "an empty heretical confidence,"(1157) and in three distinct canons denied the properties attributed to faith by the early Protestant dogmaticians.(1158)

a) Holy Scripture again and again warns us that we can never be sure of our salvation. St. Paul, though himself "a vessel of election," freely admits: "I am not conscious to myself of any thing, yet I am not hereby justified; but he that judgeth me is the Lord,"(1159) and declares: "I chastise my body and bring it into subjection, lest perhaps, when I have preached to others, I myself should become a castaway."(1160) He exhorts the faithful to work out their salvation "with fear and trembling."(1161)

b) The Fathers also teach the uncertainty of justification in the individual, and attribute it to the fact that, while we know that God pardons penitent sinners, no man can be entirely certain that he has complied with all the conditions necessary for justification.

"Our fate," says St. Chrysostom, "is uncertain for a number of reasons, one of which is that many of our own works are hidden from us."(1162) St. Jerome,

commenting on Eccles. IX, 1 sq.,(1163) observes: “In the future they will know all, and all things are manifest to them, that is to say, the knowledge of this matter will precede them when they depart this life, because _then_ the judgment will be pronounced, while _now_ we are still battling, and it is now uncertain whether those who bear adversities, bear them for the love of God, like Job, or because they hate Him, as do many sinners.”(1164) Pope St. Gregory the Great said to a noble matron who asked him whether she could be sure of her salvation: “You ask me something which is both useless and difficult [to answer]; difficult, because I am unworthy to receive a revelation; useless, because it is better that you be uncertain with regard to your sins, lest in your last hour you should be unable to repent.”(1165)

c) We now proceed to the theological explanation of the dogma embodied in our thesis.

α) The purpose of this dogma is not, as Harnack(1166) thinks, “partly to assuage and partly to excite the restlessness that still remains, by means of the sacraments, indulgences, liturgical worship and ecclesiastical encouragement of mystical and monkish practices,” but to prevent undue security and careless assurance. What the Church condemns, in accordance with Sacred Scripture and Tradition, is the _certitudo fidei_, that vain confidence which leads men to feel certain that they are in the state of grace (_inanis fiducia_), not the _certitudo spei_, _i.e._ humble trust in God’s abundant mercy. “As no pious person ought to doubt of the mercy of God, of the merit of Christ, and of the virtue and efficacy of the sacraments,” says the Tridentine Council, “even so each one, when he regards himself and his own weakness and indisposition, may have fear and apprehension touching his own grace; seeing that no one can know with a certainty of faith, which cannot be subject to error, that he has obtained the grace of God.”(1167)

One needs but to apply to theology the epistemological principles and criteria furnished by philosophy to perceive that the Catholic dogma is as reasonable as the Protestant theory is absurd. The Protestant syllogism: “I know with a certainty of faith that the penitent sinner who does his share, is justified through the grace of Christ; now, I, who am a penitent sinner, know with a certainty of faith that I have done my share; therefore, I know with a certainty of faith that I am justified,” may be formally correct, but the minor premise embodies a material error, because no man knows with a certainty of faith that he has done his share, unless it be specially revealed to him by God. No matter how sure I may feel of my own goodness, I have no certainty of faith, such as that which Mary Magdalen had, or that which was vouchsafed to the penitent thief on the cross, that I am justified. It is one of the approved rules of syllogistic reasoning that “the conclusion must follow the weaker premiss.”(1168) Hence, in the above syllogism the certainty cannot be of faith, but human and moral only. We do not mean to deny that God may grant to this or that individual a certainty of faith with regard to his justification; in fact theologians expressly teach that in such a rare and exceptional case the privileged person would be obliged to believe in his own justification, _fide divinâ_.(1169)

β) Can any one, without a special revelation, be _theologically_ certain that he is justified? Theological certainty (_certitudo theologica_) is the result of a syllogism

which embodies an article of faith in one of its premises and an obvious truth of reason in the other. Ambrosius Catharinus(1170) stands alone among Catholic theologians in holding that there are rare cases in which men do have a theological certainty as to their justification without a private revelation. All other writers deny the possibility: (1) because Scripture and Tradition do not countenance the proposition; (2) because there are no criteria available for such certainty outside of private revelation, and (3) because the Tridentine Council censured the assertion "that they who are truly justified must needs, without any doubt whatever, settle within themselves that they are justified."(1171)

γ) For precisely the same reasons no man can be _metaphysically_ certain of his own justification. Hence there remains only _moral_ certainty. Moral certainty admits of varying degrees. The highest degree of moral certainty concerning justification can be had in the case of baptized infants, though, of course, we can never be metaphysically certain even in regard to them, because there is always room for doubt as to the intention of the minister and the validity of the matter and form employed in the administration of the sacrament. In the case of adults, certainty regarding justification varies in proportion to the measure in which it can be ascertained whether one has complied with all the requirements demanded by God. However, certainty may be so great as to exclude all reasonable doubt. St. Paul says: "I am sure that neither death nor life ... shall be able to separate us from the love of God, which is in Christ Jesus our Lord."(1172) And St. Augustine: "What do we know? We know that we have passed from death to life. Whence do we know this? Because we love our brethren. Let no one ask another. Let each question his own heart; if he there finds fraternal charity, let him be sure that he has passed from death to life."(1173) This teaching has led theologians to set up certain criteria by which the faithful may be relieved of unreasonable anxiety and obtain some sort of assurance as to the condition of their souls. Such criteria are: a taste for things spiritual; contempt of earthly pleasures; zeal and perseverance in doing good; love of prayer and pious meditation; patience in suffering and adversity; a fervent devotion to the Blessed Virgin Mary; frequent reception of the sacraments, etc.(1174)

Thesis II: Sanctifying grace admits of degrees and therefore can be increased by good works.

Both propositions contained in this thesis are _de fide_.

Proof. The Protestant contention that the grace of justification is shared in an equal measure by all the justified, was a logical deduction from Luther's false principle that men are justified by faith alone through the external justice of Christ. If this were true, good works would be superfluous, and all Christians would enjoy an equal measure of grace. Luther formally asserted this in his sermon on the nativity of the Blessed Virgin: "All we who are Christians are equally great and holy with the Mother of God."(1175) The Catholic Church rejects this teaching. She holds that justification is an intrinsic process by which the justice and holiness of Christ becomes our own through sanctifying grace, and that consequently sanctifying grace may be present in the soul in a greater or less degree, according to the liberality of God and the disposition of the individual Christian, and those who are in the state of

grace may augment it by good works. The Council of Trent formally defines these truths when it says: “[We receive] justice within us, each one according to his own measure, which the Holy Ghost distributes to every one as He wills, and according to each one’s proper disposition and coöperation.”(1176) And: “[The justified], faith coöperating with good works, increase in that justice which they have received through the grace of Christ, and are still further justified....”(1177) The second and more important of these truths is re-iterated and emphasized in the canons of Session VI: “If anyone saith that the justice received is not preserved and also increased before God through good works, but that those works are merely the fruits and signs of justification obtained, but not a cause of the increase thereof: let him be anathema.”(1178)

a) The Tridentine Fathers base their teaching on a number of Scriptural texts which either expressly declare or presuppose that grace is capable of being increased in the soul after justification.

Thus we read in Prov. IV, 18: “The path of the just, as a shining light, goeth forwards and increaseth even to perfect day.”(1179) Ecclus. XVIII, 22: “Let nothing hinder thee from praying always, and be not afraid to be justified even to death: for the reward of God continueth for ever.”(1180) 2 Pet. III, 18: “Grow in grace and in the knowledge of our Lord and Saviour Jesus Christ.”(1181) 2 Cor. IX, 10: “[God] will increase the growth of the fruits of your justice.”(1182) Eph. IV, 7: “But to every one of us is given grace, according to the measure of the giving of Christ.”(1183) Apoc. XXII, 11 sq.: “He that is just, let him be justified still; and he that is holy, let him be sanctified still. Behold, I come quickly, and my reward is with me, to render to every man according to his works.”(1184)

Such texts could easily be multiplied.

b) Tradition found definite utterance as early as the fourth century.

When Jovinian attempted to revive the Stoic theory of the absolute equality of all virtues and vices, he met with strenuous opposition on the part of St. Jerome, who wrote a special treatise _Contra Iovinianum_, in which he said: “Each of us receives grace according to the measure of the grace of Christ (Eph. IV, 7); not as if the measure of Christ were unequal, but so much of His grace is infused into us as we are capable of receiving.”(1185) St. Augustine teaches that the just are as unequal as the sinners. “The saints are clad with justice (Job XXIX, 14), some more, some less; and no one on this earth lives without sin, some more, some less: but the best is he who has least.”(1186) But, we are told, life as such is not capable of being increased; how then can there be an increase of spiritual life? St. Thomas answers this objection as follows: “The natural life pertains to the substance of man, and therefore can be neither augmented nor diminished; but in the life of grace man participates _accidentaliter_, and consequently he can possess it in a larger or smaller degree.”(1187)

c) From what we have said it is easy to understand the distinction which theologians make between justification as _gratia prima_ and justification as _gratia secunda_. The latter is merely another term for an increase of grace after

justification.

α) Such an increase may be effected either _ex opere operantis_, that is, by good works, or _ex opere operato_, through the sacraments, and is called justification (_iustificatio_, δικαίωσις) partly because Sacred Scripture refers to it by that name(1188) and partly because “to become just” (_iustum fieri_) and “to become more just” (_iustiorem fieri_) both imply true sanctification.

In this connection the question may be raised whether sanctifying grace is diminished by venial sin. Venial sin does not destroy the state of grace and consequently cannot augment or diminish grace. To assume that it could, would lead to the absurd conclusion that a definite number of venial sins might eventually grow into a mortal sin, or that repeated venial sins gradually diminish grace until finally it disappears. The first-mentioned assumption is impossible because venial differs generically from mortal sin, and a transition from the one to the other would be a μετάβασις εἰς ἄλλο γένος. The second assumption would entail the heretical inference that the state of grace can be lost without mortal sin.(1189) No doubt venial sin influences the state of grace unfavorably; but this evil influence must be conceived as indirect—by committing venial sins man weakens his will-power, and temptation eventually grows so strong as to make mortal sin inevitable. “He that contemneth small things, shall fall little by little.”(1190)

β) If we inquire how sanctifying grace increases in the soul, we find that the process must be conceived as a growing intensity analogous to that of light and heat in the physical order.

Gratia prima, as we have seen in a previous chapter, is a supernatural physical quality.(1191) Hence its increase, _i.e._ _gratia secunda_, must be an increase of physical quality. Such an increase is called in Scholastic parlance _intensio_.(1192) In what does this process consist? Certain Thomists(1193) describe it as a _maior radicatio in subiecto_, while the majority of theologians hold that it is simply an _additio gradus ad gradum_. This latter explanation is probably the correct one. Sanctifying grace is either capable of gradual increase, or it is not. If it is, there is no reason why God should deny such an increase under certain conditions. If it is not, Luther would have been right in contending that a newly baptized infant enjoys the same measure of holiness as the Blessed Virgin Mary or the human soul of our Divine Lord. It is impossible to imagine how grace could produce a quantitatively higher holiness by simply striking its roots deeper into the soul.(1194)

γ) A question of greater practical importance is this: Is the increase of sanctifying grace accompanied by a corresponding increase of the infused virtues, and _vice versa._

Every increase or decrease of sanctifying grace must _eo ipso_ entail a corresponding increase or decrease, respectively, of theological charity. Charity is either identical with grace or it is not.(1195) If it is, an increase of the one implies an increase of the other; if it is not, the one cannot increase without an increase of the other, because they are inseparable and related to each other as nature to faculty, or root to blossom. Moreover, the degree of heavenly glory enjoyed by a soul will be

commensurate with the measure of charity which it possessed at death. Now grace and glory bear a proportional relation to each other. Consequently, grace is augmented as charity increases, and _vice versa_. The same argument applies to the infused moral virtues.

The case is different, however, with the theological virtues of faith and hope. These may continue to exist in the soul after charity has departed, and hence are not inseparable from sanctifying grace and charity, nor from the moral virtues. This consideration led Suarez to infer that, as the theological virtues of faith and hope may be infused into the soul independently of charity and before justification, they must be susceptible of increase in the course of justification without regard to the existing state of grace and charity.(1196) This is true of the sinner. In the justified, as Suarez himself admits, an increase of grace (or charity) probably always entails an increase of faith and hope,(1197)—a proposition which finds strong support in the decree of Trent which says: “This increase of justification Holy Church begs, when she prays: ‘Give unto us, O Lord, increase of faith, hope, and charity.’ ”(1198)

δ) A final question forces itself upon the enquiring mind, _viz._: Is sanctifying grace capable of an indefinite increase, or is there a limit beyond which it cannot grow? In trying to find an answer to this question we must draw a careful distinction between the absolute and the ordinary power of God.

There is no intrinsic contradiction in the assumption that grace can be indefinitely augmented. True, it can never become actually infinite, as this would involve an absurdity.(1199) But if we regard the power of God as He sees fit to exercise it in the present economy (_potentia Dei ordinata_), we find that it is limited by two sublime ideals of holiness to which neither man nor angel can attain, _viz._: the overflowing measure of sanctifying grace in the human soul of our Lord Jesus Christ(1200) and the “fulness of grace” granted to His Mother.(1201) Though these ideals are beyond our reach, we must not be discouraged, but try to approach them as nearly as possible.(1202)

Thesis III: Sanctifying grace is lost by mortal sin.

This thesis also embodies an article of faith.

Proof. Calvin asserted that neither justification nor faith can be lost by those who are predestined to salvation, and that the unpredestined are never truly justified. Luther held that justifying grace is lost solely through the sin of infidelity. Against the former the Council of Trent declared: “If anyone saith that a man once justified can sin no more, nor lose grace, and that therefore he that falls and sins was never truly justified; ... let him be anathema.”(1203) Against the latter the same council defined: “If anyone saith that there is no mortal sin but that of infidelity, or that grace once received is not lost by any other sin, however grievous and enormous, save by that of infidelity, let him be anathema.”(1204) At the same time, however, the Holy Synod expressly declared that venial sin does not destroy the state of grace: “For although during this mortal life, men, how holy and just soever, at times fall into at least light and daily sins, which are also called venial, they do not therefore cease to be just.”(1205)

a) This teaching is so obviously in accord with Sacred Scripture that we confine ourselves to quoting three or four passages. Ezechiel says that sanctifying grace may be irretrievably lost: “If the just man turn himself away from his justice, and do iniquity according to all the abominations which the wicked man useth to work, shall he live? All his justices which he hath done shall not be remembered; in the prevarication, by which he hath prevaricated, and in his sin, which he hath committed, in them he shall die.”(1206) Our Lord Himself admonishes His Apostles: “Watch ye and pray, that ye enter not into temptation.”(1207) St. Paul not only warns the faithful in general terms: “He that thinketh himself to stand, let him take heed lest he fall;”(1208) but expressly designates certain mortal sins as a bar to Heaven: “Neither fornicators, nor idolaters, nor adulterers, nor the effeminate, nor liers with mankind, nor thieves, nor covetous, nor drunkards, nor railers, nor extortioners, shall possess the kingdom of God.”(1209)

b) The teaching of Tradition was brought out clearly in the fight against Jovinian.

That wily heretic claimed the authority of St. John for the assertion that the grace of Baptism can never be lost. The Johannean passage in question reads: “Whosoever is born of God, committeth no sin: for His seed abideth in him, and he cannot sin, because he is born of God.”(1210) St. Jerome in his reply paraphrases the passage as follows: “Therefore I tell you, my little children, whosoever is born of God, committeth no sin, in order that you may not sin and that you may know that you will remain sons of God so long as you refrain from sin.”(1211) St. Augustine teaches: “If a man, being regenerate and justified, relapses of his own will into an evil life, assuredly he cannot say: ‘I have not received,’ because of his own free choice of evil he has lost the grace of God that he has received.”(1212) And St. Gregory the Great:

“As he who falls away from the faith is an apostate, so he who returns to an evil deed is regarded by Almighty God as an apostate, even though he may seem to retain the faith; for the one without the other can be of no use, because faith availeth nought without [good] works, nor [good] works without faith.”(1213) The penitential discipline of the primitive Church furnishes additional proofs for the doctrine under consideration. If grace could be lost in no other way than by unbelief, the Sacrament of Penance would be useless.(1214)

c) In connection with this subject theologians are wont to discuss the question whether or not the forfeiture of sanctifying grace involves the loss of its supernatural concomitants.

Theological love or charity is substantially identical with sanctifying grace, or at least inseparable from it, and hence both are gained and lost together. This is an article of faith. To lose sanctifying grace, therefore, is to lose theological love. On the other hand, it is equally _de fide_ that theological faith (_habitus fidei_) is not destroyed by mortal sin;(1215) it can be lost only by the sin of unbelief.(1216) The same is true, _mutatis mutandis_, of theological hope. True, the Church has not definitely declared her mind with regard to hope, but it may be set down as her teaching that hope is not lost with grace and charity but survives like faith.(1217) The two contrary opposites of hope are desperation and presumption, concerning which

theologians commonly hold that the former destroys hope, while the latter probably does not. But even if hope and charity are lost, faith may remain in the soul like a solitary root, from which, under more favorable conditions, new life is apt to spring. As regards the infused moral virtues and the seven gifts of the Holy Ghost (and, _a fortiori_, His personal indwelling in the soul),(1218) it is the unanimous teaching that these disappear with sanctifying grace and charity, even though faith and hope survive. The reason is that these virtues and gifts are merely supernatural adjuncts of sanctifying grace and cannot persist without it. "_Accessorium sequitur principale._"(1219)

Chapter III. The Fruits Of Justification, Or The Merit Of Good Works

The principal fruit of justification, according to the Tridentine Council,(1220) is the meritoriousness of all good works performed in the state of sanctifying grace.

Merit (_meritum_), as we have explained in the first part of this treatise,(1221) is that property of a good work which entitles the doer to a reward (_praemium, merces_).

Ethics and theology distinguish two kinds of merit: (1) condign merit or merit in the strict sense of the term (_meritum adaequatum sive de condigno_), and (2) congruous merit or quasi-merit (_meritum inadaequatum sive de congruo_). Condign merit supposes an equality between service and return. It is measured by commutative justice and confers a strict claim to a reward. Congruous merit, owing to its inadequacy and the lack of strict proportion between service and recompense, confers no such claim except on grounds of equity.(1222)

In this treatise we are concerned with merit only in the theological sense of the term, _i.e._ supernatural merit. We shall consider (1) its Existence,(1223) (2) its Requisites,(1224) and (3) its Objects.(1225)

Section 1. The Existence Of Merit

1. HERETICAL ERRORS AND THE TEACHING OF THE CHURCH.—a) The medieval Beguins and Beghards held that man is able to attain such a perfect state of holiness here below as no longer to require an increase of grace or good works.(1226) Luther, holding that justification consists in the covering up of sin and the external imputation of the justice of Christ, consistently though falsely asserted that "the just man sins in every good work,"(1227) that "a good work, no matter how well performed, is a venial sin,"(1228) and that "every work of the just deserves damnation and is mortally sinful, if it be considered as it really is in the judgment of God."(1229) Calvin rejected good works as "impurities and defilements,"(1230) which God covers with the cloak of the merits of Jesus Christ and which He sometimes rewards with temporal blessings but never with eternal life. Modern Protestantism has given up or at least attenuated these harsh doctrines.(1231)

b) The Church had defined her teaching on this point centuries before the time of the “Reformers.” Thus the Second Council of Orange declared as early as 529: “Good works, when performed, deserve a reward; but grace, which is a free gift, precedes good works and is a necessary condition of them.”(1232) The Fourth Lateran Council reiterated this doctrine: “Not only virgins and those who practice continence, but the married also, who please God by having the right faith and performing good works, deserve to obtain eternal happiness.”(1233) The Tridentine Council goes into the matter at length in the sixteenth Chapter of its Sixth Session, where we read _inter alia_: “And for this reason life eternal is to be proposed to those working well unto the end and hoping in God, both as a grace mercifully promised to the sons of God through Jesus Christ, and as a reward which is according to the promise of God Himself to be faithfully rendered to their good works and merits.”(1234)

The same Council formally condemned the Lutheran position as heretical: “If anyone saith that in every good work the just man sins at least venially, or, which is more intolerable still, mortally, and consequently deserves eternal punishments; and that for this cause only he is not damned that God does not impute those works unto salvation; let him be anathema.”(1235) The positive teaching of the Church may be gathered from the following condemnation: “If anyone saith that the just ought not, for their good works done in God, to expect and hope for eternal recompense from God through His mercy and the merit of Jesus Christ, if so be that they persevere to the end in well-doing and in keeping the commandments; let him be anathema.”(1236) The existence of merit in the true and proper sense of the term is specially emphasized as follows: “If anyone saith that ... the justified, by the good works which he performs through the grace of God and the merit of Jesus Christ, whose living member he is, does not truly merit increase of grace...; let him be anathema.”(1237) The quietistic errors of Michael de Molinos were condemned by Pope Innocent XI, Nov. 20, 1687.(1238)

2. THE MERITORIOUSNESS OF GOOD WORKS DEMONSTRATED FROM SCRIPTURE AND TRADITION.—Both Holy Scripture and Tradition employ _opus bonum_ and _meritum_ as reciprocal or correlative terms.

a) In the Old Testament the good deeds of the just are often declared to be meritorious in the sight of God. Cfr. Wisd. V, 16: “But the just shall live for evermore, and their reward is with the Lord.”(1239) Ecclus. XVIII, 22: “Be not afraid to be justified even to death, for the reward of God continueth for ever.”(1240) The New Testament teaching culminates in the “eight beatitudes,” each of which is accompanied by a special reward. After enumerating them all, with the promises attached to each, our Divine Saviour significantly adds: “Be glad and rejoice, for your reward is very great in heaven.”(1241)

St. Paul, who so strongly insists on the absolute gratuitousness of Christian grace, nevertheless acknowledges the existence of merits to which a reward is due from God. Cfr. Rom. II, 6 sq.: “[God] will render to every man according to his works, to them indeed who according to patience in good work, seek glory and honor and incorruption, eternal life.”(1242) 2 Tim. IV, 7 sq.: “I have fought a good fight, I have finished my course, I have kept the faith. As to the rest, there is laid up for me a

crown of justice, which the Lord the just judge will render to me in that day, and not only to me, but to them also that love his coming."(1243) 1 Cor. III, 8: "Every man shall receive his own reward, according to his own labor."(1244) Col. III, 23 sq.: "Whatsoever you do, do it from the heart, as to the Lord, and not to men, knowing that you shall receive of the Lord the reward of inheritance."(1245) The most eloquent exponent of the necessity of good works is St. James, who also insists on their meritoriousness: "Blessed is the man that endureth temptation; for when he hath been proved, he shall receive the crown of life, which God hath promised to them that love him."(1246) In the Apocalypse Jesus says: "Be thou faithful until death, and I will give thee the crown of life."(1247)

b) The teaching of the Fathers is an effective commentary on the Scriptural doctrine just expounded, as may be seen from their homilies reproduced in the Roman Breviary.

St. Ignatius of Antioch says: "Suffer me to be eaten by the beasts, through whom I can attain to God."(1248) St. Irenæus: "Precious should be to us the crown which we gain in battle, ... and the more we obtain it by combat, the more precious it is."(1249) St. Ambrose: "Is it not evident that the reward and punishment of merits endure after death?"(1250) St. Augustine: "Eternal life contains the whole reward in the promise of which we rejoice; nor can the reward precede desert, nor be given to a man before he is worthy of it. What can be more unjust than this, and what is more just than God? We should not then demand the reward before we deserve to get it."(1251) And again: "As death is given, so to speak, to reward the merit of sin, so eternal life is given to reward the merit of justice, ... and hence it is also called reward in many Scriptural passages."(1252)

c) Theologically the meritoriousness of good works is based on the providence of God. There must be some sort of sanction to enforce the divine laws,—not only the natural law (_lex naturae_), but, _a fortiori_, the "law of grace" (_lex gratiae_), as the supernatural order is so much more important than the natural.

α) By the good works which he performs in the state of sanctifying grace, and with the aid of actual graces (_in gratia et ex gratia_), man acquires a twofold merit,—he helps to execute the divine plan of governance in regard to his fellow-creatures and assists in furthering the external glory of God, which is the ultimate purpose of creation. For this he is entitled to a double reward, just as the sinner is deserving of a double punishment for the injury he does to his fellowmen and the dishonor he reflects upon his Creator.(1253)

It is objected against this argument that our supernatural merits, being finite, are in no proportion to the possession and enjoyment of an Infinite Good. This objection vanishes in the light of the following considerations: (1) Sanctifying grace is a kind of _deificatio_, which raises man above himself to a quasi-divine dignity that colors all his actions.(1254) (2) The ability of the justified to perform supernaturally good works is based entirely upon the infinite merits of Jesus Christ.(1255) (3) The Infinite Good is possessed by the creature, not in an infinite but in a merely finite manner. Hence there _is_ a due proportion between good works and merit.(1256)

One difficulty still remains, _viz._: By what title do infants who die in the state of baptismal innocence attain to eternal beatitude, which they have been unable to merit? We answer: The just man has two distinct claims to Heaven, one as a child of God,(1257) and another as a laborer in His vineyard. Baptized infants who have not yet arrived at the use of reason, possess only the first claim, while adult Christians who lead a good life enjoy also the _titulus mercedis_ and consequently are entitled to a richer reward. Both claims ultimately rest on the merits of Jesus Christ.(1258)

β) What we have said is sufficient to disprove the groundless assertion that the Catholic doctrine concerning the meritoriousness of good works derogates from the merits of Christ and fosters "self-righteousness." Would it not be far more derogatory to the honor of our Saviour to assume that He failed to obtain for those for whom He suffered and died, a limited capacity for gaining merits? Does it in any way impair the dignity of God as the _causa prima_ to assume that He communicates to His creatures a limited causality, by which they are enabled to act as true _causae secundae_, instead of being mere _causae occasionales_, as the Occasionalists assert?(1259) As regards the other charge, no true Catholic is guilty of "self-righteousness" because he regards his good works as "fruits of justification," owing purely to grace. The "self-righteousness" of which Luther speaks is incompatible with the virtue of humility. The faithful Christian, according to St. Paul, may safely rejoice over his merits, because the uncertainty of justification and the consciousness that his good works are but limited at best, are a sufficient protection against self-righteousness and presumption.(1260)

3. EXPLANATION OF THE CATHOLIC DOCTRINE.—Though the Tridentine Council merely defined in general terms that all good works performed in the state of sanctifying grace are meritorious,(1261) it is theologically certain that the merit due to good works is the merit of condignity.

a) According to Pallavicini(1262) the Fathers of Trent without exception were convinced that the merit inherent in good works is a _meritum de condigno_, based upon divine justice, and they purposely employed the term _vere_ to exclude that quasi-merit which in the technical terminology of the Schools is called _meritum de congruo_.(1263) They refrained from expressly employing the term _meritum de condigno_, because _meritum verum_ is a plain and adequate term, and for this additional reason that they wished to avoid certain theological controversies regarding the nature of the _meritum de condigno_ and its requisites.(1264)

b) We need not enter into these controversies to understand that condign merit supposes an equality between service and reward. The proposition can be proved from Sacred Scripture by an indirect argument. The _meritum de condigno_ is based on a strict claim of justice, not on mere equity. Now the Bible leaves no doubt that God meant to make himself a debtor to man in strict justice. Cfr. Heb. VI, 10: "For God is not unjust, that he should forget your work."(1265) 2 Tim. IV, 8: "... there is laid up for me a crown of justice, which the Lord the just judge will render to me in that day: and not only to me, but to them also that love his coming."(1266) James I, 12: "Blessed is the man that endureth temptation; for when he hath been proved, he shall receive the crown of life, which God hath promised to them that love

him."(1267) That there must be a _condignitas_ between service and reward is clearly apparent from such texts as these:—Wis. III, 5: "... God hath tried them and found them worthy of himself."(1268) 2 Thess. I, 4 sq.: "... in all your persecutions and tribulations, which you endure, for an example [as a token] of the just judgment of God, that you may be counted worthy of the kingdom of God, for which also you suffer."(1269) Apoc. III, 4: "... they shall walk with me in white, because they are worthy."(1270) Not merely as their benefactor but as the just judge, Christ will say to the elect on judgment day: "Come, ye blessed of my Father, possess you the kingdom prepared for you from the foundation of the world. For I was hungry, and you gave me to eat...."(1271) Justly therefore is sanctifying grace, as the _principium dignificativum operum_, called the "seed of God,"(1272) because it contains a celestial reward even as an acorn contains the oak. True, St. Thomas, to whom we are indebted for this simile,(1273) in another part of the _Summa_(1274) defends the theological axiom: "_Deus punit circa condignum et remunerat ultra condignum_," but he does not mean to deny the equality between service and reward, but merely to exalt the generosity that prompts God to bestow upon creatures what is due to them more bountifully than they deserve. Cfr. Luke VI, 38: "Give, and it shall be given to you: good measure and pressed down and shaken together and running over shall they give into your bosom."(1275)

Section 2. The Requisites Of Merit

As we are dealing with the "fruits of justification," it becomes necessary to ascertain the requisites or conditions of true merit. There are seven such; four have reference to the meritorious work itself, two to the agent who performs it, and one to God who gives the reward.

1. REQUISITES OF MERIT ON THE PART OF THE MERITORIOUS WORK.—A work, to be meritorious, must be morally good, free, performed with the assistance of actual grace, and inspired by a supernatural motive.

a) As every evil deed implies demerit and is deserving of punishment, so the notion of merit supposes a morally good work (_opus honestum_).

Cfr. Eph. VI, 8: "Knowing that whatsoever good thing any man shall do, the same shall he receive from the Lord."(1276) 2 Cor. V, 10: "We must all be manifested before the judgment-seat of Christ, that every one may receive the proper things of the body, according as he hath done, whether it be good or evil."(1277) There are no morally indifferent works _in individuo_, _i.e._ practically; and if there were, they could be neither meritorious nor demeritorious, but would become meritorious in proportion as they are made morally good by means of a "good intention." It would be absolutely wrong to ascribe merit only to the more perfect works of supererogation (_opera supererogatoria_), such as the vow of perpetual chastity, excluding all works of mere obligation, such as the faithful observance of the commandments. Being morally good, the works of obligation are also meritorious, because goodness and meritoriousness are correlative terms.(1278) Whether the mere omission of an evil act is in itself meritorious, is doubtful.(1279) But most theologians are agreed in

holding that the external work, as such, adds no merit to the internal act, except in so far as it reacts on the will and sustains and intensifies its operation. This and similar questions properly belong to moral theology.

b) The second requisite of merit is moral liberty (_libertas indifferens ad actum_), that is to say, freedom from both external and internal compulsion. This has been dogmatically defined against Jansenius.(1280)

That there can be no merit without liberty is clearly inculcated by Sacred Scripture. Cfr. 1 Cor. IX, 17: “For if I do this willingly, I have a reward.”(1281) Matth. XIX, 17: “If thou wilt enter into life, keep the commandments.”(1282) “Where there is compulsion,” says St. Jerome, “there is neither a crown nor damnation.”(1283) The morality of an act depends entirely on its being an _actus humanus_. Now no act is truly “human” unless it be freely performed. Consequently, freedom of choice is an indispensable condition of moral goodness and therefore also of merit.

What kind of liberty is necessary to enable the will to acquire merit? Theologians answer by saying that it is _libertas contradictionis sive exercitii_. If I do a good deed which I am free to do or not to do, I perform a morally good and therefore meritorious work. As regards the _libertas specificationis_, (that freedom by which a person may act thus or otherwise, _e.g._ give alms to one applicant in preference to another, or mortify himself in this or that particular manner), there can be no doubt that, whatever the choice made, the action is always good and meritorious. However, theologians have excogitated a hypothetical case in which an action may be _physically_ free without being meritorious. It is when one is compelled to do a certain thing and is free only in so far as he is able to choose between two actions exactly equal in moral worth. This would be the case, for instance, if he had to pay a debt of ten dollars and were left free to pay it either in coin or in currency. The more common opinion is that in a case of this kind there would be a lack of that liberty which is necessary to render an act morally good and therefore meritorious.(1284)

c) The third requisite of merit is actual grace. Its necessity is evident from the fact that, to be meritorious, an act must be supernatural and consequently cannot be performed without the aid of prevenient and coöperating grace.(1285)

d) Merit further requires a supernatural motive, for the reason that every good work must be supernatural, both as regards object and circumstances (_ex obiecto et circumstantiis_), and the end for which it is performed (_ex fine_). In determining the necessary qualities of this motive, however, theologians differ widely.

α) A considerable number, mostly of the Thomist persuasion, demand the motive of theological charity, and consequently regard the state of charity (_caritas habitualis sive status caritatis et gratiae_) as essential for the meritoriousness of all good works performed in the state of grace, even if they are performed from some other, truly supernatural though inferior motive, such as obedience, the fear of God, etc. This rigorous school is constrained to raise the question whether every single good work, to be supernaturally meritorious, must proceed from an act of divine charity (_toties quoties_), or whether the virtual influence of one act is sufficient to endow a series of subsequent acts with meritoriousness. Only a few Thomist theologians(1286) defend

the first-mentioned theory. The majority(1287) hold that the _influxus virtualis caritatis_ is sufficient. This view is vigorously defended by Cardinal Bellarmine, who says: “It is not enough to make a general good intention at the beginning of a year, or month, or day, by which all future actions are referred to God; but it is necessary to refer each particular act to God before it is performed.”(1288) The advocates of this theory base their opinion on certain Scriptural and Patristic texts, and especially on St. Thomas, whose teaching they misunderstand.(1289)

The dogmatic question whether good works can be meritorious without being inspired by supernatural charity, has nothing to do with the moral problem whether there is an obligation to make an act of charity from time to time, except in so far as habitual charity,—_i.e._ the state of charity, which is always required for merit, nay even for the preservation of sanctifying grace,—cannot be permanently sustained unless renewed from time to time and effectuated by a fresh act of that virtue.(1290) St. Alphonsus teaches that every man is obliged to make an act of charity at least once a month, but he is contradicted by other eminent moralists. In practice it is well to insist on frequent acts of charity because such acts not only confirm and preserve the state of grace, but render our good works incomparably more meritorious in the sight of God. Hence, too, the importance of making a “good intention” every morning before beginning the day’s work.(1291)

β) There is a second group of very eminent theologians, including Suarez,(1292) Vasquez,(1293) De Lugo, and Ballerini, who hold that, to be meritorious, the good works of a just man, who has habitual charity, need only conform to the divine law, no special motive being required. These writers base their teaching on the Tridentine decree which says: “For this is that crown of justice which the Apostle declared was, after his fight and course, laid up for him, to be rendered to him by the Just Judge, and not only to him, but also to all that love His coming. For, whereas Jesus Christ Himself continually infuses His virtue into the said justified,—as the head into the members and the vine into the branches,—and this virtue always precedes, and accompanies, and follows their good works, which without it could not in any wise be pleasing and meritorious before God (can. 2), we must believe that nothing further is wanting to the justified to prevent their being accounted to have, by those very works which have been done in God, fully satisfied the divine law according to the state of this life, and to have truly merited eternal life, to be obtained also in its [due] time, if so be, however, that they depart in grace.”(1294) This teaching is in harmony with Scripture. The Bible nowhere requires an act of charity to make good works meritorious for Heaven. In the “eight beatitudes”(1295) our Lord Himself promises eternal glory for works which are not all works of charity, nor even dictated by charity, either formal or virtual. When He was asked: “Master, what good shall I do that I may have life everlasting?”(1296) he did not answer with Bellarmine: “Steep all thy works in the motive of charity,” but declared: “If thou wilt enter into life, keep the commandments.”(1297) And when requested to specify, He simply cited the ordinary precepts of the Decalogue.(1298) We also know that at the Last Judgment He will receive the elect into the “kingdom of His Father” solely in consideration of the works of mercy they have done.(1299)

Theological reasoning lends its support to this view. If good works performed without the motive of charity were not supernaturally meritorious, this would be attributable to one of three causes. Either the just would sin by doing good; or good works performed without charity would not be deserving of eternal beatitude; or, finally, there would be no strict equality between service and reward. All three of these suppositions are untenable. The first would lead to Bajanism or Jansenism.(1300) The second and third overlook the fact that the requisite proportion (_condignitas_) between service and reward is furnished by sanctifying grace or habitual charity, which, as _deificatio_, adoptive sonship, and union with the Holy Ghost, actually supplies that for which the _motivum caritatis_ is demanded.

We might ask the advocates of the more rigorous opinion, whence the act of charity which they demand for every meritorious work, derives its peculiar proportionality or _condignitas_ with the beatific vision. Surely not from itself, because as an act it is merely _primus inter pares_, without in any essential respect excelling other motives. There is no alternative but to attribute it to that quasi-divine dignity which is imparted to the just man and his works by sanctifying grace.

For these reasons present-day theology regards the second theory as sufficiently well established and the faithful are largely guided by it in practice.(1301)

2. REQUISITES OF MERIT ON THE PART OF THE AGENT WHO MERITS.—The agent who merits must be a wayfarer and in the state of sanctifying grace.

a) The wayfaring state (_status viae_) is merely another name for life on earth. Death as the natural, though not essentially necessary limit of life, closes the time of meriting. Nothing is more clearly taught in Holy Scripture than that we must sow in this world if we desire to reap in the next.(1302)

b) The second requisite is the state of sanctifying grace. Only the just can be “sons of God” and “heirs of heaven.”(1303) Cfr. John XV, 4: “As the branch cannot bear fruit of itself, unless it abide in the vine, so neither can you, unless you abide in me.”(1304) Rom. VIII, 17: “And if sons, heirs also; heirs indeed of God, and joint heirs with Christ.”(1305)

Does the degree of sanctifying grace existing in the soul exert a decisive influence on the amount of merit due to the good works performed? This question can be easily solved on the theological principle that the supernatural dignity of the soul increases in proportion to its growth in sanctifying grace. Vasquez holds that, other things being equal, one who is holier gains no greater merit by performing a given work than one who is less holy.(1306) All other theologians(1307) hold with St. Thomas(1308) that the meritoriousness of a good deed is larger in proportion to the godlike dignity of the agent, which in turn is measured by the degree of sanctifying grace in the soul. This explains why God, in consideration of the greater holiness of some saints who are especially dear to Him, often deigns through their intercession to grant favors which He refuses to others.(1309)

3. THE REQUISITES OF MERIT ON THE PART OF GOD.—Merit requires but one thing on the part of God, _viz._: that He accept the good work _in actu secundo_ as deserving of reward. Since, however, theologians are not agreed on this point, we are

dealing merely with a more or less well-founded opinion.

Though the good works of the just derive a special intrinsic value from the godlike dignity of adoptive sonship, and, consequently, _in actu primo_, are truly meritorious prior to and apart from their acceptance by God, yet human service and divine remuneration are separated by such a wide gulf that, in order to make a good deed meritorious _in actu secundo_, the divine acceptance and promise of reward must be expressly superadded.

In regard to the relation between service and reward Catholic theologians are divided into three schools.

The Scotists(1310) hold that the _condignitas_ of a good work rests entirely on God's gratuitous promise and free acceptance, without which even the most heroic act would be utterly devoid of merit, whereas with it even naturally good works may become meritorious. This rather shallow theory almost completely loses sight of the godlike dignity peculiar to the just in their capacity of "adopted children of God" and "temples of the Holy Ghost," and is unable to account for such important Biblical terms as "crown of justice," "prize of victory," "just judge," etc.

Suarez and his school contend that there is such a perfectly balanced equality between merit and reward that God is obliged in strict justice (_ex obligatione iustitiae_), prior to and apart from any formal act of acceptance or promise on His part, to reward good works by the beatific vision. This view is scarcely tenable because there is no common basis on which to construe a relation of strict justice between the Creator and His creatures,(1311) and moreover St. Paul expressly teaches that "The sufferings of this time are not worthy to be compared with the glory to come."(1312)

Hence we prefer to hold with Lessius,(1313) Vasquez,(1314) and De Lugo(1315) that the _condignitas_ or equality existing between merit and reward, owes its origin both to the intrinsic value of the good work itself and to the free acceptance and gratuitous promise of God. This solution duly respects the intrinsic value of merit _in actu primo_, without derogating from the sublime dignity of God, who rewards good works not because He is obliged to do so by the merits of a mere creature, but solely because He is bound by His own truthfulness and fidelity. Thus God's justice towards His creatures is placed upon a free basis, and there is no violation of justice (_iniuria_) on His part. "From the fact that our actions have no merit except on the supposition that God so ordained," says St. Thomas, "it does not follow that God is simply our debtor; He is His own debtor, _i.e._ He owes it to Himself to see that His commands are obeyed."(1316) This teaching can be proved from Sacred Scripture. Cfr. James I, 12: "He shall receive the crown of life, which God hath promised to them that love him."(1317) It is reechoed by St. Augustine: "God is made our debtor, not by receiving anything from us, but because it pleased Him to promise us something. For it is in a different sense that we say to a man: You are indebted to me because I have given you something, and: You owe this to me because you have promised it. To God we never say: Give back to me because I have given to Thee. What have we given to God, since it is from Him that we have received whatever we are and whatever good

we possess? We have therefore given Him nothing.... In this manner, therefore, may we demand of God, by saying: Give me what Thou hast promised, because we have done what Thou didst command, and it is Thyself that hast done it because Thou hast aided our labors."(1318) The Tridentine Council seems to endorse this view when it says: "Life eternal is to be proposed to those ... hoping in God ... as a reward which is, according to the promise of God Himself, to be faithfully rendered to their good works and merits."(1319)

Section 3. The Objects Of Merit

After defining the existence of merit the Tridentine Council enumerates its objects as follows: "If anyone saith that the justified, by the good works which he performs, ... does not truly merit increase of grace, eternal life, and the attainment of that eternal life,—if it be so, however, that he depart in grace,—and also an increase of glory: let him be anathema."(1320) Hence merit calls for a threefold reward: (1) an increase of sanctifying grace; (2) heavenly glory; and (3) an increase of that glory. The expression "_vere mereri_" shows that all three of these objects can be merited in the true and strict sense of the term (_de condigno_). This is, however, no more than a theologically certain conclusion.

1. INCREASE OF SANCTIFYING GRACE.—The first grace of justification (_gratia prima_) can never be merited;(1321) hence the meaning of the above-quoted conciliar definition is that it can be increased by good works. This increase is technically called _gratia secunda_. All Scriptural texts which assert that sanctifying grace is unequal in different individuals, also prove that it can be increased or augmented by the performance of meritorious works.(1322)

a) No adult person can merit the first grace of assistance (_gratia prima actualis_), nor any one of the series of actual graces which follow it, and by which justification ultimately comes to pass. They are all purely gratuitous. Similarly, too, the first grace of justification (_gratia prima habitualis_) cannot be strictly merited by the sinner preparing for justification. This is the express teaching of Trent: "But we are therefore said to be justified freely, because that none of those things which precede justification—whether faith or works—merit the grace itself of justification; for, if it be a grace, it is not now by works; otherwise, as the same Apostle says, grace is no more grace."(1323) To deny this would not only imperil the dogma of the gratuity of grace (because if the first grace given before active justification could be strictly merited, this would necessarily involve the _gratia prima actualis_), but it would also start a vicious circle (because the _gratia prima habitualis_ is an indispensable condition of merit). This explains why St. Paul and St. Augustine again and again insist on the gratuity both of the first grace of assistance and the grace of justification proper.(1324) "This grace of Christ," says St. Augustine, "without which neither infants nor adults can be saved, is not bestowed for any merits, but is given freely, on account of which it is also called grace. 'Being justified,' says the Apostle, 'freely through His blood.' "(1325)

In the light of this teaching it is easy to decide the question, raised by Vasquez, whether perfect contrition justifies the sinner merely _per modum dispositionis_ or _per modum causae formalis_. Both contrition and charity, be they perfect or imperfect, are essentially acts that dispose the soul for justification.(1326) Hence, no matter how perfect, neither is capable of effecting justification itself by way of merit (_merendo_), nay, of entering even partially, as Vasquez would have it, into the formal cause of justification, because, according to the Tridentine Council, sanctifying grace and not perfect contrition is the _unica causa formalis_ of justification.(1327)

b) In connection with the dogma just explained theologians discuss the question whether a just man may strictly (_de condigno_) merit the actual graces which God bestows on him. We must carefully distinguish between merely sufficient and efficacious graces. Theologians commonly hold(1328) that merely sufficient graces may be merited _de condigno_, not so efficacious graces, because the right to efficacious graces would necessarily include a strict right to final perseverance (_donum perseverantiae_), which lies outside the sphere of condign merit. Assuming that the justified could by good works strictly merit the _prima gratia efficax_ (an impossible hypothesis, because merit presupposes efficacious grace), this would involve a similar claim to a second, third, fourth grace—and ultimately to the final grace of perseverance, which, in matter of fact, no man can merit. Not even heroic acts of virtue give a strict right to infallibly efficacious graces, or to final perseverance. Even the greatest saint is obliged to watch, pray, and tremble, lest he lapse from righteousness.(1329) For this reason the Tridentine Council mentions neither final perseverance nor efficacious graces among the objects of merit.(1330)

2. ETERNAL LIFE OR HEAVENLY GLORY.—The second object of merit is eternal life. The dogmatic proof for this assertion has been given above.(1331) Eternal life is described by the Tridentine Council(1332) both as a grace and as a reward.

a) In the canon quoted in the introduction of this Section the same Council(1333) enumerates four apparently separate and distinct objects of merit, _viz._: increase of grace, eternal life, the attainment of eternal life, and increase of glory. Why the distinction between “eternal life” and the “attainment of eternal life”? Does this imply a twofold reward, and consequently a twofold object of merit? Theologians deny that such was the intention of the Council, because the right to a reward evidently coincides with the right to the payment of the same. An unattainable eternal life would be a chimera.(1334) Nevertheless, the distinction is not superfluous, since the attainment of eternal life does not coincide with the gaining of merit but must be put off until death, and even then depends upon the condition of the soul: “_si tamen in gratia decesserit_” (provided he depart in grace). With this last condition the holy Synod also wished to inculcate the salutary truth that the loss of sanctifying grace _ipso facto_ entails the forfeiture of all previously acquired merits. Even the greatest saint, were he to die in the state of mortal sin, would enter eternity with empty hands and as an enemy of God. All his former merits would be cancelled. To revive them would require a new justification.(1335)

b) A close analysis of the Tridentine canon under review gives rise to another difficulty. Can the _gloria prima_ be merited? In defining the _gratia secunda_ as an

object of strict merit, the Council expressly excludes the _gratia prima_. It makes no such distinction in regard to glory, but names both “eternal life” (_gloria prima_) and “increase of glory” (_gloria secunda_) as objects of merit. This naturally suggests the query: Why and to what extent can the just man merit the _gloria prima_, seeing that he is unable to merit the _gratia prima_? Some theologians(1336) contend that the justified are entitled to the _gloria prima_ only as a heritage (_titulo haereditatis_), never as a reward (_titulo mercedis_). Because of its intimate causal connection with the _gratia prima_, which is beyond the reach of merit, the _gloria prima_, they argue, cannot be regarded as an object of merit except on the assumption that the merits which precede justification confer a claim to the _gloria prima_. This assumption is false, because without sanctifying grace no condign merits can be acquired.(1337) In spite of this difficulty, however, most theologians(1338) hold that, unlike the _gratia prima_, the _gloria prima_ may under certain conditions be an object of strict merit. The main reason is that, as the state of glory is not a necessary requisite of the meritoriousness of good works, while the state of grace is, the former may _positis ponendis_ be an effect of the _meritum de congruo_, though the latter may not. A mere statement of the problem shows that it cannot be satisfactorily solved unless we distinguish between and enter into a detailed examination of two distinct hypotheses. It is generally agreed that infants dying in the state of baptismal grace owe that grace, and the state of glory which they enjoy in Heaven, solely to God’s mercy and have no claim to beatitude other than that of heredity (_titulus hereditatis_). Adults who preserve their baptismal innocence until death, manifestly cannot merit the _gloria prima_ by their good works, because they already possess a legal title to it through Baptism.(1339) It follows that their good works increase, but do not merit, the _gloria prima_, to which these souls are already entitled _titulo haereditatis_. The case is quite different with catechumens and Christians guilty of mortal sin, who are justified by an act of perfect contrition before the reception of Baptism or the Sacrament of Penance. Of them it may be said, without fear of contradiction, that they merit for themselves _de condigno_, not indeed the first grace of justification, but the _gloria prima_, because perfect contrition, being an _opus operans_, at the very moment of its infusion becomes an _opus meritorium_ entitled to eternal glory.(1340) As regards the great majority of adult Catholics who, because of defective preparation, never get beyond imperfect contrition (_attritio_), and therefore are not justified until they actually receive the Sacrament, it is certain that they owe whatever grace they possess and whatever glory they have a claim to, entirely to the _opus operatum_ of the Sacrament.(1341)

3. INCREASE OF HEAVENLY GLORY.—The third object of merit, according to the Tridentine Council, is “increase of glory.” This must evidently correspond to an increase of grace, which in its turn is conditioned upon the performance of additional good works. That there is a causal connection between meritorious works performed on earth and the glory enjoyed in Heaven is clearly taught by Holy Scripture. Cfr. Matth. XVI, 27: “For the Son of man shall ... render to every man according to his works.”(1342) 1 Cor. III, 8: “And every man shall receive his own reward, according to his own labor.”(1343) A further argument may be derived from the unequal apportionment of glory to the elect in Heaven.(1344) This inequality is based on

inequality of grace, which in turn is owing to the fact that grace can be augmented by good works. Consequently, the inequality of glory depends ultimately on good works.(1345)

4. NOTE ON THE MERITUM DE CONGRUO.—Congruous, as distinguished from condign merit, gives no real claim to a reward, but only a quasi-claim based on equity (_ex quadam aequitate_, _congruentia_, _decentia_).

Hence congruous merit and condign merit are not species of the same genus, but merely analogous terms. Because of the ambiguity of the word “equity” Dominicus Soto, Becanus, and a few other Scholastics rejected the use of the term _meritum de congruo_ in theology. But this was a mistake. The Fathers engaged in the Semipelagian controversy, notably St. Augustine,(1346) did not assert that the justifying faith of the sinner is entirely without merit. The requisites of congruous merit are identical with those of condign merit(1347) in all respects except one,—the _meritum de congruo_ does not require the state of grace.

a) According to the common opinion, from which but few theologians dissent,(1348) a Christian in the state of mortal sin can, from the moment he begins to coöperate with supernatural grace, merit _de congruo_ by good works, and obtain by prayer the dispositions necessary for justification, and ultimately justification itself.

“Prayer relies on mercy,” says St. Thomas, “condign merit on justice. And therefore man obtains from the divine mercy many things by prayer which he does not merit in strict justice.”(1349) This teaching is based partly on Holy Scripture and partly on the writings of St. Augustine, and is confirmed by certain utterances of the Council of Trent. By conscientiously preparing himself with the aid of actual grace, the sinner probably merits an additional claim (in equity) to justification. Cfr. Ps. L, 19: “A sacrifice to God is an afflicted spirit: a contrite and humbled heart, O God, thou wilt not despise.”(1350) Dan. IV, 24: “Redeem thou thy sins with alms, and thy iniquities with works of mercy to the poor: perhaps he [God] will forgive thy offences.”(1351) St. Augustine says: “The remission of sins itself is not without some merit, if faith asks for it. Nor is that faith entirely unmeritorious by which the publican was moved to say: ‘God, be merciful to me, a sinner,’ and then went away justified through the merit of faithful humility.”(1352)

b) By good works the just may merit for themselves, not in strict justice (_de condigno_), but as a matter of equity (_de congruo_), final perseverance, conversion from mortal sin, spiritual favors for others, and also such temporal blessings as may be conducive to eternal salvation.

α) It is a theologically certain conclusion, accepted by all theologians without exception, that the grace of final perseverance (_donum perseverantiae_) cannot be merited in the strict sense (_de condigno_). Most authors hold, however, that it can be merited de congruo. This _meritum_ is technically called _meritum de congruo fallibili_. Those who deny that it can be merited at all, admit that it can be infallibly obtained by fervent and unremitting prayer.(1353)

β) It is impossible to answer with anything like certainty the question whether the just man is able to merit for himself in advance the grace of conversion against the eventuality of a future lapse into mortal sin. Following the lead of Albertus Magnus, St. Thomas takes a negative view,(1354) on the ground that mortal sin interrupts the state of grace and annihilates all former merits. In another passage of his writings, however, the Angelic Doctor says: “There are two kinds of merit, one based on justice, and this is called condign; and another based solely upon mercy, and this is called congruous. Of the latter St. Paul says that it is just, _i.e._ congruous, that a man who has performed many good works should merit.... And in this wise God does not forget our work and love.”(1355) Scotus,(1356) Bonaventure,(1357) and Suarez(1358) regard this as “a pious and probable opinion,” well supported by Holy Scripture. The prophet Jehu said to Josaphat, King of Juda: “Thou helpest the ungodly, and thou art joined in friendship with them that hate the Lord, and therefore thou didst deserve indeed the wrath of the Lord; but good works are found in thee.”(1359) To this argument add the following consideration: If previous mortal sin does not prevent those acts whereby man is disposed for justification from being at least to a limited extent meritorious, there is no reason to assume that merits cancelled by subsequent mortal sin will not be imputed to the sinner, with due regard, of course, to a certain proportion between past merits and future sins.(1360) To pray for the grace of conversion against the eventuality of future mortal sin, is always good and useful,(1361) because it cannot but please God to know that we sincerely desire to be restored to His friendship if we should ever have the misfortune of losing it.(1362)

γ) The just man may congruously merit for others whatever he is able to merit for himself, _e.g._ the grace of conversion, final perseverance, and also the first prevenient grace (_gratia prima praeveniens_), which no man in the state of original sin is able to merit for himself.(1363) The reason for this, according to St. Thomas, is the intimate relation of friendship which sanctifying grace establishes between the just man and God.(1364) However, as Sylvius rightly observes, it is not in the power of the just to obtain by this friendship favors which would involve the abrogation of the divinely established order of salvation. Such a favor would be, for example, the justification of a sinner without the medium of grace, or of a child without the agency of Baptism. An unreasonable petition deserves no consideration, even if made by a friend. What may be obtained by the merit of good works may be even more effectively obtained by prayer for others. The Apostle St. James teaches: “Pray for one another that you may be saved; for the continual prayer of a just man availeth much.”(1365) This consoling truth is confirmed by the dogma of the Communion of Saints, by many illustrious examples from the Bible(1366) and ecclesiastical history,(1367) and by the traditional practice of the Church in praying God to give strength and perseverance to the faithful and the grace of conversion to the heathen and the sinner.(1368)

δ) A final question remains to be answered: Can the just congruously merit such temporal blessings as good health, a comfortable living, and success in business? They can, but only in so far as these favors are conducive to eternal salvation; for otherwise they would not be graces. St. Thomas seems to go even further than this by

describing temporal favors as objects of condign merit when they are conducive to salvation, and of congruous merit when they bear no relation to that end.(1369) We have no space left to enter into an argument on this point, but in conclusion wish to call attention to two important facts: first, that prayer is more effective than good works in obtaining temporal as well as spiritual favors; and secondly, that we should not strive with too much anxiety for earthly goods, but direct our thoughts, desires, prayers, and actions to God, the Infinite Good, who has promised to be our "exceeding great reward."(1370)

READINGS:—St. Thomas, _Summa Theologica_, 1a 2ae, qu. 114, art. 1 sqq.—Billuart, _De Gratia_, diss. 8, art. 1-5.—*Bellarmine, _De Iustificatione_, V, 1-22.—*Suarez, _Opusc. de Divina Iustitia_.—IDEM, _De Gratia_, l. XII, cap. 1 sqq.—Oswald, _Lehre von der Heiligung, d. i. Gnade, Rechtfertigung, Gnodenwahl_, § 7, 3rd ed., Paderborn 1885.—Tepe, _Institutiones Theologicae_, Vol. III, pp. 223 sqq., Paris 1896.—*Heinrich-Gutberlet, _Dogmatische Theologie_, Vol. VIII, § 473 sqq., Mainz 1897.—Chr. Pesch, _Praelectiones Dogmaticae_, Vol. V, 3rd ed., pp. 215 sqq., Freiburg 1908.—*S. Schiffini, _De Gratia Divina_, pp. 594 sqq., Freiburg 1901.—Kneib, _Die Lohnsucht der christlichen Moral_, Vienna 1904.—I. J. Remler, C. M., _Supernatural Merit_, St. Louis 1914.—A. Devine, C. P., _The Sacraments Explained_, 3rd ed., London 1905, pp. 74-89.—L. Labauche, S. S., _God and Man_, pp. 254-270, N. Y. 1916. (On merit in general see M. Cronin, _The Science of Ethics_, Vol. I, Dublin 1909, pp. 544 sqq.)—B. J. Otten, S. J., _A Manual of the History of Dogmas_, Vol. II, St. Louis 1918, pp. 249 sqq.

On the Protestant idea of the fruits of justification see Möhler, _Symbolik_, § 21 sqq. (English edition, pp. 157 sqq.).

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FOOTNOTES

1 The Fathers and the Schoolmen “do not emphasize the difference, and frequently speak of habitual and actual grace as of one whole. Controversial reasons account for this discrepancy, which readers of the older theologians should constantly bear in mind.” (Wilhelm-Scannell, _Manual of Catholic Theology_, Vol. II, p. 229, 2nd ed., London 1901.)

2 The asterisk before an author’s name indicates that his treatment of the subject is especially clear and thorough. As St. Thomas is invariably the best guide, the omission of the asterisk before his name never means that we consider his work inferior to that of other writers. There are vast stretches of theology which he scarcely touched.

3 Cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _God the Author of Nature and the Supernatural_, pp. 181 sqq., St. Louis 1912.

_ 4 Theologiae Graecorum Patrum Vindicatae circa Universam Materiam Gratiae Libri III_, I, 4, Paris 1646.

5 “The same name is loosely applied to the act of ‘blessing’ the food before taking it, which is properly the function of a priest, but which is suitably performed by every Christian.” (Hunter, _Outlines of Dogmatic Theology_, Vol. III, p. 6.) Cfr. S. Thomas, _Summa Theologica_, 1a 2ae, qu. 110, art. 1: “_Secundum communem loquendi modum tripliciter gratia accipi consuevit: uno modo pro dilectione alicuius...; secundo sumitur pro aliquo dono gratis dato...; tertio modo sumitur pro recompensatione beneficii gratis dati, secundum quod dicimur agere gratias beneficiorum._”

6 Rom. XI, 6: “_Si autem gratia, iam non ex operibus; alioquin gratia iam non est gratia._”

_ 7 Tract. in Ioannem_, III, n. 9: “_Quid est gratia? Gratis data. Quid est gratis data? Donata, non reddita._”

_ 8 Debitum naturae._

_ 9 Epistula ad Innocent._, n. 2: “_Nam si intellexissent illi episcopi, eam illum dicere gratiam, quam etiam cum impiis habemus, cum quibus homines sumus, negare vero eam quâ Christiani et filii Dei sumus, quis eum patienter ... ante oculos suos ferret? Quapropter non culpandi sunt iudices, qui ecclesiasticâ consuetudine nomen gratiae_ [_i.e._ _christianae] audierunt._”

10 On the difference between these two categories see Pohle-Preuss, _God the Author of Nature and the Supernatural_, pp. 180 sqq.

_ 11 Epist. ad Innocent._, _l.c._: "_Etsi quâdam non improbandâ ratione dicitur gratia Dei quâ creati sumus [gratia naturalis], ... alia est tamen, quâ praedestinati vocamur, iustificamur, glorificamur [gratia supernaturalis]._"

_ 12 Epist. ad Sixt._, 194, n. 8: "_Haec est enim gratia, quam in libris Dei legere et populis praedicare catholici antistites consueverunt, et gratia quam commendat Apostolus non est ea quâ creati sumus, ut homines essemus, sed quâ iustificati sumus, quum mali homines essemus._"

13 St. Augustine, _Ep._, 217: "_Hoc [scil. credere] opus est gratiae, non naturae. Opus est, inquam, gratiae quam nobis attulit secundus Adam, non naturae quam totam perdidit in seipso Adam._"

_ 14 Gratia est donum gratis datum supernaturale._

15 Cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _Soteriology. A Dogmatic Treatise on the Redemption_, pp. 24 sqq., St. Louis 1914.

_ 16 Gratia est donum gratis datum, supernaturale, ex meritis Christi._

17 Cfr. St. Augustine, _Contra Duas Epistolas Pelagianorum_, IV, 15.

18 Cfr. Rom. III, 21 sqq.; Gal. II, 16.

_ 19 Gratia est donum gratis datum, supernaturale, internum, ex meritis Christi._

20 St. Matthew X, 8: "_Infirmos curate, mortuos suscitate, leprosos mundate, daemones eiicite: gratis accepistis, gratis date_ (δωρεὰν δότε)."—The name "gratuitously given," as Fr. Hunter observes (_Outlines_, III, 10), is "tautological and not particularly expressive," and "helps in no way to indicate what is the nature of the graces which it is intended to exclude. These are such as, for want of a better word, we call ingratiating: the Latin name used by theologians (_gratum faciens_) denotes that they make a man pleasing to God, grateful to Him, if we understand _grateful_ of that which gives pleasure, and not in its commoner sense, which is nearly the same as thankful."

21 For a list of the charismata see 1 Cor. XII, 4 sqq. Cfr. Englmann, _Von den Charismen im allgemeinen und von dem Sprachencharisma im besonderen_, Ratisbon 1848; Cornely, _Comment. in S. Pauli Priorem Epistolam ad Corinthios_, pp. 410 sqq., Paris 1890; Chr. Pesch, _Praelect. Dogmat._, Vol. V, 3rd ed., pp. 243 sqq., Freiburg 1908.

22 1 Cor. XII, 31: "_Aemulamini autem charismata meliora, et adhuc excellentiorem viam vobis demonstro._"

_ 23 Caritas_, ἀγάπη.

24 1 Cor. XIII, 1 sqq. Cfr. St. Thomas Aquinas, _Summa Theol._, 1a 2ae, qu. 111, art. 5: "_Unaquaeque virtus tanto excellentior est, quanto ad altius bonum ordinatur. Semper autem finis potior est his, quae sunt ad finem [i.e. media]. Gratia autem gratum faciens ordinat hominem immediate ad coniunctionem ultimi finis; gratiae autem gratis datae ordinant hominem ad quaedam praeparatoria finis ultimi, sicut per prophetiam et miracula et huiusmodi homines inducuntur ad hoc quod ultimo fini

coniungantur. Et ideo gratia gratum faciens est multo excellentior quam gratia gratis data._”

_ 25 Gratia est donum gratis datum, supernaturale, internum, gratum faciens, ex meritis Christi._

26 Cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _God the Author of Nature and the Supernatural_, pp. 229 sq.

_ 27 Ibid._, pp. 298 sq.

_ 28 Ep. ad Simplician._, I, 9, 22: “_Voluntas ipsa, nisi aliquid occurrerit quod delectet et invitet animum, moveri nullo modo potest; hoc autem, ut occurrat, non est in hominis potestate._”

_ 29 Enchiridion_, c. 98: “_Quis tam impie desipiat, ut dicat, Deum malas hominum voluntates, quas voluerit, quando voluerit, ubi voluerit, in bonum non posse convertere?_”

30 “_Domine, ... ad te nostras etiam rebelles compelle propitius voluntates._” For a full treatment of God’s moral causality the student is referred to Ripalda, _De Ente Supernaturali_, disp. 109, sect. 2 sq.

31 Cfr. D. Palmieri, _De Gratia Divina Actuali_, thes. 15.

_ 32 Causa formalis._

_ 33 Causa efficiens._

_ 34 Causa meritoria._

_ 35 Causa materialis._

_ 36 Causalitas moralis._

_ 37 Causalitas physica._

_ 38 Causa finalis inadaequata._

_ 39 Causa finalis adaequata._

40 On the _potentia obedientialis_ see Pohle-Preuss, _God the Author of Nature and the Supernatural_, pp. 188 sqq.

41 Can. 7, quoted by Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 180.

_ 42 Supra_, p. 11.

43 “_Lex Domini immaculata, convertens animas, ... praeceptum Domini lucidum, illuminans oculos._”

44 “_Christus passus est pro nobis, vobis relinquens exemplum, ut sequamini vestigia eius._”

_ 45 De Spiritu et Litera_, c. 34: “_Visorum suasionibus agit Deus, ut velimus et ut credamus, sive extrinsecus per evangelicas exhortationes sive intrinsecus, ubi nemo habet in potestate, quid ei veniat in mentem._”

46 2 Cor. III, 4 sq.: "_Fiduciam autem talem habemus per Christum ad Deum; non quod sufficientes simus cogitare aliquid a nobis quasi ex nobis, sed sufficientia nostra ex Deo est._"

47 1 Cor. III, 6: "_Ego plantavi, Apollo rigavit; sed Deus incrementum dedit_ (ἀλλὰ ὁ θεὸς ηὔξανεν). _Itaque neque qui plantat est aliquid neque qui rigat, sed qui incrementum dat, Deus_ (ὁ αὐξάνων θεός)."

_ 48 De Gratia Christi_, c. 19: "_Ipse in bonis arboribus cooperatur fructum, qui et forinsecus rigat atque excolit per quemlibet ministrum et per se dat intrinsecus incrementum._" Cfr. also Eph. I, 17 sq., Acts XXVI, 16 sqq., 2 Cor. IV, 6, 1 John II, 20 and 27.

49 Cfr. Mazzella, _De Gratia_, disp. 1, art. 1, §4, 3rd ed., Rome 1882.

_ 50 Tract. in Ioa._, III, 13: "_Magisteria forinsecus adiutoria quaedam sunt et admonitiones; cathedram in coelo habet, qui corda tenet._"

_ 51 L.c._: "_Interior magister est, qui docet; Christus docet, inspiratio ipsius docet._"

_ 52 Ep. 17 de Incarn. et Grat._ n. 67: "_Frustra [divinus sermo] exterioribus auribus sonat, nisi Deus spiritali munere auditum hominis interioris aperiat._" Other Patristic texts will be found in the classic work of Ripalda, _De Ente Supernaturali_, disp. 101, sect. 3-4.

53 It is to be noted, however, that the term _gratia inspirationis_, both in the writings of St. Augustine and in the decrees of Trent (Sess. VI, can. 3), sometimes also denotes the immediate illuminating grace of the mind.

_ 54 De Gratia Christi_, c. 12: "_Quâ gratiâ agitur, non solum ut facienda noverimus, verum etiam ut cognita faciamus, nec ut solum diligenda credamus, verum etiam ut credita diligamus._"

_ 55 Op. cit._, c. 26: "_Cognitionem et dilectionem, sicut sunt discernenda, discernat, quia scientia inflat, quando caritas aedificat.... Et quum sit utrumque donum Dei, sed unum minus, alterum maius, non sic iustitiam nostram super laudem iustificatoris extollat, ut horum duorum quod minus est divino tribuat adiutorio, quod autem maius est humano usurpet arbitrio._"

56 He applies a variety of practically synonymous terms to the strengthening grace of the will, for instance: _delectatio coelestis_, _spiritus caritatis_, _inspiratio dilectionis_, _bona voluntas_, _voluptas_, _sanctum desiderium_, _inspiratio suavitatis_, _cupiditas boni_, etc.

57 Canon 4: "_Quisquis dixerit, eandem gratiam Dei per Iesum Christum D. N. propter hoc tantum adiuvare ad non peccandum, quia per ipsam nobis aperitur el revelatur intelligentia mandatorum, ut sciamus quid appetere et quid vitare debeamus, non autem per illam nobis praestari ut quod faciendum cognoverimus, etiam facere diligamus atque valeamus, a. s.; ... quum sit utrumque donum Dei, et scire quid facere debeamus et diligere ut faciamus._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 104.)

_ 58 Contra Collator._, c. VII, 2: "_Trahit timor; principium enim sapientiae timor Domini (Prov. I, 7). Trahit laetitia, quoniam laetatus sum in his, quae dicta sunt mihi: in domum Domini ibimus (Ps. CXXI, 1). Trahit desiderium, quoniam concupiscit et deficit anima mea in atria Domini (Ps. LXXXIII, 3). Trahunt delectationes: quam dulcia enim faucibus meis eloquia tua, super mel et favum ori meo (Ps. CXVIII, 103). Et quis perspicere aut enarrare possit, per quos affectus visitatio Dei animum ducat humanum?_" Cfr. Schiffini, _De Gratia Divina_, thes. 11; Palmieri, _De Gratia Divina Actuali_, thes. 8.

_ 59 De Anima_, I, 8: Ἄνευ φαντάσματος οὐκ ἔστι νοεῖν.

_ 60 De Peccatorum Meritis et Remissione_, II, 19, 33: "_... ut suave faciat, quod non delectabat._"

61 2 Cor. XII, 9: "_Sufficit tibi gratia mea._" For further information on this point the student is referred to Ripalda, _De Ente Supernaturali_, disp. 44, sect. 9.

_ 62 In Psalmos_, 102, n. 16: "_Vocat [Deus] per intimam cognitionem._"—_Tract. in Ioa._, 26, n. 7: "_Videte quomodo trahit Pater, docendo delectat._"

_ 63 Summa Theol._, 1a 2ae, qu. 110, art. 2.

_ 64 S. Theol._, 1a 2ae, qu. 25, art. 2.

65 "_... quum sit utrumque donum Dei, et scire quid facere debeamus, et diligere ut faciamus._" (_V. supra_, p. 25.)

66 "_Amor Dei propter se super omnia._"

_ 67 V. infra_, Part II, Ch. I.

68 Cfr., _e.g._, _De Trinitate_, VIII, 10: "_Quid est dilectio vel caritas, quam tantopere Scriptura divina laudat et praedicat, nisi amor boni?_"—_Contra Duas Epistolas Pelag._, II, 9, 21: "_Quid est boni cupiditas nisi caritas?_"—_De Gratia Christi_, c. 21: "_Quasi vero aliud sit bona voluntas quam caritas._"

69 It should also be noted that in Augustine's writings _inspiratio caritatis_, as an immediate grace of the will, is not necessarily identical with the infusion of theological love.

_ 70 E.g._ Berti, _De Theol. Discipl._, XIV, 7.

71 Cfr. Alvarez, _De Aux._, disp. 67, n. 6.

72 Alvarez, _op. cit._, disp. 74.—Cfr. John VI, 44: "_Nemo potest venire ad me, nisi Pater, qui misit me, traxerit eum._" Apoc. III, 20: "_Ecce sto ad ostium et pulso; si quis audierit vocem meam et aperuerit mihi ianuam, intrabo ad illum._"

_ 73 Comment. in Summam Theol. S. Thomae Aquinatis_, p. 2, tr. 6, qu. 2, art. 2, §2.

_ 74 V. supra_, Nos. 1 and 2.

_ 75 Ad Simplic._, I, 2, n. 21: "_Quis potest credere, nisi aliquâ vocatione, h. e. aliquâ rerum testificatione tangatur? Quis habet in potestate tali viso attingi mentem

suam, quo eius voluntas moveatur ad fidem?_”

76 Cfr. Suarez, _De Div. Grat._, III, 4: “_In Conciliis et Patribus nullum vestigium talis gratiae invenimus, quin potius ipsam inspirationem ponunt ut gratiam primam et praeterea indicant immediate infundi ab ipso Spiritu Sancto et non mediante aliquâ qualitate._”

_ 77 De Gratia_, diss. 4, art. 2.

_ 78 Summa Theol._, 1a 2ae, qu. 110, art. 2: “_In eo, qui dicitur gratiam Dei habere, significatur esse quidam effectus gratuitae Dei voluntatis. Dictum est autem supra (qu. 109, art. 1), quod dupliciter ex gratuita Dei voluntate homo adiuvatur: uno modo inquantum anima hominis movetur a Deo ad aliquid cognoscendum vel volendum vel agendum; et hoc modo ipse gratuitus effectus in homine non est qualitas, sed motus quidam animae; actus enim moventis in moto est motus, ut dicitur (Phys. 1, 3, text. 18). Alio modo adiuvatur homo ex gratuita Dei voluntate, secundum quod aliquod habituale donum a Deo animae infunditur ... et sic donum gratiae qualitas quaedam est._”—Cfr. Palmieri, _De Gratia Div. Actuali_, thes. 16; Pesch, _Praelect. Dogmat._, Vol. V, 3rd ed., pp. 23 sqq.; Schiffini, _De Gratia Divina_, pp. 220 sqq. The Thomistic doctrine on this point is viewed with favor by several Molinist theologians, _e.g._, Platel (_De Gratia_, n. 547) and Gutberlet (_Dogmatische Theologie_, Vol. VIII, pp. 25 sq., Mainz 1897).

_ 79 De Peccat. Merit. et Rem._, II, 18: “_Quoniam quod a Deo nos avertimus nostrum est, et haec est voluntas mala; quod vero ad Deum nos convertimus nisi ipso excitante et adiuvante non possumus, et haec est voluntas bona._”

_ 80 De Grat. et Lib. Arbitr._, c. 17, 33: “_Ipse ut velimus, operatur incipiens, qui volentibus cooperatur perficiens._”—On certain differences of opinion on this point between Suarez (_De Div. Motione_, III, 5) and St. Thomas (_Summa Theol._, 1a 2ae, qu. 111, art. 2), see Schiffini, _De Gratia Divina_, pp. 252 sqq.

81 Cfr. Ps. LVIII, 11; XXII, 6.

_ 82 Enchiridion_, c. 32: “_Nolentem praevenit, ut velit; volentem subsequitur, ne frustra velit._”

_ 83 Conc. Trident._, Sess. VI, cap. 5: “_Declarat praeterea, ipsius justificationis exordium in adultis a Dei per Iesum Christum praeveniente gratia sumendum esse, h. e. ab eius vocatione, qua nullis eorum existentibus meritis vocantur._” (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 797.)

_ 84 Summa Theol._, 1a 2ae, qu. 111, art. 3: “_Sicut gratia dividitur in operantem et cooperantem secundum diversos effectus, ita etiam in praevenientem et subsequentem, qualitercumque gratia accipiatur (i.e. sive habitualis sive actualis). Sunt autem quinque effectus gratiae in nobis, quorum primus est ut anima sanetur; secundus ut bonum velit; tertius est ut bonum quod vult efficaciter operetur; quartus est ut in bono perseveret; quintus est ut ad gloriam perveniat. Et ideo gratia, secundum quod causat in nobis primum effectum, vocatur praeveniens respectu secundi effectus; et prout causat in nobis secundum, vocatur subsequens respectu primi effectus. Et sicut unus effectus est posterior uno effectu et prior alio, ita gratia

potest dici praeveniens et subsequens secundum eundem effectum respectu diversorum._”

_ 85 Conc. Trident._, Sess. VI, cap. 16: “_Iesus Christus in ipsos iustificatos iugiter virtutem influit, quae virtus bona eorum opera semper antecedit et comitatur et subsequitur._”

86 On the distinction to be drawn between the various members of these pairs, whether it be real or merely logical, theologians differ. Cfr. Palmieri, _De Div. Grat._, thes. 18; Chr. Pesch, _Praelect. Dogmat._, Vol. V, 3rd ed., pp. 17 sqq.; Schiffini, _De Gratia Divina_, pp. 241 sqq.

_ 87 V. supra_, Nos. 1 and 4.

88 Sess. VI, cap. 5 and can. 4, quoted in Denzinger-Bannwart’s _Enchiridion_, n. 797 and 814.

_ 89 Ad Simplic._, I, qu. 2, n. 22: “_Voluntas ipsa, nisi aliquid occurrerit, quod delectet atque invitet animum, moveri nullo modo potest; hoc autem ut occurrat, non est in hominis potestate._”

_ 90 Contr. Collator._, c. VII, 2: “_Et quis perspicere aut enarrare possit, per quos affectus visitatio Dei animum ducat humanum, ut quae fugiebat sequatur, quae oderat diligat, quae fastidiebat esuriat, ac subitâ commutatione mirabili quae clausa ei fuerant sint aperta, quae onerosa levia, quae amara sint dulcia, quae obscura sint lucida?_”

91 Cfr. M. Cronin, _The Science of Ethics_, Vol. I, pp. 30 sqq., Dublin 1909.

_ 92 Contra Duas Epistolas Pelagian._, II, 9, 21: “_Multa Deus facit in homine bona, quae non facit homo; nulla vero facit homo, quae non facit Deus, ut faciat homo._”

_ 93 De Gratia et Lib. Arbitr._, c. 17, n. 33: “_Ut ergo velimus, sine nobis operatur; quum autem volumus et sic volumus ut faciamus, nobiscum cooperatur; tamen sine illo vel operante ut velimus, vel cooperante quum volumus, ad bona pietatis opera nihil valemus._”

_ 94 De Gratia et Lib. Arbitr._, c. 14: “_Si ergo Deus tria haec, h. e. bonum cogitare, velle, perficere, operatur in nobis (2 Cor. III, 5; Phil. II, 13), primum profecto sine nobis, secundum nobiscum, tertium per nos facit. Siquidem immittendo bonam cogitationem, nos praevenit; immutando etiam malam voluntatem sibi per consensum iungit; ministrando et consensui facultatem foris per apertum opus nostrum internus opifex innotescit. Sane ipsi nos praevenire nequaquam possumus. Qui autem bonum neminem invenit, neminem salvat, quem non praevenit. A Deo ergo sine dubio nostrae fit salutis exordium, nec per nos utique nec nobiscum. Verum consensus et opus, etsi non ex nobis, non iam tamen sine nobis._”—On the misinterpretation of this text by the Jansenists, see Palmieri, _De Gratia Divina Actuali_, pp. 84 sq.

_ 95 Moral._, XVI, 10: “_Superna pietas prius agit in nobis aliquid sine nobis [gratia praeveniens], ut subsequente libero arbitrio bonum, quod appetimus, agat nobiscum [gratia cooperans]._”

_ 96 Conc. Trid._, Sess. VI, c. 16: "_Tanta est [Dei] erga homines bonitas, ut eorum velit esse merita quae sunt ipsius dona._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 810.)

_ 97 De Grat. et Lib. Arbitr._, c. 16, 32: "_Certum enim est nos mandata servare, si volumus; sed quia praeparatur voluntas a Domino, ab illo petendum est, ut tantum velimus quantum sufficit, ut volendo faciamus. Certum est nos velle, quum volumus; sed ille facit ut velimus bonum, de quo dictum est quod paulo ante posui (Prov. VIII, 35): ____Praeparatur voluntas a Domino____; de quo dictum est (Ps. XXXVI, 32): ____A Domino gressus hominis dirigentur et viam eius volet____; de quo dictum est (Phil. II, 13): ____Deus est qui operatur in nobis et velle.____ Certum est nos facere quum facimus; sed ille facit ut faciamus, praebendo vires efficacissimas voluntati, qui dixit (Ezech. XXXVI, 27): ____Faciam ut in iustificationibus meis ambuletis et iudicia mea observetis et faciatis.____ Quum dicit: ____Faciam ut faciatis,____ quid aliud dicit nisi (Ezech. XI, 19): ____Auferam a vobis cor lapideum,____ unde non faciebatis, (Ezech. XXXVI, 26), et ____dabo vobis cor carneum,____ unde facitis._"—On the subject of this paragraph see Palmieri, _op. cit._, thes. 10, and Chr. Pesch, _op. cit._, pp. 14 sqq.

98 Cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _God the Author of Nature and the Supernatural_, pp. 67 sqq.

99 Cfr. Palmieri, _De Div. Grat. Actuali_; thes. 17, and Chr. Pesch, _Praelect. Dogmat._, Vol. V, 3rd ed., pp. 28 sqq.

_ 100 V. infra_, Ch. III, Sect. 2.

_ 101 De Grat. et Lib. Arbitr._, c. 16, 32: "_Certum est nos facere, quum facimus; sed ille facit ut faciamus, praebendo vires efficacissimas voluntati._"

_ 102 De Corrept. et Grat._, c. 11: "_Acceperat posse, si vellet [gratia sufficiens]; sed non habuit velle [gratia efficax] quod posset, nam si habuisset, perseverasset._" Cfr. Palmieri, _De Div. Grat. Actuali_, thes. 11.

_ 103 De Nat. et Grat._, 43: "_Nam Deus impossibilia non iubet, sed iubendo monet, et facere quod possis, et petere quod non possis, et adiuvat ut possis._"

_ 104 De Gratia Christi_, IV, 10: "_... ita inefficax, ex qua operatio ne possit quidem sequi, nisi eius inefficacia per aliam suppleatur._"

105 "_Illud a recentioribus prolatum gratiae sufficientis genus, quo adiuvante nullum unquam opus factum est aut fiet unquam, videtur monstrum quoddam singulare gratiae, solummodo peccatis faciendis maiorique damnationi accersendae serviens._" (_De Grat. Christi_, III, 3).

106 "_Gratia sufficiens statui nostro non tam utilis quam perniciosa est, sic ut proinde merito possimus petere: A gratia sufficienti libera nos, Domine._" This assertion was condemned by Pope Alexander VIII in 1690. It is convincingly refuted by Schiffini, _De Gratia Divina_, pp. 354 sqq.

107 "_Hoc etiam secundum fidem catholicam credimus, quod acceptâ per baptismum gratiâ omnes baptizati Christo auxiliante et cooperante, quae ad salutem pertinent, possint et debeant, si fideliter laborare voluerint, adimplere._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 200.)

108 Sess. VI, can. 4: “_Si quis dixerit, liberum hominis arbitrium a Deo motum et excitatum nihil cooperari Deo, ... neque posse dissentire, si velit, anathema sit._” (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 814.)

109 Is. V, 4: “_Quid est, quod debui ultra facere vineae meae et non feci ei? An quod exspectavi, ut faceret uvas et fecit labruscas?_”

110 Prov. I, 24: “_Vocavi et renuistis, extendi manum meam et non fuit qui adspiceret._”

111 Matth. XI, 21.

112 Cfr. Matth. XXIII, 37; Acts VII, 51; 1 Cor. X, 13; 2 Cor. VI, 1; 1 Thess. V, 19.

_ 113 Contra Haer._, IV, 37, 1: “_Illud autem quod dicit (Matth. XXIII, 37): Quoties volui colligere filios tuos, et noluisti, veterem libertatem hominis manifestat, quia liberum eum fecit Deus ab initio.... Vis enim a Deo non fit, sed bona sententia adest illi semper. Et propter hoc consilium quidem bonum dat omnibus.... Et qui operantur quidem illud [gratia efficax], gloriam et honorem percipient, quoniam operati sunt bonum, quum possint non operari illud; hi autem, qui illud non operantur, indicium iustum excipient Dei, quoniam non sunt operati bonum [gratia inefficax], quum possint operari illud [gratia vere et mere sufficiens]._”

114 “_Gratia Dei ... quae hominum adiuvat voluntates: qua ut non adiuventur, in ipsis itidem causa est, non in Deo._” _De Peccat. Mer. et Rem._, II, 17.

_ 115 De Lib. Arbitr._, III, 16: “_Ex eo quod non accepit, nullus reus est; ex eo autem quod non facit quod debet, iuste reus est. Debet autem [facere], si accepit et voluntatem liberam et sufficientissimam facultatem._” On the Jansenist distortions of St. Augustine’s teaching see Palmieri, _De Gratia Divina Actuali_, thes. 48. The doctrine of the Greek Fathers is thoroughly rehearsed by Isaac Habert, _Theol. Patr. Graec._, II, 6 sq.

_ 116 Conc. Vat.,_ Sess. III, De Revel., can. 1: “_Si quis dixerit, Deum unum et verum, Creatorem et Dominum nostrum, per ea, quae facta sunt, naturali rationis humanae lumine certo cognosci non posse, anathema sit._”

_ 117 Conc. Vat._, Sess. III, cap. 4: “_Hoc quoque perpetuus Ecclesiae catholicae consensus tenuit et tenet, duplicem esse ordinem cognitionis, non solum principio, sed obiecto etiam distinctum: principio quidem, quia in altero naturali ratione et altero fide divinâ cognoscimus; obiecto autem, quia praeter ea, ad quae naturalis ratio pertingere potest, credenda nobis proponuntur mysteria in Deo abscondita, quae, nisi revelata divinitus, innotescere non possunt._” (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 1795.)

118 Nicholas d’Autricourt, a master in the University of Paris, in 1348, was compelled by the Sorbonne and the Apostolic See to retract a number of propositions taken from his writings which were infected with scepticism. These propositions, most of which had been censured as heretical, and some as merely false, may be found in Natalis Alexander, _Hist. Eccles._, ed. Bing., XV, 195, and also, with some explanatory remarks, in Denifle-Chatelain, _Chartularium Univ. Paris._, II, 1, Paris

1891.

119 “_Klotz-, Stock- und Steintheorie_.”

120 On Traditionalism, see Pohle-Preuss, _God: His Knowability, Essence, and Attributes_, pp. 44 sqq., 2nd ed., St. Louis 1914.

121 Wisd. XIII, 1 sqq.; Rom. I, 20 sq.; Rom. II, 14 sq. Cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _op. cit._, pp. 17 sqq.

_ 122 Ibid._, pp. 38 sqq.

_ 123 Summa Theol_., 1a, qu. 2, art. 2, ad 1: “_Deum esse et alia huiusmodi ... non sunt articuli fidei, sed praeambula ad articulos; sic enim fides praesupponit cognitionem naturalem, sicut gratia naturam et perfectio perfectibile_.”

_ 124 Luther’s Werke_, ed. Walch, XII, 400, Halle 1742: “_Alles, was sie örtert und schleusst, so gewisslich falsch und irrig ist, als Gott lebt._”

_ 125 Conc. Trid._, Sess. VI, cap. 1 and canon 5.

126 On the _vulnera naturae_ cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _God the Author of Nature and the Supernatural_, pp. 298 sqq., St. Louis 1912. Already St. Augustine observed: “_Ad miseriam iustae damnationis pertinet ignorantia et difficultas, quam patitur homo ab exordio nativitatis suae, nec ab isto malo nisi Dei gratiâ liberatur._” (_Retract._, I. 9.)

_ 127 Propos._ 41: “_Omnis cognitio Dei etiam naturalis, etiam in philosophis ethnicis, non potest venire nisi a Deo; et sine gratia non producit nisi praesumptionem, vanitatem et oppositionem ad ipsum Deum loco affectuum adorationis, gratitudinis et amoris._” (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 1391.)

128 On the _debitum naturae_ cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _God the Author of Nature and the Supernatural_, pp. 184 sq.

_ 129 Summa Theol._, 1a 2ae, qu. 2, art. 4.

_ 130 Conc. Vatic._, Sess. III, _De Revel._, cap. 2: “_Ut ea, quae in rebus divinis humanae rationi per se impervia non sunt, in praesenti quoque generis humani conditione ab omnibus expedite, firmâ certitudine et nullo admixto errore cognosci possint._”

131 Cfr. Chastel, S. J., _De la Valeur de la Raison Humaine_, Paris 1854; O. Willmann, _Geschichte des Idealismus_, Vol. III, 2nd ed., pp. 811 sqq., Braunschweig 1908; Bellarmine, _De Gratia et Libero Arbitrio_, V, 1 sqq.

132 The only dissenting voice is that of Cardinal Cajetan.

133 Mezzofanti spoke perfectly thirty-eight languages, thirty others less perfectly, and was more or less familiar with fifty dialects. Cfr. U. Benigni in the _Catholic Encyclopedia_, Vol. X, p. 271.

134 On the question whether grace can enable a man to acquire an unlimited, universal knowledge, see Pohle-Preuss, _Christology_, pp. 258 sqq., St. Louis 1913. Cfr. also St. Thomas, _Summa Theol._, 1a 2ae, qu. 109, art. 1, and Palmieri, _De Gratia Divina Actuali_, thes. 19.

_ 135 Prop. Baii Damn._, 27: "_Liberum arbitrium sine gratiae Dei adiutorio nonnisi ad peccandum valet._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 1027.)

_ 136 Prop. Baii Damn._, 37: "_Cum Pelagio sentit, qui boni aliquid naturalis, i.e. quod ex naturae solis viribus ortum ducit, agnoscit._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 1037.)

_ 137 Prop. Baii Damn._, 25: "_Omnia opera infidelium sunt peccata et philosophorum virtutes sunt vitia._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 1025.)

_ 138 Prop. Damn. ab Alex. VIII_: "_Necesse est infidelem in omni opere peccare._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 1298.)

139 Matth. V, 46 sq.

_ 140 Mercedem_, μισθόν.

_ 141 Salutaveritis_, ἀσπάσησθε.

_ 142 Ethnici_, οἱ ἐθνικοί.

143 Rom. II, 14 sqq.

_ 144 Gentes_, ἔθνη.

145 That is, the _Mosaic_ law.

_ 146 Naturaliter_, φύσει.

_ 147 Naturaliter_, φύσει.

148 "_Quae legis sunt, faciunt._"

149 Rom. I, 21 sqq.

150 For other germane texts see Ezech. XXIX, 18 sqq.; Rom. I, 21.

151 πᾶν δὲ ὅ οὐκ ἐκ πίστεως, ἁμαρτία ἐστιν.

152 πίστις = συνείδησις.

153 Cfr. also 1 Cor. VIII, 10 sqq. For a fuller explanation see Scheeben, _Dogmatik_, Vol. III, pp. 954 sqq.

154 Ezech. XXIX, 20: "And for the service that he hath done me against it [the city of Tyre], I have given him the land of Egypt, because he hath labored for me, saith the Lord God."

_ 155 In Ezech._, XXIX, 20: "_Ex eo quod Nabuchodonosor accepit mercedem boni operis, intelligimus etiam ethnicos, si quid boni fecerint, non absque mercede Dei iudicio praeteriri._"

_ 156 In Gal._, I, 15: "_Multi absque fide et evangelio Christi vel sapienter faciunt aliquid vel sancte, ut parentibus obsequantur, ut inopi manum porrigant, non opprimant vicinos, non aliena diripant._"

_ 157 De Spiritu et Litera_, c. 28: "_Sicut enim non impediunt a vita aeterna iustum quaedam peccata venialia, sine quibus haec vita non ducitur, sic ad salutem aeternam nihil prosunt impio aliqua bona opera, sine quibus difficillime vita cuiuslibet pessimi

hominis invenitur._”

_ 158 Ep._, 144, 2.

_ 159 Confess._, VI, 10.

_ 160 Ep._, 138, c. 3: “_Deus enim sic ostendit in opulentissimo et praeclaro imperio Romanorum, quantum valerent civiles etiam sine verâ religione virtutes, ut intelligeretur hâc additâ fieri homines cives alterius civitatis, cuius rex veritas, cuius lex caritas, cuius modus aeternitas._”

_ 161 De Spiritu et Litera_, c. 3, n. 5: “_Neque liberum arbitrium quidquam nisi ad peccandum valet, si lateat veritatis via._”

_ 162 Sent. ex August._, n. 106: “_Omnis vita infidelium peccatum est et nihil est bonum sine summo bono. Ubi enim deest agnitio summae et incommutabilis veritatis, falsa virtus est etiam in optimis moribus._”

163 What Augustine himself observes of the literary style of St. Cyprian (_Ep._, 93, c. 10, n. 39): “_Habet quandam propriam faciem, quâ possit agnosci_,” applies in an even truer sense to his own writings.

164 Cfr. _Enchirid._, c. 30.

165 Cfr. _De Correptione et Gratia_, c. 9, n. 20 sqq.

166 For a fuller and more adequate treatment of this question see J. Ernst, _Werke und Tugenden der Ungläubigen nach Augustinus_, Freiburg 1871; Ripalda, _De Ente Supernaturali_, t. III, Cologne 1648; S. Dechamps, _De Haeresi Ianseniana_, Paris 1645; and, more briefly, Palmieri, _De Gratia Divina Actuali_, thes. 21.

167 Palmieri, _l.c._, thes. 20. Concerning the effects of original sin on free-will, see Pohle-Preuss, _God the Author of Nature and the Supernatural_, pp. 291 sq.

168 On this distinction see _supra_, pp. 15 sqq.

_ 169 Summa Theol._, 2a 2ae, qu. 10, art. 4: “_Bona opera, ad quae sufficit bonum naturae, aliqualiter operari possunt [infideles]. Unde non oportet quod in omni suo opere peccent; sed quandocunque aliquod opus operantur ex infidelitate, tunc peccant._”

170 Cfr. _Conc. Trident._, Sess. VI, can. 7: “_Si quis dixerit, opera omnia quae ante iustificationem fiunt, quacunque ratione facta sint, vere esse peccata vel odium Dei mereri, aut quanto vehementius quis nititur se disponere ad gratiam, tanto eum gravius peccare, anathema sit._” (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 817.)

_ 171 V. infra_, No. 3.

172 Cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _God the Author of Nature and the Supernatural_, pp. 226 sqq.

173 “_Propositio temeraria et errori proxima._”

_ 174 Conc. Trid._, Sess. VI, cap. 13: “_Verumtamen qui se existimant stare, videant ne cadant, et cum timore ac tremore salutem suam operentur.... Formidare

enim debent ... de pugna, quae superest cum carne, cum mundo, cum diabolo, in qua victores esse non possunt, nisi cum Dei gratiâ Apostolo obtemperent dicenti: Debitores etc._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 806.)

175 Rom. VII, 22 sqq.

176 Rom. VII, 24 sq.

177 Cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _Mariology_, pp. 80 sqq., St. Louis 1914.

178 Cfr. St. Thomas, _Summa Theol._, 1a 2ae, qu. 109, art. 5; Heinrich-Gutberlet, _Dogmatische Theologie_, Vol. VIII, § 416, Mainz 1897.

_ 179 De Ente Supernaturali_, disp. 114, sect. 18.

_ 180 Concord._, art. 13, disp. 19.

181 Cfr. Chr. Pesch, _Praelect. Dogmat._, Vol. V, pp. 87 sqq.

182 Cfr. the following passage from the Tridentine Council: "_... cum timore ac tremore salutem suam operentur in laboribus, in vigiliis, in eleemosynis, in orationibus et oblationibus, in ieiuniis et castitate._"

_ 183 De Natura et Gratia_, c. 48, n. 62: "_Fideles enim orantes dicunt: Ne nos inferas in tentationem. Si adest possibilitas, ut quid orant? Aut a quo malo se liberari orant nisi maxime de corpore mortis huius?... de vitiis carnalibus, unde non liberatur homo sine gratiâ Salvatoris.... Orare sinatur, ut sanetur. Quid tantum de naturae possibilitate praesumitur? Vulnerata, sauciata, vexata, perdita est; verâ confessione, non falsâ defensione opus habet._" The necessity of grace, and of prayer to obtain grace, is admirably and exhaustively treated by Suarez, _De Necessitate Gratiae_, I, 23, sqq. Cfr. also Bellarmine, _De Gratia et Libero Arbitrio_, V, 7 sqq.

_ 184 Comment. in Quatuor Libros Sent._, III, dist. 27, qu. unica: "_Ratio recta docet, solum summum bonum infinitum esse summe diligendum et per consequens voluntas hoc potest ex puris naturalibus; nihil enim potest intellectus recte dictare, in quod dictatum non possit voluntas rationalis naturaliter tendere._"

_ 185 Comment. in Summam Theol. S. Thomae Aqu._, 2a 2ae, qu. 171, art. 2.

_ 186 Comment. in Summam Theol. S. Thomae Aqu._, 2a 2ae, qu. 24, art. 2.

_ 187 De Natura et Gratia_, I, 21.

_ 188 Concord._, qu. 14, art. 13, disp. 14.

_ 189 De Gratia_, I, 33.

_ 190 De Gratia et Libero Arbitrio_, VI, 7: "_Existimamus non posse Deum sine ope ipsius diligi neque ut auctorem naturae neque ut largitorem gratiae et gloriae, neque perfecte neque imperfecte ullo modo, ... quicquid aliqui minus considerate in hac parte scripserint._" On the attitude of St. Thomas (_Summa Theol._, 1a 2ae, qu. 109, art. 3) cfr. Billuart, _De Gratia_, diss. 3, art. 4.

191 It is not true, as Bellarmine argues, that the _amor Dei naturalis_ at its highest would result in justification.

_ 192 Prop. Baii Damn._, 34: "_Distinctio illa duplicis amoris, naturalis videlicet, quo Deus amatur ut auctor naturae, et gratuiti, quo Deus amatur ut beatificator, vana est et commentitia._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 1034).—36: "_Amor naturalis, qui ex viribus naturae exoritur, ex sola philosophia per elationem praesumptionis humanae cum iniuria crucis Christi defenditur a nonnullis doctoribus._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 1036.)

_ 193 Cfr. Conc. Arausic._ II, a. 529, can. 25: "_Prorsus donum Dei est diligere Deum._"

194 Cfr. _Conc. Trid._, Sess. VI, can. 3.

_ 195 Praelect. Dogm._, Vol. V, pp. 73 sqq.

_ 196 Instit. Theolog._, Vol. III, pp. 19 sqq.

197 Rom. I, 21.

198 Rom. I, 25.

_ 199 In Epist. ad Roman._, I, 18: "_Potuerunt enim id per legem naturae apprehendere, fabricâ mundi testificante auctorem Deum solum diligendum, quod Moyses literis tradidit; sed impii facti sunt non colendo Creatorem et iniustitia in eis apparet, dum videntes dissimulabant a veritate, non fatentes unum Deum._"

_ 200 Comment. in Summam Theol. S. Thomae Aqu._, 1a 2ae, disp. 189 sq.

_ 201 De Ente Supernaturali_, disp. 20.

_ 202 Op. cit._

203 To admit the possibility of true _actus humani_ that are neither good nor bad, but ethically indifferent, is to escape the error of Baius that "Free-will without the aid of divine grace avails for nothing but sin." (_Prop. Damn._, 27.)

204 We should not, however, apply the ecclesiastical censures pronounced against Baius to the writings of Vasquez. This, as Schiffini convincingly shows (_De Gratia Divina_, pp. 159 sqq.), would be an injustice.

205 Suarez, _De Gratia_, I, 8, 46: "... _quia secundum Augustini et divi Thomae sententiam communis a theologis probatam non datur in voluntate libere operante actus indifferens in individuo, et ideo iuxta veram theologiam recte sequitur, si liberum arbitrium potest sine gratia non male operari, posse etiam bene._"

_ 206 Supra_, p. 8.

207 "_Quâ vero parte inter dominantem cupiditatem et caritatem dominantem nulli ponuntur affectus medii, a natura ipsa insiti suapteque naturâ laudabiles ... falsa, alias damnata._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 1524.)

_ 208 De Ente Supernaturali_, disp. 20, sect. 2: "_Quotiescunque homo agit quod sibi datum est, ut actum virtutis naturalem efficiat, iam adesse antecedenter Deum auxilio intrinsece supernaturali gratiae, ... ita [ut] nullus sit conatus moraliter bonus naturae, quem aliqua gratia supernaturalis non praeveniat._"

209 This must be kept in mind in judging Ripalda's famous thesis: "_Ad quodlibet bonum opus morale sive ad quemlibet virtutis moralis actum necessarium esse per se naturae rationali elevatae auxilium theologicum gratiae._" (_Ibid._, sect. 3.)

210 He urges the supernatural character, in principle, of the present economy of salvation; the practical identity of the naturally good with the supernaturally salutary acts of the will, which he claims is taught in Sacred Scripture (cfr. Acts XIV, 14 sqq.; Rom. I, 19 sqq.), and also by St. Augustine and his disciples Prosper and Orosius; the merciful dispensation of grace towards heathens, unbelievers, and sinners (_v. infra_, Sect. 3, Art. 2); the universal belief of Christians in the salutary effects of all good works, including those of the purely natural order, etc. For a discussion of these arguments consult Palmieri, _De Gratia Divina Actuali_, pp. 254 sqq.

_ 211 Synopsis de Gratia_, n. 530.

_ 212 Praelect. Dogmat._, Vol. V, p. 72.

_ 213 De Virtute Fidei Divinae_, disp. 12, sect. 2.

_ 214 Instit. Theolog._, Vol. III, pp. 22 sq., 248 sqq.

_ 215 De Gratia Div. Actuali_, p. 268: "_Si tamen ad solos fideles coarctetur, quum nulla argumenta obstent et pro hac hypothesi maxime valeant rationes Ripaldae, eam censemus veram esse._"

_ 216 V. supra_, No. 1.

217 Cfr. Mazzella, _De Gratia Christi_, disp. 2, art. 9.

_ 218 V. supra_, p. 71.

219 "_Fides late dicta ex testimonio creaturarum similive motivo ad iustificationem sufficit._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 1173.)

_ 220 Conc. Vat._, Sess. III, De Fide, can. 2: "_Si quis dixerit, ... ad fidem divinam non requiri, ut revelata veritas propter auctoritatem Dei revelantis credatur, anathema sit._" On this whole dispute cfr. Schiffini, _De Gratia Divina_, pp. 156 sqq. The arguments adduced by the defenders of Ripalda's opinion can be studied in Palmieri, _De Gratia Divina Actuali_, pp. 265 sqq. Cfr. also Scheeben, _Dogmatik_, Vol. III, pp. 996 sqq. A difficulty arises from the twenty-second canon of the Second Council of Orange (A. D. 529): "_Nemo habet de suo nisi mendacium et peccatum._" But this canon was probably never approved by the Holy See. It is ably discussed by Gutberlet in his continuation of Heinrich's _Dogmatische Theologie_, Vol. VIII, § 415.

221 "_Ex viribus suis [natura] coram Deo nihil nisi peccare potest._" (_Solida Declar._, I, § 22.) Cfr. J. A. Möhler, _Symbolik_, § 6-7 (English tr. by J. B. Robertson, _Symbolism_, 5th ed., London 1906, pp. 54 sqq.)

_ 222 Conc. Trid._, Sess. VI, can. 7: "_Si quis dixerit, opera omnia, quae ante iustificationem fiunt, ... vere esse peccata, ... anathema sit._"

223 Cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _God the Author of Nature and the Supernatural_, pp. 183 sqq., _et passim_.

224 A. D. 1585-1638. Cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _op. cit._, pp. 223 sqq.

225 On this important document (issued A. D. 1713) see A. Schill, _Die Konstitution Unigenitus_, Freiburg 1876; Thuillier, _La Seconde Phase du Jansénisme_, Paris 1901; M. Ott, art. “Unigenitus” in Vol. XV of the _Catholic Encyclopedia_.

_ 226 Prop. Damn._, 38.

_ 227 Prop. Damn._, 44.

228 “_Doctrina synodi de duplici amore enuntians, hominem sine gratia esse sub virtute peccati ipsumque in eo statu per generalem cupiditatis dominantis influxum omnes suas actiones inficere et corrumpere—quatenus insinuat, in homine, dum est sub servitute sive in statu peccati, … sic dominari cupiditatem ut per generalem huius influxum omnes illius actiones in se inficiantur et corrumpantur, aut opera omnia quae ante iustificationem fiunt, quacunque ratione fiant, sint peccata, quasi in omnibus suis actibus peccator serviat dominanti cupiditati: falsa, perniciosa, inducens in errorem a Tridentino damnatum ut haereticum, iterum in Baio damnatum art. 40._” (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 1523).

_ 229 Prop. Damn._, 59: “_Oratio impiorum est novum peccatum, et quod Deus illis concedit, est novum in eos iudicium._” (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 1409.)

230 This passage, and the meaning it evidently bears in the context of St. Matthew’s Gospel, is thoroughly discussed by Suarez, _De Gratia_, I, 4. Cfr. also J. B. Faure, _Notae in Enchiridion S. August._, c. 15. Other Scriptural texts distorted by the Jansenists are quoted and explained in their true sense by Scheeben, _Dogmatik_, Vol. III, pp. 923 sqq.

_ 231 Hom. in Is._, 5, n. 2.

232 “_Scimus autem quia peccatores Deus non audit._”

_ 233 Tract. in Ioa._, 44, n. 13: “_Adhuc inunctus loquitur; nam et peccatores exaudit Deus. Si enim peccatores Deus non exaudiret, frustra ille publicanus oculos in terram demittens et pectus suum percutiens diceret: Domine, propitius esto mihi peccatori [Luc. XVIII, 13]._”

_ 234 Contr. Collat._, n. 36: “_Naturae humanae, cuius creator est Deus, etiam post praevaricationem manet substantia, manet forma, manet vita et sensus et ratio ceteraque corporis et animi bona, quae etiam malis vitiosisque non desunt. Sed non illis veri boni perceptio est, quae mortalem vitam honestare possunt, aeternam conferre non possunt._” For additional Patristic texts in confirmation of our thesis see Ripalda, _De Ente Supernaturali_, t. III, disp. 20, sect. 4.

_ 235 Enchiridion_, c. 117, n. 31: “_Regnat carnalis cupiditas, ubi non est Dei caritas._”

_ 236 De Gratia Christi_, c. 26: “_Ubi non est dilectio, nullum bonum opus imputatur, non recte bonum opus vocatur, quia omne quod non est ex fide peccatum est et fides per dilectionem operatur._”

_ 237 De Gratia et Libero Arbitrìo_, c. 18: "_Praecepta dilectionis, i.e. caritatis, tanta et talia sunt, ut quidquid se putaverit homo facere bene, si fiat sine caritate, nullo modo fiat bene._"

238 Cfr. _supra_, p. 29.

_ 239 Proposit. Baii Damn._, 38: "_Omnis amor creaturae rationalis aut vitiosa est cupiditas quâ mundus diligitur, quae a Ioanne prohibetur, aut laudabilis caritas quâ per Spiritum Sanctum in corde diffusa Deus amatur._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 1038.)

_ 240 Prop. Quesnelli Damn._, 45: "_Amore Dei in corde peccatorum non amplius regnante necesse est, ut in eo carnalis regnet cupiditas omnesque actiones eius corrumpat._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 1395.)

_ 241 Infra_, Ch. III, Sect. 1.

242 Especially against Julian of Eclanum. Cfr. _Contra Iulianum_, IV, 3.

243 Matth. VI, 24.

_ 244 Retract._, I, 15: "_Quando peccatum tale est, ut idem sit poena peccati, quantum est quod valet voluntas sub dominante cupiditate, nisi forte, si pia est, ut oret auxilium?_"

_ 245 Prop. Baii Damn._, 40: "_In omnibus suis actibus peccator servit dominanti cupiditati._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 1040.)

_ 246 De Spiritu et Litera_, c. 27, n. 48: "_Si hi qui naturaliter, quae legis sunt, faciunt, nondum sunt habendi in numero eorum quos Christi iustificat gratia [Rom. II, 24], sed in eorum potius, quorum (etiam impiorum nec Deum verum veraciter iusteque colentium) quaedam tamen facta vel legimus vel novimus vel audimus, quae secundum iustitiae regulam non solum vituperare non possumus, verum etiam merito recteque laudamus; quamquam si discutiantur, quo fine fiant, vix inveniuntur quae iustitiae debitam laudem defensionemve mereantur._"

_ 247 Serm. de Temp._, 349, c. 1, 1 sq.: "_Caritas alia est divina, alia humana; alia est humana licita, alia illicita.... Prius ergo loquor de humana licita, quae non reprehenditur; deinde de humana illicita, quae damnatur; tertio de divina, quae nos perducit ad regnum.... Licitam ergo caritatem habete; humana est, sed ut dixi licita, sed ita licita ut, si defuerit, reprehendatur. Liceat vobis humanâ caritate diligere coniuges, diligere filios, diligere amicos vestros, diligere cives vestros. Sed videtis istam caritatem esse posse et impiorum, i.e. paganorum, Iudaeorum, haereticorum. Quis enim eorum non amat uxorem, filios, fratres, vicinos, affines, amicos? Haec ergo humana est. Si ergo tali quisque crudelitate effertur, ut perdat etiam humanum dilectionis affectum, et non amat filios suos, ... nec inter homines numerandus est._" (Migne, _P. L._, XXXIX, 1529.)

_ 248 Institutiones Theologicae_, Vol. III, p. 23.

249 As explained above, pp. 71 sqq.

250 Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 1524. On the teaching of St. Augustine, see J. Mausbach, _Die Ethik des hl. Augustinus_, Vol. II, pp. 260 sqq., Freiburg 1909.

251 Cfr. _supra_, Art. 1.

252 On these and similar formulas see Palmieri, _De Gratia Divina Actuali_, thes. 22.

253 Cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _God the Author of Nature and the Supernatural_, pp. 218 sqq.

254 For details of his life see J. Pohle, art. “Pelagius and Pelagianism” in Vol. XI of the _Catholic Encyclopedia_.

_ 255 Impeccantia_, ἀναμαρτησία.

256 Cfr. St. Augustine, _De Haeres. ad Quodvultdeum_, n. 88.

257 “_Hoc est occultum et horrendum virus haeresis vestrae, ut velitis gratiam Christi in exemplo eius esse, non in dono eius, dicentes quia per eius imitationem fiunt iusti, non per subministrationem Spiritus Sancti._” (S. Aug., _Opus Imperf. contr. Iulian._, II, 146.)

258 On the _regnum coelorum_ in contradistinction to _vita aeterna_, in the teaching of Pelagius, see St. Augustine, _De Pecc. Mer. et Rem._, I, 18 sqq.

_ 259 V. infra_, Sect. 2.

_ 260 V. supra_, p. 8.

_ 261 e.g._ Petavius, _De Pelag. et Semipelag._, c. 8 sq.; Wirceburg., _De Gratia_, n. 182; Palmieri, _De Gratia Div. Actuali_, pp. 140 sqq.

262 Among them Suarez, _Prolegom. de Gratia_, c. 3, and J. Scheeben, _Dogmatik_, Vol. III, pp. 739 sq.

263 “_Quicunque dixerit, ideo nobis gratiam iustificationis dari, ut quod facere per liberum iubemur arbitrium facilius possimus implere per gratiam, tamquam etsi gratia non daretur, non quidem facile, sed tamen possimus etiam sine illa implere divina mandata, anathema sit._” (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 105.)

264 “_Si quis per naturae vigorem bonum aliquod, quod ad salutem pertinet vitae aeternae, cogitare ut expedit aut eligere sive salutari, i.e. evangelicae praedicationi consentire posse confirmat absque illuminatione et inspiratione Spiritus Sancti, qui dat omnibus suavitatem in consentiendo et credendo veritati, haeretico fallitur spiritu._” (Can. 7, quoted by Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 180.)

265 Sess. VI, can. 2: “_Si quis dixerit, ad hoc solum divinam gratiam per Iesum Christum dari, ut facilius homo iuste vivere ac vitam aeternam promereri possit, quasi per liberum arbitrium sine gratia utrumque, sed aegre tamen et difficulter possit, anathema sit._” (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 812.)

266 “_Sicut palmes non potest ferre fructum a semetipso, nisi manserit in vite: sic nec vos, nisi in me manseritis. Ego sum vitis, vos palmites: qui manet in me, et ego in eo, hic fert fructum multum: quia sine me nihil potestis facere_ (ὅτι χωρὶσ ἐμοῦ οὐ

δύνασθε ποιεῖν οὐδέν).”

267 St. Augustine, _Tract. in Ioa._, 81, n. 3: “_Non ait, quia sine me parum potestis facere, sed nihil potestis facere. Sive ergo parum sive multum, sine illo fieri non potest, sine quo nihil fieri potest._”

268 Cfr. John XV, 3.

269 “_Non quod sufficientes simus, cogitate aliquid a nobis quasi ex nobis, sed sufficientia nostra ex Deo est._” On this text cfr. Cornely, _Comment. in h. l._, Paris 1892.

270 “_Moysi enim dicit: Miserebor cuius misereor et misericordiam praestabo cuius miserebor. Igitur non volentis neque currentis_ (οὐ τοῦ θέλοντος οὐδὲ τοῦ τρέχοντος), _sed miserentis est Dei._” (Rom. IX, 15 sq.)

271 “_Deus est enim, qui operatur in vobis et velle et perficere_ (καὶ τὸ θέλειν καὶ τὸ ἐνεργεῖν) _pro bona voluntate._” (Phil. II, 13.)

272 “_Nemo potest dicere: Dominus Iesus, nisi in Spiritu Sancto._” (1 Cor. XII, 3.)

273 Cfr. Matth. VII, 21; VIII, 29.

274 Others explain the passage 1 Cor. XII, 3 differently. Cfr. also Rom. VIII, 26; Phil. I, 6; Eph. II, 5 sqq.

_ 275 De Gratia et Libero Arbitrio_, c. 4: “_Talis est haeresis pelagiana, non antiqua, sed ante non multum tempus exorta._”

276 “_Desinat, si res ita sunt, incessere novitas vetustatem._”

_ 277 Adv. Haer._, III, 17, 2: “_Sicut arida terra, si non percipiat humorem, non fructificat, sic et nos lignum aridum existentes nunquam fructificaremus vitam sine superna voluntaria pluvia.... Non a nobis, sed a Deo est bonum salutis nostrae._”

278 “_Legem credendi lex statuat supplicandi. Quum enim sanctarum plebium praesules madatâ sibi legatione fungantur apud divinam clementiam, humani generis agunt causam et tota secum Ecclesia congemiscente postulant et precantur, ut infidelibus donetur fides, ut idololatrae ab impietatis suae liberentur erroribus, ut Iudaeis ablato cordis velamine lux veritatis appareat, ut haeretici catholicae fidei perceptione resipiscant, ut schismatici spiritum redivivae caritatis accipiant, ut lapsis poenitentiae remedia conferantur, ut denique catechumenis ad regenerationis sacramenta perductis coelestis misericordiae aula reseretur._” (Migne, _P. L._, XLV, 1759.)

279 For additional Patristic texts see Palmieri, _De Gratia Divina Actuali_, thes. 26.

_ 280 Hom. in 1 Cor., 7._

_ 281 De Civitate Dei_, XII, 9: “_Istam [bonam voluntatem] quis fecerat nisi ille, qui eos cum bona voluntate, i.e. cum amore casto quo illi adhaererent creavit, simul eis et condens naturam et largiens gratiam?... Confitendum est igitur cum debita laude Creatoris, non ad solos sanctos homines pertinere, verum etiam de sanctis angelis posse dici, quod caritas Dei diffusa sit in eis per Spiritum Sanctum, qui datus est

eis._”

_ 282 Enchiridion_, c. 106: “_Sicut mori est in hominis potestate, quum velit, ... ad vitam vero tenendam voluntas non satis est, si adiutoria sive alimentorum sive quorumcunque tutaminum desint, sic homo in paradiso ad se occidendum relinquendo iustitiam idoneus erat per voluntatem; ut autem ab eo teneretur vita iustitiae, parum erat velle nisi ille, qui eum fecerat, adiuvaret._”

283 Can. 19: “_Natura humana, etiamsi in illa integritate in qua est condita permaneret, nullo modo seipsam, Creatore suo non adiuvante, servaret. Unde quum sine gratia Dei salutem non possit custodire quae accepit, quomodo sine Dei gratia poterit reparare quod perdidit?_” (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 192.)—St. Augustine holds that our first parents would have been able to preserve the state of grace by the divine _adiutorium sine quo non_, and that consequently the _adiutorium quo_ would have been superfluous to them. On this subtle question cfr. Pesch, _Praelectiones Dogmaticae_, Vol. V, pp. 55 sqq., and Schiffini, _De Gratia Divina_, pp. 472 sqq.

_ 284 Summa Theol._, 1a 2ae, qu. 109, art. 5: “_Vita aeterna est finis excedens proportionem naturae humanae ... et ideo homo per sua naturalia non potest producere opera meritoria proportionata vitae aeternae; sed ad hoc exigitur altior virtus, quae est virtus gratiae. Et ideo sine gratia homo non potest mereri vitam aeternam. Potest tamen facere opera perducentia ad bonum aliquod homini connaturale, sicut laborare in agro, bibere, manducare et habere amicum et alia huiusmodi._”

285 For the necessary Augustinian citations in proof of this assertion see Palmieri, _De Gratia Divina Actuali_, pp. 174 sqq.

286 Cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _God the Author of Nature and the Supernatural_, pp. 186 sqq.

_ 287 V. supra_, pp. 20.

_ 288 V. supra_, pp. 26 sq.

_ 289 V. supra_, pp. 69 sqq.

290 On the teaching of Scotus himself with regard to this point cfr. P. Minges, O.F.M., _Die Gnadenlehre des Duns Scotus auf ihren angeblichen Pelagianismus und Semipelagianismus geprüft_, Münster 1906.

291 This is true of man even in the exalted state in which he existed in Paradise. It is true also of the angels. It is true even of the human nature of our Lord Jesus Christ Himself. Cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _Christology_, pp. 221 sqq.

292 Cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _God the Author of Nature and the Supernatural_, pp. 190 sqq.

293 Palmieri, _De Gratia Divina Actuali_, p. 184.

294 Suarez, _De Necessitate Gratiae_, II, 4.

295 On the whole subject of this Article cfr. S. Schiffini, _De Gratia Divina_, pp. 227 sqq.; Rademacher, _Natur und Gnade_, M. Gladbach 1908.

296 Died 432. On his life and works see Bardenhewer-Shahan, _Patrology_, pp. 515 sqq.

297 Reproduced in Migne, _P. L._, XLIX, 477-1328.

298 This contention is false, but it has never been proscribed as heretical. Prosper says in his _Ep._ 226, 5: "_Tales aiunt perdi talesque [infantes] salvari, quales futures illos in annis maioribus, si ad activam servarentur vitam, scientia divina praeviderit._" On this absurd assertion see Pohle-Preuss, _God: His Knowability, Essence, and Attributes_, pp. 380 sq.

_ 299 De Praedest. Sanctorum_, c. 3, n. 7: "_... putans fidem, quâ in Deum credimus, non esse donum Dei, sed a nobis esse in nobis et per illam nos impetrare Dei dona, quibus temperanter et iuste et pie vivamus in hoc saeculo._"

300 Cfr. Denzinger-Bannwart, _Enchiridion_, n. 128 sqq.

301 Ernst (_Werke und Tugenden der Ungläubigen nach Augustinus_, Freiburg 1871) contends that the approbation of Boniface II comprised all the canons of this synod.

302 Cfr. F. Wörter, _Zur Dogmengeschichte des Semipelagianismus_, Münster 1900.

_ 303 Conc. Arausic._ II, can. 5 (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 178): "_Si quis sicut augmentum, ita etiam initium fidei ipsumque credulitatis affectum, quo in eum credimus qui iustificat impium et ad regenerationem sacri baptismatis pervenimus, non per gratiae donum, i.e. per inspirationem Spiritus S., ... sed naturaliter nobis inesse dicit, apostolicis dogmatibus adversarius approbatur._" Cfr. _Conc. Vatican._, Sess. III, cap. 3. (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 1791).

304 In his treatise _De Praedestinatione Sanctorum_.

305 In his work _Adversus Collatorem_.

_ 306 Discernit_, διακρίνει.

_ 307 Per fidem_, διὰ πίστεως.

_ 308 Non ex vobis_, οὐκ ἐξ ὑμῶν.

_ 309 Dei donum_, θεοῦ τὸ δῶρον.

_ 310 Non ex operibus_, οὐκ ἐξ ἔργων.

311 Eph. II, 8 sq.

312 Cfr. Rom. III, 20 sqq., IX, 15 sqq.

313 John VI, 44: "_Nemo potest venire ad me, nisi Pater, qui misit me, traxerit_ (ἑλκύσῃ) _eum._"

_ 314 Opus Dei_, τὸ ἔργον τοῦ Θεοῦ.

_ 315 Ep._, 177: “_Oratio est clarissima gratiae testificatio._”

_ 316 Dial. c. Tryph._

_ 317 De Dono Persev._, c. 19, n. 50: “_Isti tales tantique doctores dicentes non esse aliquid, de quo tamquam de nostro quod nobis Deus non dederit gloriemur nec ipsum cor nostrum et cogitationes nostras in potestate nostra esse, ... haec utique gratiae Dei tribuunt, Dei munera agnoscunt, ab ipso nobis, non a nobis esse testantur._”—For additional Patristic texts see Palmieri, _De Gratia Div. Act._, pp. 290 sqq.

318 Cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _God the Author of Nature and the Supernatural_, pp. 239 sqq.

_ 319 Hom. in Heb._, 12, n. 3.

_ 320 V. infra_, Ch. III, Sect. 1.

_ 321 De Praedest. Sanct._, c. 14: “_Quid opus est ut eorum scrutemur opuscula, qui priusquam ista haeresis oriretur, non habuerunt necessitatem in hac difficili ad solvendum quaestione versari? Quod procul dubio facerent, si respondere talibus cogerentur. Unde factum est, ut de gratia Dei quid sentirent breviter quibusdam scriptorum suorum locis et transeunter attingerent._”

_ 322 De Gratia Div. Act._, p. 288.

323 Cfr. Ripalda, _De Ente Supernaturali_, l. I, disp. 17, sect. 11.

_ 324 Ep._, 24 (to Maximilian, Patriarch of Constantinople): “_Sequere priorum, a quibus eruditus es et nutritus, exempla pontificum, beatissimi Ioannis scientiam, sancti Attici in repugnandis haeresibus vigilantiam._”

_ 325 Hom. in 1 Cor._, XII, n. 2.

_ 326 Hom. in Ep. ad Hebr._, XII, 2.

327 Αὐτὸς ἐν ἡμῖν πίστιν ἐνέθησεν, αὐτὸς τὴν ἀρχὴν ἔδωκεν.

328 They are fully explained by Palmieri, _l.c._, pp. 295 sqq.

_ 329 Die Lehre von der Heiligung_, p. 161, Paderborn 1885.

_ 330 V. supra_, pp. 19 sqq., 27 sq.

_ 331 De Praedest. Sanct._, c. 2, p. 5: “_Attendant hic et verba perpendant, qui putant ex nobis esse fidei coeptum et ex Deo esse fidei supplementum. Quis enim non videat prius esse cogitare quam credere? Nullus quippe credit aliquid nisi prius cogitaverit esse credendum.... Quod ergo pertinet ad religionem atque pietatem, si non sumus idonei cogitare aliquid quasi ex nobismet ipsis, sed sufficientia nostra ex Deo est, profecto non sumus idonei credere aliquid quasi ex nobismet ipsis, quod sine cogitatione non possumus, sed sufficientia nostra, quâ credere incipiamus, ex Deo est._”—Cfr. also the seventh canon of the Second Council of Orange (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 180), and Suarez, _De Fide_, disp. 6, sect. 7 sq.; IDEM, _De Gratia_, III, 7.

_ 332 Conc. Arausic._ II, can. 7.

333 Sess. VI, can. 3: "_Si quis dixerit, sine praeveniente Spiritus Sancti inspiratione atque eius adiutorio hominem credere, sperare, diligere aut poenitere posse, sicut oportet, ut ei iustificationis gratia conferatur, anathema sit._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 813.)

_ 334 Supra_, pp. 87 sqq.

335 John XV, 5: "_Sine me nihil potestis facere._"

_ 336 Contra Duas Epistolas Pelag._, II, 8: "_Dominus ut responderet futuro Pelagio non ait: Sine me difficile potestis facere, sed ait: Sine me nihil potestis facere.... Non ait: sine me nihil potestis perficere, sed facere. Hoc uno verbo initium finemque comprehendit._"

337 Phil. II, 12 sq.: "_Cum metu et tremore vestram salutem_ (σωτηρίαν) _operamini; Deus est enim qui operatur in vobis et velle et perficere._"

338 Rom. XV, 13: "_Deus autem spei repleat vos omni gaudio et pace in credendo_ (ἐν τῷ πιστεύειν), _ut abundetis in spe (ἐν τῇ ἐλπίδι) et virtute Spiritus Sancti._"

339 1 John IV, 7: "_Caritas ex Deo est_ (ἡ ἀγάπη ἐκ τοῦ Θεοῦ ἐστιν)." Cfr. also John VI, 44 sqq., which text is fully explained by Schiffini, _De Gratia Divina_, pp. 128 sqq.

_ 340 Enchiridion_, c. 32: "_Porro si nullus dicere Christianus audebit: Non miserentis est Dei, sed volentis est hominis, ne Apostolo apertissime contradicat, restat ut propterea dictum intelligatur (Rom. IX, 16): ____Non volentis neque currentis, sed miserentis est Dei,____ ut totum Deo detur, qui hominis voluntatem bonam et praeparat adiuvandam et adiuvat praeparatam. Praecedit enim bona voluntas hominis multa Dei dona, sed non omnia; quae autem non praecedit ipsa, in iis est et ipsa. Nam utrumque legitur in sanctis eloquiis: et (Ps. LVIII, 11): ____Misericordia eius praeveniet me,____ et (Ps. XXII, 6): ____Misericordia eius subsequetur me.____ Nolentem praevenit, ut velit; volentem subsequitur, ne frustra velit. Cur enim admonemur orare pro inimicis nostris, utique nolentibus pie vivere, nisi ut Deus in illis operetur et velle? Itemque cur admonemur petere ut accipiamus, nisi ut ab illo fiat quod volumus, a quo factum est ut velimus? Oramus ergo pro inimicis nostris, ut misericordia Dei praeveniat eos, sicut praevenit et nos; oramus autem pro nobis, ut misericordia eius subsequatur nos._" On this important passage cfr. J. B. Faure, _Notae in Enchiridion S. Augustini_, c. 32. Similar expressions will be found in _Contra Duas Epist. Pelag._, II, 9 and _De Gratia et Lib. Arb._, c. 17.

_ 341 Ep. ad Ctesiph._, 133: "_Velle et currere meum est, sed ipsum meum sine Dei semper auxilio non erit meum; dicit enim Apostolus (Phil. II, 13): ____Deus est enim qui operatur in vobis et velle et perficere.____... Non mihi sufficit, quod semel donavit, nisi semper donaverit._"

_ 342 Serm. de Pret. Marg._

_ 343 Conc. Arausic._ II. (A. D. 529); "_Hoc etiam salubriter profitemur et credimus, quod in omni opere bono non nos incipimus et postea per Dei misericordiam adiuvamur, sed ipse nobis nullis praecedentibus bonis meritis et fidem

et amorem sui prius inspirat, ut et baptismi sacramenta fideliter requiramus et post baptismum cum ipsius adiutorio ea, quae sibi sunt placita, implere possimus._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 200.)

344 Cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _God the Author of Nature and the Supernatural_, pp. 192 sqq.

345 Cfr. Schiffini, _De Gratia Divina_, pp. 132 sq.

346 Perrone, _De Gratia_, n. 203: "_Quaestio haec non ad scholasticas quaestiones pertinet, sed est dogma fidei ab Ecclesia definitum._"

347 Sess. VI, cap. 16: "_Quum enim ille ipse Christus Iesus tamquam caput in membra et tamquam vitis in palmites in ipsos iustificatos iugiter virtutem influat, quae virtus bona eorum opera semper antecedit et comitatur et subsequitur et sine qua nullo pacto Deo grata et meritoria esse possent, nihil ipsis iustificatis amplius deesse credendum est._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 809.) Cfr. Tepe, _Institutiones Theologicae_, Vol. III, pp. 41 sqq., Paris 1896.

348 John XV, 5.

_ 349 V. supra_, pp. 87 sq. Other pertinent Scriptural texts are: 2 Cor. III, 5; Phil. II, 12 sq.; III, 13 sq.; Heb. XIII, 21.

_ 350 De Gratia et Lib. Arb._, c. 17: "_Sine illo vel operante vel cooperante quum volumus ad bona pietatis opera nihil valemus._"

_ 351 De Natura et Gratia_, c. 26: "_Mala nostra non ad hoc solum medicus supernus sanat, ut illa iam non sint, sed ut de cetero recte ambulare possimus, quod quidem etiam sani nonnisi illo adiuvante poterimus.... Sicut oculus corporis etiam plenissime sanus, nisi candore lucis adiutus non potest cernere, sic et homo etiam perfectissime iustificatus, nisi aeternae luce iustitiae divinitus adiuvetur, recte non potest vivere._"

352 "_Actiones nostras, quaesumus Domine, aspirando praeveni et adiuvando prosequere, ut cuncta nostra oratio et operatio a te semper incipiat et per te coepta finiatur._" (_Missale Romanum._) The argument from Tradition is more fully developed by Palmieri, _De Gratia Divina Actuali_, thes. 28.

353 Thus Molina (_Concord._, qu. 14, art. 13 disp. 8), Bellarmine (_De Gratia et Lib. Arb._, VI, 15), and Thomassin; the question is well treated by Ruiz, _De Providentia Divina_, disp. 41, sect. 5 sq.

354 Cfr. Heinrich-Gutberlet, _Dogmatische Theologie_, Vol. VIII, § 399, Mainz 1897.

355 Cfr. Ripalda, _De Ente Supernaturali_, disp. 106, sect. 3 sqq.

_ 356 Impeccantia_, ἀναμαρτησία.

357 "_Item placuit ut quicunque ipsa verba dominicae orationis, ubi dicimus: Dimitte nobis debita nostra, ita volunt a sanctis dici, ut humiliter hoc, non veraciter dicatur, anathema sit._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 108.)

358 Sess. VI, can. 23: “_Si quis hominem semel iustificatum dixerit ... posse in tota vita peccata omnia etiam venialia vitare nisi ex speciali Dei privilegio, quemadmodum de beata virgine tenet Ecclesia, anathema sit._” (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 833.)

359 On this privilege of our Blessed Lady see Pohle-Preuss, _Mariology_, pp. 72 sqq., St. Louis 1914.

360 Sess. VI, cap. 11: “_... quantumvis sancti et iusti in levia saltem et quotidiana, quae etiam venialia dicuntur, peccata quandoque cadunt._” (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 804.)

_ 361 De Gratia Divina Actuali_, p. 236.

362 Epistle of St. James, III, 2: “_In multis enim offendimus omnes_ (πολλὰ γὰρ πταίομεν ἅπαντες).”

363 1 John III, 6: “_Omnis qui in eo [scil. Christo] manet, non peccat._”

364 ὀφειλήματα.

365 Matth. VI, 12. Cfr. Mark XI, 25.

366 Prov. XX, 9: “_Quis potest dicere: Mundum est cor meum, purus sum a peccato?_”

367 On this text cfr. J. V. Bainvel, _Les Contresens Bibliques des Prédicateurs_, 2nd ed., pp. 102 sq., Paris 1906: “_... ces chutes sont surtout les souffrances, les tribulations. Le contexte l’indique clairement: __‹ __N’attaquez pas le juste (15); car Dieu le defend, et s’il tombe il se relèvera; mais pour l’impie c’est la ruine irréparable.__ ›__ Peut-on, comme on le fait d’ordinaire, entendre le texte des chutes morales, des péchés véniels? Plusieurs commentateurs répondent: non; et ils citent à l’appui saint Augustin: Septies cadet iustus et resurget, id est, quotiescumque cediderit, non peribit: quod non de iniquitatibus, sed de tribulationibus ad humilitatem perducentibus intelligi voluit_ (Civ. D. xi, 31).—_D’autres Pères, saint Jérôme par exemple, sont moins exclusifs; et de fait, pourquoi la maxime, dans sa plénitude, ne comprendrait-elle pas toutes sortes de chutes, péchés ou afflictions? En tout cas, c’est aller trop loin que de vouloir prouver par là la thèse catholique sur l’impossibilité morale d’éviter pendant longtemps tout péché de fragilité. L’écrivain sacré veut dire autre chose, et nous avons des textes meilleures_ ...”

368 Eccles. VII, 21: “_Non est enim homo iustus in terra, qui faciat bonum et non peccet_.”

_ 369 Ibid._, v, 23: “_Scit enim conscientia tua, quia et tu crebro maledixisti aliis_.”

370 1 John I, 8: “_Si dixerimus, quoniam peccatum non habemus, ipsi nos seducimus et veritas in nobis non est_.”

_ 371 E.g._ 1 John I, 10, III, 4, III 8, _et passim_.

372 The Johannine text here under consideration does, however, furnish a telling argument against the Pelagians, in so far as they denied the necessity of the atonement. The passage is effectively employed for this purpose by the Second

Council of Mileve (can. 6, quoted in Denzinger-Bannwart's _Enchiridion_, n. 106). Cfr. Chr. Pesch, _Praelectiones Dogmaticae_, Vol. V, 3rd ed., p. 99 and Al. Wurm, _Die Irrlehrer im ersten Johannesbrief_, Freiburg 1903.

_ 373 De Dono Perseverantiae_, c. 2, n. 4: "_Tria sunt, ut scitis, quae maxime adversus eos [scil. Pelagianos] defendit Ecclesia, quorum est unum, gratiam Dei non secundum merita nostra dari.... Alterum est, in quantacunque iustitia sine qualibuscunque peccatis in hoc corruptibili corpore neminem vivere. Tertium est, obnoxium nasci hominem peccato primi hominis_."

_ 374 De Natura et Gratia_, c. 35, n. 41: "_Ubi parum attendit, quum sit acutissimus, non frustra etiam iustos in oratione dicere: Dimitte nobis debita nostra.... Etiamsi hic non vivatur sine peccato, licet mori sine peccato, dum subinde veniâ deletur, quod subinde ignorantiâ vel infirmitate committitur_."

_ 375 Ibid._, c. 36. "_Si omnes illos sanctos et sanctas, quum hic viverent, congregare possemus et interrogare, utrum essent sine peccato, ... nonne unâ voce clamassent: Si dixerimus quia peccatum non habemus, ipsi nos seducimus et veritas in nobis non est?_"—For other confirmatory Patristic texts see Suarez, _De Gratia_, IX, 8.

376 The above-quoted analogy is taken from Heinrich-Gutberlet, _Dogmatische Theologie_, Vol. VIII, p. 81.

_ 377 Summa Theol._, 1a 2ae, qu. 109, art. 8: "_Non potest homo abstinere ab omni peccato veniali propter corruptionem inferioris appetitus sensualitatis, cuius motus singulos quidem ratio reprimere potest, et ex hoc habent rationem peccati et voluntarii, non autem omnes, quia dum uni resistere nititur, fortassis alius insurgit, et etiam quia ratio non potest semper esse pervigil ad huiusmodi motus vitandos_."

378 Sardagna (_De Gratia_, n. 336) incorrectly asserts this.

379 Cfr. Tepe, _Instit. Theolog._, Vol. III. pp. 47 sq.

380 Cfr. St. Augustine, _Contra Iulian._, IV, 3, 28: "_Ideo factum est in loco infirmitatis, ne superbe viveremus, ut sub quotidiana peccatorum remissione vivamus_."

381 Andr. de Vega, _De Iustificatione Doctrina Universa_, 1. XIV, cap. ult.

382 Suarez, _De Gratia_, IX, 8, 14: "_quia si vel in uno homine posset contingere, ut illa duo coniungerentur, scil. carere speciali privilegio et nihilominus cavere omne peccatum veniale per totam vitam, propositio Concilii esset simpliciter falsa; nam est absoluta et universalis, ad cuius falsitatem satis est quod in uno deficiat_."

383 Aug., _Ep._, 181, n. 8: "_Nemo itaque dicat, se esse sine peccato, sed non tamen ideo debemus amare peccatum. Oderimus ea, fratres; etsi non sumus sine peccatis, oderimus tamen ea, et maxime a criminibus nos abstineamus; abstineamus quantum possumus a levibus peccatis._"—On the whole subject of this thesis cfr. Schiffini, _De Gratia Divina_, pp. 181 sqq.

_ 384 V. supra_, pp. 98 sqq.

_ 385 Conc. Arausic._ II, can. 10: "_Adiutorium Dei etiam renatis ac sanctis semper est implorandum, ut ad finem bonum pervenire vel in bono possint opere perdurare_." (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 183.)

386 Sess. VI, can. 22: "_Si quis dixerit, iustificatum vel sine speciali auxilio Dei in accepta iustitia perseverare posse vel cum eo non posse, anathema sit_." (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 832.)

387 Sess. VI, cap. 11: "_Deus namque suâ gratiâ semel iustificatos non deserit, nisi ab eis prius deseratur_." (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 804.)

388 Cfr. Wisd. IV, 11: "_Raptus est, ne malitia mutaret intellectum eius_."

389 Sess. VI, can. 16: "_magnum illud usque in finem perseverantiae donum_." On St. Augustine's teaching in regard to the different heads of doctrine defined above, see Chr. Pesch, _Praelectiones Dogmaticae_, Vol. V, 3rd ed., pp. 103 sqq.

390 John XVII, 11: "_Pater sancte, serva eos in nomine tuo_ (τήρησον αὐτοὺς ἐν τῷ ὀνόματί σου), _quos dedisti mihi, ut sint unum, sicut et nos_."

391 Col. IV, 12: "_Salutat vos Epaphras ... semper sollicitus pro vobis in orationibus, ut stetis perfecti_ (ἵνα στῆτε τέλειοι) _et pleni in omni voluntate Dei_."

392 Matth. XXVI, 41: "_Vigilate, et orate, ut non intretis in tentationem_."

393 Phil. I, 6: "... _confidens hoc ipsum, quia qui coepit in vobis opus bonum, perficiet_ (ἐπιτελέσει) _usque in diem Christi Iesu_."

394 1 Pet. I, 5: "..._qui in virtute Dei custodimini per fidem in salutem, paratam revelari in tempore novissimo_."—For Old Testament texts in confirmation of this thesis see Schiffini, _De Gratia Divina_, pp. 198 sq.

_ 395 De Dono Perseverantiae_. An English translation of this treatise may be found in _The Anti-Pelagian Works of Saint Augustine, Bishop of Hippo_, Translated by Peter Holmes and R. E. Wallis, Vol. III, pp. 171 sqq. (Vol. XV of Dods' translation of the _Works of St. Augustine_), Edinburg 1876.

_ 396 De Dono Perseverantiae_, c. 2, n. 3: "_Cur autem perseverantia ista poscitur a Deo, si non datur a Deo? An et ista irrisoria petitio est, quum id ab eo petitur quod scitur non ipsum dare, sed ipso non dante esse in hominis potestate?... An ab illo perseverantia ista forte non poscitur? Iam hoc qui dicit, non meis disputationibus refellendus, sed sanctorum orationibus onerandus est. An vero quisquam eorum est, qui non sibi poscat a Deo ut perseveret in eo, quum ipsâ oratione quae dominica nuncupatur, quia eam Dominus docuit, quando oratur a sanctis, nihil paene aliud quam perseverantia posci intelligatur_?"

_ 397 Op. cit._, c. 7, n. 15: "_Prorsus in hac re non operosas disputationes exspectet Ecclesia, sed attendat quotidianas orationes suas. Orat ut increduli credant: Deus ergo convertit ad fidem. Orat ut credentes perseverent; Deus ergo donat perseverantiam usque in finem_."

_ 398 Op. cit._, c. 23, n. 63: "_Quis enim veraciter gemat desiderans accipere quod orat a Domino, si hoc a seipso se sumere existimet, non ab illo_?"

_ 399 Op. cit._, c. 6, n. 10: "_Hoc Dei donum suppliciter emereri potest, sed quum datum fuerit, amitti contumaciter non potest_."

_ 400 Op. cit._, c. 16, n. 39: "... _quum constet Deum alia danda etiam non orantibus, sicut initium fidei, alia nonnisi orantibus praeparasse, sicut in finem perseverantiam, profecto qui ex se ipso se hanc habere putat, non orat ut habeat_."

_ 401 De Ente Supernaturali_, disp. 94, sect. 2.

402 Suarez, _De Gratia_, XII, 38: "_Infallibilitas non convenit merito de congruo ratione sui, ut ita dicam, sed ratione impetrationis quae propriae soli orationi, ut talis est, respondet. Ratio est, quia haec infallibilitas solum fundatur in promissione divina, quae non invenitur facta operibus iustorum quatenus meritoriis de congruo, sed tantum orationi; quare ut fructus huius meriti certior sit, adiungenda semper est petitio perseverantiae_."

403 John XVI, 23.

404 Cfr. Suarez, _De Gratia_, XII, 38, n. 14: "... _quia ut oratio habeat perseverantiam debitam, perdurare debet cum illis circumstantiis moralibus, quas a principio habere etiam debuit, ut congrue fieret; unde eo ipso quod novum impedimentum ponitur [peccando] effectui orationis, deficit perseverantia in orando, saltem debito modo._"

_ 405 Ibid._, n. 17: "_Igitur perseverantia orationis in tali materia requisita est, ut non semel tantum aut iterum fiat, set ut toto tempore vitae duret, et praesertim ut in occurrentibus occasionibus servandi mandata aut vincendi tentationes cum debita fiducia repetatur._"—For more detailed information we must refer the reader to Palmieri, _De Gratia Divina Actuali_, thes. 36, n. vi sqq. The theological argument for our thesis is convincingly set forth by Gutberlet in Heinrich's _Dogmatische Theologie_, Vol. VIII, § 404. The _donum perseverantiae_ must not be confounded with the _confirmatio in gratia_; on this point see Schiffini, _De Gratia Divina_, pp. 197 sqq.

_ 406 V. supra_, pp. 7 sq.

407 Cfr. St. Thomas, _Summa Theol._, 1a 2ae, qu. 114, art. 1: "_Meritum et merces ad idem referuntur. Id enim merces dicitur quod alicui recompensatur pro retributione operis vel laboris quasi quoddam pretium ipsius. Unde sicut reddere iustum pretium pro re accepta ab aliquo est actus iustitiae, ita etiam recompensare mercedem operis vel laboris est actus iustitiae._" Cfr. Taparelli, _Saggio Teoretico del Diritto Naturale_, diss. 1, c. 6, n. 130, Palermo 1842.

408 "This word is scarcely used in modern English, except as expressing that punishment which is fully deserved, a usage originating with the Tudor Parliaments; but it was once commonly used in the language in a wider sense, for whatever had been justly earned, and some attempts to revive it have been made in recent times; certainly some word is wanted to express the idea." (Hunter, _Outlines of Dogmatic Theology_, Vol. III, pp. 58 sq.) Cfr. Dr. Murray's _New English Dictionary_, Vol. II, p. 784, Oxford 1893.

409 Eck did not, however, approve the term _meritum de condigno_; he preferred _meritum digni_. Cfr. J. Greving, _Johann Eck als junger Gelehrter_, pp. 153 sqq., Münster 1906.

410 Cfr. St. Augustine, _In Ps._, 86: "_Debitorem Deus ipse fecit se, non accipiendo, sed promittendo._" On this point consult Pohle-Preuss, _God: His Knowability, Essence, and Attributes,_ pp. 455 sqq.

_ 411 Oratio, preces._

_ 412 Capacitas, dispositio._

413 Vasquez, _Comment. in S. Theol. S. Thomae Aquin._, 1a 2ae, disp. 216, c. 4.

414 Already in the fourth century the Church emphasized the proposition "_Gratiam Christi non secundum merita dari_" against Pelagius.

415 Cfr. St. Augustine, _Ep._ 194 _ad Sixt._, n. 19: ___Vita etiam aeterna, quam certum est bonis operibus debitam reddi, ab Apostolo tamen gratia nuncupatur, nec ideo quia meritis non datur, sed quia data sunt ipsa merita, quibus datur.___ The dogma was formally defined by the Council of Trent: "... _cuius tanta est erga omnes homines bonitas, ut eorum velit esse merita, quae sunt ipsius dona._" (Sess. VI, cap. 16, quoted in Denzinger-Bannwart's _Enchiridion_, n. 809.)

416 For further information on this point see Palmieri, _De Gratia Divina Actuali,_ thes. 35.

_ 417 V. supra_, pp. 83 sqq.

418 "_Gratiam Dei secundum merita nostra dari._"

419 "_Debetur merces bonis operibus, si fiant; sed gratia quae non debetur praecedit, ut fiant._" (Arausic. II, can. 18; see Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 191.)

420 "... _ipsius iustificationis exordium in adultis a Dei per Christum Iesum praeveniente gratia sumendum esse, h. e. ab eius vocatione, quâ nullis eorum existentibus meritis vocantur._" (Sess. VI, cap. 5. Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 797.)

421 Rom. IX, 16: "_Igitur non volentis neque currentis, sed miserentis est Dei._"

422 Rom. IX, 18: "_Ergo cuius vult miseretur et quem vult indurat_ (ἄρα οὖν θέλει δ' δε θέλει σκληρύνει.")

423 Rom. XI, 6: "_Si autem gratiâ, iam non ex operibus_ (ἐξ ἔργων), _alioquin gratia iam non est gratia._"

424 Eph. II, 8-10: "_Gratiâ enim estis salvati per fidem et hoc non ex vobis: Dei enim donum est, non ex operibus, ut ne quis glorietur. Ipsius enim sumus factura_ (ποίημα), _creati in Christo Iesu in operibus bonis, quae praeparavit Deus, ut in illis ambulemus._"

_ 425 E.g._, 2 Cor. V, 14; Gal. III, 22; 2 Tim. I, 9; Tit. III, 5; 1 Pet. I, 3; 1 John IV, 10.

_ 426 Tract, in Ioa._, 86: "_Gratia non invenit, sed efficit merita._"

_ 427 Serm._, 169, c. 2: ___Gratia praecessit meritum tuum, non gratia ex merito, sed meritum ex gratia. Nam si gratia ex merito, emisti non gratis accepisti.___ Other Patristic texts quoted by Ripalda, _De Ente Supernaturali,_ disp. 15 sqq.

_ 428 V. supra_, pp. 50 sqq.

429 For a more extensive treatment of this important point the reader is referred to Heinrich-Gutberlet, _Dogmatische Theologie_, Vol. VIII, § 418, Mainz 1897.

_ 430 V. supra_, p. 98.

431 Can. 20: "_Multa Deus facit in homine bona, quae non facit homo; nulla vero facit homo bona, quae non Deus praestat, ut faciat homo._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 193.)

432 "_Sed ipse [Deus] nobis nullis praecedentibus bonis meritis [scil. naturalibus] et fidem et amorem sui prius inspirat._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 200.)

433 Matth. XXV, 15: "_Et uni dedit quinque talenta, alii autem duo, alii vero unum, unicuique secundum propriam virtutem_ (ἑκάστῳ κατὰ τὴν ἰδίαν δύναμιν)."

434 Cfr. Maldonatus' commentary on this text.

435 Cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _God the Author of Nature and the Supernatural_, p. 326.

_ 436 De Praedest. Sanct._, 3, 10, 31: "_Nihil huic sensui tam contrarium est quam de suis meritis sic quemquam gloriari, tamquam ipse sibi ea fecerit, non Dei gratia, sed gratia quae bonos discernit a malis, non quae communis est bonis et malis._"

_ 437 De Peccato Orig._, c. 24, n. 28: "_Non enim gratia Dei erit ullo modo, nisi gratuita fuerit omni modo._"

438 Cyril of Jerusalem (_Catech._, I, 17), Athanasius (_C. Gent._, n. 30), Basil (_Epist._, 294: "_Divinum auxilium in nostra situm est potestate_"), Gregory of Nazianzus (_Or._, 31), and especially Chrysostom (_Hom. in Gen._, 12; _Hom. in Epist. ad Rom._, 2).

_ 439 Hom. in Epist. ad Ephes._, 4.

_ 440 Hom. in 1 Epist. ad Cor._, 12. Cfr. Palmieri, _De Gratia Divina Actuali_, thes. 33.

441 Cfr. St. Thomas, _Summa Theol._, 1a 2ae, qu. 114, art. 5: "_Donum gratiae considerari potest dupliciter. Uno modo secundum rationem gratuiti doni, et sic manifestum est quod omne meritum repugnat gratiae, quia ut Rom. XI, 9 Apostolus dicit: ____Si autem gratia, iam non ex operibus.____ Altero modo potest considerari secundum naturam ipsius rei, quae donatur, et sic etiam non potest cadere sub merito non habentis gratiam, tum quia excedit proportionem naturae, tum etiam quia ante gratiam in statu peccati homo habet impedimentum promerendi gratiam, scil. ipsum peccatum. Postquam autem aliquis iam habet gratiam, non potest gratia iam habita sub merito cadere, quia merces est terminus operis, gratia autem est principium cuiuslibet boni operis in nobis._" This is equally true of the _meritum de condigno_ and the _meritum de congruo_.

442 John XVI, 24: "_Petite et accipietis._"

_ 443 V. supra_, theses I and II.

444 "_Si quis ad invocationem humanam [i.e. naturalem] gratiam Dei dicit posse conferri, non autem ipsam gratiam facere, ut invocetur a nobis, contradicit Isaiae prophetae vel Apostolo idem dicenti: Inventus sum a non quaerentibus me, palam apparui his, qui me non interrogabant._" (Can. 3, Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 176.)

445 Rom. VIII, 26: "_Quid oremus, sicut oportet, nescimus, sed ipse Spiritus postulat [postulare facit] pro nobis gemitibus inenarrabilibus._"

446 1 Cor. XII, 3: "_Nemo potest dicere Dominus Deus, nisi in Spiritu sancto._"

447 John XV, 7: "_Si manseritis in me et verba mea in vobis manserint, quodcunque volueritis, petetis et fiet vobis._"

_ 448 De Dono Perseverantiae_, 23, n. 63 sq.: "_Quis veraciter gemat, desiderans accipere quod orat a Domino, si hoc a se ipso sumere existimet, non ab illo?... Ubi intelligimus et hoc ipsum esse donum Dei, ut veraci corde et spiritualiter clamemus ad Deum. Attendant ergo, quomodo falluntur, qui putant esse a nobis, non dari nobis ut petamus, quaeramus, pulsemus_, etc."

449 Cfr. Palmieri, _De Gratia Divina Actuali_, thes. 32.

450 On this difficult question consult Ruiz, _De Provid._, disp. 18, sect. 3. and De Lugo, _De Fide_, disp. 12, sec. 3.

_ 451 De Praedest. Sanct._, c. 12.

452 Cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _God the Author of Nature and the Supernatural_, pp. 226 sqq.

_ 453 Op. cit._, pp. 228 sq.

454 Further information on this head _infra_, Part II, Ch. III.

455 Cfr. Pesch, _Praelect. Dogmat._, Vol. V, 3rd ed., pp. 117 sqq.

_ 456 À titre de curiosité_ we may note the opinion of Ripalda (_De Ente Supernat._, disp. 17, sect. 1) and Vasquez (_Comment. in S. Theol._, 1a, disp. 91, c. 10) that some pre-Tridentine theologians ascribed to nature the ability of positively disposing itself for actual graces and thereby, though in perfect good faith, entertained Semipelagian views. Even St. Thomas has been accused of conceding too much to Semipelagianism in two of his earlier works (_Comment. in Quatuor Libros Sent._, II, dist. 28, qu. 1, art. 4, and _De Veritate_, qu. 14, art. 11), though his teaching in the _Summa_ is admittedly orthodox. On the extremely doubtful character of such a summary indictment see Palmieri, _De Gratia Divina Actuali_, thes. 34; Schiffini, _De Gratia Divina_, pp. 495 sqq., 542 sqq.; Glossner, _Die Lehre des hl. Thomas von der Gnade_, Mainz 1871.

457 Vasquez, _Comment. in S. Theol._, 1a, disp. 91, c. 10-11.

_ 458 Dogmatik_, Vol. II, pp. 191 sq., Ratisbon 1874.

_ 459 De Auxil._, III, 2, 3.

_ 460 De Gratia Effic._, c. 10.

461 Disproved historically by Palmieri.

462 Cfr. Pesch, _Praelect. Dogmat._, Vol. V, 3rd ed., pp. 119 sqq.

463 Cfr. St. Augustine, _De Praedest. Sanct._, c. 15.

464 Cfr. St. Augustine, _Tract. in Ioa._, 36, n. 4: "_Venit Christus, sed primo salvare, postea iudicare, eos iudicando in poenam, qui salvari noluerunt, eos perducendo ad vitam, qui credendo salutem non respuerunt._"

465 Cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _Soteriology_, pp. 75 sqq., St. Louis 1914.

466 Sess. VI, can. 17: "_Si quis iustificationis gratiam nonnisi praedestinatis ad vitam contingere dixerit, reliquos vero omnes qui vocantur, vocari quidem, sed gratiam non accipere, utpote divinâ potestate praedestinatos ad malum, anathema sit._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 827.)

467 Prop. 5, _apud_ Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 1096. Cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _Soteriology_, p. 76.

468 "_Qui propter nos homines et propter nostram salutem descendit de coelis._" (_Credo_).

_ 469 V. infra_, Thesis II.

470 πᾶς ὁ πιστεύων εἰς αὐτόν.

471 Among them was one of our Lord's own chosen Apostles.

472 Wisd. XI, 24 sqq.: "_Sed misereris omnium, quia omnia potes, et dissimulas peccata hominum propter poenitentiam. Diligis enim omnia quae sunt et nihil odisti eorum quae fecisti.... Parcis autem omnibus, quoniam tua sunt, Domine, qui amas animas._"

473 1 Tim. II, 1 sqq.: "_Obsecro igitur primum omnium fieri obsecrationes, orationes, postulationes, gratiarum actiones pro omnibus hominibus_ (ὑπερ πάντων ἀνθρώπων).... _Hoc enim bonum est et acceptum coram Salvatore nostro Deo, qui omnes homines vult salvos fieri_ (ὸς πάντας ἀνθρώπους θέλει σωθῆναι) _et ad agnitionem veritatis venire: unus enim Deus_ (εἶς γὰρ Θεός), _unus et mediator_ (εἶς καὶ μεσίτης) _Dei et hominum homo Christus Iesus, qui dedit redemptionem semetipsum pro omnibus_ (ὑπὲρ πάντων)."

474 "_Unus enim Deus._" Cfr. Rom. III, 29 sq., X, 12.

475 Cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _Soteriology_, pp. 77 sqq.

476 Cfr. Matth. XVIII, 11; 2 Cor. V, 15. That God's will to redeem mankind is universal has been proved in _Soteriology_, pp. 77 sqq.

477 Cfr. on this text Estius, _Comment. in Epist. S. Pauli, h. l._

478 In his work _De Partitione Voluntatis Divinae in Primam et Secundam_, Rome 1851.

_ 479 In Ps._, 39, n. 20: “_Ille omnes suos vult esse, quos condidit et creavit. Utinam tu homo non fugias et te abscondas! Ille etiam fugientes requirit et absconditos non vult perire._”

_ 480 Orat._, 33, n. 9.

_ 481 Resp. ad Capitula Gallor._, c. 2: “_Sincerissime credendum est, Deum velle ut omnes homines salvi fiant, siquidem Apostolus sollicite praecipit, ut Deo pro omnibus supplicetur._”

_ 482 Op. cit._, c. 8: “... _qui et omnes vult salvos fieri et ad agnitionem veritatis venire, ... ut et qui salvantur ideo salvi sint, quia illos voluit Deus salvos fieri, et qui pereunt, ideo pereant, quia perire meruerunt._”

483 For further information on this subject consult Ruiz, _De Voluntate Dei_, disp. 19 sqq.; Petavius, _De Deo_, X, 4 sq.

_ 484 De Spiritu et Litera_, c. 33, n. 58: “_Vult Deus omnes homines salvos fieri et ad agnitionem veritatis venire; non sic tamen ut iis adimat liberum arbitrium, quo vel bene vel male utentes iustissime iudicentur._”

_ 485 Enchiridion_, c. 103.

_ 486 Contra Iulian._, IV, 8, 42: “_Nemo salvatur nisi volente Deo._”

_ 487 De Corrept. et Gratia_, c. 15, n. 47: “_Omnes homines vult Deus salvos fieri, quoniam nos facit velle, sicut misit Spiritum Filii sui clamantem: Abba, pater, i.e. nos clamare facientem._”

_ 488 Confessiones_, XII, 17 sqq.

489 Faure has proved this in his _Notae in Enchiridion S. Augustini_, c. 103, Naples 1847, pp. 195 sqq.

_ 490 Summa Theol._, 1a, qu. 19, art. 6, ad 1. On Augustine’s teaching see Franzelin, _De Deo Uno_, thes. 51 sq., and, less favorably, Bardenhewer-Shahan, _Patrology_, pp. 498 sqq., Freiburg 1908.

_ 491 E.g._ Arrubal (_Comment. in S. Theol._, 1a, disp. 91, c. 3 sq.) and Kilber (_Theol. Wirceburg., De Deo_, disp. 4, c. 2, art. 3).

492 Cfr. Albertus a Bulsano, _Theol. Dogmat._, ed. Graun, Vol. II, p. 141, Innsbruck 1894.

493 Cfr. Bellarmine, _De Gratia et Libero Arbitrio_, II, 12: “... _haec responsio non videtur digna Chritianis, qui providentiam Dei erga homines ex sacris literis et ecclesiastica traditione didicerunt. Nam si non cadit passer in terram sine Patre nostro, qui in coelis est, quanto magis nos apud Deum pluris sumus illis?_”

494 “_Definimus illorum animas, qui in actuali mortali peccato vel solo originali decedunt, mox in infernum descendere._” (_Decret. Unionis_, quoted by Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 693.)

495 Cfr. Pallavicini, _Hist. Conc. Trid._, IX, 8.

496 It occurs in his commentary on the _Summa_, 3a, qu. 68, art. 2, 11.

497 Cfr. Heinrich-Gutberlet, _Dogmatische Theologie_, Vol. VIII, p. 295, Mainz 1897.

498 On the probable fate of unbaptized infants cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _God the Author of Nature and the Supernatural_, pp. 300 sqq.

499 Thesis II.

500 Quoted _supra_, p. 156.

501 Quoted _supra_, p. 157.

502 On the whole question consult Franzelin, _De Deo Uno_, thes. 53, 3rd ed., Rome 1883.

503 On the notion and existence of sufficient grace see _supra_, Ch. I, Sect. 2, No. 6.

_ 504 Conc. Trident._, Sess. VI, can. 18: "_Si quis dixerit, Dei praecepta homini etiam iustificato et sub gratia constituto esse ad observandum impossibilia, anathema sit._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 828). Cfr. Sess. VI, cap. 11 (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 804).

505 "_Aliqua Dei praecepta hominibus iustis volentibus et conantibus secundum praesentes, quas habent vires, sunt impossibilia: deest quoque illis gratia, quâ possibilia fiant._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 1092.)

506 On the distinction between _gratia proxime sufficiens_ and _gratia remote sufficiens_, cfr. _supra_, pp. 43 sq.

507 1 John V, 3 sq.: "_Haec est caritas Dei, ut mandata eius custodiamus et mandata eius gravia non sunt_ (αἱ ἐντολαὶ αὐτοῦ βαρεῖαι οὐκ εἰσίν): _quoniam omne quod natum est ex Deo [= iustus] vincit mundum._"

508 Matth. XI, 30.

509 1 Cor. X, 13: "_Fidelis autem Deus est, qui non patietur vos tentari supra id quod potestis_ (πειραςθῆναι ὑπέρ ἡ δύνασθε), _sed faciet etiam cum tentatione proventum_ (ἔκβασιν), _ut possitis sustinere._"

_ 510 V. supra_, pp. 65 sq.

511 1 Cor. X, 12: "_Itaque qui se existimat stare, videat ne cadat._"

_ 512 V. infra_, Thesis II. Cfr. also Ecclus. II, 11 sqq.; John VI, 37; 2 Pet I, 10 sq.

513 "_Gratiam non omnibus dari._"

514 Migne, _P. L._, XVII, 1073 sqq. Cfr. Bardenhewer-Shahan, _Patrology_, p. 515.

_ 515 Benignitas Dei generalis—specialis Dei misericordia._

516 “_Deo autem placuit et hanc [gratiam efficacem] multis tribuere et illam [sufficientem] a nemine submovere, ut ex utraque appareat, non negatum universitati, quod collatum est portioni._” (_De Vocatione Omnium Gentium_, II, 25.) For further information on the doctrinal character of this work see Fr. Wörter, _Zur Dogmengeschichte des Semipelagianismus_, Münster 1900.

517 Chrysostom, _Hom. in Matth._, 82, n. 3.

518 Augustine, _Serm._, 296: “_Plus ausus erat, quam eius capacitas sustinebat._”

519 Matth. XXVI, 41: “Watch ye and pray that ye enter not into temptation.”

_ 520 Lib. de Unitate Ecclesiae_, 9: “_Quis dubitaverit quod Iudas Christum, si voluisset, non utique tradidisset, et Petrus, si voluisset, ter Dominum non negasset?_”

521 John VI, 40.

522 Cfr. _Conc. Trident._, Sess. VI, can. 19-21.

523 Cfr. Schiffini, _De Gratia Divina_, pp. 573 sqq.

524 Cfr. 1 Cor. X, 13.

525 1 John V, 3 sq.

526 Cfr. 1 John II, 16.

_ 527 De Natura et Gratia_, c. 43, n. 50: “_Deus impossibilia non iubet, sed iubendo admonet, et facere quod possis et petere quod non possis._”

528 For an explanation of certain difficult passages bearing on this point in the writings of St. Augustine, see Schiffini, _De Gratia Divina_, pp. 531 sqq.

_ 529 V. supra_, pp. 104 sq.

530 Ez. XXXIII, 11: “_Vivo ego, dicit Dominus Deus, nolo mortem impii, sed ut convertatur impius a via sua et vivat. Convertimini, convertimini a viis vestris pessimis._”

531 2 Pet. III, 9: “_Non tardat Dominus promissionem suam, sicut quidam existimant, sed patienter agit_ (μακροθυμεῖ) _propter vos, nolens aliquos perire, sed omnes ad poenitentiam reverti_ (μὴ βουλόμενός τινας ἀπολέσθαι, ἀλλὰ πάντας εἰς μετάνοιαν χωρῆσαι).”

532 Cfr. Is. V, 20.

533 According to Ruiz (_De Praedest._, disp. 39, sect. 1), there are but very few divines (_valde pauci_) who hold this view.

534 Wisd. XII, 10.

535 Rom. II, 4 sq.: “_An divitias bonitatis eius et patientiae et longanimitatis contemnis? Ignoras quoniam benignitas Dei ad poenitentiam_ (εἰς μετάνοιαν) _te adducit? Secundum autem duritiem_ (σκληρότητα) _tuam et impoenitens cor_ (ἀμετανόητον καρδίαν) _thesaurizas tibi iram in die irae et revelationis iusti iudicii Dei, qui reddet unicuique secundum opera eius._” Cfr. Prov. I, 20 sqq.

536 Ex. VII, 3: “_Ego indurabo cor eius._”

537 Ex. IX, 12: “_Induravitque Dominus cor Pharaonis, etc._”

538 Ex. VIII, 15.

539 For the solution of other difficulties see Schiffini, _De Gratia Divina_, pp. 529 sq.

540 St. Augustine, _Enarr. in Ps._, VI, n. 8: “_Dedit illos in reprobum sensum (Rom. I, 28); nam ea est caecitas mentis. In eam quisquis datus fuerit, ab interiore Dei luce secluditur, sed nondum penitus, quum in hac vita est. Sunt enim tenebrae exteriores, quae magis ad diem iudicii pertinere intelliguntur, ut penitus extra Deum sit, quisquis, dum tempus est, corrigi noluerit._”

541 St. Augustine, _Retractationes_, 419: “_De quocunque quamvis pessimo homine hac in vita constituto non est desperandum._”

_ 542 Tract. in Ioa._, XII, 39. Similarly _ibid._, LIII, n. 6. For a complete exposition of St. Augustine’s teaching on this point consult Dechamps, _De Haeresi Ianseniana_, III, 6 sqq., and Palmieri, _De Gratia Divina Actuali_, thes. 40.

543 Cfr. St. Thomas, _De Veritate_, qu. 24, art. 11: “_Haec est obstinatio imperfecta, quâ aliquis potest esse obstinatus in statu viae, dum scilicet habet aliquis ita firmatam voluntatem in peccato, quod non surgunt motus ad bonum nisi debiles. Quia tamen aliqui surgunt, ex iis datur via, ut praeparentur ad gratiam._”

_ 544 Conc. Lateran._ IV (1215), cap. “_Firmiter_”: “_Et si post susceptionem baptismi quisquam prolapsus fuerit in peccatum, per veram potest semper poenitentiam reparari._” (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 430.)

545 Cfr. _Conc. Trid._, Sess. VI, cap. 14; Sess. XIV, cap. 1.

546 “_Pagani, Iudaei, haeretici aliique huius generis nullum omnino accipiunt a Iesu Christo influxum, adeoque hinc recte inferes, in illis esse voluntatem nudam et inermem sine omni gratia sufficienti._” (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 1295.)

547 “_Extra ecclesiam nulla conceditur gratia._” (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 1379.)

548 Rom. II, 6 sqq.

549 Rom. II, 10 sq.: “_Gloria autem et honor et pax omni operanti bonum, Iudaeo primum et Graeco (Ἕλληνι=pagano); non enim est acceptio personarum (προσωποληψία) apud Deum._”

550 σωτὴρ πάντων ἀνθρώπων, μάλιστα πιστωῶν.

551 Cfr. 1 Tim. II, 1 sqq.; John I, 9.

_ 552 Ep. ad Corinth._, 1, 7.

553 ἐν γενεᾷ καὶ γενεᾷ.

554 ἀλλότριοι τοῦ Θεοῦ.

_ 555 Hom. in Ioa._, VIII, 1.

556 II, c. 31.

557 De _Arbitrii Libertate_, n. 19: "_... quotidie per tempora, per dies, per momenta, per ἄτομα et cunctis et singulis._"

558 Heb. XI, 6.

559 "_Initium, fundamentum et radix omnis iustificationis._" Sess. VI, cap. 8, _apud_ Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 801.

560 "_Fides late dicta, ex testimonio creaturarum similive motivo, ad iustificationem sufficit._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 1173.)

561 "_... fides, quâ Dei aspirante et adiuvante gratiâ ab eo revelata vera esse credimus, non propter intrinsecam rerum veritatem naturali rationis lumine perspectam, sed propter auctoritatem ipsius Dei revelantis, qui nec falli nec fallere potest._" (Sess. III, cap. 3; Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 1789.)

562 "_Quoniam vero sine fide impossible est placere Deo, ... ideo nemini unquam sine illa contigit iustificatio._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 1793.)

563 Rom. X, 17.

564 Cfr. Acts X, 1 sqq.

565 Card. Toletus, _Comment. in S. Th._, I, qu. 1, art. 1.

566 Cfr. St. Thomas, _De Verit._, qu. 14, art. 11, ad 1: "_Hoc ad divinam providentiam pertinet, ut cuilibet provideat de necessariis ad salutem, dummodo ex parte eius non impediatur. Si enim aliquis taliter (in silvis vel inter bruta animalia) nutritus ductum naturalis rationis sequeretur in appetitu boni et fuga mali, certissime est tenendum quod ei Deus vel per internam inspirationem revelaret ea, quae sunt ad credendum necessaria, vel aliquem fidei praedicatorem ad eum dirigeret, sicut misit Petrum ad Cornelium._"

567 Gotti, _De Fide_, qu. 2, dub. 4, § 1: "_Sententia negans fidem explicitam Christi et Trinitatis esse ita necessariam, ut sine ea nemo iustificari vel salvari queat, valde probabilis est. Eam enim videtur docere S. Thomas tum 2—2 p., qu. 10, art. 4, tum 3 p., qu. 69, art. 4, ubi de Cornelio Centurione ait: Ante baptismum Cornelius et alii similes consequuntur gratiam et virtutes per fidem Christi et desiderium baptismi implicite vel explicite._"

568 Cfr. Fr. Schmid, _Die ausserordentlichen Heilswege für die gefallene Menschheit_, pp. 225 sqq., Brixen 1899.

569 A. Fischer, _De Salute Infidelium_, Essen 1886; Heinrich-Gutberlet, _Dogmatische Theologie_, Vol. VIII, pp. 491 sqq. On their teaching see P. Minges, O. F. M., _Compendium Theologiae Dogmaticae Generalis_, pp. 270 sqq., Munich 1902.

570 With regard to certain other controversies on this subject consult Schiffini, _De Gratia Divina_, pp. 535 sqq., and Tepe, _Instit. Theol._, Vol. III, pp. 109 sqq., Paris 1896.

571 See Articles 1 and 2, _supra_.

_ 572 Conc. Trid._, Sess. VI, cap. 12: "_Arcanum divinae praedestinationis mysterium._"

_ 573 De Dono Perseverantiae_, n. 21: "_Ex duobus parvulis originali peccato pariter obstrictis cur iste assumatur, ille relinquatur et ex duobus aetate iam grandibus impiis, cur iste ita vocetur ut vocantem sequatur, ille autem aut non vocetur [praedicatione fidei] aut non ita vocetur, inscrutabilia sunt iudicia Dei._" On this mysterious dispensation see Scheeben, _Die Mysterien des Christentums_, § 99-103, 3rd ed., Freiburg 1912, and Palmieri, _De Gratia Divina Actuali_, thes. 62.

574 Eph. I, 3 sqq., and in other passages.

_ 575 De Dono Persev._, c. 10, n. 19: "_Praedestinatio est gratiae praeparatio, gratia vero iam ipsa donatio._"

_ 576 V. infra_, pp. 199 sqq.

_ 577 De Dono Persev._, c. 14, n. 35: "_Praedestinatio nihil est aliud quam praescientia et praeparatio beneficiorum Dei, quibus certissime liberantur [scil. salvantur] quicunque liberantur._"

_ 578 S. Theol._, 1a, qu. 23, art. 2: "_Praedestinatio est praeparatio gratiae in praesenti et gloriae in futuro._" On the Biblical, the Patristic, and the theological use of the term, see Chr. Pesch, _Praelect. Dogmat._, Vol. II, 3rd ed., pp. 189 sqq., Freiburg 1906.

579 The Tridentine Council presupposes it as an unquestioned dogma (Sess. VI, cap. 12).

580 Rom. VIII, 28 sqq.; "_Scimus autem quoniam diligentibus Deum omnia cooperantur in bonum, iis qui secundum propositum vocati sunt sancti (κατὰ πρόθεσιν κλητοῖς οὖσιν). Nam quos praescivit, et praedestinavit conformes fieri imaginis Filii sui, ut sit ipse primogenitus in multis fratribus; quos autem praedestinavit, hos et vocavit; et quos vocavit, hos et iustificavit: quos autem iustificavit, illos et glorificavit._"

581 Cfr. Eph. I, 4-11.

_ 582 De Praedestinatione Sanctorum_, c. 25: "_Praedestinationis huius fidem, quae contra novos haereticos novâ nunc solicitudine defenditur, nunquam Ecclesia Christi non habuit._"

_ 583 Resp. ad Obiect. Gallor._, 1: "_Praedestinationem Dei nullus Catholicus negat._"

_ 584 Ep. ad Rufin._: "_Praedestinationem tam impium est negare quam ipsi gratiae contraire._"

_ 585 De Correptione et Gratia_, c. 7, n. 14: "_Horum si quisquam perit, fallitur Deus; sed nemo eorum perit, quia non fallitur Deus._" On the question how this infallible foreknowledge is compatible with the dogma of free-will, see Pohle-Preuss, _God, His Knowability, Essence, and Attributes_, pp. 364 sqq.

586 Cfr. Apoc. XVII, 8: “_Liber vitae_, τὸ βιβλίον τῆς ζωῆς.” Cfr. St. Augustine, _De Civ. Dei_, XX, 13: “_Praescientia Dei, quae non potest falli, liber vitae est._”

587 Luke X, 20: “_Gaudete quod nomina vestra scripta sunt in coelis._”

588 Cfr. 2 Pet. I, 10: “_Satagite, ut per bona opera certam (βεβαίαν) vestram vocationem et electionem faciatis._”

589 Apoc. III, 5: “_Non delebo nomen eius de libro vitae._” Cfr. Ex. XXXII, 32; Ps. LXVIII, 29.

590 On the _liber vitae_, cfr. St. Thomas, _S. Theol._, 1a, qu. 24, art. 1-3; and Heinrich-Gutberlet, _Dogmatische Theologie_, Vol. VIII, § 435.

_ 591 De Correpт. et Grat._, c. 13: “_... quorum ita certus est numerus, ut nec addatur eis quisquam nec minuatur ex eis._”

_ 592 S. Theol._, 1a, qu. 23, art. 7: “_De numero omnium praedestinatorum hominum quis sit, dicunt quidam quod tot ex hominibus salvabuntur, quot angeli ceciderunt; quidam vero, quod tot ex hominibus salvabuntur, quot angeli remanserunt; quidam vero, quod tot ex hominibus salvabuntur, quot angeli ceciderunt et insuper tot quot fuerunt angeli creati. Sed melius dicitur quod soli Deo est cognitus numerus electorum in superna felicitate locandus, ut habet collecta pro vivis et defunctis._”

_ 593 De Bono Viduitatis_, n. 28: “_Quasi propter aliud retardetur hoc saeculum, nisi ut impleatur praedestinatus numerus ille sanctorum, quo citius impleto profecto nec terminus saeculi differetur._”

594 Dieringer, _Epistelbuch_, “Fest Allerheiligen.”

_ 595 S. Theol._, 1a, qu. 23, art. 7, ad 3: “_Pauciores sunt qui salvantur._”

596 Cfr. Heinrich-Gutberlet, _Dogmat. Theol._, Vol. VIII, pp. 363 sqq., and W. Schneider, _Das andere Leben_, 9th ed., pp. 476 sqq., Paderborn 1908.

_ 597 Le Rigorisme, le Nombre des Élus et la Doctrine du Salut_, 2nd ed., Bruxelles 1899.

_ 598 De Paucitate Salvandorum quid Docuerunt Sancti_, 3d ed., Bruxelles 1899.

599 Cfr. 1 Tim. IV, 10: σωτὴρ πάντων ἀνθρώπων, μάλιστα πιστῶν. This opinion is convincingly defended by the Spanish theologian Genér (_Theol. Dogmat. Scholast._, II, 342 sqq., Rome 1767.) Timid souls may profitably ponder what Thomas à Kempis says in the _Imitation_, I, 25.

600 Genér, _Theol. Dogmat. Scholast._, II, 342: “_... ne dici possit cum dedecore et iniuria divinae maiestatis et clementiae, maius esse imperium daemonis quam Christi._”

_ 601 Lect. in Ep. ad Rom._, VIII, 6: “_Unde ponere quod aliquod meritum ex parte nostra praesupponatur, cuius praescientia sit ratio [scil. motivum] praedestinationis, nihil est aliud quam supponere gratiam dari ex meritis nostris [scil. naturalibus]._” _V. supra_, Ch. II, Sect. 2.

602 “_Gratiam Dei secundum merita dari._”

_ 603 De Dono Perseverant._, n. 53: “_Quid autem coegit loca Scripturarum, quibus praedestinatio commendata est, copiosius et enucleatius isto nostro labore defendi, nisi quod Pelagiani dicunt, gratiam Dei secundum merita nostra [naturalia] dari?_”

604 Charles Du Plessis d’Argentré (d. 1740), after a careful study of all Scholastic works written between 1120 and 1708, concluded: “_Veteres Scholastici de causa praedestinationis omnino considerate et ad gratiam et ad gloriam praecipue agebant. Idea nolebant eam esse ex praevisis meritis, quia gratia, quae in ea includitur, non datur nec proin praedestinatur ob praevisa merita._” (_De Praedest._, c. 10, § 1).

_ 605 V. infra_, Part II, Ch. III, Sect. 3.

_ 606 E.g._, Bañez, Alvarez, Lemos, Gonet, Contenson, Goudin.

_ 607 E.g._, Berti and Norisius.

_ 608 E.g._, Suarez, Ruiz, De Lugo, Bellarmine.

609 “_Nisi breviati fuissent dies illi, non fieret salva omnis caro, sed propter electos (διὰ τοὺς ἐκλεκτούς) breviabuntur dies illi.... Surgent enim pseudochristi, ... ita ut in errorem inducantur, si fieri potest, etiam electi._”

610 Cfr. Col. III, 12; 1 Pet. I, 1.

611 “_Non volentis neque currentis, sed miserentis est Dei ... Cuius vult miseretur, et quem vult indurat._” On the meaning of this text _v. supra_, pp. 137, 177.

612 Cfr. Franzelin, _De Deo Uno_, thes. 65; Heinrich-Gutberlet, _Dogmat. Theol._, Vol. VIII, pp. 345 sqq.; Chr. Pesch, _Prael. Dogmat._, Vol. II, 3rd ed., pp. 212 sqq., Freiburg 1906; Val. Weber, _Kritische Geschichte der Exegese des 9. Kapitels des Römerbriefes_, Würzburg 1889.

_ 613 Die Lehre von der Heiligung_, p. 242, 3rd ed., Paderborn 1885.

_ 614 E.g._, Petrus de Comitibus, O. S. A. (_De Praedest. et Reprobat._, disp. 3, art. 4 sqq.), Tricassinus (_De Praedest._), and the Jesuits Lessius, Gregory of Valentia, Franzelin, and Schrader.

_ 615 De Deo Uno_, p. 677: “_Si vero dissensus esset manifestus, ut prudenter [cum ceteris patribus] conciliari non posset, tum sane non dubitarem, cum Pighio, Catharino, Osorio, Camerario, Maldonato, Toleto, Petavio, reverenter ab Augustino discedere, quum haec non posset esse nisi privata eius sententia._”

_ 616 De Praedest._, qu. 4.

_ 617 Comment. in S. Theol. S. Thomae Aqu._, I, qu. 23, art. 5, conclus. 2.

_ 618 De Deo_, X, col. 9.

619 A careful analysis of the Augustinian texts bearing on this question will be found in the _Theol. Wirceburg._, _De Deo Uno_, n. 231 sqq., and Franzelin, _De Deo Uno_, thes. 53.

620 Cfr. Heinrich-Gutberlet, _Dogmat. Theologie_, Vol. VIII, pp. 351 sqq.

_ 621 Clypeus Thomist._, _De Praedest._, disp. 2, § 2, n. 26: "_Qui ordinate vult, prius vult finem quam media ad finem. Sed Deus ordinate vult. Ergo prius vult finem quam media ad illum. Atqui gloria est finis et merita sunt media ad illum conducentia. Ergo prius vult gloriam quam merita, et consequenter electio ad gloriam non potest esse ex praevisione meritorum._"

622 Cfr. Heinrich-Gutberlet, _Dogmat. Theol._, Vol. VIII, p. 330.

_ 623 V._ Art. 4, No. 2, _infra_. The opposite opinion is defended by Billuart _De Deo_, diss. 9, art. 4, § 3 (ed. Lequette, p. 386).

_ 624 Orth. Praed._, c. 1, n. 7: "_Deus primo praeparavit dona gratiae ac deinde eos, quos praevidebat bene usuros eiusmodi donis, elegit ad vitam aeternam._"

625 "_... sententiam illam antiquitate, suavitate ac Scripturarum nativâ auctoritate nobilissimam de praedestinatione ad gloriam post praevisa merita semper ut Dei misericordiae ac gratiae magis consentaneam, veriorem ac amabiliorem existimavi._" (Cfr. _Traité de l'Amour de Dieu_, III, 5).

_ 626 V. supra_, pp. 153 sqq.

_ 627 V. supra_, No. 4.

628 2 Tim. IV, 7 sq.: "_Bonum certamen certavi, cursum consummavi, fidem servavi; in reliquo reposita est (ἀπόκειται=praeparata ab aeterno) mihi corona iustitiae, quam reddet (ἀποδώσει) mihi Dominus in illa die, iustus index._" Cfr. 1 Cor. IX, 24 sqq.; Apoc. II, 7, 26.

629 Matth. XXV, 34 sqq.: "_Venite, benedicti Patris mei, possidete paratum vobis regnum a constitutione mundi._"

_ 630 De Deo_, ed. Lequette, p. 391.

631 For instance, John VIII, 44; 1 John III, 8; Acts XIII, 10.

632 Cfr. Tepe, _Inst. Theol._, Vol. III, pp. 289 sqq., Paris 1896; Heinrich-Gutberlet, _Dogmat. Theol._, Vol. VIII, § 430.

633 Lessius, _Antapol._, prop. 8: "_Tenent hanc sententiam omnes Patres Graeci, adeo ut communiter dicatur esse sententia Graecorum._"

_ 634 Hom. in Matth._, 80, n. 2: "_Haereditate possidete regnum quasi proprium, quasi paternum et vestrum, iam olim vobis debitum; priusquam enim existeretis, haec vobis parata erant et disposita, quia ego vos tales futuros esse praescivi._"

_ 635 In Rom._, VIII, 29 (Migne, _P. G._, LXXXII, 142): "_Non simpliciter praedestinavit, sed quum praescivisset, praedestinavit._"

_ 636 In Ps._, 64, n. 5: "_Multi vocati sunt, sed pauci electi.... Itaque non res indiscreti iudicii est electio, sed ex meriti delectu facta discretio est._"

_ 637 De Fide_, V, 6, 83: "_Unde et Apostolus ait: quos praescivit, et praedestinavit (Rom. VIII, 29); non enim ante praedestinavit quam praescivit, sed quorum merita praescivit, eorum praemia praedestinavit._" Cfr. Franzelin, _De Deo Uno_, thes. 59; Lessius, _De Praedest. et Reprob._, sect. 2, n. 7 sqq.

_ 638 De Gratia_, II, 11.

639 Cfr. O. Rottmanner, O. S. B., _Der Augustinismus_, München 1892; O. Pfülf, S. J., "_Zur Prädestinationslehre des hl. Augustinus_" in the Innsbruck _Zeitschrift für kath. Theologie_, 1893, pp. 483 sqq.

_ 640 V. supra_, pp. 200 sqq., 216 sqq.

641 Cfr. Franzelin, _De Deo Uno_, thes. 64.

_ 642 Comment. in IV Libros Sent._, 1, dist. 41: "_Eligatur [ea sententia] quae magis placet, dum tamen salvetur libertas divina sine aliqua iniustitia et alia quae salvanda sunt circa Deum._"

643 Many Scholastic utterances bearing on this subject have been collected by Lessius, _De Praedest. et Reprob._, sect. 2, n. 7 (_Opusc._ II, pp. 208 sqq., Paris 1878).

_ 644 Comment. in Quatuor Libros Sent._, 1, dist. 41, qu. 1.

_ 645 Comment. in Quatuor Libros Sent._, 1, dist. 41, art. 2.

_ 646 S. Theol._, 1a, qu. 23, disp. 3, art. 4.

647 In his treatise _De Praedestinatione_, dedicated to the Council of Trent.

_ 648 De Deo_, disp. 9, art. 3.

_ 649 De Praedest. et Reprob._, Paris edition of the _Opuscula_, 1878, p. 412: "_... privilegia eius omnem modum superant et ad nullum alium sunt extendenda._"

_ 650 Sent._, 1, dist. 40: "_... est praescientia iniquitatis quorundam et praeparatio damnationis eorumdem._"

_ 651 Supra_, Art. 3, No. 4.

652 Calvin's teaching in his _Inst._, l. III, c. 21, 24. On Arminianism see J. F. Loughlin in the _Catholic Encyclopedia_, Vol. I, pp. 740 sqq.

653 "_Aliquos vero ad malum divinâ potestate praedestinatos esse non solum non credimus, sed etiam, si sunt qui tantum malum credere velint, cum omni detestatione illis anathema dicimus._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 200.)

654 Sess. VI, can. 17: "_Si quis iustificationis gratiam nonnisi praedestinatis ad vitam contingere dixerit, reliquos vero omnes qui vocantur, vocari quidem, sed gratiam non accipere, utpote divinâ potestate praedestinatos ad malum, anathema sit._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 827.)

_ 655 V. supra_, Art. 1.

_ 656 V. supra_, Art. 2, Thesis II.

657 Cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _God: His Knowability, Essence, and Attributes_, pp. 251 sqq.

_ 658 V. supra_, pp. 201 sqq.

659 1 Pet. II, 7 sq.: “_Non credentibus autem [Christus] ... lapis offensionis ... qui offendunt verbo nec credunt, in quo (εἰς δ) et positi sunt._”

660 “_In hoc positi, i.e. praedestinati sunt, ut non credant._”

661 “And he shall be a sanctification to you. But for a stone of stumbling and for a rock of offense to the two houses of Israel, for a snare and a ruin to the inhabitants of Jerusalem.”

662 “And whosoever shall fall on this stone, shall be broken: but on whomsoever it shall fall, it shall grind him to powder.”

663 Cfr. Oecumen., _in h. l._: “_Ad quod positi sunt, non dicitur, quasi a Deo ad hoc essent destinati; nulla enim causa perditionis ministratur ab eo, qui omnes homines vult salvos fieri._”

_ 664 Contr. Iulian._, III, 18, 35: “_Bonus est Deus, iustus est Deus: potest aliquos sine bonis meritis liberare, quia bonus est; non potest quemquam sine malis meritis damnare, quia iustus est._”

_ 665 Resp. ad XII Object. Vincent._: “_Voluntate exierunt, voluntate ceciderunt, et quia praesciti sunt casuri, non sunt praedestinati; essent autem praedestinati, si essent reversuri et in sanctitate remansuri, ac per hoc praedestinatio Dei multis est causa standi, nemini est causa labendi._”

_ 666 Ad Monim._, l. I. Cfr. Petavius, _De Deo_, X, 7 sqq.

_ 667 Clypeus Thomist._, Vol. II, tr. 5, disp. 5, art. 2, n. 23.

668 Cfr. Limbourg, S. J., in the Innsbruck _Zeitschrift für kath. Theologie_, 1879, pp. 203 sqq.

669 Cfr. Suarez, _De Praedest._, V, 4 sqq.

_ 670 Conc. Trident._, Sess. V, can. 5.

671 Which explains why both theories have the same defenders. _V. supra_, Art. 3, No. 4.

672 Bañez, Alvarez, Gonet.

673 “_Deus non serio vult, sed vellet salvare etiam reprobos, nisi per hoc impediretur pulchritudo universi._”

_ 674 V. supra_, Art. 1 and 2.

_ 675 De Praedest._, V, 8, 8: “_Non est in potestate hominis, cum non-electione seu cum non-praedestinatione aut, quod idem est, cum reprobatione negativa actu ponere seu componere suam aeternam salutem._” Cfr. Franzelin, _De Deo Uno_, p. 583, 3rd ed., Rome 1888.

676 “_Deus ex omnibus hominibus, quos infectos originali peccato praevidit, efficaciter ex meritis Christi venturi quosdam elegit ad gloriam, et alios in poenam eiusdem originalis peccati et ad ostensionem suae iustitiae erga illos et maioris misericordiae erga electos voluit permittere, ut deficerent a consecutione gloriae seu

positive eis non voluit gloriam.... Ex vi huius intentionis efficacis excogitavit media apta ad consecutionem talis finis, et videns in aliquibus hominibus esse aptum medium in solo originali peccato eos relinquere, in aliis vero permittere, ut cadant in haec vel illa peccata actualia ac in illis perseverent, has permissiones per subsequentem electionem approbavit. Et tandem ... per actum imperii sui intellectus haec media ad praedictum finem ordinavit._" _Clyp. Thomist._, Vol. II, disp. 5, art. 4, n. 155.

_ 677 De Reprob._, c. 3, n. 6.

_ 678 De Praedest._, V, 7, 14: "_Electio ad finem est ratio dandi media efficacia seu infallibilia ad illum; ergo negatio illius electionis erit suo modo ratio non dandi media, quae cognoscuntur congrua et infallibilia ad illum finem consequendum._"

679 2 Pet. III, 9: "_... nolens aliquos perire, sed omnes ad poenitentiam reverti._"

_ 680 De Praedest._, sect. 2, n. 13: "_Secundum communem aestimationem hominum paria videntur, Deum velle ut pereas et nolle te ponere in electorum suorum numero neque gratiam congruam et perseverantiam dare; aeque enim infallibiliter ex huiusmodi decretis sequeretur damnatio. Et si alterutrum horum decretorum esset subeundum, quivis censeret sibi esse indifferens, utrum eligatur, quum utrumque ante praevisionem operum sit conceptum._" The teaching of St. Augustine and that of St. Thomas on this point is in dispute. See Chr. Pesch, _Praelect. Dogmat._, Vol. II, 3rd ed., pp. 230 sqq., and Heinrich-Gutberlet, _Dogmatische Theol._, Vol. VIII, § 433.

681 In his treatise _De Servo Arbitrio_.

682 Cfr. Denifle, _Luther und Luthertum in der ersten Entwicklung_, Vol. I, Mainz 1904.

_ 683 Instit. Christ. Religionis_, l. II.

684 Cfr. Schiffini, _De Gratia Divina_, pp. 378 sqq.

685 Cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _God the Author of Nature and the Supernatural_, pp. 291 sqq.

686 Sess. VI, can. 4: "_Si quis dixerit, liberum hominis arbitrium a Deo motum et excitatum nihil cooperari assentiendo Deo vocanti ... neque posse dissentire, si velit, sed velut inanime quoddam nihil omnino agere mereque passive se habere, anathema sit._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 814.)

687 Cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _op. cit._ (note 5), pp. 295 sq.

688 In support of this contention Jansenius quoted St. Augustine, _In Gal._, n. 49: "_Quod amplius nos delectat, secundum id operemur necesse est._"

689 J. Forget in the _Catholic Encyclopedia_, Vol. VIII, pp. 288 sqq. On Jansenism see Hergenröther, _Kirchengeschichte_, 4th ed., ed. by J. P. Kirsch, Vol. III, pp. 386 sqq., 466 sqq., Freiburg 1909.

690 Sess. VI, cap. 5: “_Unde in sacris literis quum dicitur: ____Convertimini ad me et ego convertar ad vos,____ libertatis nostrae admonemur; quum respondemus: ____Converte nos, Domine, ad te et convertemur,____ Dei nos gratiâ praeveniri confitemur._” (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 797.) Cfr. Oswald, _Die Lehre von der Heiligung_, 3rd ed., pp. 186 sq.

691 Zach. I, 3.

692 Jer. XXXI, 21.

693 Rom. IX, 19: “_Voluntati enim eius quis resistit?_”

694 1 Tim. IV, 7: “_Exerce autem teipsum (γύμναζε δέ σεαυτόν) ad pietatem._”

695 Acts VII, 51: “_Vos semper Spiritui Sancto resistitis (ἀντιπίπτετε), sicut patres vestri, ita et vos._”

696 Matth. XIX, 17: “_Si autem vis ad vitam ingredi, serva mandata._” Cfr. Apoc. IV, 20: “_Ecce sto ad ostium et pulso; si quis audierit vocem meam et aperuerit mihi ianuam, intrabo ad illum._”

697 Cfr. the Scriptural argument for the existence of sufficient grace, _supra_, pp. 45 sq.

_ 698 V. supra_, pp. 102 sq., 141 sq.

_ 699 Instit._, l. II, c. 3, sect. 10: “_Voluntatem movet [gratia Christi], non qualiter multis saeculis traditum est et creditum, ut nostrae postea sit electionis, motioni aut obtemperare aut refragari, sed illam efficaciter afficiendo. Illud ergo toties a Chrysostomo repetitum repudiari necesse est: ____Quem trahit, volentem trahit.___” Many Patristic texts of similar tenor have been gathered and explained by Cardinal Bellarmine in his treatise _De Gratia et Libero Arbitrio_, VI, 11.

700 Cfr. _De Gratia Christi_, c. 47: “_Ista quaestio, ubi de arbitrio voluntatis et Dei gratia disputatur, ita est ad discernendum difficilis, ut quando defenditur liberum arbitrium, negari Dei gratia videatur; quando autem asseritur Dei gratia, liberum arbitrium putetur auferri._”

_ 701 De Corrept. et Gratia_, XII, 38: “_Subventum est infirmitati voluntatis humanae, ut divinâ gratiâ indeclinabiliter et insuperabiliter ageretur._”

702 Cfr. his _Sermones_, 163, c. 11, n. 13: “_Totum ex Deo, non tamen quasi dormientes, non quasi ut non conemur, non quasi ut non velimus. Sine voluntate tua non erit in te iustitia Dei. Voluntas quidem non est nisi tua, iustitia non est nisi Dei.... Sine te fecit te Deus. Non enim adhibuisti aliquem consensum, ut te faceret Deus. Quomodo consentiebas, qui non eras? Qui ergo fecit te sine te, non te iustificat sine te. Ergo fecit nescientem, iustificat volentem. Tamen ipse iustificat, ne sit iustitia tua._”

_ 703 De Spiritu et Litera_, c. 34: “_Consentire vocationi Dei vel ab ipsa dissentire propriae voluntatis est._”

_ 704 Ep._, 157, 2, 10: "_Neque enim voluntatis arbitrium ideo tollitur, quia iuvatur; sed ideo iuvatur, quia non tollitur._" (Migne, _P. L._, XXXIII, 677).

_ 705 De Gratia et Libero Arbitrio_, I, 2: "_Tolle liberum arbitrium et non erit, quod salvetur; tolle gratiam et non erit, unde salvetur._" On other difficult passages in the writings of St. Augustine cfr. Mausbach, _Die Ethik des hl. Augustinus_, Vol. II, pp. 208 sqq., Freiburg 1909.

706 Cfr. Bañez, _Comment. in S. Theol._, 1 p., qu. 14, art. 13: "_Nulla secunda causa potest operari, nisi sit efficaciter determinata a prima._"

707 Cfr. Billuart, _De Deo_, diss. 8, art. 4: "_Movet nempe Deus non solum ad substantiam actus, sed etiam ad modum eius, qui est libertas._"

708 Cfr. Alvarez, _De Auxiliis_, disp. 83, n. 9: "_Quando agens infinitae virtutis movet aliquod subiectum, tale subiectum infallibiliter movetur, quid tunc resistentia passi non superat nec adaequat virtutem agentis. Sed Deus est agens infinitae virtutis. Ergo motio Dei efficax respectu cuiuscumque hominis in quibuslibet circumstantiis positi erit medium congruum et aptum, ut infallibiliter inducat effectum, ad quem ex Dei intentione datur._"

709 Cfr. Billuart, _De Deo_, diss. 8, art. 5: "_Restat ergo tertia sententia, scilicet Deum praemovere physice ad entitatem peccati et sic se effecturum definivisse decreto positivo et effectivo; operatur enim omnia secundum consilium voluntatis suae._"

710 Cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _God the Author of Nature and the Supernatural_, pp. 73 sqq.

711 Cfr. De Lemos, _Acta Congr. de Aux._, p. 1065: "_Illa praepositio 'prae' nihil aliud denotat aut denotare potest quam Deum esse priorem et primam causam, prius naturâ et causalitate moventem, applicantem, inclinantem et determinantem voluntatem, quam ipsa voluntas se determinet._"

712 Cfr. Gonet, _Clypeus Theol. Thomist._, disp. 11, art. 5: "_Haec divina motio in creatura recepta a Thomistis ____physica____ appellatur, ... quia ex propria essentia et ab intrinseco est efficax, independenter a quocumque creato consensu._"

713 Cfr. Graveson, _Epist. Theol. Polem._, t. I, ep. 11: "_Voluntas creata priusquam se determinet, a Deo debet determinari, quia scil. indifferens sit eaque indifferentia non solvatur quam per praeviam Dei motionem._" Cfr. Alvarez, _De Auxiliis_, disp. 28: "_Liberum arbitrium, quia creatum est, licet determinet sibi actum, illum tamen determinat praedeterminatum a Deo._"

714 Cfr. Reginald., _De Novit. Antiquit. Nominis Praedeterm. Phys._, l. II, c. 36: "_Quum Deus hanc motionem det causis sciens et volens atque adeo cum [aeterna] cognitione et intentione certa cuiusdam determinati effectus, alias haec essent a casu respectu Dei: consequitur illam praemotionem physicam esse praedeterminationem._"

715 Cfr. Nazarius, _Comment. in S. Theol. S. Thom._, 1 p., qu. 22, art. 4: "_Sublatâ a Deo physicae praemotionis efficacitate nulla relinquitur alia in Deo sufficiens

causalitas respectu determinationis liberorum actuum et consequenter neque in Deo esse poterit talium praescientia futurorum._" See also Pohle-Preuss, _God: His Knowability, Essence, and Attributes_, pp. 383 sqq., 400 sqq.

716 Cfr. Contenson, _Theol. Mentis et Cordis_, l. VIII, diss. 2, specul. 3: "_Generalem praemotionem ideo solum adstruimus, ut per eam ad gratiam per se efficacem uberius fortiusque stabiliendam viam muniamus ad eamque propugnandam serviat etiam philosophia._"

717 Cfr. Alvarez, _De Auxiliis_, disp. 92, n. 6: "_Repugnant ad invicem auxilium efficax ad consentiendum et actualis dissensus._"

718 Cfr. Alvarez, _op. cit._, disp. 122, n. 16: "_Efficacia auxilii praevenientis gratiae et connexio eius infallibilis cum libera cooperatione arbitrii tota fundatur et desumitur, tamquam ex prima radice, ex omnipotentia Dei atque ex absoluto et efficaci decreto voluntatis eius volentis, ut homo quem movet convertatur et pie operetur, nec huiusmodi efficacia ullo modo dependet etiam, tamquam a conditione sine qua non, ex futura cooperatione arbitrii creati._"

719 Cfr. Alvarez, _op. cit._, disp. 19, n. 7: "_Praedictum auxilium actuale determinat liberum arbitrium ad unam numero actionem, non subditur libero arbitrio quantum ad usum._"

720 Cfr. Graveson, _Epist. Theol. Polem._, t. I, ep. 1: "_Gratia thomistice sufficiens ita ex naturâ sua essentialiter distinguitur a gratia thomistice efficaci, ut numquam et in nullo casu gratia thomistice sufficiens evadere possit gratia efficax thomistice nec umquam ponatur actus secundus, nisi accesserit gratia efficax thomistice._"

_ 721 Prael. Theol._, disp. 5, c. 6: "_In gratia sufficiente totum id continetur quod ad potentiam bene operandi exigitur, non autem totum id quod ulterius requiritur ad actum; certum est enim in omni causa agente aliquid plus ad actum quam ad potentiam requiri._"

_ 722 Panoplia_, t. IV, p. 2, tr. 3, c. 2: "_Auxilium sufficiens ita sufficientiam tribuit ad operandum, si homo velit, quod defectus operationis nullo modo provenit ex insufficientia aliqua ipsius auxilii, sed tantum ex defectu arbitrii, quod ei resistit et impedimentum ponit._"

723 Cfr. Limbourg, S. J., "_Selbstzeichnung der thomistischen Gnadenlehre_" in the Innsbruck _Zeitschrift für kath. Theologie_, 1877.

724 Billuart, _De Deo_, diss. 8, art. 4. § 3.

725 Cfr. Bañez, _Comment. in S. Theol. S. Thom._, 1 p., qu. 14, art. 13, concl. 14: "_Nam voluntas creata infallibiliter deficiet circa quamcumque materiam virtutis, nisi efficaciter determinetur a divina voluntate ad bene operandum._"

726 Other evasions are treated by Schiffini, _De Gratia Divina_, pp. 400 sqq. On the true notion of merely sufficient grace, _v._ Ch. I, Sect. 2, No. 6, _supra_.

727 The Molinists also regard supernatural grace as a _praemotio physica_; cfr. Chr. Pesch, _Praelect. Dogmat._, Vol. V, 3rd ed., pp. 145 sq., Freiburg 1908.

728 Gonet, _Clypeus Theol. Thomist._, disp. 9, art 5, § 3.

729 Cfr. Alvarez, _De Auxiliis_, disp. 22, n. 39: "_Solus Deus propter suam infinitatem et omnipotentiam, quia est auctor voluntatis creatae, potest illam immutare conformiter ad suam naturam et movere efficaciter atque applicare ad producendum actum in particulari, non solum secundum substantiam, sed etiam secundum modum libertatis, quod tamen non potest alia causa creata._"

730 Cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _God: His Knowability, Essence, and Attributes_, pp. 282 sqq.

731 Alvarez, _De Auxiliis_, disp. 22, n. 19: "_Nam tamdiu manet libertas in voluntate, quamdiu intellectus illi repraesentat obiectum cum indifferentia._"

_ 732 De Deo_, diss. 8, art. 4, § 2.

_ 733 De Auxiliis_, disp. 92, n. 11: "_Etiam posito auxilio efficaci in voluntate componitur cum illo potentia ad dissentiendum, quamvis nulla sit potentia ad coniungendum actualem dissensum cum auxilio efficaci_ [not: _cum actuali consensu_]."]

734 Sess. VI, cap. 5: "_Homo ... inspirationem illam [gratiam efficacem] recipiens ... illam et abiicere potest._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 797). Sess. VI, can. 4: "_Si quis dixerit, liberum hominis arbitrium a Deo motum et excitatum nihil cooperari assentiendo Deo excitanti atque vocanti, quo ad obtinendam iustificationis gratiam se disponat ac praeparet, neque posse dissentire, si velit, sed velut inanime quoddam nihil omnino agere mereque passive se habere, anathema sit._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 814.)

735 Thus Alvarez, _De Auxiliis_, disp. 93, art. 1: "_Nunc autem dicimus Concilium Tridentinum ... numquam usum fuisse verbo illo ____resistere,____ sed verbo ____dissentire____ et ____[abiicere],____ ut insinuaret non esse idem formaliter resistere seu posse resistere auxilio efficaci et posse dissentire seu abiicere gratiam vocationis.... Unde licet arbitrium motum auxilio efficaci ad consentiendum possit dissentire, si velit, non tamen potest Deo resistere vel auxilio eius efficaci, secundum quod est instrumentum voluntatis divinae._"

736 Sess. III, cap. 3: "_Quare fides ipsa in se, etiamsi per caritatem non operetur, donum Dei est et actus eius est opus ad salutem pertinens, quo homo liberam praestet ipsi Deo obedientiam, gratiae eius cui resistere possit consentiendo et cooperando._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 1791.)

737 Cfr. Tepe, _Instit. Theol._, Vol. III, pp. 74 sqq., Paris 1896; Chr. Pesch, _Praelect. Dogmat._, Vol. V, 3rd ed., pp. 140 sqq., Freiburg 1908; Schiffini, _De Gratia Divina_, pp. 405 sqq., Freiburg 1901. On the teaching of St. Augustine see Palmieri, _De Gratia Divina Actuali_, thes. 50; on that of St. Thomas, L. de San, S. J., _De Deo Uno_, t. I: _De Mente S. Thomae circa Praedeterminationes Physicas_, Louvain 1894.

738 Cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _God: His Knowability, Essence, and Attributes_, pp. 383 sqq., 400 sqq.

739 “_Quidquid entitatis reperitur in quocumque actu peccati, etiamsi alias sit intrinsece malus, debet reduci in Deum tamquam in primam causam praemoventem et praedeterminantem actuali motione voluntatem creatam ad talem actum, inquantum actus est, secundum quod est ens._” Alvarez, _De Auxil._, disp. 24, n. 15.

740 Cfr. Bañez, _Comment. in S. Theol. S. Thom._, 1 p., qu. 23, art. 3, dub. 2, conclus. 2: “_Deus cognoscit cognitione intuitivâ peccatum quatenus Dei voluntas est causa entitatis actus peccati et simul permittens, quod ad eundem actum concurrat liberum arbitrium deficiendo a regula._”

741 Sess. VI, can. 6. Cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _God: His Knowability, Essence, and Attributes_, pp. 253 sqq., 442 sqq.

742 “_Voluntas Adami ante peccatum non erat tibia curva, sed omnino recta, facta autem est curva ex promotione physica._” _Praelect. Dogmat._, Vol. II, 3rd ed., p. 137.

743 Cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _God the Author of Nature and the Supernatural_, pp. 72 sqq.

744 Cfr. on this subject Palmieri, _De Gratia Divina Actuali_, thes. 41; T. Papagni, O. P., _La Mente di S. Tommaso intorno alla Mozione Divina nelle Creature_, p. 44, Benevento 1901.

745 The principal representatives of Augustinianism are Berti, Bellelli, and Bertieri.

746 Published at Rome in 1739 sqq.

747 Cfr. his work _Le Bajanisme et le Jansénisme Resuscités dans les Livres de Bellelli et Berti, s. l._, 1745.

748 Cfr. Schiffini, _De Gratia Divina_, pp. 419 sqq.

749 Cfr. Berti, _De Theol. Disciplinis_, XIV, 9, n. 6: “_Sententia est Thomistarum et Augustinensium omnium affirmantium, gratiam efficacem esse se ipsâ, non talem reddi aut cooperatione liberi arbitrii aut ex circumstantiis congruis, utque certissime et infallibiliter cum effectu coniunctam esse._”

750 Cfr. Berti, _op. cit._, XIV, 11: “_In aequali gradu concupiscentiae et gratiae gratia concupiscentiae, non concupiscentia gratiae succumbet, quia homo etiam cum aequali virtute maiorem habet ad malum quam ad bonum inclinationem.... Agere et non agere in aequilibrio virium et determinare seipsum absque efficaci Dei praemotione est liberi arbitrii sani et robusti, non autem infirmi._”

751 Cfr. Berti, _De Theol. Disciplinis_, XIV, 8, n. 18: “_Quamvis sit haec efficax gratia antecedens et Deus sine nobis faciat ut velimus, nihilo tamen minus per illam non proponitur nobis bonum sub ratione omnis boni, quemadmodum proponitur beatis per lumen gloriae, ideoque remanet indifferentia iudicii et vera libertas._”

752 Calvinism, Bajanism, Jansenism—Thomism, Augustinianism, Molinism, and Congruism.

_ 753 De Gratia et Libero Arbitrio_, c. 17.

754 Cfr. Palmieri, _De Gratia Divina Actuali_, pp. 433 sqq.

755 On the insufficiency of the _indifferentia iudicii_ to preserve free-will, _v. supra_, p. 242.

_ 756 Conc. Trid._, Sess. VI, cap. 6.

757 "_Proponitur praemium ut pecces, i.e. quod te delectat_," he says; "... _Terreris minis, facis propter quod times.... Si cupiditas non valuit, forte timor valebit ut pecces.... Itaque ad omne recte factum amor et timor ducit. Ut facias bene, amas Deum et times Deum; ut autem facias male, amas mundum et times mundum._" _In Ps._, 79, c. 13.

758 Cfr. Schiffini, _De Gratia Divina_, pp. 422 sqq.; Palmieri, _De Gratia Divina Actuali_, thes. 54.

759 On the _Congregatio de Auxiliis_, so called because the principal question under discussion was the help (_auxilia_) afforded by grace, see Astrain, S. J., in the _Catholic Encyclopedia_, Vol. IV, pp. 238 sq., and Schneemann, S. J., _Die Entstehung und weitere Entwicklung der thomistisch-molinistischen Controverse_, Freiburg 1879; also in a Latin translation, Freiburg 1881.

760 Cfr. Molina, _Concordia Liberi Arbitrii cum Gratiae Donis_, qu. 14, art. 13, dip. 38: "_Asserimus auxilia praevenientis atque adiuvantis gratiae ... pendere a libero consensu et cooperatione liberi arbitrii nostri cum illis atque adeo in libera potestate nostra esse, vel illa efficacia reddere consentiendo et cooperando cum illis ad actus, quibus ad iustificationem disponimur, vel inefficacia illa reddere continendo consensum et cooperationem nostram aut ettam eliciendo contrarium consensum._" _Ibid._, disp. 12: "_Quare fieri potest, ut duorum qui aequali auxilio interius a Deo vocantur, unus pro libertate sui arbitrii convertatur et alter infidelitate permaneat._"

761 "_Auxilium gratiae praevenientis_," says Molina, "_est influxus Dei in liberum arbitrium, quo illud movet et excitat potensque reddit, ut eo pacto motum tamquam habens iam in se ipso principium efficiens actuum supernaturalium simul influendo ulterius eos producat._" Molina, _op. cit._, qu. 14, art. 13, disp. 41.

762 Cfr. Molina, _op. cit._, qu. 23, art. 4, disp. 1: "_Quando audis consensum nostrum efficacia reddere auxilia gratiae, non ita id intelligas, quasi arbitrium nostrum vim aliquam seu efficacitatem tribuat auxiliis ipsis; arbitrium enim et influxus noster nullam vim conferunt gratiae auxiliis, sed potius auxilia vim et propensionem arbitrio tribuunt ad consensum eliciendum._" _Ibid._, _Appendix ad obi._ 3 (ed. Paris., 1876, p. 595): "_Solum significare volumus, auxilium illud liberum nobis relinquere consensum nostrum ad conversionem, nec tale esse, ut nullam necessitatem, etiam consequentiae, arbitrio ad talem consensum aut conversionem ponat._"

763 Cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _God: His Knowability, Essence, and Attributes_, pp. 383 sqq.

764 Cfr. Molina, _op. cit._, qu. 19, art. 6, disp. 2: "_Hac ratione Deus O. M. vult omnia bona, quae per arbitrium nostrum sunt futura, non solum voluntate

conditionali, si nos quoque ea velimus, sed etiam voluntate absoluta, quatenus ipsi praevidenti ea futura placent eademque divina eius ac singularis bonitas per arbitrium nostrum intendit ac vult. Quod autem haec etiam absoluta voluntas semper impleatur, ex eo est manifestum, quia nititur certitudine praescientiae divinae, quod ita res futura sit per nostrum arbitrium._"—_Ibid._, qu. 23, art. 4, disp. 3: "_Quoniam quod Deus elegerit eum rerum ordinem, circumstantiarum et auxiliorum, sive maiorum sive minorum, in quo praevidebat eos pro sua libertate salvandos, qui electione eius ordinis eo ipso praedestinati sunt vitamque aeternam pro sua libertate consequuntur, potius quam alium ex infinitis, in quo res aliter pro eadem ipsorum libertate habuisset, non fuit ex nobis aut pro meritorum et cooperationis nostrae qualitate, sed ex sola misericordia Dei._" Cfr. G. Schneemann, _Historia Controversiarum de Divinae Gratiae Liberique Arbitrii Concordia Initia et Progressus_, Freiburg 1881, pp. 38 sqq.

765 Cfr. his treatise _De Gratia et Libero Arbitrio_, I, 12 (ed. Fèvre, tom. V, p. 527, Paris 1873): "_Prima opinio eorum est, qui gratiam efficacem constituunt in assensu et cooperatione humana, ita ut ab eventu dicatur gratia efficax, quia videlicet sortitur effectum et ideo sortitur effectum, quia voluntas humana cooperatur. Itaque existimant hi autores, in potestate hominis esse ut gratiam faciat esse efficacem, quae alioquin ex se non esset nisi sufficiens._" Bellarmine treats this opinion as the extreme counterpart of Thomism (which he also combats) and disposes of it thus: "_Haec opinio aliena est omnino a sententia b. Augustini et, quantum ego existimo, a sententia etiam Scripturarum divinarum._" (_l.c._) Among the Scriptural texts which he quotes in support of this view are John VI, 45, 1 Cor. IV, 7, Rom. IX, 11.

766 The learned Cardinal describes the difference between Congruism and extreme Molinism (which latter, it may be remarked, was not defended by Molina himself) as follows: "_Neque enim intelligi potest, quo pacto gratia efficax consistat in illa interna suasione, quae per liberum arbitrium respui potest, et tamen infallibilem effectum habeat, nisi addamus, Deum iis quos efficaciter et infallibiliter trahere decrevit, eam suasionem adhibere quam videt congruere ingenio eorum et quam certo novit ab eis non contemnendam._" (_Op. cit._, p. 531.) The objection that this explanation eventually resolves itself into the Molinistic theory which he had censured, Bellarmine meets as follows: "_Respondeo sententiam nostram, quam S. Augustini esse demonstravimus, aliqua in re cum prima illa opinione convenire, sed in multis ab illa discrepare. Convenit enim in eo quod utraque sententia gratiam sufficentem et efficacem ponit in auxilio excitante potissimum, non in adiuvante. Sed discrepant inter se, quod prima opinio vult efficaciam gratiae pendere a voluntate humana, nostra vero pendere vult a voluntate Dei._" (_l.c._, cap. 13.)

767 Further details in Schneemann, _Hist. Controv._, pp. 302 sqq.

768 Cfr. _Ad Simplician._, I, qu. 2, n. 13: "_Si vellet [Deus] etiam ipsorum misereri, posset ita vocare, quomodo illis aptum esset, ut et moverentur et intelligerent et sequerentur. Verum est ergo: Multi vocati, pauci electi. Illi enim electi, qui congruenter vocati; illi autem qui non congruebant neque contemperabantur vocationi, non electi, quia non secuti, quamvis vocati. Item verum est: Neque volentis neque currentis, sed miserentis est Dei, quia etiamsi multos vocet, eorum tamen

miseretur, quos ita vocat, quomodo iis vocari aptum est ut sequantur. Falsum est autem, si quis dicit: Igitur non miserentis Dei, sed volentis atque currentis est hominis, quia nullius Deus frustra miseretur. Cuius autem miseretur, sic eum vocat quomodo scit ei congruere, ut vocantem non respuat._”

769 Cfr. Suarez, _De Aux._, V, 25: “_Vocatio efficax illa est, quae ... includit congruitatem quandam respectu personae, cui datur, ut sit illi proportionata et accommodata, sicut oportet, ut in tali persona, in tali tempore et occasione infallibiliter effectum habeat, et per hoc habet illa vocatio quod congrua et efficax sit._”

770 1 Kings XVII, 38 sqq.—Cfr. Lessius, _De Praedest. et Reprob._, sect. 5, n. 106: “_Ex quibus patet, gratiam efficacem, si physice spectetur, non semper esse maius beneficium, quum saepenumero ea, quae effectu caret, secundum suam entitatem longe sit praestantior. Si tamen spectetur moraliter, nimirum ut subest praescientiae infallibili effectus, sic semper maius est beneficium, etiam ut praecisa ab actuali effectu et gratia cooperante seu ut prior actuali suo influxu in opus, quum Deus, qui non caeco modo operatur, ex mero suo beneplacito et inscrutabili iudicio seligat pro quibusdam gratias illas quas effectum habituras videt, non solum ut gratiae quaedam sunt, sed etiam formaliter, ut effectum habiturae sunt.... Ex quibus constat, quo sensu distinctio gratiae congruae et non congruae admittenda sit, quam numquam reieci, sed totis animis et sensu et praxi semper sum amplexus._”

_ 771 De Grat. et Lib. Arbitr._, ed. Fèvre, t. V, p. 533.

_ 772 V. supra_, p. 16.

773 For the proofs of this assertion see Palmieri, _De Gratia Divina Actuali_, thes. 50.

774 Cfr. St. Augustine, _De Civitate Dei_, V, 9, 4: “_Quod [voluntates] facturae sunt, ipsae omnino facturae, quia facturas ille praescivit, cuius praescientia falli non potest._”

775 On Congruism cfr. Chr. Pesch, _Prael. Dogmat._, Vol. V, 3rd ed., pp. 167 sqq.; Heinrich-Gutberlet, _Dogmat. Theologie_, Vol. VIII, § 447. On the various interpretations of the _praedefinitio actuum salutarium_, within as well as without the Jesuit Order, see Tepe, _Instit. Theol._, Vol. III, pp. 93 sqq., Paris 1896, and especially Schiffini, _De Gratia Divina_, pp. 458 sqq.

776 Chief among them Ysambert, Tournely, St. Alphonsus de’ Liguori, Albert Knoll, and more recently Cardinal Katschthaler.

777 For a more detailed account see Tournely, _De Gratia Christi_, qu. 7, art. 4, concl. 5; Katschthaler, _De Gratia_, pp. 173 sqq., Ratisbon 1880.

778 Cfr. Suarez, _De Gratia_, V, 20, 2.

779 Rom. XI, 33. On Syncretism cfr. Alb. a Bulsano, _Inst. Theol. Dogmat. Specialis_, ed. by Gottfried a Graun, O. M. Cap., tom. II, pp. 193 sqq., Innsbruck 1894.

_ 780 Conc. Trid._, Sess. VI, cap. 5: “_De Necessitate Praeparationis_,” and cap. 6: “_De Modo Praeparationis_.”

781 Sess. VI, cap. 8: “_Fides est humanae salutis initium, fundamentum et radix omnis iustificationis._”

782 Sess. VI, cap. 6: “_Disponuntur autem ad ipsam iustitiam, dum excitati divinâ gratiâ et adiuti fidem ex auditu concipientes libere moventur in Deum, credentes vera esse quae divinitus revelata et promissa sunt._” (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 798).

783 Sess. VI, can. 12: “_Si quis dixerit, fidem iustificantem nihil aliud esse quam fiduciam divinae misericordiae peccata remittentis propter Christum, vel eam fiduciam solam esse, quâ iustificamur, anathema sit._” (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 822.) Cfr. _Conc. Vatic._, Sess. III, cap. 3, “_De Fide_” (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 1789).

784 κηρύξατε τὸ εὐαγγέλιον.

785 ἵνα πιστεύσητε ὅτι.

786 John XX, 31.

787 Acts VIII, 37.

788 Rom. X, 9 sq.: “_Quia si confitearis in ore tuo Dominum Iesum et in corde tuo credideris quod Deus illum suscitaverit a mortuis, salvus eris. Corde enim creditur ad iustitiam, ore autem confessio fit ad salutem._”

789 Heb. XI, 6: “_Sine fide autem impossibile est placere Deo; credere enim oportet accedentem ad Deum [i.e. iustificandum] quia est [=existentia Dei] et inquirentibus se remunerator sit._”

790 Cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _God: His Knowability, Essence, and Attributes_, pp. 39 sq.

791 Murray, _De Gratia_, disp. 10, n. 18. Cfr. Becanus, _De Gratia Habituali_, c. I, qu. 7, art. 6 sq.; Bellarmine, _De Iustificatione_, I, 5 sqq.

792 Cfr. Bardenhewer-Shahan, _Patrology_, p. 616, Freiburg and St. Louis 1908.

_ 793 Prologus: ____Gaudeo quod pro fide vera sine ullo perfidiae vitio custodienda sollicitudinem geris, sine qua nulla potest prodesse, imo nec esse conversio. Apostolica quippe dicit auctoritas, quia sine fide impossibile est placere Deo. Fides namque est bonorum omnium fundamentum. Fides est humanae salutis initium. Sine hac fide nemo ad filiorum Dei numerum potest pervenire, quia sine ipsa nec in hoc saeculo quisquam iustificationis gratiam consequitur nec in futuro possidebit vitam aeternam.___

794 On the traditional concepts of “faith” and “justification” as held in the Church before Luther’s time, see Denifle, O. P., _Die abendländischen Schriftausleger bis Luther über die Iustitia Dei und Iustificatio_, Mainz 1905.

795 Cfr. Mark XVI, 15 sq.; Gal. I, 6 sqq.; Tit. III, 10 sq.

796 Cfr. St. Thomas, _Summa Theol._, 2a 2ae, qu. 2, art. 7: “_Post tempus autem gratiae revelatae tam maiores quant minores tenentur [necessitate praecepti] habere fidem explicitam de mysteriis Christi, praecipue quantum ad ea, quae communiter in

Ecclesia solemnizantur et publice proponuntur, sicut sunt articuli Incarnationis.... Alias autem subtiles considerationes circa Incarnationis articulos tenentur aliqui magis vel minus explicite credere, secundum quod convenit statui et officio uniuscuiusque._" This point is well developed by Ballerini, _Opus Theologicum Morale_, ed. D. Palmieri, Vol. II, 3rd ed., pp. 9 sqq., Prati 1898.

797 Heb. XI, 6.

798 Chiefly Andrew Vega, Ripalda, and some modern writers.

_ 799 Conc. Trid._, Sess. VI, cap. 6; _Conc. Vatican._, Sess. III, cap. 3, _V. supra_, pp. 182 sqq.

800 "_Nonnisi fides unius Dei necessaria videtur necessitate medii, non autem explicita remuneratoris._" _Prop. Damn. ab Innocenti XI._, prop. 22, in Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 1172.

801 Heb. XI, 6.

802 Cfr. Wirceburg, _De Gratia_, n. 120: "_Quia tamen qui credit et sperat remuneratorem supernaturalem, satis hoc ipso etiam credit animae perpetuitatem et necessitatem auxilii melioris ad salutem, fides horum explicita et per distinctos conceptus non semper in re et actualiter necessaria existimatur._"

803 Gregory of Valentia, Becanus, Thomas Sanchez, and many Thomists.

804 Suarez, De Lugo, and a large number of other theologians.

805 Cfr. Rom. III, 22.

806 Cfr. John III, 18.

807 Cfr. Acts IV, 12.

808 Cfr. St. Thomas, _Summa Theol._, 2a 2ae, qu. 2, art. 7, ad 3: "_Si qui salvati fuerunt, quibus revelatio non fuit facta, non fuerunt salvati absque fide mediatoris, quia, etsi non habuerunt fidem explicitam, habuerunt tamen fidem implicitam in divina providentia, credentes Deum esse liberatorem hominum secundum modos sibi placitos._"

809 The practical bearing of this question on the heathens is treated _supra_, pp. 179 sqq.

810 "_Missionarium teneri adulto etiam moribundo, qui incapax omnino non sit, explicare fidei mysteria, quae sunt necessaria necessitate medii, ut sunt praecipue mysteria Trinitatis et Incarnationis._" Cfr. _Prop. Damn. ab Innocentio XI. a._ 1679, prop. 64 (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 1214). For a full explanation of the topics treated in the present Section consult Suarez, _De Fide_, disp. 12, sect. 4; De Lugo, _De Fide_, disp. 12, sect. 4 sq.; W. Liese, _Der heilsnotwendige Glaube_, Freiburg 1902.

811 Cfr. _Solid. Declar._, art. 3: "_Neque contritio neque dilectio neque ulla virtus, sed sola fides [=fiducia] est medium et instrumentum, quo gratiam Dei, merita Christi et remissionem peccatorum apprehendere possumus._"

_ 812 Instit._, III, 11, § 19: "_Dicimus hominem solâ fide iustificari._" For a classic exposition of the Lutheran and Calvinistic views of faith, see Möhler, _Symbolik_, § 16; English tr. by James Burton Robertson, 5th ed., London 1906, pp. 124 sqq.

813 Sess. VI, can. 9: "_Si quis dixerit, solâ fide impium iustificari, ita ut intelligat nihil aliud requiri quod ad iustificationis gratiam consequendam cooperetur et nullâ ex parte necesse esse, eum suae voluntatis motu praeparari atque disponi, anathema sit._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 819.)

814 Sess. VI, cap. 6. The passage is quoted _infra_, p. 296.

815 He contemptuously called it "_ein ströherne Epistel_," a letter of straw.

816 Matth. VII, 21: "_Non omnis, qui dicit mihi, Domine, Domine, intrabit in regnum caelorum: sed qui facit voluntatem Patris mei, qui in caelis est, ipse intrabit in regnum caelorum._"

817 Jas. II, 24: "_Videtis quoniam ex operibus iustificatur homo, et non ex fide tantum (ἐξ ἔργων δικαιοῦνται ἄνθρωπος, καὶ οὐκ ἐκ πίστεως μόνον)._"

818 1 Cor. XIII, 2: "_Et si habuero omnem fidem (πάσαν τὴν πίστιν), ita ut montes transferam, caritatem (ἀγάπην) autem non habuero, nihil sum._"

819 Ecclus. I, 28: "_Qui sine timore est, non poterit iustificari._"

820 Rom. VIII, 24: "_Spe enim salvi facti sumus._"

821 Luke VII, 47: "_Remittuntur ei peccata multa, quoniam (ὅτι) dilexit multum._"

822 Luke XIII, 3: "_Nisi poenitentiam habueritis, omnes similiter peribitis._"

823 Jac. II, 17: "_Fides, si non habet opera, mortua est in semetipso._"

824 Gal. V, 6: "_In Christo Iesu neque circumcisio aliquid valet neque praeputium, sed fides quae per caritatem operatur_ (πίστις δι᾽ ἀγάπης ἐνεργουμένη)."

825 Jac. II, 26: "_Sicut enim corpus sine spiritu mortuum est, ita et fides sine operibus mortua est._"

826 Rom. III, 28: "_Arbitramur enim hominem iustificari per fidem sine operibus legis._"

_ 827 De Fide et Lib. Arbitrio_, c. 7, n. 18.

828 On the misinterpretation of other Scripture texts by the Reformers see Bellarmine, _De Iustificatione_, I, 19-24.

_ 829 Ep. ad Philipp._, 3.

830 Serm., XVI, c. 6: "_A fide incipit homo, sed et daemones credunt et contremiscunt; adde ergo fidei spem speique ipsi adde caritatem._"

_ 831 De Trinit._, XXV, 18: "_Sine caritate quippe fides potest quidem esse, sed non et prodesse._"

_ 832 Hom. in Evang._, 29: "_Fortasse unusquisque apud semetipsum dicat: Ego iam credidi, salvus ero. Verum dicit, si fidem operibus tenet. Vera etenim fides est,

quae in hoc quod verbis dicit moribus non contradicit._" As to the sense in which some of the Fathers speak of faith as the only thing that can save men, cfr. Bellarmine _De Iustificat._, I, 26.

833 Cfr. St. Thomas Aquinas, _Summa Theol._, 1a 2ae, qu. 113, art. 5: "_Iustificatio impii est quidam motus, quo humana mens movetur a Deo a statu peccati in statum iustitiae.... Unde oportet quod mens humana, dum iustificatur, per motum liberi arbitrii recedat a peccato et accedat ad iustitiam. Recessus autem et accessus in motu liberi arbitru accipitur secundum detestationem et desiderium.... Oportet igitur quod in iustificatione impii sit motus liberi arbitrii duplex: unus quo per desiderium tendat in Dei iustitiam, et alius quo detestetur peccatum._"

_ 834 De Libertate Voluntatis Humanae_, Leipzig 1555.

835 "_Klotz-, Stock- und Stein-theorie._"

836 "_Das Torgische Buch_," A. D. 1576.

837 "_Articulus stantis et cadentis ecclesiae._" Cfr. Newman, _Lectures on Justification_, p. 113.

_ 838 Geschichte der protestantischen Theologie_, p. 583, München 1867.

_ 839 Die Gnadenlehre und die stille Reformation_, Christiania 1894. Not long after writing this book Dr. Krogh-Tonning became a Catholic.

840 How Luther came to adopt the _sola fides_ theory is exhaustively explained by H. Grisar, S. J., _Luther_, Vol. I, Freiburg 1911; English tr., Vols. I and II, London 1913. Cfr. also F. Hettinger, _Die Krisis des Christentums_, pp. 72 sqq., Freiburg 1881.

841 Cfr. Pohle, art. on "Tradition" in Herder's _Kirchenlexikon_, 2nd ed., Vol. XI, 1933 sqq., Freiburg 1899.

842 "_Pecca fortiter, crede fortius._" Cfr. Möhler, _Symbolism_ (English tr., p. 130).

843 Cfr. Heinrich-Gutberlet, _Dogmatische Theologie_, Vol. VIII, §455, Mainz 1899. The "orthodox" Lutheran teaching is strongly stated by the famous convert Dr. Edw. Preuss in his work, still regarded as a classic by "orthodox" Lutherans, _Die Rechtfertigung des Sünders vor Gott_, Berlin 1868.

844 Sess. VI, cap. 8.

845 Sess. VI, cap. 6.

846 Sess. VI, cap. 8: "_Fides est humanae salutis initium, fundamentum et radix omnis iustificationis._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 801.)

_ 847 V. supra_, pp. 100 sq.

848 Sess. VI, cap. 6: "_Disponuntur autem ad ipsam iustitiam, dum excitati divinâ gratiâ et adiuti, fidem ex auditu concipientes, libere moventur in Deum, credentes vera esse, quae divinitus revelata et promissa sunt, atque illud in primis, a Deo iustificari impium per gratiam eius, per redemptionem, quae est in Christo Iesu, et

dum peccatores se esse intelligentes, a divinae iustitiae timore, quo utiliter concutiuntur, ad considerandam Dei misericordiam se convertendo, in spem eriguntur fidentes, Deum sibi propter Christum propitium fore, illumque tamquam omnis iustitiae fontem diligere incipiunt: ac propterea moventur adversus peccata per odium aliquod et detestationem, hoc est, per eam poenitentiam, quam ante baptismum agi oportet: denique dum proponunt suscipere baptismum, inchoare novam vitam et servare divina mandata._"

849 "_Diligere incipiunt._" (_ibid._)

_ 850 Contritio cum proposito novae vitae._

_ 851 Contritio caritate perfecta._

_ 852 Votum sacramenti, sacramentum in voto._

853 Cfr. _Conc. Trid._, Sess. VI, cap. 4 and 14.

854 Cfr. Ez. XVIII, 30; Joel II, 12; Luke XIII, 3; Acts II, 38. Cfr. _Conc. Trid._, Sess. XIV, cap. 4: "_Contritio, quae primum locum inter dictos poenitentis actus habet, animi dolor ac detestatio est de peccato commisso cum proposito non peccandi de cetero. Fuit autem quovis tempore ad impetrandam veniam peccatorum hic contritionis motus necessarius._"

855 Cfr. _Summa Theol._, 3a, qu. 87, art. 1: "_Exigitur autem ad remissionem peccati mortalis perfectior poenitentia, ut scil. homo actualiter pecoatum mortale commissum detestetur, quantum in ipso est, ut scil. diligentiam adhibeat ad memorandum singula peccata mortalia, ut singula detestetur. Sed hoc non requiritur ad remissionem venialium peccatorum.... Unde sequitur quod requiratur quaedam virtualis displicentia, ... quod tamen non sufficit ad remissionem peccati mortalis, nisi quantum ad peccata oblita post diligentem inquisitionem._"

856 Cfr. Tepe, _Inst. Theol._, Vol. III, pp. 204 sqq., Paris 1896.

_ 857 Fides mortua_ in contradistinction to _fides viva_.

858 Gal. V, 6.

_ 859 Conc. Trid._, Sess. VI, can. 28: "_Si quis dixerit, amissâ per peccatum gratiâ simul et fidem semper amitti aut fidem, quae remanet, non esse veram fidem, licet non sit viva, aut eum qui fidem sine caritate habet, non esse Christianum, anathema sit._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 838.) The Scriptural argument for this thesis is developed by Bellarmine, _De Iustificatione_, I, 15.

_ 860 Conc. Trid._, Sess. VI, cap. 4: "_Iustificatio impii [est] translatio ab eo statu, in quo homo nascitur filius primi Adae, in statum gratiae et adoptionis filiorum Dei per secundum Adam Iesum Christum Salvatorem nostrum._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 796.)

861 Cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _God the Author of Nature and the Supernatural_, pp. 221 sq.

862 Cfr. the second on the list of Lutheran propositions condemned by Leo X, A. D. 1520: “_In puero post baptismum negare remanens peccatum est Paulum et Christum simul conculcare._” (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 742.)

_ 863 Form. Conc._, p. 2, c. 3: “_Quando autem docemus, quod per operationem Spiritus Sancti regeneramur et iustificamur, non ita accipiendum est quod iustificatis et renatis nulla prorsus iniustitia substantiae ipsorum et conversationi adhaereat, sed quod Christus perfectissimâ obedientiâ suâ omnia ipsorum peccata tegat, quae quidem in ipsa natura infixa haerent. Nihilominus tamen per fidem propter obedientiam Christi boni et iusti pronuntiantur et reputantur, etiamsi ratione corruptae naturae suae sint maneantque peccatores, dum mortale hoc corpus circumferunt._”

_ 864 Antid. Conc. Trid._, ad Sess. V: “_Manet vere peccatum in nobis neque per baptismum statim uno die extinguitur._” Cfr. Möhler, _Symbolik_, § 14 (Robertson’s translation, 5th ed., pp. 110 sqq.).

_ 865 Conc. Trid._, Sess. V, can. 5: “_Si quis per Iesu Christi D. N. gratiam, quae in baptismate confertur, reatum originalis peccati remitti negat aut etiam asserit, non tolli totum id quod veram et propriam peccati rationem habet, sed illud dicit tantum radi aut non imputari, anathema sit._” (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 792.)

866 Sess. VI, cap. 14; Sess. XIV, cap. 2. See Pohle-Preuss, _The Sacraments_, Vol. II, _Penance_.

867 “_Dele iniquitatem meam._”

868 Is. XLIII, 25: “_Ego sum ipse, qui deleo iniquitates tuas._”

869 Is. XLIV, 22: “_Delevi ut nubem iniquitates tuas et quasi nebulam peccata tua._”

870 Acts III, 19: “_Poenitemini igitur et convertimini, ut deleantur peccata vestra._”

871 2 Kings XII, 13: “_Dominus quoque transtulit peccatum tuum._”

872 1 Paral. XXI, 8: “_Obsecro, aufer iniquitatem servi tui._”

873 Mich. VII, 18 sq.: “_Quis, Deus, similis tui, qui aufers iniquitatem?... Deponet [Deus] iniquitates nostras et proiiciet in profundum maris omnia peccata nostra._”

874 Ps. X, 15: “_Quaeretur peccatum illius, et non invenietur._”

875 Ps. CII, 12: “_Quantum distat ortus ab occidente, longe fecit a nobis iniquitates nostras._”

876 Luke VII, 47: “_Remittuntur ei peccata multa._”

877 Ps. L, 4: “_Amplius lava me ab iniquitate mea et a peccato meo munda me._”

878 Is. I, 16: “_Lavamini, mundi estote._”

879 Ez. XXXVI, 25 sq.: “_Effundam super vos aquam mundam et mundabimini ab omnibus inquinamentis vestris.... Et dabo vobis cor novum._”

880 1 Cor. VI, 11: “_Et haec quidam [fornicarii etc.] fuistis, sed abluti estis, sed sanctificati estis, sed iustificati estis._”

881 Ps. L, 9: “_Asperges me hyssopo et mundabor, lavabis me et super nivem dealbabor._”

882 Is. I, 18: “_Si fuevint peccata vestra ut coccinum, quasi nix dealbabuntur, et si fuerint rubra quasi vermiculus, velut lana alba erunt._”

883 Apoc. I, 5: “_... dilexit nos et lavit nos a peccatis nostris in sanguine suo._”

884 1 John I, 7: “_Sanguis Iesu Christi ... emundat nos ab omni peccato._”

885 1 John III, 14: “_Translati sumus de morte ad vitam, quoniam diligimus fratres: qui non diligit, manet in morte._”

886 Col. II, 13: “_Et vos, quum mortui essetis in delictis, ... convivificavit cum illo donans vobis omnia delicta._”

887 Eph. V, 8: “_Eratis enim aliquando tenebrae, nunc autem lux in Domino._”

888 Acts XXII, 16: “_Exsurge et baptizare et ablue peccata tua._”

889 Rom. VIII, 1: “_Nihil ergo nunc damnationis est iis, qui sunt in Christo Iesu._” Cfr. on this point the dogmatic treatise on the Sacrament of Baptism.

890 Cfr. Becanus, _Theol. Scholast._, P. II, tr. 5, cap. 1, qu. 1.

891 Ps. XXXI, 1 sq.: “_Beati quorum remissae sunt iniquitates et quorum tecta sunt peccata; beatus vir cui non imputavit Dominus peccatum nec est in spiritu eius dolus._”

892 Heb. IV, 13. Cfr. St. Augustine, _Enarr. in Ps._, II, 31, n. 12: “_Deus tegat vulnera, noli tu. Nam si tu tegere volueris erubescens, medicus non curabit. Medicus tegat et curet; emplastro enim tegit. Sub tegmine medici curatur vulnus, sub tegmine vulnerati celatur vulnus._”

893 Rom. VII, 17: “_Nunc autem iam non ego operor illud, sed quod habitat in me peccatum._”

_ 894 Peccatum_, ἁμαρτία.

895 Sess. V, can. 5: “_... ex peccato est et ad peccatum inclinat._” Cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _God the Author of Nature and the Supernatural_, pp. 242 sqq., 261 sqq. On Jas. I, 14 sq., St. Augustine observes: “_Profecto in his verbis partus a pariente discernitur. Pariens enim est concupiscentia, partus peccatum. Sed concupiscentia non parit nisi conceperit, nec concipit nisi illexerit, h. e. ad malum perpetrandum obtinuerit volentis assensum. Quod ergo adversus eam dimicamur, hoc agitur, ne concipiat pariatque peccatum._” (_Contra Iulian._, VI, 15, 47.) For a more exhaustive discussion of this subject see Bellarmine, _De Justif._, II, 9.

_ 896 Dial. c. Tryph._, n. 141.

_ 897 Strom._, l. II.

_ 898 Or._, 40.

_ 899 Contra Duas Epistolas Pelagian._, I, 13, 26: "_Quis hoc adversus Pelagianos nisi infidelis affirmet? Dicimus ergo baptisma dare omnium indulgentiam peccatorum et auferre crimina, non radere; nec ut omnium peccatorum radices in mala carne teneantur, quasi rasorum in capite capillorum, unde crescunt iterum resecanda peccata._"

_ 900 Ep._, l. II, ep. 45: "_Si qui vero sunt qui dicunt, peccata in baptismate superficie tenus dimitti, quid est hac praedicatione infidelius?... Qui dicit peccata in baptismate funditus non dimitti, dicat in mari rubro Aegyptios non veraciter mortuos. Si autem fatetur, Aegyptios veraciter mortuos, fateatur necesse est, peccata in baptismate funditus mori._" Other confirmatory texts _apud_ Alb. a Bulsano, _Instit. Theol. Dogmat. Specialis_, ed. P. Gottfr. a Graun, O. Cap., Vol. II, pp. 226 sq., Innsbruck 1894.

901 Apoc. XXI, 27: "_Non intrabit in coelum aliquod coinquinatum._"

_ 902 Privatio_, στέρησις.

903 Cfr. St. Thomas, _De Veritate_, qu. 28, art. 1 sqq.; IDEM, _Summa Theol._, 1a 2ae, qu. 113, art. 2.

904 Cfr. Bellarmine, _De Iustificatione_, II, 1 and 6.

_ 905 Apol. Confess. August._, c. 3, art. 6: "_Iustificare veto hoc loco (Rom. VIII, 1) forensi consuetudine significat reum absolvere et pronuntiare iustum, sed propter alienam iustitiam, videl. Christi, quae aliena iustitia nobis communicatur per fidem._"

_ 906 Solida Declar._, III, "_De Fide Iustif._," § 11: "_Vocabulum iustificationis in hoc negotio significat iustum pronuntiare, a peccatis et aeternis peccatorum suppliciis absolvere propter iustitiam Christi, quae a Deo fidei imputatur._"

907 The Lutheran doctrine is fully and lucidly set forth by Dr. Edward Preuss in his work, _Die Rechtfertigung des Sünders vor Gott_ (Berlin 1868), which he retracted at his conversion, in 1872. Cfr. also Newman's _Lectures on Justification_, Lecture I (8th impression, London 1900).

908 Sess. VI, cap. 7: "_Iustificatio non est sola peccatorum remissio, sed et sanctificatio et renovatio interioris hominis per voluntariam susceptionem gratiae et donorum...._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 799.)

909 Sess. VI, cap. 11: "_Si quis dixerit, homines iustificari vel solâ imputatione iustitiae Christi vel solâ peccatorum remissione, exclusâ gratiâ et caritate, quae in cordibus eorum per Spiritum Sanctum diffundatur atque illis inhaereat, aut etiam gratiam quâ iustificamur esse tantum favorem Dei, anathema sit._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 821.)

910 Sess. VI, cap. 7: "_Huius iustificationis causae sunt: formalis quidem gloria Dei et Christi ac vita aeterna; efficiens vero misericors Deus, qui gratuito abluit et sanctificat; ... meritoria autem dilectissimus Unigenitus suus D. N. Iesus Christus, qui ... suâ sanctissimâ passione in ligno crucis nobis iustificationem meruit; ... instrumentalis item sacramentum baptismi, quod est sacramentum fidei, sine quâ nulli unquam contigit iustificatio; demum unica formalis causa est iustitia Dei, non

quâ ipse iustus est, sed quâ nos iustos facit, quâ videl. ab eo donati renovamur spiritu mentis nostrae et non modo reputamur, sed vere iusti nominamur et sumus._” (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 799).

911 Sess. VI, can. 10: “_Si quis dixerit, homines sine Christi iustitia, per quam nobis meruit iustificari aut per eam ipsam formaliter iustos esse, anathema sit._” (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 820.)

_ 912 V. supra_, Article 1.

913 Cfr. Eph. II, 5; Col. II, 13; 1 John III, 14.

914 Cfr. Eph. IV, 23 sq.

915 Cfr. 2 Cor. V, 17; Gal. VI, 15; Jas. I, 18; Ps. L, 12.

916 Cfr. John III, 5; Tit. III, 5.

917 Cfr. Rom. VIII, 29; 2 Cor. III, 18; 2 Pet. I, 4.

918 John III, 5.

919 Tit. III, 5 sqq.: “_Non ex operibus iustitiae quae fecimus nos, sed secundum suam misericordiam salvos nos fecit (ἔσωσεν ἡμᾶς) per lavacrum regenerationis et renovationis (διὰ λυτροῦ παλιγγενεσίας καὶ ἀνακαινώσεως) Spiritus Sancti, quem effudit (ἐξέχεεν) in nos abunde per Iesum Christum Salvatorem nostrum, ut iustificati (δικαιωθέντες) gratiâ ipsius haeredes simus secundum spem vitae aeternae._”

920 Cfr. John I, 12 sq.; Rom. VIII, 16; Gal. III, 7; IV, 6 sq.; 1 John III, 1.

921 Cfr. Eph. IV, 22 sqq.

922 Cfr. Col. III, 9 sq.

923 Cfr. Acts II, 38; X, 45 sqq.; Rom. V, 5.

924 Cfr. J. Pohle, article “Regeneration” in the _Catholic Encyclopedia_, Vol. XII, and A. Rademacher, _Die übernatürliche Lebensordnung nach der paulinischen und johanneischen Theologie_, pp. 41 sqq., Freiburg 1903.

925 2 Cor. V, 17: “_Si qua ergo in Christo nova creatura (καινὴ κτίσις), vetera transierunt; ecce facta sunt omnia nova._” Cfr. Eph. II, 10.

926 Jac. I, 18: “_Voluntarie enim genuit (ἀπεκύησεν) nos verbo veritatis, ut simus initium aliquod creaturae eius._”

927 Gal. VI, 15: “_In Christo enim Iesu neque circumcisio aliquid valet neque praeputium, sed nova creatura (καινὴ κτίσις)._”

928 Gal. V, 6: “_Nam in Christo Iesu neque circumcisio aliquid valet neque praeputium, sed fides quae per caritatem operatur_ (πίστις δι᾽ ἀγάπης ἐνεργουμένη).”

929 On the argument from Rom. V, 15 sqq. cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _God the Author of Nature and the Supernatural_, pp. 247 sqq.

_ 930 Iustificare,_ δικαιοῦν.

_ 931 E.g._, Rom. V, 15 sqq. and Gal. III, 8 sqq.

932 Ps. CXVIII, 8: "_Iustificationes tuas custodiam._"

933 Ps. CXVIII, 26: "_... doce me iustificationes tuas._"

934 Apoc. XXII, 11: "_Qui iustus est, iustificetur adhuc, et sanctus sanctificetur adhuc_." On the different meanings of the term justification in Scripture see Bellarmine, _De Iustific._, I, 1; II, 3.

935 Gal. III, 27: "_Quicunque enim in Christo baptizati estis, Christum induistis._"

936 Cfr. Eph. IV, 22 sqq.; Col. III, 8 sqq.

937 1 Cor. I, 30: "_Qui factus est nobis sapientia a Deo et iustitia (δικαιοσύνη) et sanctificatio (ἁγιασμός) et redemptio_."

938 Other objections are refuted by Bellarmine, _De Iustif._, II, 9 sqq.

939 Cfr. Calvin, _Instit._, III, 11, § 15: "_Ac nec Augustini quidem sententia recipienda est, qui gratiam ad sanctificationem refert, quâ in vitae novitatem per Spiritum Sanctum regeneramur._"

940 On the Epistle of Barnabas see Bardenhewer-Shahan, _Patrology_, p. 24. The passage quoted will be found _Ep. Barn._, VI, 11.

_ 941 Hom. ad Illumin._, I, n. 3.

942 ὡς ἄν εἰ ἄνωθεν ἐγεννήθημεν.

943 καὶ γὰρ ἄνωθεν ἡμᾶς δημιουργεῖ καὶ κατασκευάζει.

_ 944 De Myst._, c. 7: "_Accepisti post haec vestimenta candida [scil. post baptismum], ut sint indicium quod exueris involucrum peccati, indueris innocentiae casta velamina._"

_ 945 De Iustific._, II, 8.

_ 946 De Spiritu et Litera_, c. 9, n. 15: "_Non dicit iustitia hominis,... sed iustitia Dei, non quâ Deus iustus est, sed quâ induit hominem, quum iustificat impium.... Iustitia autem Dei per fidem Iesu Christi, hoc est, per fidem quâ creditur in Christum. Sicut autem ista fides Christi dicta est, non quâ credit Christus, sic et illa iustitia Dei, non quâ iustus est Deus. Utrumque enim nostrum est; sed ideo Dei et Christi dicuntur, quod eius nobis largitate donatur._"

_ 947 De Gratia Christi_, c. 13: "_Si data est nobis iustitia, non dicitur iustitia nostra, sed Dei, quia sic fit nostra, ut sit nobis ex Deo._"

_ 948 Serm._, 131: "_Dei gratia per Dominum nostrum Iesum Christum iustitia Dei dicitur, non quâ iustus est Dominus, sed quâ iustificat eos, quos ex impiis iustos facit._"

_ 949 De Spir. et Lit._, c. 32, n. 56: "_Caritas Dei dicta est diffundi in cordibus nostris, non quâ ipse nos diligit, sed quâ, nos facit dilectores suos, sicut iustitia Dei, quâ nos iusti eius munere efficimur._"

_ 950 De Trinit._, XV, 8, 14: "_Quod vero ait_ (2 Cor. III, 18): ___In eandem imaginem transformamur,____ utique imaginem Dei vult intellegi, eandem dicens istam ipsam, scil., quam speculamur ... atque transimus de forma obscura in formam lucidam.... Quae natura [humana] in rebus creatis excellentissima, quum a suo Creatore ab impietate iustificatur, a deformi forma formosam transfertur in formam._"

951 Other Patristic texts can be seen in Ripalda, _De Ente Supernal._, disp. 132, sect. 7; Petavius, _De Trinit._, VIII, 4-7; Bellarmine, _De Gratia et Lib. Arbitrio_, I, 4.

952 For a more detailed treatment of this point we must refer the reader to Heinrich-Gutberlet, _Dogmat. Theologie_, Vol. VIII, pp. 537 sqq.

953 Quoted by De Wette, II, 37.

_ 954 V. infra_, Section 3.

955 Sess. IV, cap. 7.

_ 956 V. infra_, Sect. 2, Art. 2.

957 Cfr. Bellarmine, _De Iustific._, II, 1.

958 Seripando, Albertus Pighius, Gropper, and others.

959 On the discussion referred to in the text see Pallavicini, _Hist. Conc. Trid._, VIII, 11, 12; Aug. Theiner, _Acta Genuina Concil. Trid._, tom. I, pp. 222 sqq., Leipzig 1874.

960 Eph. V, 8; 2 Cor. VI, 14.

961 Col. II, 13; 1 John III, 14.

962 Eph. IV, 22 sqq.; Col. III, 9.

_ 963 V. supra_, No. 2.

964 On the history of the Tridentine decree regarding justification cfr. J. Hefner, _Die Entstehungsgeschichte des Trienter Rechtfertigungsdekretes_, Paderborn 1909.

965 Ockam, Gabriel Biel, _et al._

966 Henno, Mastrius, _et al._

967 Suarez, _De Gratia_, 1. VII, c. 20, n. 7: "... _non obstante illâ oppositione et repugnantiâ connaturali potest Deus de suâ absolutâ potentiâ eam vincere et conservare gratiam in eo, qui peccavit, non remittendo illi peccatum._"

968 Vasquez, Sardagna, Antoine, Mazzella, Tepe, _et al._

969 Col. II, 13; 1 John III, 14.

970 2 Cor. VI, 14 sqq.

971 Cfr. 1 John III, 9: "_Omnis, qui natus est ex Deo, peccatum non facit, quoniam semen ipsius_ (σπέρμα αὐτοῦ) _in eo manet et non potest peccare_ (οὐ δύναται ἁμαρτάνειν), _quoniam ex Deo natus est._"

_ 972 V. infra_, Sect. 2, Art. 1.

973 For the solution of other difficulties consult Tepe, _Inst. Theol._, Vol. VIII, pp. 152 sqq. On the whole subject of this subdivision cfr. Billuart, _De Gratia_, diss. 7, art. 2 sq. On certain incidental questions, _e.g._ whether justification takes place _in instanti_, whether the infusion of sanctifying grace _in ordine naturae_ precedes or follows the forgiveness of sins, whether justification is the greatest of God's works, whether it is to be regarded as a miracle, etc., see St. Thomas, _Summa Theol._, 1a 2ae, qu. 113, art. 7-10; cfr. also Scheeben, _Die Mysterien des Christentums_, 3rd ed., pp. 543 sqq., Freiburg 1912.

_ 974 Conc. Trid._, Sess. VI, cap. 7: "_Per spiritum sanctum caritas Dei diffunditur in cordibus eorum, qui iustificantur, atque ipsis inhaeret._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 800.)

975 Sess. VI, cap. 16: "_Quae enim iustitia nostra dicitur, quia per eam nobis inhaerentem iustificamur, illa eadem Dei est, quia a Deo nobis infunditur per Christi meritum._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 809.)

976 Sess. VI, can. 11: "_Si quis dixerit, homines iustificari ... exclusâ gratiâ et caritate, quae in cordibus eorum per Spiritum sanctum diffundatur atque in illis inhaereat, ... anathema sit._"(Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 821.)

977 Sess. VI, cap. 4: "_[Iustificatio est] translatio ... in statum gratiae et adoptionis filiorum Dei._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 796.)

978 Cfr. Pallavicini, _Hist. Conc. Trid._, VIII, 14, 3: "_Postulantibus quibusdam, ut expressius declararetur fieri iustitiam per habitum infusum, delecti Patres ad id responderunt, id satis explicari per vocem ____inhaeret,____ quae stabilitatem significat et habitibus congruit, non actibus._" It was on the same ground that Pius V censured the forty-second proposition of Baius, _viz._: "_Iustitia quâ iustificatur per fidem impius, consistit formaliter in obedientia mandatorum, quae est operum iustitia; non autem in gratia aliqua animae infusa, quâ adoptatur homo in filium Dei, et secundum interiorem hominem renovatur ac divinae naturae consors efficitur._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 1042.)

979 Cfr. the _Cap. Maiores_ of Pope Innocent III (_Decret._, l. 3, tit. 42, _De Bapt._): "_Aliis asserentibus, per virtutem baptismi parvulis quidem culpam remitti, sed gratiam non conferri; nonnullis dicentibus, dimitti peccatum et virtutes infundi quantum ad habitum, non quoad usum._"

_ 980 De Summa Trinit. et Fide Cath._: "_Quantum ad effectum baptismi in parvulis reperiuntur doctores quidam theologi opiniones contrarias habuisse, quibusdam ex ipsis dicentibus, per virtutem baptismi parvulis quidem culpam remitti, sed gratiam non conferri, aliis e contra asserentibus, quod et culpa eisdem in baptismo remittitur et virtutes ac informans gratia infunduntur quoad habitum, etsi non pro illo tempore quoad usum. Nos attendentes generalem efficaciam mortis Christi, quae per baptisma applicatur pariter omnibus baptizatis, opinionem secundam tamquam probabiliorem et dictis sanctorum et modernorum theologorum magis consonam et conformem sacro approbante concilio duximus eligendam._"

981 Cfr. _Conc. Trid._, Sess. V, can. 4; Sess. VII, can. 13. For a fuller treatment consult Suarez, _De Gratia_, VI, 3; Vasquez, _Comment. in S. Th._, I, 2, disp. 203, cap. 6. The false views of Hermes and Hirscher are refuted by Kleutgen, _Theologie der Vorzeit_, Vol. II, 2nd ed., pp. 254-343, Münster 1872.

_ 982 Libri Quatuor Sent._, I, dist 17, § 18.

_ 983 Summa Theol._, 2a 2ae, qu. 23, art. 2.

_ 984 Conc. Trid._, Sess. VI, can. 24.

985 Cfr. Schiffini, _De Gratia Divina_, pp. 263 sq.

986 Cfr. St. Thomas, _Summa Theol._, 1a 2ae, qu. 110, art. 1; _Summa contra Gentiles_, III, 150.

987 Cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _God the Author of Nature and the Supernatural_, p. 193.

_ 988 Summa Theol._, 1a 2ae, qu. 110, art. 2, ad 2: "_Omnis substantia vel est ipsa natura rei, cuius est substantia, vel est pars naturae, secundum quem modum materia vel forma substantia dicitur. Et quia gratia est supra naturam humanam, non potest esse quod sit substantia aut forma substantialis, sed est forma accidentalis ipsius animae. Id enim quod substantialiter est in Deo, accidentaliter fit in anima participante divinam bonitatem._"

989 Cfr. Billuart, _De Gratia_, diss. 6, art. 2.

990 This theory was based on such texts as Ps. L, 12: "_Cor mundum crea in me._"

_ 991 Cat. Rom._, P. II, c. 2 _de Bapt._, qu. 49: "_Est autem gratia ... divina qualitas in anima inhaerens ac veluti splendor quidam et lux, quae animarum nostrarum maculas omnes delet ipsasque animas pulchriores et splendidiores reddit._" On the supernatural character of sanctifying grace see Pohle-Preuss, _God the Author of Nature and the Supernatural_, pp. 191 sqq.

_ 992 Categ._, 6.

993 "_... qualitas difficile mobilis, secundum quam res bene vel male se habet in ordine ad suam naturam et ad operationem vel finem eius._" Cfr. St. Thomas, _Summa Theol._, 1a 2ae, qu. 19, art. 2; S. Schiffini, _Principia Philosophica ad Mentem Aquinatis_, pp. 574 sqq., Turin 1886; A. Lehmen, _Lehrbuch der Philosophie auf aristotelisch-thomistischer Grundlage_, Vol. I, 3rd ed., pp. 398 sqq., Freiburg 1904.

_ 994 De Veritate_, qu. 27, art. 2, ad 7: "_Gratia est in prima specie qualitatis, quamvis non proprie possit dici habitus, quia non immediate ordinatur ad actum, sed ad quoddam esse spiritale, quod in anima facit._"

_ 995 De Gratia_, VI, 4, 1: "_Abstinuimus ab hac voce, quia per habitum solet intelligi principium actus; quamvis, si vox illa latius sumatur, pro quacumque qualitate perficiente animam, quae non sit actus secundus, eadem certitudine, quâ ostendimus dari gratiam permanentem, concluditur esse qualitatem habitualem._"

_ 996 De Gratia et Libero Arbitrio_, I, 3.

997 Cfr. Ripalda, _De Ente Supernaturali_, disp. 30. Under these circumstances Suarez was justified in saying, in regard to the degree of certitude to be attributed to this teaching: "_Si quis negaret gratiam sanctificantem esse habitum, licet esse temere dictum, non posset tamen ut haereticum damnari._"

998 Cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _God the Author of Nature and the Supernatural_, pp. 190 sqq.

999 Cfr. 1 John, III, 9: "σπέρμα αὐτοῦ [scil. Θεοῦ] ἐν αὐτῷ μένει."

1000 Cfr. 2 Cor. IV, 7: "_... thesaurum in vasis fictilibus._"

1001 Cfr. John XIV, 23: "_Mansionem apud eum faciemus._"

1002 Cfr. 1 Cor. III, 16.—On the subtle question whether habitual grace is to be regarded as a real or merely as a modal accident of the soul, see Tepe, _Inst. Theol._, Vol. III, pp. 154 sqq., Paris 1896; Chr. Pesch, _Prael. Dogmat._, Vol. V, 3rd ed., pp. 181 sqq., Freiburg 1908. An extreme and altogether unacceptable view is that of Billuart (_De Gratia_, diss. 6, art. 2), who regards sanctifying grace as an absolute accident, _i.e._ one which the omnipotence of God could miraculously sustain if the soul ceased to exist. Cfr. Suarez, _De Gratia_, VII, 15; Schiffini, _De Gratia Divina_, p. 259; Tepe, _Inst. Theol._, Vol. III, pp. 164 sqq.

_ 1003 Comment. in Quatuor Libros Sent._, II, dist. 27.

_ 1004 E.g._, Mastrius, _De Iustif._, disp. 7, qu. 6.

_ 1005 De Gratia et Libero Arbitrio_, I, 6.

1006 Luke VII, 47: "_Remittuntur ei peccata multa, quoniam dilexit (ἠγάπησεν) multum._"

1007 1 Pet. IV, 8: "_Caritas (ἀγάπη) operit multitudinem peccatorum._"

1008 1 John IV, 7: "_Omnis qui diligit (πᾶσ ὁ ἀγαπῶν) ex Deo natus est._"

_ 1009 De Natura et Gratia_, c. 70, n. 84: "_Caritas ergo inchoata, inchoata iustitia est, ... caritas magna, magna iustitia est, caritas perfecta, perfecta iustitia est._"

_ 1010 Conc. Trid._, Sess. VI, cap. 7: "_... dum caritas Dei diffunditur in cordibus eorum qui iustificantur atque ipsis inhaeret._"

1011 Preëminently Suarez, Tanner, Ripalda.

_ 1012 Summa Theol._, 1a 2ae, qu. 110, art. 3 sq.; _De Veritate_, qu. 27, art. 2.

_ 1013 Summa Theol._, 1a 2ae, qu. 110, art. 4, ad 1: "_Sicut ab essentia animae effluunt eius potentiae, quae sunt operum principia, ita etiam ab ipsa gratia effluunt virtutes [theologicae] in potentias animae, per quas [virtutes] potentiae moventur ad actus._"

_ 1014 De Dono Perseverantiae_, c. 16, n. 41: "_Gratia praevenit caritatem._"

1015 2 Cor. XIII, 13: "_Gratia Domini nostri Iesu Christi et caritas Dei._"

1016 1 Tim. I, 14: “_Superabundavit autem gratia Domini nostri cum fide et dilectione._”

1017 Cfr. _Conc. Viennense_, A. D. 1311: “_... gratiam informantem et virtutes._” _Conc. Trid._, Sess. VI, cap. 7: “_... per voluntariam susceptionem gratiae et donorum._” Sess. VI, can. 11: “_... exclusâ gratiâ et caritate._”

1018 For a fuller treatment of this topic consult Billuart, _De Gratia_, diss. 4, art. 4.

1019 Ripalda justly observes (_De Ente Supernaturali_, disp. 132, n. 132, n. 53): “_Haec controversia olim Celebris fuit. Nunc facile dirimitur, quum iam constiterit nullius partis argumenta plane convincere._” On the theological aspects of Herbart’s philosophy, which denies the existence of qualities and faculties in the soul, see Heinrich-Gutberlet, _Dogmatische Theologie_, Vol. VIII, p. 560, Mainz 1897.

1020 2 Pet. I, 4: “_... per quem [i.e. Christum] maxima et pretiosa nobis promissa donavit, ut per haec efficiamini divinae consortes naturae_ (θείας κοινωνοὶ φύσεως).”

1021 John I, 13: “_... qui non ex sanguinibus, ... sed ex Deo nati sunt._”

1022 John III, 5: “_Nisi quis renatus fuerit ex aqua et Spiritu Sancto, non potest introire in regnum Dei._”

1023 Jac. I, 18: “_Voluntarie enim genuit nos verbo veritatis._”

1024 1 John III, 9: “_Omnis qui natus est ex Deo, peccatum non facit._”

_ 1025 Or. contr. Arian._, I, 39.

1026 ἵνα μᾶλλον ἡμᾶς θεοποιήση.

_ 1027 In Psalmos_, 49, n. 2: “_Ille iustficat, qui per seipsum, non ex alio iustus est; et ille deificat qui per seipsum non alterius participatione Deus est. Qui autem iustificat, ipse deificat, quia iustificando filios Dei facit.... Filii Dei facti sumus et dii facti sumus; sed hoc gratia est adoptantis, non natura generantis. Unicum enim Dei Filius Deus, ... ceteri qui dii fiunt, gratiâ ipsius fiunt, non de substantia ipsius nascuntur, ut hoc sint quod ille, sed ut per beneficium perveniant ad eum et sint cohaeredes Christi._” Many other cognate Patristic texts in Ripalda, _De Ente Supernaturali_, disp. 132, sect. 7-9.

1028 See, _e.g._, the Offertory and Preface for the festival of the Ascension of our Lord and the _Secreta_ for the fourth Sunday after Easter.

1029 Cfr. Ripalda, _De Ente Supernaturali_, disp. 132, sect. 7: “_Per gratiam vero habitualem fieri hominem participem divinae naturae ideoque gratiam esse participationem deitatis, adeo frequens est et constans theologorum assertum, ut absque temeritate negari non possit._” On the teaching of St. Thomas and the Thomists see Billuart, _De Gratia_, diss. 4, art. 3.

1030 Cfr. _Prop. Ekkardi a. 1329 damn. a Ioanne XXII_, prop. 10, quoted in Denzinger-Bannwart’s _Enchiridion_, n. 510.

1031 Cfr. _Prop. Mich. de Molinos a. 1687 damn, ab Innocentio XI_, prop. 5, in Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 1225.

1032 The Fourth Council of the Lateran (A. D. 1215) calls it "_doctrina non tam haeretica quam insana_." (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 433.)

1033 St. Augustine, _De Peccatorum Meritis et Remissione_, II, 8, 10: "_Nunc ergo et similes esse iam coepimus primitias spiritus habentes, et adhuc dissimiles sumus per reliquias vetustatis. Proinde inquantum similes, in tantum regenerante Spiritu filii Dei; inquantum autem dissimiles, in tantum filii carnis et saeculi._"

1034 Quoted by Ripalda, _De Ente Supernaturali_, disp. 132, sect. 9.

1035 Cfr. St. Thomas, _Summa Theol._, 1a 2ae qu. 112, art. 1: "_Donum autem gratiae excedit omnem facultatem naturae creatae, quum nihil aliud sit quam quaedam participatio divinae naturae, quae excedit omnem aliam naturam._"

1036 Cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _God: His Knowability, Essence, and Attributes_, pp. 165 sqq.; _Christology_, pp. 85 sqq.

1037 Cfr. St. John of Damascus, _De Fide Orthodoxa_, II, 12 "[ἄνθρωπον] θεούμενον δὲ μετοχῇ τῆς θείας ἐλλάμψεως καὶ οὐκ εἰς τὴν θείαν μεθιστάμενον οὐσίαν."

1038 Cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _God: His Knowability, Essence, and Attributes_, pp. 165 sqq.

_ 1039 Clyp. Thomist._, tom. VI, disp. 2, § 10.

1040 Cfr. Suarez, _De Gratia_, VII, 1, 27: "_Eo ipso quod divinum esse participatur, non participatur ut imparticipatum est._"

_ 1041 De Ente Supernaturali_, disp. 20, sect. 14.

_ 1042 S. Theol._, 1a, qu. 93, art. 4.

1043 Cfr. Suarez, _De Gratia_, VII, 1, 30: "_Vera ergo excellentia gratiae habitualis, propter quam dicitur esse singularis participatio divinae naturae, est ... quia, quum natura divina sit quaedam intellectualis natura altioris ordinis quam sit vel esse possit ulla substantia intellectualis creata, ille gradus intellectualitatis, qui est in divina natura, divino quodam et supernaturali modo participatur per habitualem gratiam, quo quidem modo a nulla substantia creata per se ipsam vel per potentiam sibi connaturalem participari potest.... Divina enim essentia in ratione obiecti intelligibilis in se et per visionem intuitivam ad ipsam Dei essentiam immediate terminatam adeo est elevata et excellens ratione purissimae actualitatis et immaterialitatis suae, ut a nulla substantia intellectuali possit connaturaliter videri, nisi a seipsa. Per gratiam vero et dona supernaturalia elevatur natura creata intellectualis ad participationem illius gradus intellectualitatis divinae, in quo possit obiectum illud intelligibile divinae essentiae in se intueri._"

1044 John III, 6; cfr. 2 Cor. III, 18; Eph. V, 18.

_ 1045 De Spiritu Sancto_, c. 9, n. 23.

1046 πνευματικαί.

1047 ἡ πρὸς Θεὸν ὁμοίωσις.

1048 θεὸν γενέσθαι.

1049 1 John III, 2: “_Nunc filii Dei sumus et nondum apparuit, quid erimus; scimus quoniam, quum apparuerit, similes ei erimus (ὅμοιοι αὐτῷ ἐσόμεθα), quoniam videbimus eum sicuti est._” On this passage see Pohle-Preuss, _God: His Knowability, Essence, and Attributes_, pp. 96 sq. On the whole subject treated in this subdivision consult Heinrich-Gutberlet, _Dogmatische Theologie_, Vol. VIII, pp. 588 sqq.; A. Rademacher, _Die übernatürliche Lebensordnung nach der paulinischen und johanneischen Theologie_, pp. 88 sqq., Freiburg 1903; A. Prumbs, _Die Stellung des Trienter Konzils zu der Frage nach dem Wesen der heiligmachenden Gnade_, Paderborn 1910.

1050 For a fuller treatment we must refer the reader to Scheeben, _Die Herrlichkeiten der göttlichen Gnade_, 8th ed., Freiburg 1908; English translation by a Benedictine monk of St. Meinrad’s Abbey, _The Glories of Divine Grace_, 3rd ed., New York _s. a._

1051 Eph. IV, 24: “_Induite novum hominem, qui secundum Deum creatus est in iustitia et sanctitate veritatis._” On this text see Pohle-Preuss, _God the Author of Nature and the Supernatural_, p. 197.

1052 Sess. VI, cap. 7: “_... non est sola peccatorum remissio, sed et sanctificatio et renovatio interioris hominis per voluntariam susceptionem gratiae et donorum, unde homo ex iniusto fit iustus._”

1053 On the concept of sanctity see Pohle-Preuss, _God: His Knowability, Essence, and Attributes_, pp. 251 sqq.

1054 Gal. II, 20: “_Vivo autem iam non ego, vivit vero in me Christus._” On the life of the soul in and through grace cfr. Heinrich-Gutberlet, _Dogmatische Theologie_, Vol. VIII, § 466.

1055 Cfr. 2 Cor. VII, 4: “_Superabundo gaudio in omni tribulatione nostra._”

1056 Is. XLIX, 16: “_Ecce in manibus meis descripsi te._”

1057 Rom. VIII, 28: “_Diligentibus Deum omnia cooperantur in bonum._”

_ 1058 In Ps._, 25: “_Gratia divina pulchrificat sicut lux._”

_ 1059 Cat. Rom._, P. II, Ch. II, qu. 49: “_Est autem gratia ... splendor quidam et lux, quae animarum maculas delet ipsasque animas pulchriores et splendidiores reddit._” On the aptness of this simile see Schiffini, _De Gratia Divina_, p. 268. Freiburg 1901.

1060 Ἄνθρωπος μέτρον πάντων.

1061 Θεὸς μέτρον πάντων.

1062 On the notion of beauty see Pohle-Preuss, _God: His Knowability, Essence, and Attributes_, pp. 265 sqq.

_ 1063 V. supra_, Art. 1, No. 4.

1064 On the divine appropriations see Pohle-Preuss, _The Divine Trinity_, pp. 244 sqq.

1065 Rom. VIII, 29: "_... praedestinavit conformes fieri imaginis Filii sui._"

1066 Gal. IV, 19: "_Filioli mei, quos iterum parturio, donec formetur Christus in vobis._"

_ 1067 V. infra_, No. 4.

_ 1068 V. infra_, Art. 3, No. 4. On the whole subject cfr. Heinrich-Gutberlet, _Dogmatische Theologie_, Vol. VIII, § 465; H. Krug, _De Pulchritudine Divina_, pp. 53 sqq., 144 sqq., 241 sqq., Freiburg 1902.

1069 Sess. VI, cap. 7: "_... unde homo ex iniusto fit iustus et ex inimico amicus._"

1070 Sess. VI, cap. 10: "_Sic ergo iustificati et amici Dei ac domestici facti...._"

1071 Wisd. VII, 14: "_Participes facti sunt amicitiae Dei._"

1072 John XV, 14 sq.: "_Iam non dicam vos servos, ... vos autem dixi amicos._"

1073 Matth. IX, 15: "_Numquid possunt filii sponsi lugere, quamdiu cum illis est sponsus?_"

1074 Apoc. XIX, 7: "_Venerunt nuptiae Agni et uxor eius praeparavit se._" Cfr. John III, 29; Eph. V, 23 sqq.; 2 Cor. XI, 2; Cant. IV, 1 sqq.; Ps. XLIV, 22 sqq. On the teaching of the Fathers see Cornelius a Lapide, _Comment. in 2 Cor._, XI, 2.

_ 1075 Eth. ad Nichom._, VIII sq.

1076 Cfr. St. Thomas, _Comment. in Quatuor Libros Sent._, III, dist. 27, qu. 2, art. 1, ad 1: "_Amicitia vera desiderat videre amicum et colloquiis mutuis gaudere facit, ad quem principaliter est amicitia; non autem ita, quod delectatio ex amici visione et perfruitione, finis amicitiae ponatur._"

1077 Cfr. St. Thomas, _Summa Theologica_, 1a 2ae, qu. 28, art. 1: "_Quum aliquis amat aliquem amore amicitiae, vult ei bonum, sicut et sibi vult bonum, unde apprehendit eum ut alterum se, inquantum scil. ei vult bonum, sicut et sibi vult bonum. Et inde est, quod amicus dicitur esse alter ipse. Et Augustinus dicit in l. 4 Confess.: Bene quidam dixit de amico suo, ____dimidium animae meae____._"

1078 "_Amicitia pares aut invenit aut facit._" _In Mich._, 7.

1079 Prov. VIII, 31: "_Deliciae meae esse cum filiis hominum._"

_ 1080 V. supra_, Art. 1, No. 3.

1081 Cfr. St. Thomas, _Comment. in Quatuor Libros Sent._, III, dist. 37, qu. 2, art. 1, ad 10: "_Amicitia dicitur esse non latens, non quod per certitudinem amor amid cognoscatur, sed quia per signa probabilia amor mutuus habentium coligitur. Et talis manifestatio potest esse de caritate, inquantum per aliqua signa potest aliquis probabiliter aestimare se habere caritatem._"

1082 Cfr. Ecclus. XXXIV, 14 sqq.

1083 Cfr. St. Thomas, _op. cit._, III, dist. 29, qu. 1, art. 3, ad 4: "_Si esset possibile, quod ex nostris operibus aliquid Deo accresceret, habens caritatem multo plura faceret propter beatitudinem ei conservandam, quam propter eam sibi adipiscendam._"

1084 1 John III, 17: "_Qui habuerit substantiam huius mundi et viderit fratrem suum necessitatem habere et clauserit viscera sua ab eo, quomodo caritas Dei_ (ἡ ἀγάπη τοῦ Θεοῦ) _manet in ea?_"

_ 1085 V. supra_, Art. 1, No. 4.

1086 The singular opinion of Ripalda (_De Caritate_, disp. 33), that such a relation would be possible even in the state of pure nature, is rejected by Suarez as incorrect (_De Caritate_, disp. 3, sect. 5, n. 4). On the whole question cfr. Schiffini, _De Gratia Divina_, pp. 305 sqq.

_ 1087 Conc. Trident._, Sess. VI, cap. 4: "_... status gratiae et adoptionis filiorum Dei._"

1088 Rom. VIII, 15 sqq.: "_Accepistis ... spiritum adoptionis filiorum, in quo clamamus Abba, Pater; ipse enim Spiritus testimonium reddit spiritui nostro, quod sumus filii Dei; si autem filii, et haeredes: haeredes quidem Dei, cohaeredes autem Christi._"

1089 1 John III, 1 sq.: "_Videte, qualem caritatem dedit nobis Pater, ut filii Dei nominemur et simus ... Carissimi, nunc filii Dei sumus._"

1090 Gal. IV, 5: "_... ut adoptionem filiorum reciperemus._"

1091 John I, 12 sq.: "_... dedit eis potestatem filios Dei fieri, qui ... ex Deo nati sunt_ (ἔδωκεν αὐτοῖς ἐξουσίαν τέκνα Θεοῦ γενέσθαι, τοῖς ... ἐκ Θεοῦ ἐγεννήθησαν)."

_ 1092 Summa Theol._, 3a, qu. 23, art. 1: "_Adoptio est personae extraneae in filium et haeredem gratuita assumptio._"

1093 Cfr. Gal. IV, 7: "_Itaque iam non est servus, sed filius; quod si filius, et haeres per Deum._"

1094 Cfr. Rom. VIII, 17; Gal. IV, 7.

1095 Cfr. St. Thomas, _Summa Theol._, 3a, qu. 23, art. 1, ad 2.

1096 Cfr. _Conc. Trident._, Sess. VI, cap. 7: "_... per voluntariam susceptionem gratiae et donorum._"

1097 Cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _The Divine Trinity_, pp. 49 sqq.

1098 Cfr. John III, 5 sq.; 2 Cor. III, 18; Tit. III, 5 sqq.

1099 Cfr. St. Thomas, _Summa Theologica_, 3a, qu. 23, art. 2, ad. 2: "For He [God the Father] is Christ's father by natural generation; and this is proper to him: whereas He is our Father by a voluntary operation, which is common to Him and to the Son and the Holy Ghost: so that Christ is not the Son of the whole Trinity, as we are."

1100 Cfr. St. Thomas, _l.c._, ad 2.

1101 Suarez, _De Incarnatione_, disp. 49, sect. 2, n. 5.

1102 This heresy is called Adoptionism; for a refutation of it see Pohle-Preuss, _Christology_, pp. 196 sqq.

1103 1 John III, 1.

1104 Cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _Soteriology_, pp. 15 sqq.

_ 1105 Or. in Is._, II, 4.

_ 1106 V. infra_, Art. 3, No. 4.

1107 Cfr. J. Scheeben, "_Kontroverse über die Formalursache der Kindschaft Gottes_," in the _Katholik_, of Mayence, 1883, I, pp. 142 sqq., II, pp. 561 sqq.; 1884, I, 18 sqq. II, 465 sqq., 610 sqq.; Granderath, "_Kontroverse über die Gotteskindschaft_," in the Innsbruck _Zeitschrift für kath. Theologie_, 1881, pp. 283 sqq., 1883, pp. 491 sqq., 593 sqq., 1884, pp. 545 sqq.

_ 1108 De Trinitate_, VIII, 4 sqq.

_ 1109 Comment. in S. Theol._, 3a, qu. 23, art. 3.

1110 Cfr. Gal. IV, 7. On the subject of the adoptive sonship of the just the student may profitably consult A. Rademacher, _Die übernatürliche Lebensordnung nach der paulinischen und johanneischen Theologie_, pp. 97 sqq., Freiburg 1903.

_ 1111 V. supra_, p. 340.

_ 1112 Cat. Rom._, P. II, c. 1, n. 51: "_Huic [gratiae sanctificanti] additur nobilissimus omnium virtutum comitatus, quae in animam cum gratia divinitus infunduntur._"

_ 1113 Conc. Trident._, Sess. VI, cap. 7: "_Unde in ipsa iustificatione cum remissione peccatorum haec omnia simul infusa accipit homo per Iesum Christum, cui inseritur, fidem, spem et caritatem._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 800.) The question whether the three theological virtues are genuine _habitus operativi_, must be answered in the affirmative; but its denial incurs no censure so long as the distinction existing between these habitual virtues and actual grace is left intact. It is of faith that habitual charity is infused simultaneously with habitual grace. Cfr. _Conc. Trident._, Sess. VI, can. 11: "_Si quis dixerit, homines iustificari ... exclusâ gratiâ et caritate, quae in cordibus eorum per Spiritum Sanctum diffundatur atque illis inhaereat, anathema sit._" On the bearing of this definition see Tepe, _Instit. Theol._, Vol. III, pp. 175 sq., Paris 1896; Schiffini, _De Gratia Divina_, pp. 315 sqq., Freiburg 1901.

1114 Rom. V, 5: "_Caritas Dei (ἡ ἀγάπη τοῦ Θεοῦ) diffusa est (ἐκκέχυται) in cordibus nostris per Spiritum Sanctum, qui datus est nobis._"

1115 1 Cor. XIII, 2: "_Et si habuero omnem fidem, ita ut montes transferam, caritatem autem non habuero, nihil sum._"

1116 1 Cor. XIII, 13: "_Nunc autem manent fides, spes, caritas (πίστις, ἐλπίς, ἀγάπη), tria haec; maior autem horum est caritas._"

_ 1117 Quaestiones Disputatae de Virtutibus in Communi_, art. 12: "_Ad hoc autem, quod moveamur recte in finem [scil. Deum], oportet finem esse et cognitum et desideratum. Desiderium autem finis duo exigit, scil. fiduciam de fine obtinendo, quia nullus sapiens movetur ad id quod consequi non potest; et amorem finis, quia non desideratur nisi amatum. Et ideo virtutes theologicae sunt tres, scil. fides quâ Deum cognoscimus, spes quâ ipsum nos obtenturos esse speramus, et caritas quâ eum diligimus._"

1118 Sess. VI, cap. 7.

1119 This thesis is not, however, so certain that it would be wrong to contradict it, as has actually been done by Scotus, Durandus, and others. Cfr. Suarez, _De Gratia_, VI, 9, 12.

1120 Cfr. St. Thomas, _Summa Theol._, 1a 2ae, qu. 57 sqq. That the cardinal virtues are four in number, St. Thomas proves as follows: "_[Bonum rationis] potest dupliciter considerari: uno modo, prout habet rationein consiliabilis et eligibilis, secundum quam ratio circa illud operatur et sic est prudentia, quae est media inter intellectuales et morales; ... alio modo, secundum quod habet rationem boni appetibilis. Ad appetitum autem duo pertinent, scil. actio et passio; passio autem est in irascibili et concupiscibili. Circa actiones ergo est iustitia, circa passiones irascibiles est fortitudo, circa passiones concupiscibiles est temperantia. Et sic sunt quatuor virtutes cardinales._" (_Comment. in Quatuor Libros Sent._, III, dist. 33, qu. 2, art. 1, solut. 3.)

1121 Wis. VIII, 7: "_Et si iustitiam quis diligit, labores huius magnas habent virtutes; sobrietatem enim et prudentiam docet [Deus] et iustitiam et virtutem, quibus utilius nihil est in vita hominibus._"

1122 Ez. XI, 19 sq.: "_Et auferam cor lapideum de came eorum et dabo eis cor carneum, ut in praeceptis meis ambulent et iudicia mea custodiant._"

1123 Cfr. Jer. XXXI, 33; Col. I, 10 sq.; 1 John II, 27.

_ 1124 In Ps._, 83: "_Istae virtutes nunc in convalle plorationis per gratiam Dei donantur nobis._"

_ 1125 Hom. in Ezech._, I, 5, n. 11: "_In fide enim, spe atque caritate, et in aliis bonis, sine quibus ad coelestem patriam non potest perveniri, ... perfectorum corda [Spiritus Sanctus] non deserit._"

_ 1126 Summa Theol._, 1a 2ae, qu. 63, art. 3: "_Oportet effectus esse suis causis et principiis proportionatos. Omnes autem virtutes tam intellectuales quam morales, quae ex nostris actibus acquiruntur, procedunt ex quibusdam naturalibus principiis in nobis praeexistentibus.... Loco quorum naturalium principiorum conferuntur nobis a Deo virtutes theologicae, quibus ordinamur ad finem supernaturalem.... Unde oportet quod his etiam virtutibus theologicis proportionaliter respondeant alii habitus divinitus causati in nobis, qui sic se habent ad virtutes theologicas sicut se habent

virtutes morales et intellectuales ad principia naturalia virtutum._" For further information on this subject consult Heinrich-Gutberlet, _Dogmatische Theologie_, Vol. VIII, § 471, Mainz 1897; Schiffini, _De Gratia Divina_, pp. 319 sqq., Freiburg 1901; Van Noort, _De Gratia Christi_, pp. 161 sqq., Amsterdam 1908.

1127 Cfr. Gregory of Valentia, _Comment. in S. Theol._, 1a 2ae, disp. 5, qu. 8, p. 1: "_Dona Spiritus S. potentias animae perficiunt ad actiones quasdam heroicas, ... quâ ratione peculiariter procedunt ex divino quodam Spiritus S. instinctu, quo mens nostra plerumque mirabiliter solet agi et impelli ad quaedam opera praestantia et rara.... Atque ita in usu donorum homo potius agitur, in usu autem virtuturn se habet potius ut agens._" Cfr. Simar, _Dogmatik_, Vol. II, 4th ed., pp. 641 sqq., Freiburg 1899; Van Noort, _De Gratia Christi_, pp. 174 sqq.

1128 Rom. VIII, 9 sqq.

1129 Cfr. Is. XI, 1 sqq.; LXI, 1; Luke IV, 18.

1130 "_Da tuis fidelibus, in te confitentibus, sacrum septenarium._" (_Missale Rom._, Sequence for Whit Sunday.) For a more detailed treatment of the subject dealt with in Thesis III consult J. Kleutgen, _Theologie der Vorzeit_, Vol. II, 2nd ed., pp. 365 sqq., Münster 1872; C. Weiss, _S. Thomae Aquinatis de Septem Donis Spiritus S. Doctrina_, Vienne 1895; J. Regler, _Die sieben Gaben des Hl. Geistes in ihrer Bedeutung für das christliche Leben_, Ratisbon 1899; Schiffini, _De Gratia Divina_, pp. 337 sqq., Freiburg 1901. On the connection of the gifts of the Holy Ghost with the beatitudes (cfr. Matth. V, 3 sqq.) and the "twelve fruits of the Holy Ghost" (cfr. Gal. V, 22 sq.), see St. Thomas, _Summa Theol._, 1a 2ae, qu. 69 and 70. The student may also consult Suarez, _De Gratia_, VI, 10, and Vasquez, _Comment. in S. Theol._, III, disp. 44, cap. 2.

1131 Cfr. St. Bonaventure, _Compendium Theol. Verit._, I, 9: "_In iustificatione duplex caritas nobis datur, scil. creata et increata: illa quâ diligimus, et illa quâ diligimur.... Ex his colligitur, quod licet Deus sit in omnibus per essentiam, praesentiam et potentiam, non tamen habetur ab omnibus per gratiam._"

1132 John XIV, 16 sq.: "_... alium Paraclitum dabit vobis, ut maneat vobiscum in aeternum.... Vos autem cognoscetis eum, quia apud vos manebit et in vobis (ἐν ὑμῖν) erit._"

1133 Rom. V, 5: "_Caritas Dei diffusa est in cordibus nostris per Spiritum sanctum, qui datus est nobis._"

1134 Rom. VIII, 11: "_Quodsi Spiritus eius, qui suscitavit Iesum a mortuis, habitat in vobis (οἰκεῖ ἐν ὑμῖν), qui suscitavit Iesnm Christum a mortuis, vivificabit et mortalia corpora vestra propter inhabitantem Spiritum eius in vobis (διὰ τοῦ ἐνοικοῦντος αὐτοῦ πνεύματος ἐν ὑμῖν)._"

1135 "_Nescitis, quia templum Dei (ναὸς Θεοῦ) estis et Spiritus Dei habitat in vobis (οἰκεῖ ἐν ὑμῖν)?... Templum enim Dei sanctum est, quod estis vos._"

1136 1 Cor. 6, 19: "_An nescitis, quoniam membra vestra templum sunt Spiritus S., qui in vobis est, quem habetis a Deo et non estis vestri?_" Cfr. Rom. VIII, 9; Gal. IV, 6;

2 Cor. VI, 16.

_ 1137 Ep. ad Serap._, I, n. 24.

1138 θεοποιοῦνται.

_ 1139 Contra Eunom._, I, V.

_ 1140 Dialog._, VII, _per totum_.

_ 1141 De Trinitate_, XV, n. 36: "_Ita enim datur sicut donum Dei, ut etiam seipsum det sicut Deus._"

_ 1142 Serm._, 144, c. 1: "_Gratia quippe Dei donum Dei est; donum autem maximum ipse Spiritus Sanctus est, et ideo gratia dicitur._"

_ 1143 Enchiridion_, c. 37: "_Et utique Spiritus Sanctus Dei donum est, quod quidem et ipsum est aequale donanti; et ideo Deus est etiam Spiritus Sanctus, Patre Filioque non minor._" Additional Patristic texts of like tenor in Petavius, _De Trinitate_, l. VIII, cap. 4 sq.: Franzelin, _De Deo Trino_, thes. 43; J. Kleutgen, _Theologie der Vorseit_, Vol. II, 2nd ed., pp. 369 sqq.

1144 Cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _The Divine Trinity_, pp. 230 sqq.

1145 John XIV, 23: "_Si quis diligit me, sermonem meum servabit, et Pater meus diliget eum, et ad eum veniemus et mansionem (μονήν) apud eum faciemus._"

_ 1146 Ep. 1 ad Serap._, n. 30: "_Ex his una Trinitatis ἐνέργεια ostenditur ... profecto quum Dominus ait: Veniemus ego et Pater, simul venit Spiritus, non alio modo quam ut Filius in nobis habitaturus._"

_ 1147 De Trinit._, XV, 18, 32: "_Dilectio igitur, quae ex Deo est et Deus est, proprie Spiritus S. est, per quem diffunditur in cordibus nostris Dei caritas, per quam nos tota inhabitat Trinitas._"

1148 For a more detailed treatment see Franzelin, _De Deo Trino_, thes. 43-48, Rome 1881.

1149 Cfr. Pseudo-Dionys. Areop., _De Hier. Eccl._, 1, § 3 (Migne, _P. G._, III, 376): Ἡ δὲ θέωσις ἐστιν ἡ πρὸς Θεὸν ἀφομοίωσίς τε καὶ ἕνωσις.

1150 Cfr. Petavius, _De Trinit._, VIII, 7, 12: "_Ostendimus enim non semel, coniunctionem illam Spiritus S. neque φυσικήν neque ὑποστατικήν esse, h. e. neque naturalem neque personalem, quasi una fiat ex ambobus natura vel persona. Non enim quia et illi per adoptionis gratiam filii Dei sunt, ait Augustinus (In Ps. 67), ideo quisquam illorum est unigenitus. Neque enim ex personarum duarum copulatione unum aliquid per sese, sed κατα συμβεβηκός potest effici._"

1151 Cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _The Divine Trinity_, pp. 244 sqq.

1152 Cfr. Scheeben, _Die Mysterien des Christentums_, 2nd ed., p. 165, Freiburg 1898.

1153 Cfr. John XIV, 23; XVII, 20 sqq.

1154 Gutberlet takes middle ground between the two theories and tries to reconcile them. Cfr. Heinrich-Gutberlet, _Dogmatische Theologie_, Vol. VIII, § 468. See also A. Rademacher, _Die übernatürliche Lebensordnung nach der paulinischen und johanneischen Theologie_, pp. 193 sqq., Freiburg 1903.

1155 Cfr. R. F. Clarke, S. J., _Logic_, p. 174.

1156 "_Fides fiducialis_," _v. supra_, pp. 255 sqq.

1157 Sess. VI, cap. 9; Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 684.

1158 Sess. VI, can. 13-15; Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 823 sqq.

1159 1 Cor. IV, 4: "_Nihil enim mihi conscius sum, sed non in hoc iustificatus sum; qui autem iudicat me, Dominus est._"

1160 1 Cor. IX, 27: "_Castigo corpus meum et in servitutem redigo, ne forte, quum aliis praedicaverim, ipse reprobus (ἀδόκιμος) efficiar._"

1161 Phil. II, 12: "_Cum metu et tremore vestram salutem operamini._" Other Scriptural texts in Bellarmine, _De Iustificatione_, III, 4 sqq. For the solution of certain exegetical difficulties see the same author, _op. cit._, III, 9, and Tepe, _Instit. Theol._, Vol. III, pp. 210 sqq., Paris 1896.

_ 1162 Hom. in I. Epist. ad Cor._, 2.

1163 Eccles. IX, 1 sq.: "_Nescit homo, utrum amore an odio dignus, etc._"

_ 1164 Hieronymus in h. l._ (Migne, _P. L._, XXIII, 1080): "_In futuro igitur scient omnia et in vultu eorum sunt omnia, i.e. antecedet eos, quum de hac vita decesserint, notitia istius rei quia tunc est iudicum et nunc certamen. Et quicunque adversa sustinent, utrum per amorem Dei sustineant, ut Iob, an per odium, ut plurimi peccatores, nunc habetur incertum._"

_ 1165 Ep._, VII, 25: "_Rem et inutilem et difficilem postulasti: difficilem quidem, quia ego indignus sum, cui revelatio fieri debeat; inutilem vero, quia secura de peccatis tuis fieri non debes, nisi quum iam in die vitae tuae ultimo plangere eadem peccata minime valebis._" The Patristic argument is more fully developed by Bellarmine, _De Iustif._, III, 7.

_ 1166 Dogmengeschichte_, Vol. III, p. 617.

_ 1167 Conc. Trident._, Sess. VI, cap. 9: "_Sicut nemo pius de Dei misericordia, de Christi merito deque sacramentorum efficacia dubitare debet, sic quilibet, dum seipsum suamque propriam infirmitatem et indispositionem respicit, de sua gratia formidare et timere potest, quum nullus scire valeat certitudine fidei, cui non potest subesse falsum, se gratiam Dei esse consecutum._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 802.)

1168 "_Peirorem sequitur semper conclusio partem._" Cfr. Clarke, _Logic_, p. 322.

1169 Cfr. _Conc. Trident._, Sess. VI, can. 16: "_Si quis magnum illud usque in finem perseverantiae donum se certo habiturum absolutâ et infallibili certitudine dixerit, nisi hoc speciali revelatione didicerit, anathema sit._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 826.)

1170 In his little treatise _De Certitudine Gratiae_.

1171 Sess. VI, cap. 9: "_... iustificatos absque ulla dubitatione apud semetipsos statuere, se esse iustificatos._"

1172 Rom. VIII, 38 sq.: "_Certus sum enim (πέπεισμαι=persuasum habeo), quia neque mors neque vita ... poterit nos separare a caritate Dei, quae est in Christo Iesu._"

_ 1173 Tract. in Ioa._, I, 3, 5, n. 10: "_Quid nos scimus? Quia transivimus de morte ad vitam. Unde scimus? Quia diligimus fratres. Nemo interroget hominem, redeat unusquisque ad cor suum; si ibi invenerit caritatem fraternam, securus sit, quia transiit a morte ad vitam._"

1174 Cfr. the _Imitation of Christ_ by Thomas à Kempis, III, 54 sqq. On the whole subject of this subdivision the student may profitably consult the _Summa Theologica_ of St. Thomas, 1a 2ae, qu. 112, art. 5; Suarez, _De Gratia_, IX, 9-11, and Billuart, _De Gratia_, diss. 6, art. 4.

_ 1175 Serm. de Nativitate Mariae_: "_Omnes Christiani aeque magni sumus sicut mater Dei, et aeque sancti sicut ipsa._"

1176 Sess. VI, cap. 7: "_Iustitiam in nobis recipientes, unusquisque suam secundum mensuram, quam Spiritus Sanctus partitur singulis prout vult, et secundum propriam cuiusque dispositionem et cooperationem._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 799.)

1177 Sess. VI, cap. 10: "_Iustificati ... in ipsa iustitia per Christi gratiam accepta, cooperante fide bonis operibus crescunt atque magis iustificantur._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 803.)

1178 Sess. VI, can. 24: "_Si quis dixerit, iustitiam acceptam non conservari atque etiam augeri coram Deo per bona opera, sed opera ipsa fructus solummodo et signa esse iustificationis adeptae, non autem ipsius augendae causam, anathema sit._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 834.)

1179 Prov. IV, 18: "_Iustorum autem semita quasi lux splendens procedit et crescit usque ad perfectam diem._"

1180 Ecclus. XVIII, 22: "_Non impediaris orare semper et ne verearis usque ad mortem iustificari, quoniam merces Dei manet in aeternum._"

1181 2 Pet. III, 18: "_Crescite vero in gratia et in cognitione Domini nostri et Salvatoris Iesu Christi._"

1182 2 Cor. IX, 10: "_[Deus] augebit incrementa frugum iustitiae vestrae._"

1183 Eph. IV, 7: "_Unicuique autem nostrum data est gratia secundum mensuram donationis Christi._"

1184 Apoc. XXII, 11 sq.: "_Qui iustus est, iustificetur adhuc, et sanctus sanctificetur adhuc. Ecce venio cito et merces mea mecum est, reddere unicuique secundum opera sua._" Cfr. Bellarmine, _De Iustific._, III, 16.

_ 1185 Contra Iovin._, II, n. 23: "_Unicuique nostrum data est gratia iuxta mensuram gratiae (Eph. 4, 7); non quod mensura Christi diversa sit, sed tantum gratiae eius infunditur, quantum valemus haurire_."

_ 1186 Ep._, 167, n. 13: "_Induti sunt sancti iustitiâ (Job 29, 14), alius magis, alius minus; et nemo hic vivit sine peccato et hoc alius magis, alius minus: optimus autem est qui minimum._"

_ 1187 Summa Theol._, 1a 2ae, qu. 112, art. 4, ad 3: "_Vita naturalis pertinet ad substantiam hominis, et ideo non recipit magis et minus; sed vitam gratiae participat homo accidentaliter, et ideo eam potest homo magis vel minus habere._" On the teaching of Tradition cfr. Alb. a Bulsano, _Instit. Theol. Dogmat._, ed. G. a Graun, O. Cap., Vol. II, p. 254, Innsbruck 1894.

1188 Ecclus. XVIII, 22; Apoc. XXII, 11.

1189 Cfr. Vasquez, _Comment. in Summam Theol._, 1a 2ae, disp. 221, cap. 9, n. 77.

1190 Ecclus. XIX, 1: "_Qui spernit modica, paulatim decidet._" For a fuller treatment of this subject we refer the student to St. Thomas, _Summa Theol._, 2a 2ae, qu. 24, art. 10.

_ 1191 V. supra_, pp. 328 sqq.

1192 Cfr. Suarez, _Disp. Metaph._, l. II, disp. 16.

1193 The authority of St. Thomas himself can be invoked by neither party to this controversy. Cfr. Sylvius, _Comment. in S. Theol._, 2a 2ae, qu. 24, art. 3.

1194 For a fuller treatment of this topic see Tepe, _Instit. Theol._, Vol. III, pp. 217 sqq.

_ 1195 V. supra_, pp. 336 sqq.

1196 Suarez, _De Gratia_, IX, 2, 13.

1197 Suarez, _op. cit._, IX, 4, 15.

1198 Sess. VI, cap. 10: "_Hoc vero iustitiae incrementum petit sancta Ecclesia, quum orat: Da nobis, Domine, fidei, spei et caritatis augmentum._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 803). Cfr. De Lugo, _De Fide_, disp. 16, sect. 2.

1199 Cfr. St. Thomas, _Summa Theol._, 2a 2ae, qu. 24, art. 7.

1200 Cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _Christology_, pp. 231 sqq.

1201 Cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _Mariology_, pp. 24 sqq.

1202 For a more elaborate treatment the reader is referred to Suarez, _De Gratia_, IX, 6, 11, and Schiffini, _De Gratia Divina_, pp. 570 sq., Freiburg 1901.

1203 Sess. VI, can. 23: "_Si quis hominem semel iustificatum dixerit amplius peccare non posse neque gratiam amittere atque ideo eum, qui labitur et peccat, numquam vere fuisse iustificatum; ... anathema sit._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 833.)

1204 Sess. VI, can. 27: “_Si quis dixerit, nullum esse mortale peccatum nisi infidelitatis, aut nullo alio quantumvis gravi et enormi praeterquam infidelitatis peccato semel acceptam gratiam amitti, anathema sit._” (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 837).

1205 Sess. VI, cap. 11: “_Licet in hac mortali vita quantumvis sancti et iusti in levia saltem et quotidiana, quae etiam venialia dicuntur, peccata quandoque cadant, non propterea desinunt esse iusti._”

1206 Ez. XVIII, 24: “_Si autem averterit se iustus a iustitia sua, et fecerit iniquitatem secundum omnes abominationes, quas operari solet impius, numquid vivet? Omnes iustitiae eius, quas fecerat, non recordabuntur; in praevaricatione, quâ praevaricatus est, et in peccato suo, quod peccavit, in ipsis morietur._”

1207 Matth. XXVI, 41: “_Vigilate et orate, ut non intretis in tentationem._”

1208 1 Cor. X, 12: “_Qui se existitmat stare, videat ne cadat._”

1209 1 Cor. VI, 9 sq.: “_Nolite errare, neque fornicarii neque idolis servientes neque adulteri neque molles neque masculorum concubitores neque fures neque avari neque ebriosi neque maledici neque rapaces regnum Dei possidebunt._” Cfr. _Conc. Trident._, Sess. VI, cap. 15 (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 808).

1210 1 John III, 9: “_Omnis, qui natus est ex Deo, peccatum non facit: quoniam semen ipsius in eo manet, et non potest peccare, quoniam ex Deo natus est._”

_ 1211 Contra Iovin._, 1. II: “_Propterea scribo vobis, filioli mei, omnis qui natus est ex Deo, non peccat, ut non peccetis et tamdiu sciatis vos in generatione Domini permanere, quamdiu non peccaveritis._” On the different interpretations of 1 John III, 9, an admittedly difficult text, see Bellarmine, _De Iustific._, III, 15.

_ 1212 De Correpț. et Gratia_, c. VI, n. 9: “_Si iam regeneratus et iustificatus in malam vitam suâ voluntate relabitur, certe iste non potest dicere: Non accepti, quia acceptam gratiam Dei suo in malum libero amisit arbitrio._”

_ 1213 Hom. in Ez._, 9, 1: “_Sicuti qui a fide recedit, apostata est, ita qui ad perversum opus, quod deseruerit, redit, ab omnipotente Deo apostata deputatur, etiamsi fidem tenere videatur; unum enim sine altero nil prodesse valet, quia nec fides sine operibus nec opera adiuvant sine fide._”

1214 For the solution of certain difficulties see Schiffini, _De Gratia Divina_, pp. 591 sqq. On the penitential discipline of the early Church cfr. G. Rauschen, _Eucharist and Penance in the First Six Centuries_, pp. 152 sqq., St. Louis 1913.

1215 Cfr. _Conc. Trident._, Sess. VI, can. 28: “_Si quis dixerit, amissâ per peccatum gratiâ simul et fidem semper amitti, aut fidem quae remanet non esse veram fidem, licet non sit viva, aut eum qui fidem sine caritate habet, non esse Christianum, anathema sit._” (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 838.)

1216 Cfr. _Conc. Trident._, Sess. VI, cap. 15: “_Non modo infidelitate, per quam et ipsa fides amittitur, sed etiam quocunque alio mortali peccato, quamvis non amittatur fides, acceptam iustificationis gratiam amitti._”

1217 Cfr. _Prop. Quesnelli damn. a Clemente XI_, prop. 57: "_Totum deest peccatori, quando ei deest spes, et non est spes in Deo, ubi non est amor Dei._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 1407.)

_ 1218 V. supra_, Section 2.

1219 The questions discussed in this subdivision of our treatise are more fully treated by Ripalda, _De Ente Supernaturali_, disp. 128, sect. 4, and by Suarez, _De Gratia_, IX, 3 sqq.

1220 Sess. VI, cap. 16.

_ 1221 V. supra_, p. 131.

_ 1222 V. supra_, pp. 132 sqq.

_ 1223 Realitas sive existentia meriti._

_ 1224 Conditiones meriti._

_ 1225 Obiecta meriti._

1226 Cfr. _Conc. Viennense_, A. D. 1311 (_Clementin._, l. V, tit. 3: "De Haereticis") in Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 471 sqq.

1227 "_In omni opere bono iustus peccat._" _Prop. Lutheri Damnatae A. D. 1520 a Leone X_, prop. 31 (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 771).

1228 "_Opus bonum, optime factum est veniale peccatum_." Prop. 32, _l. c._, n. 772.

1229 "_Omne opus iusti damnabile est et peccatum mortale, si iudicio Dei iudicetur._"

1230 "_Inquinamenta et sordes._" _Instit._, III, 12, 4.

1231 Quietism (Michael de Molinos _et al._) denied the meritoriousness of good works performed in the "state of passive repose" (_quies_).

1232 "_Debetur merces bonis operibus, si fiant; sed gratia, quae non debetur, praecedit ut fiant._" Can. 18 (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 191.)

_ 1233 Cap. Firmiter_: "_Non solum autem virgines et continentes, verum etiam coniugati per rectam fidem et operationem bonam placentes Deo ad aeternam merentur beatitudinem pervenire._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 430.)

1234 Sess. VI, cap. 16: "_Atque ideo bene operantibus usque in finem et in Deo sperantibus proponenda est vita aeterna et tamquam gratia filiis Dei per Christum Iesum misericorditer promissa et tamquam merces ex ipsius Dei promissione bonis ipsorum operibus et meritis fideliter reddenda._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 809.)

1235 Sess. VI, can. 25: "_Si quis in quolibet bono opere iustum saltem venialiter peccare dixerit, aut quod intolerabilius est, mortaliter atque ideo poenas aeternas mereri, tantumque ob id non damnari quia Deus ea opera non imputat ad damnationem, anathema sit._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 835.)

1236 Sess. VI, can. 26: “_Si quis dixerit, iustos non debere pro bonis operibus, quae in Deo fuerint facta, exspectare et sperare aeternam retributionem a Deo per eius misericordiam et Iesu Christi meritum, si bene agendo et divina mandata custodiendo usque in finem perseveraverint, anathema sit._” (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 836.)

1237 Sess. VI, can. 32: “_Si quis dixerit, ... ipsum iustificatum bonis operibus, quae ab eo per Dei gratiam et Iesu Christi meritum, cuius vivum membrum est, fiunt, non vere mereri augmentum gratiae, ... anathema sit._” (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 842.)

1238 Cfr. Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 1221 sqq.

1239 Wisd. V, 16: “_Iusti autem in perpetuum vivent et apud Dominum est merces eorum._”

1240 Ecclus. XVIII, 22: “_Ne verearis usque ad mortem iustificari, quoniam merces Dei manet in aeternum._” Cfr. Gen. XV, 1.

1241 Matth. V, 12: “_Gaudete et exultate, quoniam merces vestra copiosa est in caelis._”

1242 Rom. II, 6 sq.: “_... qui reddet unicuique secundum opera eius, iis quidem, qui secundum patientiam boni operis gloriam et honorem et incorruptionem quaerunt, vitam aeternam._”

1243 2 Tim. IV, 7 sq.: “_Bonum certamen certavi, cursum consummavi, fidem servavi. In reliquo reposita est mihi corona iustitiae, quam reddet mihi Dominus in illa die iustus iudex; non solum autem mihi, sed et iis qui diligunt adventum eius._” Cfr. 1 Cor. IX, 25.

1244 1 Cor. III, 8: “_Unusquisque autem propriam mercedem accipiet, secundum suum laborem._”

1245 Col. III, 23 sq.: “_Quodcunque facitis, ex animo operamini sicut Domino et non hominibus, scientes quod a Domino accipietis retributionem haereditatis._”

1246 Iac. I, 12: “_Beatus vir, qui suffert tentationem, quoniam, quum probatus fuerit, accipiet coronam vitae, quam repromisit Deus diligentibus se._”

1247 Apoc. II, 10: “_Esto fidelis usque ad mortem, et dabo tibi coronam vitae._” For additional Scripture texts see Bellarmine, _De Iustificatione_, V, 3, 5.

_ 1248 Ep. ad Rom._, IV, 1.

_ 1249 Adv. Haer._, IV, 37.

_ 1250 De Offic._, I, 15, 57: “_Nonne evidens est, meritorum aut praemia aut supplicia post mortem manere?_”

_ 1251 De Moribus Ecclesiae_, I, 25: “_Vita aeterna est totum praemium, cuius promissione gaudemus, nec praemium potest praecedere merita priusque homini dari, quam dignus est. Quid enim hoc iniustius et quid iustius Deo? Non ergo debemus poscere praemia, antequam mereamur accipere._”

_ 1252 Ep. ad Sixt._, 194, n. 20: "_Sicut merito peccati tamquam stipendium redditur mors, ita merito iustitiae tamquam stipendium vita aeterna.... Unde etiam et merces appellatur plurimis s. Scripturarum locis._" Other Patristic texts inculcating the meritoriousness of good works performed in the state of grace can be found in Bellarmine, _De Iustif._, V, 4, 6. For the solution of objections raised against the Patristic argument consult Schiffini, _De Gratia Divina_, pp. 609 sqq.

1253 Cfr. St. Thomas, _Summa Theol._, 1a 2ae, qu. 21, art. 4.

_ 1254 Cfr. Prop. Baii damn, a Pio V_, 13 (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 1013): "_Opera bona a filiis adoptionis facta non accipiunt rationem meriti ex eo, quod fiunt per Spiritum adoptionis inhabitantem corda filiorum Dei, sed tantum ex eo, quod sunt conformia legi quodque per ea praestatur obedientia legi._"

1255 Cfr. _Conc. Trident._, Sess. VI, cap. 16: "_Absit, ut Christianus homo in se ipso vel confidat vel glorietur, et non in Domino, cuius tanta est erga homines bonitas, ut eorum velit esse merita, quae sunt ipsius dona._"

_ 1256 Conc. Florent._, A. D. 1439, (_apud_ Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 693): "_... et intueri clare ipsum Deum trinum et unum, sicuti est, pro meritorum tamen diversitate alium alio perfectius._"

_ 1257 V. supra_, pp. 356 sqq.

_ 1258 Conc. Trident._, Sess. XIV, cap. 8: "_Ita non habet homo, unde glorietur, sed omnis gloriatio nostra in Christo est, in quo vivimus, in quo movemur, in quo satisfacimus facientes fructus dignos poenitentiae, qui ex illo vim habent, ab illo offeruntur Patri et per illum acceptantur a Patre._" (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 904.)

1259 Cfr. _Conc. Trident._, Sess. VI, can. 33: "_Si quis dixerit, per hanc doctrinam catholicam de iustificatione, a s. Synodo hoc praesenti decreto expressam, aliquâ ex parte gloriae Dei vel meritis Iesu Christi D. N. derogari, et non potius veritatem fidei nostrae, Dei denique ac Christi Iesu gloriam illustrari, anathema sit._"

1260 Cfr. Bellarmine, _De Iustificatione_, V, 7. See also the article on "Merit" in the _Catholic Encyclopedia_, Vol. X.

1261 Sess. VI, cap. 16: "_vere promeruisse_;" Sess. VI, can. 32: "_vere mereri_."

_ 1262 Hist. Conc. Trident._, VIII, 4.

1263 "_Operibus post acceptam iustificationem peractis adeoque divinâ gratiâ informatis redditisque ob merita Christi potentioribus, cuius vivum membrum est is qui ea peragit, omnes concedebant rationem meriti condigni ad conservandam augendamque eandem gratiam aeternaeque felicitatis consequendam._" (Pallavicini, _l.c._)

_ 1264 V. infra_, Sect. 2.

1265 Heb. VI, 10: "_Non enim iniustus est Deus, ut obliviscatur operis vestri._"

1266 2 Tim. IV, 8: "_... reposita est mihi_," etc. See note 24, _supra_, p. 403.

1267 Iac. I, 12: “_Beatus vir, qui suffert tentationem_,” etc. _V. supra_, note 27, p. 403.

1268 Wisd. III, 5: “_Deus tentavit eos et invenit illos dignos se._”

1269 2 Thess. I, 4 sq.: “_In omnibus persecutionibus vestris et tribulationibus, quas sustinetis in exemplum iusti iudicii Dei, ut digni habeamini in regno Dei, pro quo et patimini._”

1270 Apoc. III, 4: “_Ambulabunt mecum in albis, quia digni sunt._”

1271 Matth. XXV, 34 sq.: “_Venite, benedicti Patris mei, possidete paratum vobis regnum a constitutione mundi; esurivi enim et dedistis mihi manducare...._”

1272 1 John III, 9.

_ 1273 Summa Theol._, 1a 2ae, qu. 114, art. 3, ad 3: “_Gratia Spiritus S., quam in praesenti habemus, etsi non sit aequalis gloriae in actu, est tamen aequalis in virtute, sicut semen arboris, in quo est virtus ad totam arborem. Et similiter per gratiam inhabitat hominem Spiritus S., qui est sufficiens causa vitae aeternae, unde et dicitur esse pignus hæreditatis nostrae._”

_ 1274 Summa Theol._, 1a, qu. 21, art. 4, ad 1.

1275 Luke VI, 38: “_Date, et dabitur vobis: mensuram bonam, et confectam, et coagitatam, et supereffluentem dabunt in sinum vestrum._” Cfr. _Prop. Baii damn. A. D. 1567 a Pio V_, 14 (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 1014): “_Opera bona iustorum non accipient in die iudicii extremi mercedem ampliorem, quam iusto Dei iudicio mereantur accipere._” For further information on this topic consult Bellarmine, _De Iustificatione_, V, 19; De Lugo, _De Poenitentia_, disp. 24, n. 10. The Thomistic axiom, “_Deus punit citra condignum et remunerat ultra condignum_” and Baius’ condemned proposition are interpreted somewhat differently than we have explained them by Suarez, _De Gratia_, XII, 31, 14. On the general argument of this Section the student may profitably consult St. Bonaventure, _Breviloquium_, P. V, § 12; Billuart, _De Gratia_, diss. 8, art. 3; Tepe, _Instit. Theol._, Vol. III, pp. 226 sqq., Paris 1896; Chr. Pesch, _Praelect. Dogmat._, Vol. V, 3rd ed., pp. 218 sqq., Freiburg 1908; Schiffini, _De Gratia Divina_, pp. 614 sqq., Freiburg 1901.

1276 Eph. VI, 8: “_Scientes, quoniam unusquisque, quodcunque fecerit bonum, hoc recipiet a Domino._”

1277 2 Cor. V, 10: “_Omnes enim nos manifestari oportet ante tribunal Christi, ut referat unusquisque propria corporis, prout gessit, sive bonum sive malum._”

1278 Cfr. St. Thomas, _Summa Theol._, 1a 2ae, qu. 114, art. 1, ad 1: “_Homo, in quantum propriâ voluntate facit illud quod debet, meretur; alioquin actus iustitiae, quo quis reddit debitum, non esset meritorius._”

1279 Cfr. Suarez, _De Gratia_, X, 2, 5 sqq.

1280 Cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _God the Author of Nature and the Supernatural_, pp. 291 sqq.

1281 1 Cor. IX, 17: “_Si enim volens hoc ago, mercedem habeo._”

1282 Matth. XIX, 17: “_Si autem vis ad vitam ingredi, serva mandata._”

_ 1283 Contra Jovin._, 1. II, n. 3: “_Ubi necessitas est, nec corona nec damnatio est._”

1284 For a more extensive treatment of this and allied questions consult Ripalda, _De Ente Supernaturali_, disp. 74, sect. 3; De Lugo, _De Incarnatione_, disp. 26, sect. 10, n. 126 sq.

_ 1285 V. supra_, pp. 82 sqq.

1286 Especially Bañez (_Comment. in S. Theol._, 1a 2ae, qu. 24, art. 6, dub. 6). This view is also taken by the so-called Augustinians.

1287 Notably Billuart; see his treatise _De Gratia_, diss. 8, art. 4.

_ 1288 De Iustificatione_, V, 15: “_Non sufficere, si quis ad initium anni vel mensis vel etiam diei generali quadam intentione referat omnia sua futura opera in Deum, sed necesse esse ut illud ipsum opus particulare referatur in Deum, quod postea faciendum est._”

_ 1289 Summa Theologica_, 1a 2ae, qu. 114, art. 4: “_Et ideo meritum vitae aeternae primo pertinet ad caritatem, ad alias autem virtutes secundario, secundum quod earum actus a caritate imperantur._” And again, _l.c._, ad 3: “_Similiter etiam actus patientiae et fortitudinis non est meritorius, nisi aliquis ex caritate haec operetur._” On the true sense of these passages cfr. Schiffini, _De Gratia Divina_, pp. 647 sqq.

1290 Cfr. _Prop. damn. ab Innocentio XI_, prop. 6 (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 1156): “_Probabile est, ne singulis quidem rigorose quinquenniis per se obligare praeceptum caritatis erga Deum._”

1291 Cfr. J. Ernst, _Die Notwendigkeit der guten Meinung. Untersuchungen über die Gottesliebe als Prinzip der Sittlichkeit und Verdienstlichkeit_, Freiburg 1905.

_ 1292 De Gratia_, IX, 3.

_ 1293 Comment. in S. Theol._, 1a 2ae, disp. 220.

_ 1294 Concilium Trident._, Sess. VI, cap. 16: “_Haec est enim illa corona iustitiae, quam post suum certamen et cursum repositam sibi esse aiebat Apostolus a iusto iudice sibi reddendam, non solum autem sibi, sed et omnibus qui diligunt adventum eius. Quum enim ille ipse Christus Iesus tamquam caput in membra et tamquam vitis in palmites in ipsos iustificatos iugiter virtutem influat, quae virtus bona eorum opera semper antecedit et comitatur et subsequitur et sine quâ nullo pacto Deo grata et meritoria esse possent, nihil ipsis iustificatis amplius deesse credendum est, quominus plene illis quidem operibus, quae in Deo_ [=_per Deum_; v. Sess. VI, can. 26, 32] _sunt facta, divinae legi pro huius vitae statu satisfecisse et vitam aeternam suo etiam tempore, si tamen in gratia decesserint, consequendam vere promeruisse censeantur._” (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 809.)

1295 Cfr. Matth. V, 2 sqq.

1296 Matth. XIX, 16: "_Quid boni faciam, ut habeam vitam aeternam?_"

1297 Matth. XIX, 17: "_Si autem vis ad vitam ingredi, serva mandata._"

1298 Cfr. Matth. XIX, 18 sqq.

1299 The Scriptural argument is more fully developed by Tepe, _Inst. Theol._, Vol. III, pp. 233 sqq.

_ 1300 V. supra_, pp. 73 sqq.

1301 On a similar controversy regarding the necessity of the motive of faith, see Pesch, _Praelect. Dogmat._, Vol. III, 3rd ed., pp. 225 sqq., and Schiffini, _De Gratia Divina_, pp. 649 sqq.

1302 The Scriptural proof for this proposition will be found in the dogmatic treatise on Eschatology. On the absurdity of the semi-Pelagian hypothesis of _merita sub conditione futura_ see Pohle-Preuss, _God: His Knowability, Essence, and Attributes_, pp. 375 sq.

1303 Cfr. _Prop. Baii damn. 1567 a Pio V_, prop. 17 (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 1017): "_Sentiunt cum Pelagio, qui dicunt esse necessarium ad rationem meriti, ut homo per gratiam adoptionis sublimetur ad statum deificum._"

1304 John XV, 4: "_Sicut palmes non potest ferre fructum a semetipso, nisi manserit in vite, sic nec vos, nisi in me manseritis._"

1305 Rom. VIII, 17: "_Si autem filii, et haeredes; haeredes quidem Dei, cohaeredes autem Christi._" Additional Biblical texts in Bellarmine, _De Iustificatione_, V, 12 sq.

_ 1306 Comment. in S. Theol._, 3a, disp. 6, cap. 4.

1307 Suarez (_De Gratia_, XII, 22), Ripalda (_De Ente Supernaturali_, disp. 81), De Lugo (_De Incarnatione_, disp. 6, sect. 2, n. 37).

_ 1308 Comment. in Sent._, II, dist. 29, qu. 1, art. 4.

1309 Cfr. Job XLII, 8; Dan. III, 35.

1310 Cfr. Scotus, _Comment. in Sent._, I, dist. 17, qu. 2.

1311 Cfr. Pohle-Preuss, _God: His Knowability, Essence, and Attributes_, PP. 456 sq.

1312 Rom. VIII, 18: "_Non sunt condignae passiones huius temporis ad futuram gloriam._"

_ 1313 De Perfect. Divin._, XIII, 2.

_ 1314 Comment. in S. Theol._, 1a 2ae, disp. 214, 223.

_ 1315 De Incarnatione_, disp. 3, sect. 1 sq.

_ 1316 Summa Theol._, 1a 2ae, qu. 114, art. 1, ad 3: "_Dicendum quod, quia actio nostra non habet rationem meriti nisi ex praesuppositione divinae ordinationis, non

sequitur quod Deus efficiatur simpliciter debitor nobis, sed sibi ipsi, inquantum debitum est, ut sua ordinatio impleatur._”

1317 Iac. I, 12: “_Accipiet coronam vitae_ [St. Paul says: ὁ τῆς δικαιοσύνης στέφανος], _quam repromisit (ἐπηγγείλατο) Deus diligentibus se._”

_ 1318 Serm._, 158, c. 2, n. 2: “_Debitor factus est Deus non aliquid a nobis accipiendo, sed quod ei placuit promittendo. Aliter enim dicimus homini: Debes mihi, quia dedi tibi; et aliter dicimus: Debes mihi, quia promisisti mihi. Deo autem nunquam dicimus: Redde mihi, quia dedi tibi. Quid dedimus Deo, quando totum quod sumus et quod habemus boni, ab illo habemus? Nihil ergo ei dedimus.... Illo ergo modo possumus exigere Dominum nostrum ut dicamus: Redde, quod promisisti, quia fecimus quod iussisti, et hoc tu fecisti, quia laborantes iuvisti._”

_ 1319 Conc. Trident._, Sess. VI, cap. 16: “_In Deo sperantibus proponenda est vita aeterna ... tamquam merces ex ipsius Dei promissione bonis ipsorum operibus et meritis fideliter [i.e. ex fidelitate] reddenda._” Cfr. Schiffini, _De Gratia Divina_, pp. 416 sqq.

1320 Sess. VI, can. 32: “_Si quis dixerit, iustificatum bonis operibus ... non vere mereri augmentum gratiae, vitam aeternam et ipsius vitae aeternae, si tamen in gratia decesserit, consecutionem atque etiam gloriae augmentum, anathema sit._”

1321 See the article on “Merit” in the _Catholic Encyclopedia_.

_ 1322 V. supra_, Ch. II, Sect. 3, Thesis II.

1323 Sess. VI, cap. 8: “_Gratis autem iustificari ideo dicimur, quia nihil eorum quae iustificationem praecedunt, sive fides, sive opera, ipsam iustificationis gratiam promeretur; si enim gratia est, iam non ex operibus, alioquin, ut idem Apostolus inquit, gratia iam non est gratia._”

_ 1324 V. supra_, Sect. 2, No. 2.

_ 1325 De Natura et Gratia_, c. 4, n. 4: “_Haec Christi gratia, sine quâ nec infantes nec aetate grandes salvi fieri possunt, non meritis redditur, sed gratis datur, propter quod et gratia nominatur. Iustificati, inquit (Rom. III, 24; V, 4), gratis per sanguinem ipsius._”

1326 Cfr. _Conc. Trident._, Sess. VI, cap. 6; Sess. VI, cap. 3; Sess. XIV, cap. 4; _supra_, pp. 286 sqq.

1327 For a more exhaustive treatment of this topic consult Tepe, _Instit. Theol._, Vol. III, pp. 158 sqq.

1328 See, for example, Suarez, _De Gratia_, XII, 26: “_De auxiliis sufficientibus et necessariis, quae post aliquod meritum de condigno augmenti gratiae dantur, vel offeruntur, probabile est concomitanter cadere sub idem meritum de condigno augmenti gratiae; nam qui meretur de condigno aliquam formam, meretur quidquid connaturaliter sequitur ex tali forma vel ei connaturaliter debetur._” On the actual distribution of sufficient grace, v. _supra_, pp. 167 sqq.

_ 1329 V. supra_, pp. 392 sqq.

1330 For a fuller treatment cfr. Tepe, _Inst. Theol._, Vol. III, pp. 258 sqq., and Chr. Pesch, _Praelect. Dogmat._, Vol. V, 3rd ed., pp. 237 sqq.

_ 1331 V. supra_, Sect. 1.

1332 Sess. VI, cap. 16; v. _supra_, pp. 400 sq.

1333 Sess. VI, can. 32.

1334 Cfr. Suarez, _De Gratia_, XII, 29: "_Dicendum vitam aeternam et vitae aeternae consecutionem non esse duo praemia distincta, quia mereri mercedem et solutionem mercedis non sunt duae mercedes._"

1335 On the _reviviscentia meritorum_ see the treatise on the Sacrament of Penance, Vol. X of this series; cfr. also Schiffini, _De Gratia Divina_, pp. 661 sqq.

_ 1336 E.g._ Ripalda (_De Ente Supernat._, disp. 89, sect. 1) and De Lugo (_De Incarnatione_, disp. 3, n. 59).

_ 1337 V. supra_, Sect. 2, No. 2.

1338 Cfr. Suarez, _De Gratia_, XII, 28, and Vasquez, _Comment. in S. Theol._, 1a 2ae, disp. 219, c. 2.

1339 Despite Bellarmine's contradiction (_De Iustificatione_, V, 20.)

1340 Cfr. St. Thomas, _Summa Theol._, 1a 2ae, qu. 122, art. 2, ad 1: "_Praeparatio hominis ad gratiam habendam quaedam est simul cum ipsa infusione gratiae; et talis operatio est quidem meritoria, sed non gratiae quae iam habetur, sed gloriae quae nondum habetur._"

1341 Cfr. Tepe, _Instit. Theol._, Vol. III, pp. 266 sqq.

1342 Matth. XVI, 27: "_Et tunc reddet unicuique secundum opera eius_ (κατὰ τὴν πρᾶξιν αὐτοῦ)."

1343 1 Cor. III, 8: "_Unusquisque autem propriam mercedem (τὸν ἴδιον μισθόν) accipiet secundum suum laborem_ (κατὰ τὸν ἴδιον κόπον)."

1344 See Eschatology.

1345 Cfr. St. Thomas Aquinas, _Summa Theol._, 1a 2ae, qu. 114, art. 8.

_ 1346 De Praed. Sanctorum_, c. 2.

_ 1347 V. supra_, Sect. 2.

1348 Prominent among the dissenters is Billuart (_De Gratia_, diss. 8, art. 5).

_ 1349 Summa Theol._, 1a 2ae, qu. 114, art. 6, ad 2: "_Impetratio orationis innititur misericordiae, meritum autem condigni innititur iustitiae. Et ideo multa orando impetrat homo ex divina misericordia, quae tamen non meretur secundum iustitiam._"

1350 Ps. L, 19: "_Cor contritum et humiliatum Deus non despicies._"

1351 Dan. IV, 24: “_Peccata tua eleemosynis redime et iniquitates tuas misericordiis pauperum; forsitan ignoscet delictis tuis._”

_ 1352 Ep. ad Sixt._, 194, c. 3, n. 9: “_Sed nec ipsa remissio peccatorum sine aliquo merito est, si fides hanc impetret. Neque enim nullum est meritum fidei, quâ fide ille dicebat: Deus propitius esto mihi peccatori, et descendit iustificatus merito fidelis humilitatis._” Cfr. _Conc. Trident._, Sess. VI, cap. 7 (Denzinger-Bannwart, n. 799): “_Hanc dispositionem seu praeparationem iustificatio ipsa consequitur._” For a fuller treatment cfr. Suarez, _De Gratia_, XII, 37.

_ 1353 V. supra_, pp. 123 sqq. The student may also consult Tepe, _Instit. Theol._, Vol. III, pp. 258 sqq., and Bellarmine, _De Iustific._, V, 22.

_ 1354 Summa Theol._, 1a 2ae, qu. 114, art. 7: “_Respondeo dicendum quod nullus potest sibi mereri reparationem post lapsum futurum neque merito condigni neque merito congrui._”

_ 1355 Lect. in Hebr._, III, 6, 10: “_Duplex est meritum. Unum quod innititur iustitiae et istud est meritum condigni; aliud quod soli misericordiae innititur, quod dicitur meritum congrui. Et de isto dicit [Paulus], quod iustum est, i.e. congruum, quod homo, qui multa bona fecit, mereatur.... Et isto modo non obliviscitur Deus operis nostri et dilectionis._”

_ 1356 Comment. in Sent._, IV, dist. 2, qu. 1, art. 2.

_ 1357 Comment. in Sent._, II, dist. 28, dub. 2.

_ 1358 De Gratia_, XII, 38, 6.

1359 2 Paral. XIX, 2 sq.: “_Impio praebes auxilium et his, qui oderunt Dominum, amicitiâ iungeris et idcirco iram quidem Domini merebaris; sed bona opera inventa sunt in te._”

1360 Suarez, _De Gratia_, XII, 38, 7: “_Possunt enim praecedentia merita esse tam pauca et tot peccata postea multiplicata, ut omnino obruant merita et efficiant, ut nullo modo Deum ad misericordiam provocent; secus vero erit, si e contrario merita magna fuerint et peccatum subsequens et rarum sit et excusationem aliquam ex ignorantia vel infirmitate habeat._”

1361 Ps. LXX, 9: “_Quum defecerit virtus mea, ne derelinquas me._”

1362 Cfr. St. Thomas, _Summa Theol._, 1a 2ae, qu. 114, art. 7, ad 1: “_Desiderium, quo quis desiderat reparationem post lapsum, iustum dicitur; et similiter oratio, quâ petit eiusmodi reparationem, dicitur iusta, quia tendit ad iustitiam; non tamen ita quod iustitiae innitatur per modum meriti, sed solum misericordiae._” Cfr. Schiffini, _De Gratia Divina_, pp. 687 sq.

_ 1363 V. supra_, pp. 136 sqq.

_ 1364 Summa Theol._, 1a 2ae, qu. 114, art. 6: “_Quia enim homo in gratia constitutus implet Dei voluntatem, congruum est secundum amicitiae proportionem ut Deus impleat hominis voluntatem in salvatione alterius, licet quandoque possit habere impedimentum ex parte illius, cuius aliquis sanctus iustificationem

desiderat._”

1365 Iac. V, 16: “_Orate pro invicem, ut salvemini; multum enim valet deprecatio iusti assidua._”

_ 1366 E.g._ Abraham, Job, St. Stephen.

_ 1367 E.g._ St. Augustine and his mother St. Monica.

1368 Cfr. Suarez, _De Gratia_, XII, 38, 21.

_ 1369 Summa Theol._, 1a 2ae, qu. 114, art. 10: “_Dicendum est quod, si temporalia bona considerentur, prout sunt utilia ad opera virtutum, quibus perducimur in vitam aeternam, secundum hoc directe et simpliciter cadunt sub merito, sicut et augmentum gratiae et omnia illa, quibus homo adiuvatur ad perveniendum in beatitudinem post primam gratiam.... Si autem considerentur huiusmodi temporalia bona secundum se, sic non sunt simpliciter bona hominis, sed secundum quid, et ita non simpliciter cadunt sub merito, sed secundum quid, inquantum scil. homines moventur a Deo ad aliqua temporaliter agenda, quibus suum propositum consequuntur Deo favente._”

1370 Gen. XV, 1: “_Ego ... merces tua magna nimis._”